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1 Samuel

1 Samuel - Introduction

Part 1: General Introduction

Outline of 1 Samuel

1. Samuel as the last judge over Israel (1:1–7:17)
2. Samuel's birth and dedication to Yahweh (1:1–2:21)
3. Yahweh's judgment against Eli the priest and his family (2:22–3:21)
4. The Philistines capture and return the Box of Yahweh (4:1–6:21)
5. Samuel leads the people to repent and defeat the Philistines (7:1–17)
6. Saul becomes the first king of Israel (8:1–15:35)
7. Samuel agrees to choose a king (8:1–22)
8. Samuel anoints Saul as king (9:1–10:27)
9. Saul defeats the Ammonites (11:1–15)
10. Samuel's farewell speech (12:1–25)
11. Saul makes bad decisions and disobeys Yahweh (13:1–15:35)
12. Yahweh chooses David to be the next king of Israel (16:1–31:13)
13. Yahweh tells Samuel to anoint David (16:1–23)
14. David fights Goliath (17:1–58)
15. Jonathan befriends David, but Saul is jealous of David (18:1–20:42)
16. David flees from Saul to Philistia and the wilderness (21:1–30:31)
17. The Philistines kill Saul in battle (31:1–13)

What is the book of 1 Samuel about?
This book begins with the story of Samuel, who was the last of the judges over Israel. He anointed Saul to be the first king of Israel. Much of the book is about how Saul became king but then later sinned against Yahweh and died. Even while Saul was still alive, Yahweh chose David to be king after him. This book shows how God protected David when Saul tried to kill him.

What is the purpose of the book of 1 Samuel?
The book of 1 Samuel is the first of four books compiled by the prophets of Israel that together tell the story of the Israelite monarchy. The other books in this series are 2 Samuel, 1 Kings, and 2 Kings. Originally they were all one long book. The entire history shows that Yahweh was not at fault for the Israelites being conquered and exiled from their land. Instead, this happened because the people disobeyed Yahweh and broke their covenant with him.

Who wrote the book of 1 Samuel?
It is uncertain who wrote 1 Samuel. It may have been someone alive soon after King Solomon died. (Later prophets would have continued the story through the books of 1 Kings and 2 Kings.) After Solomon died, the kingdom of Israel split into two kingdoms. The author probably lived in the southern kingdom of Judah. A descendant of David continued to rule over the southern kingdom. The author may have written 1 Samuel to defend David's right to be king. This would prove that David's descendant was the rightful king of all the people of Israel.

The book of 1 Samuel makes two references to Israel and Judah, in 17:52 and 18:16. However, these references appear in the text in relation to events that took place long before the two kingdoms split apart. These references to Israel and Judah in the text suggest that the author wrote at a time after the kingdoms split. He wanted the readers to understand that all of the twelve tribes had originally supported David.

What title should translators use for this book?
Translators can use the traditional title "1 Samuel" or "First Samuel." Translators may also consider another title such as "The Book About Samuel, Saul, and David." (See: How to Translate Names)

Part 2: Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Book

Who is "Yahweh's anointed"?
The author and characters in 1 Samuel often use the phrase "Yahweh's anointed." To "anoint" means to pour oil on someone's head to show symbolically that they are assuming an office such as king or high priest. In this book, Samuel pours oil on Saul's head to show that God is making him the king (10:1) and he later pours oil on David's head to show that God will make him the next king (16:13). So the phrase "Yahweh's anointed" refers to the one whom Yahweh chose to be the king of his people. Its use in this book would make later readers think about the future descendant of David who would become king of God's people. This person who Yahweh chose would be known as the Messiah. (See: anoint, anointed, anointing; and people of God; and Christ, Messiah)

1 Samuel - Introduction

Part 3: Translation Issues in This Book

"And it happened"

The author often uses the phrase "And it happened" to introduce new event in the story or a new development within an episode. To translate this phrase in its various occurrences, use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event or development. (See: Introduction of a New Event)

"behold"

The author and characters often use the word "behold" to focus their listeners' attention on what they are about to say. While the word literally means "look," the speakers do not want their listeners to look at something, but to pay careful attention. (See: Metaphor)

curses

A curse is a strong statement that a person makes to cause bad things to happen to a person if that person does or does not do a certain thing. A curse usually has this pattern: "Thus may God do to you, and thus may he add, if you hide from me a word from all of the word that he spoke to you" (3:17). Other instances of curses are found in 14:44, 20:13, and 25:22. We recommend that you represent these curses in your language in a way that shows that they are strong, threatening statements.

"to this day"

In 1 Samuel 5:5, 6:18, and 27:6, and 30:25, the author uses the phrase "to this day." He is referring to the time when he was writing. The translator should be aware that "to this day" refers to a time that is now in the past. He must avoid giving the impression that the present day of the translation's readers is meant. The translator might decide to say "at the time when this is being written" or "at the time of this writing."

"in the eyes of"

The author and characters often use the common expression "in the eyes of" to mean in someone's estimation, opinion, or judgment. For example, Elkanah says to Hannah in 1:23, "Do the good in your eyes," meaning that she should do what she considers best. The author says in 8:6 that "the matter was evil in the eyes of Samuel," meaning that Samuel did not think that it was at all the right thing to do. (See: Idiom)

"to the face of" (before)

The author and characters often use the word "face" to represent the presence of a person or group, to represent the way people can see the face of someone who is present. The expression "to the face of" can have different shades of meaning, depending on the context. The focus may be more on the actual presence of a person, as in 17:57, where the author says that after David killed Goliath, one of Saul's generals "brought him to the face of Saul." In other words, he brought him into Saul's presence. The focus may also be on something being in front of or near a person or thing, such as in 9:23, where the author says that Samuel's cook took a special portion and "set it to the face of Saul." That means that he put it in front of him as he sat at the table. Or the focus may be on the relationship between people or groups, as in 3:1, where the author says that "Samuel was serving Yahweh before the face of Eli." This probably does not mean that Samuel was always in the presence of Eli. Rather, it means that he served at the tent of meeting under Eli's authority and supervision. (See: Metonymy)

"from the face of"

In other contexts, the author or a character may use the word "face," describing part of a person, in order to represent the whole person. For example, in 1 Samuel 21:10, the author says that David fled "from the face of Saul." He is using one part of Saul, his "face," to mean all of him in his determination to kill David. (See: Synecdoche)

"into the hand of" or "into your hand"

The author and characters often use the word "hand" to represent power and capability. For example, when the Philistines ask in 4:8, "Who will rescue us from the hand of these mighty gods?" they are asking who will deliver them from the power of these gods (mistakenly thinking that the Israelites worship a number of gods). The word "hand" may also represent possession, as when the author says in 7:8 that Gideon's soldiers "took provision into their hand." The word "hand" may also represent agency, as when the author speaks in 3:4 of the commandments that Yahweh gave the Israelites "by the hand of Moses." Notes will help distinguish the difference between these shades of meaning when that may not be clear from the context. (See: Metonymy)

"listen"

The author and characters often use the term "listen" to mean complying with what someone has said. For example, the author says in 2:25 that Eli's wicked sons "would not listen to the voice of their father," meaning that they refused to obey him. Samuel says to Yahweh in 3:10, "Speak, for your servant is listening," to indicate that he is ready to obey whatever Yahweh tells him. (See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information)

1 Samuel - Chapter 1 Introduction

name of a person representing him and associated or accompanying people
The author and characters often use the name of a person to represent that person and others who are associated with or accompanying that person. For example, in 2:11, when the author says that "Elkanah went to Ramah, to his house," he is using Elkanah, one person who was involved in this action, to represent everyone who was involved. The text makes clear that Elkanah's family accompanied him when he went to Shiloh. So the author means that Elkanah and his family returned together to their house in Ramah. (See: Synecdoche)

name of nation, tribe, or city representing its people
The author and characters often use the name of a nation, tribe, or city to represent its people. When a nation has the same name as its ancestor, this is the same thing as using the name of the ancestor to represent his descendants. For example, in 1:17, when Eli speaks of "the God of Israel," he is using the name of the nation of Israel to refer to its people, the Israelites. Since the Israelites were all descended from a man named Israel, Eli may also be using the name of an ancestor to represent his descendants. (See: Metonymy)

"saying"
The author frequently uses the term "saying" to introduce a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly. (See: Quotations and Quote Margins)

"sons of"
The author and characters often speak of "the sons of" a person to mean the nation or tribe that consists of his descendants. For example, in 2:28 a man of God speaks of the "sons of Israel" to mean the Israelites. In 12:12, Samuel speaks of the "sons of Ammon" to mean the Ammonites. In this case, "sons" does not mean first-generation offspring but later descendants. (See: Metaphor)

"struck"
In many places, the author says that soldiers "struck" an opposing army, city, or king as if they had only hit them. But in various contexts, he means that they either attacked, defeated, or killed those opponents. For example, when the author says in 11:11 that Saul and his soldiers "struck Ammon," he means that they attacked the Ammonite army. When he says in 4:2 that "Israel was struck to the face of the Philistines," he means that the Philistines defeated the Israelites. And when he says in that same verse that the Philistines "struck ... about 4,000 men," he means that they killed them. Consider carefully how to translate the term "struck" in each context where it does not actually mean "hit." (See: Metonymy)

"went up," "went down"
In Hebrew, writers and speakers generally indicated whether people were going up to a higher elevation or going down to a lower elevation when they traveled. For example, the author says in 1:3 that Elkanah and his family "went up" to Shiloh because they were traveling to a higher elevation. In 10:8, Samuel tells Saul to "go down" to Gilgal because that would be a journey to a lower elevation. If your language does not mark travel for change in elevation, you can translate instances such as these simply as "went" or "go." (See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit)

1 Samuel - Chapter 1 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter is the beginning of the first section of the book of 1 Samuel, chapters 1–7, which describe Samuel as a religious leader of Israel. This chapter tells how Samuel was born and how his parents dedicated him to Yahweh.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Why does the author use the name Ramathaim Zophim for Ramah in 1:1?
The author says in 1:1 that Elkanah was from a town called Ramathaim Zophim. However, in all subsequent references in the book, the author uses the name Ramah for the town where Elkanah and later his son Samuel lived. The word Ramathaim is the dual of the word Ramah, which means "hill." The city may have been built on two hills, and it may originally have had the name Ramathaim. This name may eventually have been shortened to Ramah, but the author may wish to use the original name for clarity and accuracy in his historical account. The author adds the term Zophim, meaning that this was where the descendants of a man named Zuph lived. He does this to distinguish this city from the three other cities in the land of Canaan that also had the name Ramah. In your translation, you could use the name Ramathaim Zophim and spell it the way it sounds in your language. However, if your readers might wonder why the author says in 1:19 that Elkanah and his family returned to "their house in Ramah," in 1:1 you could use a description such as "the city called Ramah where the descendants of Zuph live." (See: Copy or Borrow Words)

Why does the author call the tent of meeting the "temple" in 1:9?
The author says in 1:9 that the priest Eli was sitting by the doorpost of "the temple of Yahweh." However, Yahweh had no temple at this time. King Solomon built a temple for him in Jerusalem many years later. It could be that this account was written or edited after the temple was built and that the author knew that his readers would understand that he was using that term to mean generally the place where the Israelites worshiped Yahweh. Alternatively, the author could have been speaking of the tent of meeting in elevated language. The word that is often translated as "temple" can also mean "palace." The author may have felt that the place where Yahweh was present among his people deserved to be described in grand language as a temple or palace. However, if it would not be clear to your readers that in 1:9 he means the tent of meeting, you could use the word that you have been using in your translation for that structure. The UST models one way to do that.

Why does Elkanah say "may Yahweh raise up his word" when Yahweh has not said anything?
In 1:23, Elkanah says "may Yahweh raise up his word," that is, "may Yahweh do what he has said," even though the author has not recorded Yahweh saying anything. It could be that Elkanah is referring to what Eli said to Hannah in 1:17, "may the God of Israel grant your request." Elkanah would be considering that what Yahweh's priest had spoken constituted a "word" from Yahweh himself. Hannah's request involved not only her having a son but that son having a long life throughout which he was specially dedicated to God and effective in his service. Elkanah could be wishing that Yahweh would make all of these things happen. Another possibility is that the term translated as "word" could have the meaning of "thing" or "matter" in this context. In that case Elkanah would be saying "may Yahweh accomplish his purpose" for the child. He would not be referring to anything that Yahweh had explicitly said.

What "vow" did Elkanah make?
In 1:21, the author says that Elkanah went to Shiloh to sacrifice a "vow." He is referring to a sacrifice that Elkanah had promised to make, and he assumes that readers will understand what he means by this. However, he has not described Elkanah making a vow. The most probable explanation is that the previous year, Hannah had told Elkanah that Eli had said to her, "may the God of Israel grant your request." Elkanah would then have made a vow that if God would indeed grant this request, he would offer a special sacrifice. Some interpreters suggest that Elkanah made this vow when, as 1:19 says, the family worshiped Yahweh the morning after Eli spoke with Hannah. However, since the text does not state any of this explicitly, it would probably be best to express the meaning of the term "vow" without saying what Elkanah vowed or when. A note to 1:21 suggests one way to do that.

1 Samuel 1:1 (#1)

וַיְהִי֩ אִ֨ישׁ אֶחָ֜ד

"Now {there} was a man"

The author is using this phrase to introduce Elkanah as a new participant in the story. If your language has its own way of introducing new participants, you can use it here in your translation. Alternate translation: [There once was a man]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Samuel 1:1 (#2)

הָרָמָתַ֥יִם צוֹפִ֛ים

"Ramathaim Zophim"

The word **Ramathaim Zophim** is the name of a city. This is the same city that the author calls Ramah in the rest of the book. See the discussion in the Introduction to 1 Samuel of why he uses a different name here.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 1:2 (#1)

הַשֵּׁנִ֑ית

"the second"

If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you can use a cardinal number here or an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [the other]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Samuel 1:3 (#3)

מִיָּמִ֥ים ׀ יָמִ֖ימָה

"from days to days"

In Hebrew, the plural **days** can mean a year. That is the meaning in this context. Alternate translation: [from year to year]

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

1 Samuel 1:3 (#1)

הָאִ֣ישׁ הַה֗וּא

"that man"

The author is speaking of Elkanah to mean him and his entire family. The text makes clear in the next two verses that his wives and children accompanied him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that man and his family]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 1:3 (#2)

וְעָלָהּ֙ הָאִ֣ישׁ הַה֔וּא

“And that man went up”

See the discussion in the Introduction to 1 Samuel of how Hebrew speakers and writers marked travel for change in elevation. The author says **up** here because Shiloh was at a higher elevation than the city where Elkanah and his family lived. Alternate translation: [And that man went]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 1:4 (#1)

וַיְהִ֣י הַיּ֔וֹם וַיִּזְבַּ֖ח אֶלְקָנָ֑ה וְנָתַ֤ן

“And it was the day, and Elkanah sacrificed, and he gave”

The author is using the term **day** to represent a specific time or occasion. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And on each occasion when Elkanah sacrificed, he gave]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 1:5 (#1)

מָנָ֣ה אַחַ֔ת אַפַּ֖יִם כִּֽי

“one portion {for} two faces, for”

The author is using one part of two people, their **faces**, to mean the people themselves. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a portion large enough to feed two people] or [a double portion]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 1:5 (#2)

וַיהוָ֖ה סָגַ֥ר רַחְמָֽהּ

“but Yahweh had shut her womb”

The author is using the idea of a **womb** opening to release a child into the world to mean the ability to have children. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [but Yahweh had prevented her from having children]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 1:6 (#1)

וְכָעֲסַתָּ֣הּ צָרָתָ֔הּ גַּם־כַּ֖עַס

“but her adversary also provoked her {with} provocation”

For emphasis, the author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [greatly provoked her]

See: Poetry

1 Samuel 1:6 (#3)

הַרְּעִמָ֑הּ

“to make her thunder”

The author is speaking as if Hannah would actually **thunder**. He means that Peninnah would try to make her so upset that she would speak loudly and emotionally. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [to make her explode] or [to make her lose her composure]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 1:6 (#4)

כִּֽי־סָגַ֥ר יְהוָ֖ה בְּעַ֥ד רַחְמָֽהּ

“because Yahweh had shut up her womb”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:5.

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 1:6 (#2)

צָרָתָ֔הּ

“her adversary”

The author assumes that readers will know that by **her adversary**, he means Peninnah. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [but Peninnah]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 1:7 (#1)

וְכֵ֣ן יַעֲשֶׂ֔ה

“And thus he did”

The author assumes that readers will know that by **thus he did**, he means that Elkanah gave portions to his wives and children as he has described. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And Elkanah gave these portions to his family]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 1:7 (#2)

עֲלֹתָהּ֙ & תַּכְעִסֶ֔נָּה וַתִּבְכֶּ֖ה

“her going up & she would provoke her. And she wept”

The first instances of **her** and **she** refer to Peninnah, while the second instances of **her** and **she** refer to Hannah. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Peninnah’s going up ... Peninnah would provoke Hannah. And Hannah wept]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 1:8 (#2)

וְלָ֣מָּה יֵרַ֣ע לִבֶּ֑ךָ

“And why is your heart bad”

Elkanah is using a common expression of his culture to mean that Hannah feeling badly. He does not mean that she is entertaining any wrong thoughts. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And why are you feeling badly]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 1:8 (#1)

חַנָּ֣ה׀ לָ֣מָּה תִבְכִּ֗י וְלָ֙מָּה֙ לֹ֣א תֹאכְלִ֔י וְלָ֥מָּה יֵרַ֖ע לִבֶּ֑ךָ הֲלוֹא֙ אָנֹכִ֣י טֽוֹב לְךָ֔ מֵֽעֲשָׂרָ֖ה בָּנִֽים

“Hannah, why do you weep? And why do you not eat? And why is your heart bad? {Am} I not better for you than ten sons”

Elkanah is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Hannah, you should not weep. You should eat. Your heart should not be bad. I am better for you than ten sons!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 1:9 (#5)

הֵיכַ֥ל

“the temple of”

See the discussion in the Introduction to this chapter of why the author uses the term **temple** here. Alternate translation: [the tent of meeting]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 1:9 (#2)

אַחֲרֵ֣י אָכְלָ֔ה & וְאַחֲרֵ֖י שָׁתֹֽתָה

“after eating and after drinking”

Elkanah assumes that readers will know that by **after eating and after drinking** he means after the others had finished eating and drinking. He said in verse 7 that Hannah herself did not eat. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [after the others had finished eating and drinking]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 1:9 (#1)

וַתָּ֥קָם חַנָּ֖ה

“And Hannah arose”

While in this context the term **arose** could refer to getting up from sitting or reclining at a table for a meal, the author could be using it here to mean that Hannah took action to address her situation by going to the tent of meeting and praying to Yahweh. Alternate translation: [And Hannah took action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 1:9 (#4)

יֹשֵׁב֙ עַל־הַכִּסֵּ֔א עַל־מְזוּזַ֖ת הֵיכַ֥ל

“was sitting on a seat by the doorpost of the temple of”

Sitting by the doorpost was a symbolic action that indicated that Eli, as a priest, would listen to people’s concerns and try to address them. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [was sitting on a seat by the doorpost of the temple to show that he was available to listen to people’s concerns]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 1:9 (#3)

וְעֵלִ֣י הַכֹּהֵ֗ן יֹשֵׁב֙ עַל־הַכִּסֵּ֔א עַל־מְזוּזַ֖ת הֵיכַ֥ל יְהוָֽה

“Now Eli the priest was sitting on a seat by the doorpost of the temple of Yahweh”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 1:10 (#1)

וְהִ֖יא מְמֶ֣רַת נָֽפֶשׁ

“And she {was} bitter of soul”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean that Hannah was deeply distressed. He does not mean that she was harboring any feelings of bitterness or thoughts of revenge. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And she was deeply distressed]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 1:10 (#2)

וּבָכֹ֥ה תִבְכֶּֽה

“and weeping, she wept”

The author is repeating the verb **wept** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [and she wept bitterly]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 1:11 (#5)

וּזְכַרְתַּ֨נִי֙ וְלֹא־תִשְׁכַּ֣ח אֶת־אֲמָתֶ֔ךָ

“and remember me and not forget your female servant”

Hannah is speaking as if Yahweh actually needs to be reminded of her. In contexts such as this, the term **remember** describes Yahweh thinking about a person or group and considering what action he can take on their behalf. It does not suggest that God ever forgets about people. Alternate translation: [and surely take action to help me]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 1:11 (#8)

וּמוֹרָ֖ה לֹא־יַעֲלֶ֥ה עַל־רֹאשֹֽׁו

“and a razor will not go up on his head”

This is an expression that people of this culture commonly used to describe cutting the hair on a person’s head. Alternate translation: [No one will ever cut his hair]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 1:11 (#1)

וַתִּדֹּ֥ר נֶ֖דֶר

“And she vowed a vow”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [And she made a vow]

See: Poetry

1 Samuel 1:11 (#6)

לַֽיהוָ֑ה

“to Yahweh”

Hannah is speaking to Yahweh, but she is respectfully using the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the second person. Alternate translation: [to you, Yahweh,]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 1:11 (#9)

וּמוֹרָ֖ה לֹא־יַעֲלֶ֥ה עַל־רֹאשֹֽׁו

“and a razor will not go up on his head”

Not cutting one’s hair was a symbolic action that indicated a vow of dedication to Yahweh. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [and to show that he has been dedicated to Yahweh, no one will ever cut his hair]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 1:11 (#2)

אִם־רָאֹ֤ה תִרְאֶה֙

“if looking, you will look”

Hannah is repeating the verb **look** in order to intensify her expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [if you will indeed look]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 1:11 (#4)

וּזְכַרְתַּנִי֙ וְלֹא־תִשְׁכַּ֣ח אֶת־אֲמָתֶ֔ךָ

“and remember me and not forget your female servant”

The terms **remember** and **not forget** mean similar things. Hannah is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [and surely remember me]

See: Doublet

1 Samuel 1:11 (#3)

אֲמָתֶ֔ךָ & אֶת־אֲמָתְךָ֖ וְנָתַתָּ֣ה לַאֲמָתְךָ֑

“your female servant & your female servant and give to your female servant”

Hannah is speaking about herself humbly in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [me, your female servant, ... me but give to me]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 1:11 (#7)

כָּל־יְמֵ֣י חַיָּ֔יו

“all of the days of his life”

Hannah is using the term **days** to represent a specific time, Samuel’s lifetime. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for his entire life]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 1:12 (#2)

הִרְבְּתָ֖ה לְהִתְפַּלֵּ֣ל

“she made much to pray”

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two verbs together. The verb **made much** tells in what way Hannah prayed. Alternate translation: [she prayed extensively]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 1:12 (#1)

וְהָיָה֙

“And it happened”

See the discussion of this phrase in the Introduction to 1 Samuel. The author is using this phrase to introduce a new event in the story. Here and in the other instances throughout the book, use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 1:12 (#3)

לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָֽה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See the discussion of the phrase **to the face of** in the Introduction to 1 Samuel. Here, **to the face of** represents being in the presence of Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the presence of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 1:13 (#2)

עַל־לִבָּ֑הּ

“in her heart”

Here, the **heart** represents the thoughts. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in her thoughts] or [to herself]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 1:13 (#3)

וְקוֹלָ֖הּ לֹ֣א יִשָּׁמֵ֑עַ

“and her voice was not heard”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [so no one heard her voice]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 1:13 (#1)

וְחַנָּ֕ה הִ֥יא מְדַבֶּ֖רֶת עַל־לִבָּ֑הּ

“Now Hannah, she was speaking in her heart”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 1:14 (#1)

עַד־מָתַי תִּשְׁתַּכָּרִין

“Until when will you make yourself drunk”

Eli is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You must stop making yourself drunk!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 1:15 (#2)

אֲדֹנִי

“my lord”

Hannah is referring to Eli by a respectful title. Use a comparable title or expression for addressing someone respectfully in your language. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [sir]

See: Politeness

1 Samuel 1:15 (#3)

וְאֶשְׁפֹּךְ אֶת־נַפְשִׁי

“but I have been pouring out my soul”

Hannah is speaking as if her **soul** were a liquid that she could pour out. She means that she has been expressing her deepest feelings to Yahweh. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but I have been expressing my deepest feelings]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 1:15 (#4)

וְאֶשְׁפֹּךְ אֶת־נַפְשִׁי

“but I have been pouring out my soul”

Hannah is using one part of herself, her **soul**, to mean all of herself in the act of praying. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but I have been expressing myself completely]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 1:15 (#1)

וַתֹּאמֶר

“and said”

The expression **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this expression explicitly. Alternate translation: [And Hannah replied]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 1:16 (#2)

אֶת־אֲמָתְךָ

“your female servant”

Hannah is speaking about herself humbly in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [me, your female servant]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 1:16 (#3)

בַּת־בְּלִיָּעַל

“a daughter of wickedness”

In certain contexts, the biblical text uses the expression **daughter of** to indicate that a person shares the qualities of something. That is the case here. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a wicked woman]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 1:16 (#1)

אַל־תִּתֵּן אֶת־אֲמָתְךָ לִפְנֵי בַּת־בְּלִיָּעַל

“Do not give your female servant to the face of a daughter of wickedness”

Hannah is speaking as if Eli might put her in front of a **daughter of wickedness**, meaning that he might make her a servant or slave of such a person. This represents Eli thinking that Hannah was such a person. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not think that your maidservant is a daughter of wickedness]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 1:16 (#4)

מֵרֹ֣ב שִׂיחִ֔י וְכַעְסִ֖י דִּבַּ֥רְתִּי עַד־הֵֽנָּה

“from the abundance of my complaint and my provocation I have been speaking until now”

Hannah is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. In your translation, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [I have been provoked greatly, and that is why I have been speaking so much until now to ask Yahweh to help me]

See: Order of Events

1 Samuel 1:17 (#1)

וַיַּ֥עַן

“and said”

See whether you represented the expression **and said** in 1:15. Alternate translation: [And Eli replied]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 1:17 (#3)

וֵאלֹהֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל יִתֵּ֕ן

“And may the God of Israel grant”

As the Introduction to 1 Samuel discusses, Eli is using the name **Israel** to represent his descendants. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And may the God of us Israelites grant]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 1:17 (#4)

אֶת־שֵׁ֣לְתֵּ֔ךְ אֲשֶׁ֥ר שָׁאַ֖לְתְּ מֵעִמּֽוֹ

“your request that you requested from him”

Eli is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [the request that you have made of him]

See: Poetry

1 Samuel 1:17 (#2)

לְכִ֥י לְשָׁלֽוֹם

“Go in peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Go peacefully]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 1:18 (#2)

שִׁפְחָתְךָ֔

“your maidservant”

Hannah is speaking about herself humbly in the third person as Eli’s **maidservant**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [me, your maidservant]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 1:18 (#5)

וּפָנֶ֖יהָ לֹא־הָי֣וּ לָ֑הּ עֽוֹד

“And her face was no longer to her”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. You could also express the meaning in plain language. Alternate translation: [And her sad face was no longer to her] or [And her face was no longer sad]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 1:18 (#1)

תִּמְצָ֤א שִׁפְחָתְךָ֙ חֵ֣ן בְּעֵינֶ֔יךָ

“May your maidservant find favor in your eyes”

See the discussion in the Introduction to 1 Samuel of this use of the expression “in the eyes of.” Hannah is using the common expression of her culture **in your eyes** to refer to the judgment or opinion of Eli. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [May your maidservant find favor in your judgment] or [May you think favorably of your maidservant]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 1:18 (#3)

שִׁפְחָתְךָ֔

“your maidservant”

Hannah is using a different term than she used previously, which the ULT translates as “female servant.” The term that she uses here refers to a lower-rank-

ing member of the household. If your language and culture have different terms for female servants of different rank, use the term for a female servant of lower rank here.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 1:18 (#4)

וַתֹּאכַל

“and she ate”

Hannah **ate** as a symbolic action that showed she was no longer too distressed to eat. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [and she began eating again, showing that she was no longer distressed]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 1:19 (#1)

וַיֵּדַע אֶלְקָנָהוּ אֶת־חַנָּֽה

“And Elkanah knew Hannah”

The author is speaking in a polite way about a private matter. Your language may have a similar discreet expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [And Elkanah slept with Hannah]

See: Euphemism

1 Samuel 1:19 (#2)

וַיִּזְכְּרֶהָ יְהוָֽה

“and Yahweh remembered her”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:11. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh helped her]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 1:20 (#1)

לִתְקֻפּוֹת הַיָּמִים וַתַּהַר חַנָּה וַתֵּלֶד בֵּֽן

“in the turning of the days, that Hannah conceived and bore a son”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to describe one period of time ending and another one beginning. This could mean: (1) that the author, as in 1:3, is using the plural form **days** to mean a year. Alternate translation: [by that time the next year, that she had conceived and borne a son]; (2) that the author is referring to Hannah’s pregnancy reaching full term and ending in childbirth. In that case, he would mean that she **conceived** to begin this period and that she **bore a son** at the end of it. Alternate translation: [that Hannah conceived and, when she had reached full term, she bore a son]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 1:20 (#3)

כִּֽי מֵיְהוָ֖ה שְׁאִלְתִּֽיו

“for “I requested him from Yahweh”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [for she said, “I requested him from Yahweh]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 1:20 (#2)

וַתִּקְרָ֥א אֶת־שְׁמ֖וֹ

“And she called his name”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [And she called him]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 1:20 (#4)

שְׁמוּאֵ֑ל

“Samuel”

The name Samuel sounds like the words in the Hebrew language that mean “heard by God.” If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain this in the text of your translation or in a footnote.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 1:20 (#5)

כִּֽי מֵיְהוָ֖ה שְׁאִלְתִּֽיו

“for “I requested him from Yahweh”

It may be more natural in your language to have an indirect quotation here. Alternate translation: [since she had requested him from Yahweh]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Samuel 1:21 (#1)

וְכָל־בֵּיתָ֑וֹ

“and all of his house”

The author is using the term **house** to represent Elkanah's family. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and all of his family]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 1:21 (#4)

אֶת־זֶ֣בַח הַיָּמִ֔ים

"the sacrifice of the days"

As in 1:3, the author is using the plural form **days** to mean a year. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the yearly sacrifice]

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

1 Samuel 1:21 (#2)

וְכָל־בֵּיתֽוֹ

"and all of his house"

The author is making an overstatement for emphasis. He means that most of Elkanah's family went with him. The next verse explains that Hannah did not go with him on this occasion. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [and most of his family]

See: Hyperbole

1 Samuel 1:21 (#3)

לִזְבֹּ֥חַ לַיהוָ֖ה אֶת־זֶ֥בַח

"to sacrifice to Yahweh the sacrifice of"

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [to offer to Yahweh the sacrifice of]

See: Poetry

1 Samuel 1:21 (#5)

וְאֶת־נִדְרֽוֹ

"and his vow"

See the discussion of the term **vow** here in the Introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [and a sacrifice that he had promised to make]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 1:22 (#5)

אֶת־פְּנֵ֣י יְהוָ֑ה

"at the face of Yahweh"

Hannah is using the term **face** to represent Yahweh's presence. While the usual expression is "to the face," here Hannah says **at the face**, perhaps to describe Samuel coming into Yahweh's presence and remaining there. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the presence of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 1:22 (#1)

עַ֣ד יִגָּמֵ֣ל הַנַּ֔עַר

"Until the boy is weaned"

Hannah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Let me wait until the boy is weaned]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 1:22 (#2)

עַ֣ד יִגָּמֵ֣ל הַנַּ֔עַר

"Until the boy is weaned"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Until I have weaned the boy]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 1:22 (#3)

וְנִרְאָ֥ה אֶת־פְּנֵ֖י יְהוָ֑ה

"And he will be seen at the face of Yahweh"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And he will appear at the face of Yahweh]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 1:22 (#4)

וְנִרְאָ֥ה אֶת־פְּנֵ֖י יְהוָ֑ה

"And he will be seen at the face of Yahweh"

When Hannah says **he will be seen**, she is using a common expression of her culture. This is similar to

the expression “was found” in 13:22. If something was seen or was found in a place, this means that it was in that place. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he will be at the face of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 1:23 (#5)

אֶת־דְּבָרֹו

“his word”

The author is using the term **word** to represent what Yahweh promised by using words, speaking through Eli. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [what he said]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 1:23 (#4)

יָקֵם יְהוָה אֶת־דְּבָרֹו

“may Yahweh raise up his word”

When Elkanah says **his word**, he means what Yahweh promised through Eli when Eli said to Hannah, “may the God of Israel grant your request.” You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [may Yahweh fulfill what he promised through Eli]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 1:23 (#2)

בְּעֵינַיִךְ

“in your eyes”

See how you translated this expression in 1:18. Alternate translation: [in your judgment]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 1:23 (#1)

עֲשֵׂה הַטּוֹב בְּעֵינַיִךְ

“Do the good in your eyes”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **good**, you could express the same idea in another way, such as by using “good” as an adjective. Alternate translation: [Do what seems good to you]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 1:23 (#3)

יָקֵם יְהוָה אֶת־דְּבָרֹו

“may Yahweh raise up his word”

Elkanah is speaking as if Yahweh’s **word** were an object that Yahweh could **raise up** to a high position. He means that he wants Yahweh to fulfill what he has promised. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [may Yahweh fulfill what he has promised]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 1:24 (#4)

וְהַנַּעַר נָעַר

“Now the boy was a boy”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand an important detail in the story. He means that Samuel, the **boy**, was still very young, only a little **boy**. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 1:24 (#1)

בְּפָרִים שְׁלֹשָׁה וְאֵיפָה אַחַת קֶמַח וְנֵבֶל יָיִן

“with three bulls and one ephah {of} flour and a skin of wine”

The author assumes that readers will know that Hannah brought these things to be used as sacrifices. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [with three bulls and one ephah of flour and a skin of wine that she planned to offer as sacrifices]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 1:24 (#2)

וְאֵיפָה אַחַת קֶמַח

“and one ephah {of} flour”

This **ephah** was equivalent to 22 liters or nearly six gallons. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this in terms of modern measurements, either in the text or in a footnote.

See: Biblical Volume

1 Samuel 1:24 (#3)

בֵּית־יְהוָה

“to} the house of Yahweh”

The author is speaking as if Yahweh actually lived in a **house**. This was a way of describing the tent of meet-

ing, where Yahweh was present. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to the tent where Yahweh was present]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 1:25 (#1)

אֶת־הַפָּֽר

“the bull”

The author assumes that readers will know that by **the bull**, he means one of the three bulls that Hannah brought. The family had decided to sacrifice this particular one as a whole burnt offering to consecrate Samuel to Yahweh’s service. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [one bull as a whole burnt offering to consecrate Samuel to Yahweh’s service]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 1:26 (#1)

אֲדֹנִי

“my lord”

See how you translated the same expression in 1:15.

See: Politeness

1 Samuel 1:26 (#2)

חֵֽי נַפְשְׁךָ

“The life of your soul”

Following the custom of her culture, Hannah is swearing an oath by guaranteeing it by something she holds sacred, the life of Yahweh’s high priest. Use a natural way in your language to express an oath.

See: Oath Formulas

1 Samuel 1:26 (#3)

חֵֽי נַפְשְׁךָ

“The life of your soul”

Hannah is using one part of Eli, his **soul**, to mean all of him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [As you are alive]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 1:27 (#1)

אֶת־שְׁאֵלָתִי אֲשֶׁר שָׁאַלְתִּי מֵעִמּוֹ

“my request that I requested from him”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [what I requested from him]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 1:28 (#2)

כָּל־הַיָּמִים אֲשֶׁר הָיָֽה

“all of the days that he is”

The author is using the term **days** to represent a period of time, Samuel’s lifetime. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for his entire life]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 1:28 (#1)

אֲנִכְי הִשְׁאִלְתִּהוּ לַיהוָֽה

“I have granted him to Yahweh”

Hannah is using the past tense to describe something that she is about to do. She is doing that to indicate that she is certainly going to do this. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use the present or future tense. Alternate translation: [I will grant him to Yahweh] or [I am now granting him to Yahweh]

See: Predictive Past

1 Samuel 1:28 (#3)

הוּא שָׁאוּל לַיהוָֽה

“he {is} granted to Yahweh”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I have granted him to Yahweh]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 1:28 (#4)

וַיִּשְׁתַּחוּ שָׁם לַיהוָֽה

“And he worshiped Yahweh there”

The pronoun **he** could refer to: (1) Eli. The implication could be that Eli was moved to praise Yahweh for answering Hannah’s prayer and for Hannah’s generous dedication of her son to Yahweh. Alternate translation: [And Eli praised Yahweh there because of what

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Hannah told him]; (2) Elkanah. The implication could be that Elkanah then led his family in offering the sacrifice that consecrated Samuel to Yahweh's service. Alternate translation: [And Elkanah then led his family in the worship of Yahweh there]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel - Chapter 2 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the first section of the book, chapters 1–7, which describe Samuel as a religious leader of Israel. This chapter tells how Samuel's mother Hannah celebrated his birth with a song. It also tells how the sons of the high priest Eli dishonored Yahweh by stealing from his offerings. This information leads into the action of the next chapter, in which Samuel has a central role.

Some translations set each line of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with Hannah's poetic prayer in 2:1–10.

Religious and Cultural Issues in This Chapter

Why did Hannah speak of a "king" when Israel had no king?

Hannah says at the end of her prayer that Yahweh will "give strength to his king and lift up the horn of his anointed one" (2:10). Israel had no king at this time. However, the people may have been expecting that Yahweh might soon appoint a king for them. The law of Moses said in Deuteronomy 17:14–20 that Israel could have a king, and it described there what kind of person he had to be and how he needed to conduct himself. The enemies of the Israelites were trying to conquer their territory, and the Israelites were wishing for a king to defend them, as Samuel describes in 12:12. It was the baby whose birth Hannah was celebrating in this prayer, Samuel, whom Yahweh told to anoint Saul as Israel's first king and then to anoint David as a king who would obey him more faithfully. So it seems that Yahweh also gave Hannah prophetic insight into what he would soon do for Israel through her son. That is why she was able to speak confidently in this prayer about what Yahweh would do for Israel's king.

What should have happened when people brought sacrifices?

The law of Moses said that when Israelites brought animals to Yahweh as sacrifices, they should slaughter the animal and cut it into pieces. They should lift up the breast and the fat to offer them to Yahweh and that a priest should burn the fat. The priest could then roast and eat the breast. The people would boil the rest of the meat from the animal. The law told them to give the right thigh to the priest. But the people could then eat the rest of the animal with their family and friends as a festive meal. The law of Moses also said that the people making the sacrifice should cut the fat off the meat and that the priests should burn this fat as a sacrifice to Yahweh. In this chapter, the author describes how Eli's sons disobeyed these regulations and took more for themselves from the sacrifices than they were entitled to have. This was disrespectful and dishonoring to Yahweh, as a prophet tells Eli in this chapter and as Yahweh tells Samuel in the next chapter.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Poetry in Hannah's prayer

In several places in her prayer in verses 1–10, Hannah speaks consecutive phrases that mean basically the same thing. The second phrase emphasizes the meaning of the first one by repeating the same idea with different words. Hebrew poetry made frequent use of this kind of repetition, and it would be good to show this to your readers by including both phrases in your translation rather than combining them. It may be clearer in your language to connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. For example, in verse 1 you might say, "My heart rejoices in Yahweh, indeed, my horn is high in Yahweh." (See: Parallelism)

Hannah's use of the third person

In her prayer, although she is addressing Yahweh, Hannah speaks about him respectfully in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this consistently in the first person. For example, as the UST illustrates, you could say "you, Yahweh" rather than simply "Yahweh." (See: First, Second or Third Person)

thunder

A note to 2:10 explains that in her prayer, Hannah uses the term "thunder" to speak of God's impending judgment against those who oppose him. That note suggests that you could express the idea behind the term with a phrase about impending judgement. However, the author uses this same term "thunder" in 1:6 to mean that Peninnah was trying to make Hannah so upset that she would lose control of her emotions. Hannah is saying here, in effect, "Be careful of trying to cause thunder—you might make Yahweh thunder against you!" So that your readers can recognize this connection, you may wish to retain the thunder image

in your translation and use the same term in 1:6 as in 2:10. (See: Metaphor)

Why does the author say "at the face of" instead of "to the face of" in verses 11, 17, and 18?
In three places in this chapter, the author slightly varies the usual phrase "to the face of" and says "at the face of." In 2:11, the word "at" probably indicates that Samuel was serving Yahweh not just in the presence of Eli but together with him, under his guidance and direction. In 2:17, the word "at" may indicate that Eli's sons were not just committing a great sin in the presence of Yahweh but against him personally, against his honor and holiness. In 2:18, conversely, the word "at" may indicate that Samuel was not merely serving Yahweh in his presence but with personal devotion. For each verse, a note suggests a way to express these possible meanings, and the UST models another way to do that. (See: Metonymy)

The author's reintroduction of participants
In this chapter, after Hannah's prayer, the author alternates between describing the wickedness of Eli's sons and the growth of Samuel into a godly young man. He does this to draw a contrast that shows why Yahweh ultimately chose to replace the descendants of Eli with a different line of priests and to have Samuel lead the nation. The author alternately reintroduces Eli or his sons and Samuel at 2:12, 2:18, 2:22, and 2:26, and he introduces the "man of God" as a new participant in 2:27. Your language may have its own way of introducing or reintroducing participants that you can use in your translation in these places. (See: Introduction of New and Old Participants)

A long quotation within a quotation in 2:27–36
When the man of God speaks to Eli in 2:27–36, first he attributes what he says to Yahweh, then he communicates Yahweh's message. As a result, there is a long second-level quotation (that is, a quotation within a quotation) in these verses. In 2:36, it becomes a third-level quotation. If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there it is all a first-level quotation. For example, changing the text of the ULT only slightly, in 2:27 you might say, "Yahweh asks you whether revealing himself, he did not reveal himself to the house of your father in their being in Egypt, to the house of Pharaoh." In 2:28 you might say, "Yahweh says that he chose him from all of the tribes of Israel for himself for a priest, to go up on his altar, to burn incense, to wear an ephod to his face. He says that he gave to the house of your father all of the gifts of the sons of Israel." The UST models further ways of translating this part of the chapter so that there are not quotations within quotations. (See: Quotes within Quotes)

A "faithful" priest or an "established" priest (2:35)?
In 2:35, the word that the ULT translates as "faithful" is actually the same word that it translates as "established" in the second part of that verse and in 3:20. Yahweh could be saying that Samuel will be an "established priest" in the sense that he and his descendants will serve "all of the days," that is, perpetually, by contrast with the descendants of Eli. In that case, 3:20 would be a confirmation of what Yahweh says here. However, the immediate context suggests that Yahweh may be using the same term in two different senses, as was common in prophetic speech, which often had poetic characteristics. Yahweh says that this priest "will do just as is in my heart and in my soul," meaning that he will be loyal and obedient. That is why ULT translates the term as "faithful." But the term really could have either meaning. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of ULT.

1 Samuel 2:1 (#1)

וַתֹּאמַ֖ר

"and said"

The expression **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this expression explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 2:1 (#3)

עָלַ֥ץ לִבִּ֛י

"My heart rejoices"

Hannah is using one part of her, her **heart**, representing her thoughts and feelings, to mean all of her in the act of rejoicing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I rejoice]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 2:1 (#9)

בִּישׁוּעָתֶֽךָ

"in your salvation"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **salvation**, you could express the same idea in

another way. Alternate translation: [the way you have saved me]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 2:1 (#2)

עָלַ֥ץ לִבִּ֖י בַּיהוָ֑ה רָ֥מָה קַרְנִ֖י בַּיהוָ֔ה

“My heart rejoices in Yahweh, my horn is high in Yahweh”

See the discussion in the Introduction to this chapter of how Hebrew poetry frequently uses pairs of phrases that mean basically the same thing, in which the second phrase emphasizes the meaning of the first phrase by repeating the same idea in different words. Consider that discussion and decide as a team how you will translate instances of that usage here and throughout verses 1–10.

See: Parallelism

1 Samuel 2:1 (#7)

רָחַ֤ב פִּי֙ עַל־אֹיְבַ֔י

“My mouth {is} wide against my enemies”

Hannah is using the idea of opening her **mouth wide** to represent speaking boldly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I speak boldly against my enemies]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 2:1 (#8)

אֹיְבַ֔י

“my enemies”

Hannah assumes that readers will know that by **enemies** she means people such as Peninnah, who has mocked her for being childless. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [those who have mocked me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 2:1 (#4)

בַּיהוָ֑ה & בַּיהוָ֔ה

“in Yahweh & in Yahweh”

As the Introduction to this chapter discusses, although Hannah is addressing Yahweh, she is speaking about him respectfully in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the second person, here and throughout her prayer. Alternate translation: [in you, Yahweh, ... in you, Yahweh]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 2:1 (#6)

רָחַ֤ב פִּי֙ עַל־אֹיְבַ֔י כִּֽי־שָׂמַ֥חְתִּי בִישׁוּעָתֶֽךָ

“My mouth {is} wide against my enemies, for I rejoice in your salvation”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Because I rejoice in your salvation, my mouth is wide against my enemies]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 2:1 (#5)

רָ֥מָה קַרְנִ֖י בַּיהוָ֔ה

“my horn is high in Yahweh”

Hannah is speaking as if she were an animal that had a **horn** that she could life up **high**. An animal that lifts its horn is demonstrating strength and assertiveness. Accordingly, in this culture, a horn represented strength and dignity. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh has given me strength and dignity]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 2:2 (#1)

וְאֵ֥ין צ֖וּר כֵּאלֹהֵֽינוּ

“and {there is} no rock like our God”

Hannah is speaking as if God were a **rock**. She means that he provides protection and security, just as people could find safety by climbing up on a high rock or by hiding among rocks. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and no one provides protection as our God does]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 2:3 (#3)

גְּבֹהָ֥ה גְבֹהָ֖ה

“haughty, haughty”

Hannah is repeating the word **haughty** in order to intensify her expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification,

it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [you very haughty person]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 2:3 (#5)

יֵצֵ֥א עָתָ֖ק מִפִּיכֶֽם

“Let the arrogant go out from your mouth”

Since Hannah is referring to a group of people (**your** is plural), it may be more natural in your language to use the plural form of **mouth**. Alternate translation: [Let the arrogant go out from your mouths]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Samuel 2:3 (#6)

יֵצֵ֥א עָתָ֖ק מִפִּיכֶֽם

“Let the arrogant go out from your mouth”

Hannah is using a common expression of her culture to mean that people should stop speaking arrogantly. She does not mean that arrogant words should **go out** from the **mouth** of these people in the sense that they should speak them. She means that those words should not be in their mouths, that is, they should not speak them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not say any more arrogant things]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 2:3 (#4)

יֵצֵ֥א עָתָ֖ק מִפִּיכֶֽם

“Let the arrogant go out from your mouth”

Hannah is using the adjective **arrogant** as a noun to mean arrogant things that people say. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [Let arrogant words go out from your mouth]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 2:3 (#9)

וְלֹא נִתְכְּנ֖וּ עֲלִלֽוֹת

“and by him actions are weighed”

Hannah is speaking as if actions were objects that could be **weighed** on a scale. She means that Yahweh evaluates everything that people do. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he evaluates everything that people do]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 2:3 (#1)

אַל־תַּרְבּ֤וּ תְדַבְּרוּ֙ גְּבֹהָ֣ה גְבֹהָ֔ה יֵצֵ֥א עָתָ֖ק מִפִּיכֶ֑ם

“May you not multiply, may you {not} speak, haughty, haughty! Let the arrogant go out from your mouth”

Hannah is speaking to people who are not present, particularly Peninnah, who had mocked her for being childless. She is doing this to show in a very strong way how she feels about their arrogant behavior. If your readers might not understand this kind of speech, you could translate her words as if she were speaking directly about these people. Alternate translation: [Let very haughty people stop talking so much! Let them stop saying arrogant things]

See: Apostrophe

1 Samuel 2:3 (#2)

גְּבֹהָ֣ה גְבֹהָ֔ה

“haughty, haughty”

Hannah is using the adjective **haughty** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [you haughty, haughty person]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 2:3 (#7)

אֵ֣ל דֵּעוֹת֮ יְהוָה֒

“Yahweh {is} a God of knowledge”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **knowledge**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Yahweh is a God who knows everything]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 2:3 (#8)

וְלֹא נִתְכְּנ֖וּ עֲלִלֽוֹת

“and by him actions are weighed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and he weighs people’s actions]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 2:4 (#3)

גִּבֹּרִים

“the mighty”

Hannah is using the adjective **mighty** as a noun to mean people of a certain type. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [mighty people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 2:4 (#4)

וְנִכְשָׁלִים

“but the stumbling ones”

Hannah assumes that readers will know that by **the stumbling ones**, she means people who are so weak that they can barely walk. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [but those who were so weak that they could barely walk]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 2:4 (#1)

קֶשֶׁת גִּבֹּרִים חַתִּתִים

“The bow of the mighty are broken”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context suggests that Yahweh is the agent. Alternate translation: [Yahweh breaks the bow of the mighty]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 2:4 (#2)

קֶשֶׁת

“The bow of”

Since Hannah is referring to a group of people, it may be more natural in your language to use the plural form of **bow**. Alternate translation: [The bows of]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Samuel 2:4 (#5)

אָאְזְרוּ חָיִל

“gird on strength”

Hannah is speaking as if **strength** were a piece of clothing that people could put on. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [become strong]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 2:5 (#6)

שִׁבְעָה

“seven”

Hannah is speaking as if the woman she is describing has had exactly **seven** children. In this culture, seven was a number of completeness that was often used to indicate “many.” If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [many children]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 2:5 (#2)

שְׂבֵעִים בַּלֶּחֶם נִשְׂכָּרוּ

“The satisfied hire themselves out for bread”

Hannah assumes that readers will know that by **the satisfied ones**, she means people who formerly were **satisfied** in the sense that they had enough to eat. The context suggests further that they had plenty of food without having to work. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Those who were formerly prosperous and at leisure now have to work to get enough to eat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 2:5 (#3)

בַּלֶּחֶם

“for bread”

Hannah is using the term **bread** to represent food in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for food] or [to get enough food to live on]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 2:5 (#1)

שְׂבֵעִים & וּרְעֵבִים

“The satisfied & but the hungry”

Hannah is using the adjectives **satisfied** and **hungry** as nouns to mean certain kinds of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you

can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [Satisfied people ... but hungry people] or [Well-fed people ... but hungry people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 2:5 (#5)

עַד־עֲקָרָה֙ יָלְדָ֣ה שִׁבְעָ֔ה וְרַבַּ֥ת בָּנִ֖ים אֻמְלָלָֽה

“Even the barren bears seven, but the plenteous of sons languishes”

Hannah is using the adjectives **barren**, **plenteous**, and **seven** as nouns to mean certain kinds of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [Even women who could not have children now have seven children, but women who have had many sons stop having children]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 2:5 (#4)

וּרְעֵבִ֖ים חָדֵ֣לּוּ

“but the hungry cease”

Hannah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but the hungry cease from hunger] or [but those who were hungry cease to be hungry]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 2:6 (#1)

יְהוָ֥ה מֵמִ֖ית וּמְחַיֶּ֑ה מוֹרִ֥יד שְׁא֖וֹל וַיָּעַֽל

“Yahweh makes die and makes alive, causing to go down to Sheol and causing to come up”

Hannah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh kills people and makes people alive, causing people to go down to Sheol and causing people to come up from there]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 2:6 (#2)

וַיָּעַֽל

“and causing to come up”

Hannah is speaking as if people could come up from Sheol, the place of the dead. She means that Yahweh can heal people who are so sick they seem almost to have died. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and healing people with deadly illnesses so that it seems they have come back from the realm of the dead]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 2:7 (#2)

מַשְׁפִּ֥יל אַף־מְרוֹמֵֽם

“bringing down yet bringing up”

Hannah is speaking as if people’s social status were a physical location that they could move down from or up to. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [lowering some people’s status yet raising other people’s status]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 2:7 (#1)

יְהוָ֥ה מוֹרִ֖ישׁ וּמַעֲשִׁ֑יר מַשְׁפִּ֥יל אַף־מְרוֹמֵֽם

“Yahweh is making poor and making rich, bringing down yet bringing up”

Hannah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh is making some people poor and making other people rich, bringing some people down yet bringing other people up]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 2:8 (#1)

מֵקִ֤ים מֵעָפָר֙ דָּ֔ל מֵאַשְׁפֹּ֖ת יָרִ֣ים אֶבְיוֹ֑ן

“Raising the poor from the dust, he lifts up the needy from the trash heap”

This could mean: (1) that Hannah is using one specific circumstance of the **poor** and **needy** to represent their desperate circumstances in general. Alternate translation: [He brings people out of poverty, yes, he helps people to have a decent living standard]; (2) that Hannah is speaking of the **poor** and **needy** as if they were mourners, to represent the way that people in this culture who were mourning would show their grief by sitting down in the **dust** of the ground or in a **trash heap**. Alternate translation: [He helps people who are sad about their impoverished situations, yes,

he helps people who are grieving over their desperate circumstances]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 2:8 (#7)

לַיהוָה֙ מְצֻקֵ֣י אֶ֔רֶץ וַיָּ֥שֶׁת עֲלֵיהֶ֖ם תֵּבֵֽל

“the pillars of the earth {are} to Yahweh, and he has set the world on them”

Hannah is speaking as if the **earth** were a building that had **pillars** supporting it. Speaking from the perspective of her culture, she is describing how Yahweh structured his creation to ensure that the world would be a stable place. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh structured his creation so that the world would be a stable place]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 2:8 (#2)

דָּ֣ל & אֶבְיוֹן

“the poor & the needy”

Hannah is using the adjectives **poor** and **needy** as nouns to mean certain kinds of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [poor people and needy people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 2:8 (#3)

לְהוֹשִׁיבִ֖י עִם־נְדִיבִֽים

“to make {them} sit with nobles, and”

In this culture, offering a person a prestigious place to **sit** was a symbolic action that showed them honor and conferred high status on them. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [to give them high status by having them sit with nobles]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 2:8 (#4)

לְהוֹשִׁיבִ֖ & וְכִסֵּ֣א כָבֹ֑וד יַנְחִלֵ֔ם

“to make {them} sit & and he makes them inherit a seat of honor”

Hannah is speaking as if a **seat of honor** were something that these people could **inherit** as if it were property. She means that people will consider a **seat of honor** to be their seat, in other words, that they have the right to sit in such seats. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [so that people consider that they have the right to sit in a seat of honor]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 2:8 (#5)

וְכִסֵּ֣א כָבֹ֑וד

“a seat of honor”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **honor**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [an honorable seat]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 2:8 (#6)

כִּ֚י

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but an explanation. The implicit idea is that since Yahweh arranged the entire physical **world**, he can certainly determine arrangements among people. Alternate translation: [After all]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 2:9 (#1)

רַגְלֵ֥י חסידו יִשְׁמֹ֖ר

“He will keep the feet of his faithful ones”

Hannah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [He will keep the feet of his faithful ones from slipping]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 2:9 (#4)

וּרְשָׁעִ֖ים & יִדָּמ֑וּ

“but the wicked will be silenced”

Hannah is using the term **silenced** to represent that the wicked will die, since people make no further sounds after they die. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [but the wicked will be put to death] or [but Yahweh will slay the wicked]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 2:9 (#3)

וּרְשָׁעִ֖ים & יִדָּמּ֑וּ

“but the wicked will be silenced”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context suggests that Yahweh is the agent. Alternate translation: [but Yahweh will silence the wicked]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 2:9 (#6)

כִּ֣י

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces an explanation of why the wicked will be **silenced**, even though they seem to be powerful. Alternate translation: [This is true because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 2:9 (#5)

בַּחֹ֔שֶׁךְ

“in darkness”

Hannah is using the term **darkness** to represent the abode of the dead, which her culture considered to be a very dark place. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the grave] or [in the abode of the dead]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 2:9 (#7)

אִ֥ישׁ

“a man”

Here the masculine term **man** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [a person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Samuel 2:9 (#2)

רַגְלֵ֤י חסידו יִשְׁמֹ֙ר

“He will keep the feet of his faithful ones”

Hannah is using one part of people, their **feet**, to mean all of them in the act of walking, which represents living. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [He will protect his faithful ones from harm wherever they go]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 2:10 (#4)

יְהוָ֔ה יָדִ֖ין אַפְסֵי־אָ֑רֶץ

“Yahweh will judge the ends of the earth”

Hannah is speaking of the **ends** or extreme limits of the earth in order to mean them and everything in between. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will judge the entire earth]

See: Merism

1 Samuel 2:10 (#8)

מְשִׁיחֽוֹ

“his anointed one”

Hannah is using the term **anointed one** to represent the king she has just mentioned, since in this culture men were anointed with oil when they became kings. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [his king]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 2:10 (#1)

יְהוָ֖ה יֵחַ֣תּוּ מריבו

“By} Yahweh, the ones opposing him will be shattered”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will shatter the ones opposing him]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 2:10 (#2)

עלו בַּשָּׁמַ֥יִם יַרְעֵ֖ם

“He will make thunder against him in the heavens”

Since Hannah is referring to a group of people, it may be more natural in your language to use a plural pronoun instead of **him**. Alternate translation: [He makes thunder against them in the heavens]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Samuel 2:10 (#6)

וְיִתֶּן־עֹז לְמַלְכּוֹ

“And he will give strength to his king”

See the discussion in the Introduction to this chapter of why Hannah speaks of a **king** even though Israel had no king at this time.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 2:10 (#7)

וְיָרֵם קֶרֶן מְשִׁיחוֹ

“and lift up the horn of his anointed one”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:1. Alternate translation: [and give strength and dignity to his anointed one]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 2:10 (#3)

עלו בַּשָּׁמַיִם יַרְעֵם

“He will make thunder against him in the heavens”

Hannah is using the first thing that she feels Yahweh would do when coming to judge and punish his enemies, make **thunder** in the sky, to mean all that he would do. In this culture, people regarded thunder as something that could indicate that Yahweh was about to act powerfully. In 7:10, for example, Yahweh thunders against the Philistines and defeats them when they attack the Israelites. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. The UST models one way to do this.

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 2:10 (#5)

יְהוָה יָדִין אַפְסֵי־אָרֶץ

“Yahweh will judge the ends of the earth”

Hannah is using the term **earth** to represent the people who live on the earth. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will judge all the people in the world]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 2:11 (#1)

וַיֵּלֶךְ אֶלְקָנָה הָרָמָתָה עַל־בֵּיתוֹ וְהַנַּעַר הָיָה מְשָׁרֵת אֶת־יְהוָה אֶת־פְּנֵי עֵלִי הַכֹּהֵן

“Then Elkanah went to Ramah, to his house. And the boy was serving Yahweh at the face of Eli the priest”

Here the author is saying what happened at the end of the story of Hannah praying for a child and dedicating him to Yahweh. Your language may have its own way of presenting such information.

See: End of Story

1 Samuel 2:11 (#2)

אֶלְקָנָה

“Elkanah”

As the Introduction to 1 Samuel discusses, here as in many other instances throughout the book, the author is using the name of a person to represent him and other people who are associated with or accompanying him. Be alert to this usage and represent it in a natural way in your translation. The UST will typically show when it is present. Alternate translation: [Elkanah and his wives and children]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 2:11 (#3)

וְהַנַּעַר

“And the boy”

The author assumes that readers will know that by **the boy**, he means Samuel. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Samuel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 2:11 (#4)

אֶת־פְּנֵי עֵלִי

“at the face of Eli”

See the discussion in the Introduction to this chapter of why the author may say **at** here rather than the usual “to.” Alternate translation: [together with Eli] or [as an apprentice to Eli]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 2:12 (#1)

וּבְנֵי עֵלִי בְּנֵי בְלִיָּעַל לֹא יָדְעוּ אֶת־יְהוָה

“Now the sons of Eli {were} sons of wickedness. They did not know Yahweh”

See the Introduction to this chapter for a discussion of how the author repeatedly reintroduces Eli or his

sons and Samuel in the rest of this chapter in order to draw a contrast between Samuel and Eli's sons. Your language may have its own way of introducing or reintroducing participants that you can use in your translation, here and in the rest of the chapter.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Samuel 2:12 (#2)

בְּנֵי בְלִיָּעַל

"were} sons of wickedness"

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:16. Alternate translation: [were very wicked men]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 2:13 (#5)

כְּבַשֵּׁשֵׁל הַבָּשָׂר

"at the boiling of the meat"

The author assumes that readers will know that this refers to the meat from the sacrifice that the worshipers were **boiling**. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [while the worshipers were boiling the sacrificial meat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 2:13 (#2)

הַכֹּהֲנִים

"the priests"

The author assumes that readers will know that by **the priests**, he means specifically Eli's sons. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Eli's sons]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 2:13 (#4)

זֹבֵחַ זָבַח

"was sacrificing a sacrifice"

The phrase translated as **sacrificing a sacrifice** is a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [was offering a sacrifice]

See: Poetry

1 Samuel 2:13 (#6)

וְהַמִּזְלֵג שְׁלֹשׁ־הַשִּׁנַּיִם

"and a fork {with} three prongs"

A **fork** is a utensil with prongs or tines used for picking up food. If your readers would not be familiar with what a fork is, in your translation you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [a three-pronged meat hook] or [a large hooked utensil]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 2:13 (#3)

כָּל־אִישׁ

"was}, {when} any man"

Here the masculine term **man** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [when any person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Samuel 2:13 (#1)

וּמִשְׁפַּט הַכֹּהֲנִים אֶת־הָעָם כָּל

"Now the custom of the priests with the people {was}, {when} any"

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 2:14 (#1)

בַּכִּיּוֹר אוֹ בַדּוּד אוֹ בַקַּלַּחַת אוֹ בַפָּרוּר

"into the pan or into the kettle or into the cauldron or into the pot"

These are all different kinds of cooking vessels. If your readers would not be familiar with what these specific items are, in your translation you could use the names of similar things that your readers would recognize, or you could use general expressions. Alternate translation: [into whatever pot the meat was cooking in]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 2:14 (#2)

יִקַּ֣ח הַכֹּהֵ֔ן בּ֖וֹ

“the priest would take with him”

The author assumes that readers will understand that the servant would bring the meat back to the priest, who would take it for himself. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the servant would bring back to the priest, and the priest would take it for himself]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 2:14 (#3)

יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“Israel”

See the discussion in the Introduction to 1 Samuel of the use of the name of an ancestor to mean his descendants, and see how you translated this usage in 1:17. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 2:15 (#1)

יַקְטִ֣רוּן אֶת־הַחֵ֔לֶב

“they burned the fat”

Here the author is not using the pronoun **they** to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the fat was burned]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 2:16 (#3)

תְּאַוֶּ֥ה נַפְשֶׁ֖ךָ

“your soul desires”

The person sacrificing is using one part of the priest, his **soul**, to mean all of him in the act of wanting something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you want]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 2:16 (#4)

כִּֽי־עַתָּ֣ה תִתֵּ֔ן וְאִם־לֹ֖א לָקַ֥חְתִּי בְחָזְקָֽה

“but you shall give now, and if not, I will take by force”

The servant is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but you must give me the meat now, and if you do not give it to me, I will take it by force]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 2:16 (#1)

קַטֵּ֤ר יַקְטִירֻן֙

“Burning, let them burn”

The person sacrificing is repeating the verb **burn** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [Let the fat indeed be burned]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 2:16 (#2)

כַּיּ֣וֹם

“as the day”

The person sacrificing is using a common expression of his culture to mean that something should happen that very **day**, with the implication that it should happen right away. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [right now]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 2:17 (#2)

אֶת־פְּנֵ֥י יְהוָֽה

“at the face of Yahweh”

See the discussion in the Introduction to this chapter of why the author may say **at** here rather than “to.” Alternate translation: [against Yahweh himself]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 2:17 (#1)

הַנְּעָרִ֔ים

“the young men”

The author assumes that readers will know that by **the young men** he means Eli’s sons, Hophni and Phinehas. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if

that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Hophni and Phinehas]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 2:18 (#2)

חָגוּר אֵפוֹד בָּד

“girded {with} an ephod of linen”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [who was wearing an ephod of linen]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 2:18 (#3)

חָגוּר אֵפוֹד בָּד

“girded {with} an ephod of linen”

Wearing an **ephod** was a symbolic action that showed Samuel was serving as a priest. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [wearing a priestly garment made of linen]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 2:18 (#1)

וּשְׁמוּאֵל מְשָׁרֵת אֶת־פְּנֵי יְהוָה

“Now Samuel was serving at the face of Yahweh”

See the discussion in the Introduction to this chapter of why the author may say **at** here rather than “to.” Alternate translation: [But Samuel was serving Yahweh devotedly]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 2:19 (#3)

לִזְבֹּחַ אֶת־זֶבַח הַיָּמִים

“to sacrifice the sacrifice of the days”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [to offer the sacrifice of the days] or [to offer the yearly sacrifice]

See: Poetry

1 Samuel 2:19 (#1)

מִיָּמִים ׀ יָמִימָה

“from days to days”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [from year to year]

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

1 Samuel 2:19 (#2)

בַּעֲלוֹתָהּ

“in her coming up”

See the discussion in the Introduction to 1 Samuel of how Hebrew speakers and writers marked travel for change in elevation, and see how you translated the comparable expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [in her coming] or [when she came]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 2:20 (#3)

הַשְּׁאֵלָה

“the request”

Eli is using the term **request** to represent Samuel, whom Hannah requested from Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the son]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 2:20 (#4)

אֲשֶׁר שָׁאַל לַיהוָה

“that one requested of Yahweh”

Here the author is not using the pronoun **one** to refer to a specific person. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [who was requested of Yahweh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 2:20 (#1)

וּבֵרַךְ עֵלִי אֶת־אֶלְקָנָה וְאֶת־אִשְׁתּוֹ וְאָמַר

“And Eli would bless Elkanah and his wife and would say”

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **say** tells what Eli did in order to **bless**. Alternate translation: [And Eli would bless Elkanah and his wife by saying]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 2:20 (#2)

זֶ֖רַע

“seed”

Eli is speaking as if children were **seed** that could be planted and grown. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [children]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 2:20 (#5)

לִמְקֹמֽוֹ

“to his place”

Since the author is referring to Elkanah and his family, it might be more natural in your language to use the plural form. Alternate translation: [to their place]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Samuel 2:21 (#3)

וַיִּגְדַּ֥ל הַנַּ֖עַר שְׁמוּאֵ֑ל עִם־יְהוָֽה

“And the boy Samuel grew with Yahweh”

The author is using the term **with Yahweh** to represent the place where the Israelites worshiped Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And the boy Samuel grew up while living at the tent of meeting]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 2:21 (#1)

כִּ֣י

“For”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And they were blessed, for]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 2:21 (#2)

פָּקַ֣ד

“visited”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean that Yahweh helped Hannah. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [helped]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 2:22 (#1)

אֵת֙ כָּל־אֲשֶׁ֣ר יַעֲשׂ֔וּן בָּנָ֖יו לְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“all that his sons were doing to all of Israel”

The author is alluding to what he said in 2:14 that Eli’s sons were doing “to all of Israel.” You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [how his sons were stealing meat from the offerings that the Israelites brought]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 2:22 (#2)

לְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“to all of Israel”

The author is making an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [to every Israelite who brought an animal to sacrifice]

See: Hyperbole

1 Samuel 2:22 (#3)

יִשְׁכְּב֖וּן אֶת

“they were lying with”

The author is speaking in a polite way about a matter that is usually private. Your language may have a similar expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [they were sleeping with]

See: Euphemism

1 Samuel 2:22 (#4)

הַנָּשִׁ֗ים הַצֹּבְאֹ֛ת פֶּ֥תַח אֹ֖הֶל מוֹעֵֽד

“the women serving {at} the entrance of the tent of meeting”

These were women who helped with various tasks at the sanctuary. If your readers would not be familiar with who these women were and what they did, in your translation you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [the women who assisted at the sanctuary]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 2:23 (#2)

כָּל־הָעָ֥ם אֱלֶֽה

“all of these people”

Eli assumes that his sons will know he means the Israelites who have been bringing sacrifices. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [all thee people who are bringing sacrifices]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 2:23 (#1)

לָ֣מָּה תַעֲשׂ֔וּן כַּדְּבָרִ֖ים הָאֵ֑לֶּה אֲשֶׁ֤ר אָנֹכִי֙ שֹׁמֵ֣עַ אֶת־דִּבְרֵיכֶ֔ם רָעִ֖ים מֵאֵ֥ת כָּל־הָעָ֖ם אֵֽלֶּה

“Why do you do like these things, that I am hearing evil things of you from all of these people”

Eli is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You should not do things like these, that I am hearing evil things of you from all these people!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 2:24 (#2)

אַ֚ל בָּנַ֔י כִּֽי־לֹא־טוֹבָ֖ה הַשְּׁמֻעָ֑ה אֲשֶׁ֤ר אָנֹכִי֙ שֹׁמֵ֣עַ מַעֲבִרִ֔ים עַם־יְהוָֹ֖ה

“No, my sons! For the report {is} not good that I am hearing the people of Yahweh passing on”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Because the report that I am hearing the people of Yahweh passing on is not good, you must stop doing these things, my sons!]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 2:24 (#3)

לֹא־טוֹבָ֖ה הַשְּׁמֻעָ֑ה

“the report {is} not good”

Eli is expressing a positive meaning by using a negative word together with a term that is the opposite of his intended meaning. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the report is very bad]

See: Litotes

1 Samuel 2:24 (#1)

אַ֚ל בָּנַ֔י

“No, my sons”

Eli is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Stop doing these things, my sons!]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 2:25 (#2)

מִֽי־יִתְפַּלֶּל־לֹ֑ו

“who will intercede for him”

Eli is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or exclamation. Alternate translation: [no one will be able to intercede for him!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 2:25 (#4)

וְלֹ֣א יִשְׁמְעוּ֮ לְקֹ֣ול אֲבִיהֶם֒

“But they would not listen to the voice of their father”

The author is using the term **voice** to represent what Eli was saying. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [But they would not listen to what their father said]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 2:25 (#1)

אִ֔ישׁ לְאִישׁ֙ & אִ֣ישׁ

“a man & against a man & a man”

In each instance, the masculine term **man** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [someone ... against another person ... someone]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Samuel 2:25 (#3)

וְלֹ֣א יִשְׁמְעוּ֮ לְקֹ֣ול אֲבִיהֶם֒ כִּֽי־חָפֵ֣ץ יְהוָ֔ה לַהֲמִיתָֽם

“But they would not listen to the voice of their father, for Yahweh desired to make them die”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second

phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [But because Yahweh had decided to put them to death, they would not listen to the voice of their father]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 2:25 (#5)

וְלֹ֣א יִשְׁמְע֗וּ לְקֹ֙ל אֲבִיהֶ֔ם

“But they would not listen to the voice of their father”

See the discussion in the Introduction to 1 Samuel of the author’s use of the term **listen** to mean “obey.” Alternate translation: [But they would not obey what their father told them to do]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 2:26 (#1)

הֹלֵ֥ךְ וְגָדֵ֖ל

“was going and growing”

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **going** tells in what way Samuel was **growing**. Alternate translation: [continued to grow]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 2:26 (#2)

וְט֛וֹב גַּ֥ם עִם־יְהוָ֖ה וְגַ֥ם עִם־אֲנָשִֽׁים

“and {was} good both with Yahweh and also with men”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean that both Yahweh and people approved of Samuel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and both Yahweh and people approved of him]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 2:27 (#1)

וַיָּבֹ֣א אִישׁ־אֱלֹהִ֗ים אֶל־עֵלִי֙ וַיֹּ֣אמֶר אֵלָ֔יו כֹּ֣ה אָמַ֔ר יְהוָ֖ה הֲנִגְלֹ֣ה
נִגְלֵ֑יתִי אֶל־בֵּ֣ית אָבִ֔יךָ בִּֽהְיוֹתָ֥ם בְּמִצְרַ֖יִם לְבֵ֥ית פַּרְעֹֽה

“And a man of God came to Eli and said to him, “Thus says Yahweh, ‘Revealing myself, did I {not} reveal myself to the house of your father in their being in Egypt, to the house of Pharaoh”

There are two levels of quotation in this verse. The author begins to quote a **man of God** directly (level 1). That man tells Eli something that Yahweh has said (level 2). He continues to do that through verse 36. Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not three levels of quotation (see the Quotes within Quotes note).

See: Quote Markings

1 Samuel 2:27 (#3)

הֲנִגְלֹ֣ה נִגְלֵ֑יתִי

“Revealing myself, did I {not} reveal myself”

Yahweh is repeating the verb **reveal** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [I certainly revealed myself]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 2:27 (#4)

הֲנִגְלֹ֣ה נִגְלֵ֑יתִי אֶל־בֵּ֣ית אָבִ֔יךָ בִּֽהְיוֹתָ֥ם בְּמִצְרַ֖יִם לְבֵ֥ית פַּרְעֹֽה

“Revealing myself, did I {not} reveal myself to the house of your father in their being in Egypt, to the house of Pharaoh”

Yahweh is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or exclamation. Alternate translation: [I certainly revealed myself to the house of your father in their being in Egypt, to the house of Pharaoh!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 2:27 (#5)

אָבִֽיךָ

“your father”

Yahweh is using the term **father** to mean “ancestor.” He is referring specifically to Eli’s ancestor Aaron. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your ancestor Aaron]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 2:27 (#6)

אֶל־בֵּ֣ית אָבִ֔יךָ

“to the house of your father”

Yahweh is using the term **house** to represent all the household or family of Eli’s ancestor Aaron. If it

would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to your ancestor Aaron and his family]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 2:27 (#7)

לְבֵ֖ית פַּרְעֹֽה

“to the house of Pharaoh”

Yahweh is using this possessive form to mean that Eli’s ancestors were slaves who belonged to Pharaoh’s household. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [when they were Pharaoh’s personal slaves]

See: Possession

1 Samuel 2:27 (#2)

כֹּ֣ה אָמַ֗ר יְהוָה֮ הֲנִגְלֹ֣ה נִגְלֵ֣יתִי֮ אֶל־בֵּ֣ית אָבִ֣יךָ בִּֽהְיוֹתָ֗ם בְּמִצְרַ֛יִם לְבֵ֥ית פַּרְעֹֽה

“Thus says Yahweh, ‘Revealing myself, did I {not} reveal myself to the house of your father in their being in Egypt, to the house of Pharaoh”

See the Introduction to this chapter for a discussion of how, if that would be clearer in your language, you can translate verses 27–36 so that there is not a quotation within a quotation.

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 2:28 (#1)

לַעֲלוֹת֙ עַל־מִזְבְּחִ֔י

“to go up on my altar”

Yahweh assumes that Eli will know what he means by the phrase **to go up on my altar**. This could mean: (1) that Yahweh chose the family of Aaron to do specific work at his altar. Alternate translation: [to approach my altar] or [to serve at my altar]; (2) that Yahweh chose the family of Aaron to offer sacrifices on his altar. Alternate translation: [to offer sacrifices on my altar]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 2:28 (#2)

וָאֶתְּנָ֣הּ לְבֵ֣ית אָבִ֔יךָ

“And I gave to the house of your father”

Yahweh is using the term **house** to represent the household or family of Aaron, and in this context specifically his descendants. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to your ancestor Aaron and to his descendants]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 2:28 (#4)

בְּנֵ֥י יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל

“the sons of Israel”

See the discussion in the Introduction to 1 Samuel of this use of the expression **the sons of** a person to mean the nation or tribe that consists of his descendants. Decide how you will translate it throughout the book. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 2:28 (#3)

אֶת־כָּל־אִשֵּׁ֖י בְּנֵ֥י יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“all of the gifts of the sons of Israel”

When Yahweh says **all**, he means “some of every,” not everything entirely. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a portion of every animal that the Israelites sacrificed]

See: Hyperbole

1 Samuel 2:29 (#4)

תִּבְעָטוּ֙ & וַתְּכַבֵּ֣ד אֶת־בָּנֶ֔יךָ & לְהַבְרִיאֲכֶ֖ם

“do you kick & and honor your sons & by the fattening of yourselves”

The pronouns **you** and **yourselves** are plural because the man of God is referring to Eli and his sons. The pronoun **your** and the verb **honor** are singular because the man of God is referring to Eli alone. Use the appropriate forms in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Samuel 2:29 (#2)

לָ֣מָּה תִבְעָטוּ֙ בִּזְבְחִ֔י וּבְמִנְחָתִ֖י

“Why do you kick at my sacrifice and at my offering”

Yahweh is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You should not kick at my sacrifice and at my offering …!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 2:29 (#3)

בְּזִבְחִי֙ וּבְמִנְחָתִ֔י

“at my sacrifice and at my offering”

In other contexts, the words **sacrifice** and **offering** can refer to two different things. But here Yahweh is using them synonymously in a phrase that expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **offering** tells what kind of **sacrifice** Yahweh means. Alternate translation: [at the sacrifices that people offer to me]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 2:29 (#1)

לָ֣מָּה תִבְעֲטוּ֩ בְּזִבְחִי֙ וּבְמִנְחָתִ֔י

“Why do you kick at my sacrifice and at my offering”

Yahweh is using a common expression of his culture to mean that Eli and his sons were treating his sacrifices with disrespect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Why do you treat my sacrifices with such disrespect]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 2:30 (#1)

לָכֵ֞ן נְאֻם־יְהוָ֣ה׀ אֱלֹהֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵל֮ אָמֹ֣ר אָמַ֣רְתִּי בֵיתְךָ֣ וּבֵ֣ית אָבִ֔יךָ
יִתְהַלְּכ֥וּ לְפָנַ֖י עַד־עוֹלָ֑ם וְעַתָּ֤ה נְאֻם־יְהוָה֙ חָלִ֣ילָה לִ֔י

“Therefore’—the declaration of Yahweh, the God of Israel—‘saying, I said your house and the house of your father would walk about to my face forever. But now’—the declaration of Yahweh—‘profane to me”

The phrases **the declaration of Yahweh, the God of Israel** and **the declaration of Yahweh** are not part of what the man of God is telling Eli that Yahweh has said (level 2 in this quotation). The man is using those phrases to assure Eli that this is something that Yahweh has said. Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to end the second-level quotation before these phrases and to resume it after them.

See: Quote Markings

1 Samuel 2:30 (#2)

אָמֹ֣ר אָמַ֣רְתִּי

“saying, I said”

Yahweh is repeating the verb **say** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [I certainly said]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 2:30 (#3)

בֵיתְךָ֣ וּבֵ֣ית אָבִ֔יךָ

“your house and the house of your father”

It may be more natural in your language to put the information about Eli’s ancestor’s family before the information about Eli’s family. Alternate translation: [the descendants of your ancestor, and therefore your family]

See: Information Structure

1 Samuel 2:30 (#4)

יִתְהַלְּכ֥וּ לְפָנַ֖י

“would walk about to my face”

Using a common expression of his culture, Yahweh is saying **walk about** to mean “live.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [would live in my presence]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 2:30 (#7)

חָלִ֣ילָה לִ֔י

“profane to me”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [profane to me to let that happen!] or [far be it from me to let that happen!]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 2:30 (#6)

חָלִ֣ילָה לִ֔י

“profane to me”

Yahweh is using a common expression of this culture to express horror at the idea he has just described.

Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [far be it from me!] or [I hope that never happens!]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 2:30 (#8)

יֵקָלּוּ

“they will despise”

Here the author is not using the pronoun **they** to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [will be despised]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 2:30 (#5)

חָלִלָה לִּ֙י כִּי־מְכַבְּדַ֔י אֲכַבֵּ֖ד וּבֹזַ֣י יֵקָלּֽוּ

“profane to me! For the ones honoring me, I will honor, but the ones disdaining me, they will despise”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since I honor those who honor me, but they will despise those who disdain me, profane to me!]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 2:31 (#1)

הִנֵּה

“Behold”

As the Introduction to 1 Samuel discusses, Yahweh is using the word **Behold** to focus Eli’s attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, here and throughout the book. Alternate translation: [Now listen:]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 2:31 (#2)

יָמִים בָּאִ֔ים

“the days are coming”

Yahweh is using the term **days** to represent a future time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the time is coming]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 2:31 (#3)

וְגָדַעְתִּי֙ אֶת־זְרֹעֲךָ֔ וְאֶת־זְרֹ֖עַ בֵּ֣ית אָבִ֑יךָ

“when I will cut off your arm and the arm of the house of your father”

Yahweh is speaking as if Eli’s strength and his family’s strength were each an **arm** that could be **cut off**. Strength, in turn, represents in this context the vigorous young men of a family. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when I will cause the vigorous young men in your family and in the house of your father to die]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 2:32 (#1)

יֵיטִ֛יב

“he will do good”

Yahweh is speaking about himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [I will do]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 2:32 (#2)

בְּבֵיתֶ֑ךָ

“in your house”

Yahweh is using the term **house** to represent Eli’s family. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in your family]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 2:32 (#3)

כָּל־הַיָּמִֽים

“all of the days”

Yahweh is using the term **days** to represent time in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [ever again]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 2:33 (#2)

לֹ֣א־אַכְרִ֔ית

“I will not cut off”

Yahweh is speaking as if he would **cut off** people from life. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will not kill]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 2:33 (#3)

וְאִ֣ישׁ לֹא־אַכְרִ֣ית לְךָ֔

“But I will not cut off a man to you”

Yahweh is not referring to a specific **man**. He means in general the men of Eli’s family. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using a plural form. Alternate translation: [But I will not cut off all the men in your family]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 2:33 (#4)

לְכַלּ֣וֹת אֶת־עֵינֶ֔יךָ וְלַאֲדִ֖יב אֶת־נַפְשֶׁ֑ךָ

“to make your eyes fail and to make your soul grieve”

Yahweh is using parts of Eli and his descendants, their **eyes** and **souls**, to mean all of them in the act of weeping and grieving. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to make you and your descendants weep greatly and grieve deeply]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 2:33 (#6)

אֲנָשִׁ֔ים

“as} men”

The specific term that Yahweh uses here for **men** indicates young men. You could state this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [as young men]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 2:33 (#5)

וְכָל־מִרְבִּ֥ית בֵּיתְךָ֖

“And all of the increase of your house”

Yahweh is using the term **increase** to represent to further members who will be born into Eli’s family. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And all those who are born into your family]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 2:33 (#1)

וְאִ֣ישׁ לֹא־אַכְרִ֣ית לְךָ֔ מֵעִ֖ם מִזְבְּחִ֑י לְכַלּ֣וֹת אֶת־עֵינֶ֔יךָ וְלַאֲדִ֖יב אֶת־נַפְשֶׁ֑ךָ

“But I will not cut off a man to you from near my altar, to make your eyes fail and to make your soul grieve”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [But to make your eyes fail and to make your soul grieve, I will not cut off a man to you from near my altar]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 2:34 (#1)

וְזֶה־לְּךָ֣ הָאוֹת֮ אֲשֶׁ֣ר יָבֹא֒ אֶל־שְׁנֵ֣י בָנֶ֔יךָ אֶל־חָפְנִ֖י וּפִינְחָ֑ס

“And this {is} the sign for you that will come to the two of your sons, to Hophni and Phinehas”

Yahweh is speaking of this **sign** as if it were a living thing that could **come** to Eli. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And when this happens to your two sons, Hophni and Phinehas, it will be a sign for you]

See: Personification

1 Samuel 2:35 (#1)

וְהַקִימֹתִ֥י לִי֙ כֹּהֵ֣ן נֶאֱמָ֔ן

“And I will raise up for myself a faithful priest”

Yahweh is speaking as if he would **raise up** a priest to a height or to a standing position. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I will appoint for myself a faithful priest]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 2:35 (#4)

וּבָנִיתִ֣י לוֹ֮ בַּ֣יִת נֶאֱמָן֒

“And I will build for him an established house”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And I will establish the house that I build for him]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 2:35 (#2)

כֹּהֵן נֶאֱמָן

“a faithful priest”

See the discussion in the Introduction to this chapter of the term that the ULT translates as **faithful**. This could mean: (1) Alternate translation: [an obedient priest]; (2) Alternate translation: [an established priest]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 2:35 (#3)

כַּאֲשֶׁר בִּלְבָבִי וּבְנַפְשִׁי

“just as {is} in my heart and in my soul”

The terms **heart** and **soul** mean similar things, representing in this context inward desires. Yahweh is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [exactly what I desire for him to do]

See: Doublet

1 Samuel 2:35 (#5)

וּבָנִיתִי לוֹ בַּיִת נֶאֱמָן

“And I will build for him an established house”

Yahweh is speaking as if he would construct a physical **house** for this new priest. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I will make sure that he has a lasting family line]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 2:35 (#7)

כָּל־הַיָּמִים

“all of the days”

Yahweh is using the term **days** to represent time in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [always]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 2:35 (#6)

וְהִתְהַלֵּךְ לִפְנֵי־מְשִׁיחִי

“and he will walk about to the face of my anointed”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:30. Alternate translation: [and he will personally serve my anointed]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 2:36 (#4)

לַאֲגֹרַת כֶּסֶף וְכִכַּר & לָחֶם

“for a piece of silver and a loaf of bread”

Yahweh is using specific small amounts to represent money and food in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for money and food]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 2:36 (#6)

לֶחֶם & לְאָכְלֹ פַּת־לָחֶם

“bread & to eat a piece of bread”

Yahweh is using one specific thing that people need to do to live, eating **bread**, to mean earning a living in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [so that I can earn enough to live on]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 2:36 (#1)

וְהָיָה כָּל־הַנּוֹתָר בְּבֵיתְךָ יָבוֹא לְהִשְׁתַּחֲוֹת לוֹ לַאֲגֹרַת כֶּסֶף וְכִכַּר־לָחֶם וְאָמַר סְפָחֵנִי נָא אֶל־אַחַת הַכְּהֻנּוֹת לֶאֱכֹל פַּת־לָחֶם

“And it will happen that every remaining one in your house will come to bow down to him for a piece of silver and a loaf of bread, and he will say, “Please assign me to one of the priestly positions to eat a piece of bread”

There are three levels of quotation in this verse. The author is continuing to quote the man of God (level 1). The man of God is continuing to tell Eli something that Yahweh has said (level 2). And in the last part of this verse, Yahweh describes what some of the remaining priests will say (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not three levels of quotation (see the Quotes within Quotes note).

See: Quote Markings

1 Samuel 2:36 (#2)

בְּבֵיתְךָ

“in your house”

Yahweh is using the term **house** to represent Eli's family. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in your family]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 2:36 (#5)

וְאָמַר

"and he will say"

Since Yahweh is referring to a group of people, it might be more natural in your language to use a plural form. Alternate translation: [and they will say]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Samuel 2:36 (#3)

לְהִשְׁתַּחֲוֹת לֹֽו

"to bow down to him"

Bowing down was a symbolic action that expressed submission and indicated need. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [to bow down to him in order to beg him]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel - Chapter 3 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the first section of the book, chapters 1–7, which describe Samuel as a religious leader of Israel. This chapter tells how Yahweh revealed to Samuel that he would judge and punish Eli and his descendants because Eli's sons had dishonored him by stealing from his offerings. This chapter also tells how Samuel grew up to be a respected prophet of Yahweh.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

How did the tent of meeting come to have "doors" (3:15)?

The author says in 3:15 that Samuel "opened the doors of the house of Yahweh." While the Bible itself does not record these developments, it appears that during the time when the tent of meeting was in Shiloh, the Israelites built some structures around it or made some changes to it so that people entered and left through doors rather than through curtains. These structural changes or additions are not significant to the biblical story itself, so you do not need to call attention in the text of your translation or in a footnote to this change from curtains to doors.

1 Samuel 3:1 (#7)

אֵֽין חָזוֹן נִפְרָֽץ

"vision {was} not spread"

The author is speaking as if a **vision** were a physical thing that could be **spread**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [not many people had visions]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 3:1 (#2)

לִפְנֵי עֵלִֽי

"to the face of Eli"

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:11. Alternate translation: [together with Eli] or [as an apprentice to Eli]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 3:1 (#3)

וּדְבַר־יְהוָ֖ה הָיָ֣ה יָקָ֑ר בַּיָּמִ֣ים הָהֵ֔ם אֵֽין חָזוֹן נִפְרָֽץ

"And the word of Yahweh was rare in those days; vision {was} not spread"

The author may be using two types of revelation, a **word** and a **vision**, to represent revelation in general, which would also include such things as dreams, signs, etc. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Not many people received revelations from Yahweh in those days]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 3:1 (#4)

וּדְבַר־יְהוָ֖ה הָיָ֣ה יָקָ֑ר

"And the word of Yahweh was rare"

The author is using the term **word** to represent what Yahweh said by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh rarely spoke to people]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 3:1 (#5)

בַּיָּמִ֣ים הָהֵ֔ם

"in those days"

The author is using the term **days** to represent a specific time, since time is made up of days. If it would be

helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [at that time]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 3:1 (#6)

אֵין חָזוֹן נִפְרָץ

“vision {was} not spread”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh was not spreading visions]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 3:1 (#1)

וְהַנַּעַר שְׁמוּאֵל מְשָׁרֵת אֶת־יְהוָה לִפְנֵי עֵלִי וּדְבַר־יְהוָה הָיָה יָקָר בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם אֵין חָזוֹן נִפְרָץ

“Now the boy Samuel was serving Yahweh to the face of Eli. And the word of Yahweh was rare in those days; vision {was} not spread”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 3:2 (#5)

וְעֵינוֹ

“Now his eyes”

The author is using the term **eyes** to represent. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Now his vision]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 3:2 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“And it happened”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:12.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 3:2 (#2)

בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא

“in that day”

The author is using the term **day** to represent a specific time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [at that time]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 3:2 (#4)

וְעֵינוֹ הֵחֵלּוּ כֵהוֹת לֹא יוּכַל לִרְאוֹת

“Now his eyes had begun {to be} dim; he was not able to see”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. If it would be clearer in your language, you could combine them. Alternate translation: [Now it had begun to be difficult for him to see well]

See: Parallelism

1 Samuel 3:2 (#3)

וְעֵינוֹ הֵחֵלּוּ כֵהוֹת לֹא יוּכַל לִרְאוֹת

“Now his eyes had begun {to be} dim; he was not able to see”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 3:3 (#3)

בְּהֵיכַל יְהוָה

“in the temple of Yahweh”

See the discussion in the Introduction to chapter 1 of why the author may use the term **temple** here and in 1:9, and see how you translated the term in 1:9. Alternate translation: [in the tent of meeting]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 3:3 (#2)

וְנֵר אֱלֹהִים טֶרֶם יִכְבֶּה

“And the lamp of God had not yet gone out”

The author is referring to the **lamp** still burning to represent that it was still night, since this lamp only burned at night. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And it was still night] or [And it was not yet morning]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 3:3 (#4)

אֲשֶׁר־שָׁ֣ם אֲרוֹן֙ אֱלֹהִ֔ים

“where the Box of God was there”

It might seem that the expression **there** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [where the Box of God was]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 3:3 (#1)

וְנֵ֣ר אֱלֹהִים֮ טֶ֣רֶם יִכְבֶּה֒

“And the lamp of God had not yet gone out”

By **the lamp of God**, the author means the lamp that the law of Moses commanded the Israelites in Exodus 27:21 to keep burning in the tent of meeting all night long. Alternate translation: [And the sacred lamp in the tent of meeting had not yet gone out]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 3:4 (#1)

הִנֵּֽנִי

“Behold me”

Samuel is responding to Yahweh with the courteous expression that a person in this culture would use to tell a superior that he had heard a summons and was ready and willing to obey. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, here and in verses 5, 6, 8, and 16. Alternate translation: [Yes, sir?] or [At your service]

See: Politeness

1 Samuel 3:5 (#1)

הִנֵּ֣נִי כִּֽי־קָרָ֔אתָ לִ֖י

“Behold me, for you called to me”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since you called me, I have come to see what I may do for you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 3:6 (#1)

בְּנִ֔י

“my son”

Eli is referring to Samuel with an affectionate expression. Use a comparable title or expression from your language and culture for addressing someone affectionately. Alternate translation: [young man]

See: Politeness

1 Samuel 3:7 (#2)

וּשְׁמוּאֵ֗ל טֶ֚רֶם יָדַ֣ע אֶת־יְהוָ֔ה וְטֶ֛רֶם יִגָּלֶ֥ה אֵלָ֖יו דְּבַר־יְהוָֽה

“Now Samuel did not yet know Yahweh, for the word of Yahweh had not yet been revealed to him”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Because the word of Yahweh had not yet been revealed to Samuel, Samuel did not yet know Yahweh]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 3:7 (#4)

וְטֶ֛רֶם יִגָּלֶ֥ה אֵלָ֖יו דְּבַר־יְהוָֽה

“for the word of Yahweh had not yet been revealed to him”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [for Yahweh had not yet revealed his word to him]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 3:7 (#3)

וּשְׁמוּאֵ֗ל טֶ֚רֶם יָדַ֣ע אֶת־יְהוָ֔ה

“Now Samuel did not yet know Yahweh”

The expression **did not … know Yahweh** has a different meaning here than it has in 2:12. The UST translation of both verses models one way of showing the difference in meaning.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 3:7 (#5)

וְטֶ֛רֶם יִגָּלֶ֥ה אֵלָ֖יו דְּבַר־יְהוָֽה

“for the word of Yahweh had not yet been revealed to him”

The author is using the term **word** to represent what Yahweh would have said by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for a message from Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 3:7 (#1)

וּשְׁמוּאֵ֗ל טֶ֚רֶם יָדַ֣ע אֶת־יְהוָ֔ה וְטֶ֥רֶם יִגָּלֶ֖ה אֵלָ֑יו דְּבַר־יְהוָֽה

“Now Samuel did not yet know Yahweh, for the word of Yahweh had not yet been revealed to him”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 3:8 (#1)

בַּשְּׁלִשִׁיתִֽ

“for a third {time”

The author is using the adjective **third** as a noun to mean a specific time. The ULT shows this by supplying the word **time**. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [yet again]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 3:8 (#2)

בַּשְּׁלִשִׁיתִֽ

“for a third {time”

If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you can use a cardinal number here or an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [for time number three]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Samuel 3:9 (#1)

דַּבֵּ֖ר יְהוָ֑ה כִּֽי שֹׁמֵ֥עַ עַבְדֶּֽךָ

“Speak, Yahweh, for your servant is listening”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since your servant is listening, speak, Yahweh]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 3:9 (#4)

כִּֽי שֹׁמֵ֥עַ עַבְדֶּֽךָ

“for your servant is listening”

Samuel assumes that Yahweh will understand that by **listening**, he means he will obey. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [for I will obey]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 3:9 (#3)

כִּֽי שֹׁמֵ֥עַ עַבְדֶּֽךָ

“for your servant is listening”

Samuel is speaking about himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [for I, your servant, am listening]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 3:9 (#2)

דַּבֵּ֖ר

“Speak”

This is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as “please” to make this clear. Alternate translation: [Please speak]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

1 Samuel 3:10 (#1)

כְּפַ֥עַם־בְּפַ֖עַם

“as time upon time”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean that Yahweh spoke this time just as he had the other times. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [just as he had the previous times]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 3:10 (#2)

דַּבֵּ֖ר כִּֽי שֹׁמֵ֥עַ עַבְדֶּֽךָ

“Speak, for your servant is listening”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:9.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 3:11 (#2)

אָנֹכִ֥י עֹשֶׂ֛ה

“I am doing”

Yahweh is speaking in the present tense of something that he is going to do in the near future. He is using that tense in order to show that he will certainly do this. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use the future tense. Alternate translation: [I am going to do]

See: Predictive Past

1 Samuel 3:11 (#1)

הִנֵּנִי

“Behold”

See how you translated the term **Behold** in 2:31. Alternate translation: [Pay attention!]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 3:11 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר כָּל־שֹׁמְעוֹ תְּצִלֶּינָה שְׁתֵּי אָזְנָיו

“that everyone hearing it, the two of his ears will tingle”

Yahweh is using a physical sensation that people will have (their **ears** will **tingle**) to represent the emotion that people will feel when they hear this news. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [that will horrify everyone who learns about it]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 3:12 (#1)

בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא

“In that day”

The author is using the term **day** to represent a specific time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [At that time]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 3:12 (#2)

אָקִים אֶל־עֵלִי

“I will raise up against Eli”

Yahweh is speaking as if what he said he would do were something physical that he could **raise up**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will make happen to Eli]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 3:12 (#4)

הָחֵל וְכַלֵּה

“beginning and ending”

Yahweh is speaking of two things in order to mean them and everything in between. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [I will do everything I said]

See: Merism

1 Samuel 3:12 (#3)

בֵּיתוֹ

“his house”

Yahweh is using the term **house** to represent a family, since members of a family often live in the same house. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [his family]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 3:13 (#1)

וְהִגַּדְתִּי לוֹ כִּי־שֹׁפֵט אֲנִי אֶת־בֵּיתוֹ עַד־עוֹלָם בַּעֲוֹן אֲשֶׁר־יָדַע כִּי־מְקַלְלִים לָהֶם בָּנָיו וְלֹא כִהָה בָּם

“Now I have declared to him that I am judging his house forever for the iniquity that he knew. For his sons have been cursing themselves, but he has not restrained them”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Because Eli’s sons have been cursing themselves and he has not restrained them, I have told him that I am judging his house forever for the iniquity that he knew]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 3:13 (#3)

שֹׁפֵט אֲנִי

“I am judging”

Yahweh is speaking in the present tense of something that he is going to do in the near future. He is using that tense in order to show that he will certainly do it. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use the future tense. Alternate translation: [I am about to judge]

See: Predictive Past

1 Samuel 3:13 (#2)

וְהִגַּדְתִּי לֹו

“Now I have declared to him”

Yahweh is providing background information to help Samuel understand why he is judging and punishing Eli’s family. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 3:13 (#5)

מְקַלְלִים לָהֶם

“have been cursing themselves”

The sense of the reflexive form here is not that Eli’s sons have actually spoken curses against themselves. Rather, Yahweh means that their actions have been so bad that these sons deserve to be cursed. Alternate translation: [have been making themselves accursed] or [have caused me to curse them]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

1 Samuel 3:13 (#4)

אֶת־בֵּיתֹו

“his house”

See how you translated the term **house** in 3:12. Alternate translation: [his family]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 3:14 (#1)

לְבֵית עֵלִי

“to the house of Eli”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:12. Alternate translation: [to the family of Eli]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 3:14 (#2)

אִם־יִתְכַּפֶּר עֲוֹן בֵּית־עֵלִי בְּזֶבַח וּבְמִנְחָה עַד־עוֹלָם

“If forever the iniquity of the house of Eli will cover itself by sacrifice or by offering”

Following the custom of this culture, Yahweh is swearing an oath by stating the first part of a condition (“if”) but not the second part (“then”). The implication is that if the first part of the condition were met, something very bad would happen, so it is certain that the first part of the condition will not be met. You could indicate that meaning in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [The iniquity of the house of Eli will certainly never cover itself by sacrifice or by offering]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Samuel 3:14 (#3)

אִם־יִתְכַּפֶּר עֲוֹן בֵּית־עֵלִי בְּזֶבַח וּבְמִנְחָה עַד־עוֹלָם

“If forever the iniquity of the house of Eli will cover itself by sacrifice or by offering”

Yahweh is speaking as if **iniquity** were a living thing that could **cover itself**. He is using the idea of covering to represent atonement for sin. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Neither sacrifice nor offering will ever cover the iniquity of the house of Eli] or [No one will ever be able to make atonement for the iniquity of the house of Eli]

See: Personification

1 Samuel 3:15 (#2)

אֶת־דַּלְתֹות בֵּית־יְהוָה

“the doors of the house of Yahweh”

See the discussion of these **doors** in the Introduction to this chapter.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 3:15 (#3)

וּשְׁמוּאֵל יָרֵא מֵהַגִּיד אֶת־הַמַּרְאָה אֶל־עֵלִי

“But Samuel was afraid of telling the vision to Eli”

The author assumes that readers will understand that Samuel did not tell Eli about the vision because he was afraid to do so. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [But Samuel was afraid of telling the vision to Eli, so he did not tell him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 3:15 (#1)

וַיִּפְתַּח אֶת־דַּלְתֹות בֵּית־יְהוָה

“then he opened the doors of the house of Yahweh”

The author is using one specific action that Samuel performed, opening these **doors**, to represent all of his regular duties. If it would be helpful in your lan-

guage, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [then he went about his duties as usual]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 3:15 (#4)

אֶת־הַמַּרְאָֽה

“the vision”

By **the vision**, the author seems to be implying that Yahweh appeared visibly to Samuel when he came and said the things he records in 3:11–14. The author’s statement in 3:10 that Yahweh “came and stationed himself” next to Samuel suggests that this was the case. Alternate translation: [what he had seen and heard]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 3:16 (#1)

בְּנִ֔י

“my son”

See how you translated this affectionate expression in 3:6. Alternate translation: [young man]

See: Politeness

1 Samuel 3:17 (#4)

כֹּֽה־יַעֲשֶׂה־לְּךָ֥ אֱלֹהִים֮ וְכֹ֣ה יוֹסִ֣יף אִם־תְּכַחֵד֩ מִמֶּ֨נִּי֙ דָּבָ֔ר מִכָּל־הַדָּבָ֕ר אֲשֶׁר־דִּבֶּ֥ר אֵלֶֽיךָ׃

“Thus may God do to you, and thus may he add, if you hide from me a word from all of the word that he spoke to you”

Eli is swearing an oath. Following the custom of his culture, he is asking God to do to Samuel the things God said he would do to Eli and his family if Samuel does not answer him truthfully. Use a natural way in your language to express an oath.

See: Oath Formulas

1 Samuel 3:17 (#1)

הַדָּבָ֖רְ

“was} the word”

Eli is using the term **word** to represent what Yahweh said by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [was the message]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 3:17 (#2)

אַל־נָ֣א תְכַחֵ֔ד מִמֶּ֖נִּי

“Please do not hide {it} from me”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could express this negative request as a positive one. Alternate translation: [Please show it to me]

See: Double Negatives

1 Samuel 3:17 (#5)

וְכֹ֣ה יוֹסִ֑יף

“and thus may he add”

Eli is using a common expression of his culture to emphasize that he wants Samuel to tell him everything. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and even more]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 3:17 (#7)

מִכָּל־הַדָּבָֽר

“from all of the word”

Eli is using the term **word** in the second instance in the verse to represent what Yahweh said by using words. In your translation, in both instances you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from the entire message]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 3:17 (#6)

דָּבָ֔ר

“a word”

Eli is making an overstatement for emphasis. By saying that he does not want Samuel to leave out a single word of what Yahweh said, he means that he wants Samuel to tell him all of the content of what Yahweh said. Alternate translation: [anything]

See: Hyperbole

1 Samuel 3:17 (#3)

אַל־נָ֣א תְכַחֵ֔ד מִמֶּ֖נִּי

“Please do not hide {it} from me”

Eli is speaking as if information were a physical object that Samuel might **hide**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Please do not withhold it from me]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 3:18 (#1)

וַיַּגֶּד־לוֹ שְׁמוּאֵל֙ אֶת־כָּל־הַדְּבָרִ֔ים וְלֹ֥א כִחֵ֖ד מִמֶּ֑נּוּ

“So Samuel declared to him all of the words, and he did not hide {anything} from him”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. If it would be clearer in your language, you could combine them. Alternate translation: [So Samuel openly told Eli everything that Yahweh had said]

See: Parallelism

1 Samuel 3:18 (#5)

הַטּ֥וֹב

“the good”

Eli is using the adjective **good** as a noun. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [what is good]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 3:18 (#3)

וַיֹּ֣אמֶר

“And he said”

The pronoun **he** refers to Eli. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Eli said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 3:18 (#4)

יְהוָ֖ה הֽוּא

“It {is} Yahweh”

Eli is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [It is Yahweh who has said this, and I acknowledge his authority to judge and punish my family]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 3:18 (#6)

בעינו

“in his eyes”

See how you translated this similar expression in 1:18. Alternate translation: [in his judgment]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 3:18 (#2)

אֶת־כָּל־הַדְּבָרִ֔ים

“all of the words”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:17. Alternate translation: [the whole message]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 3:19 (#2)

וַיהוָ֖ה הָיָ֣ה עִמּ֑וֹ

“and Yahweh was with him”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean that Yahweh helped Samuel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [and Yahweh helped him]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 3:19 (#3)

וְלֹא־הִפִּ֥יל מִכָּל־דְּבָרָ֖יו אָֽרְצָה

“and he did not cause {anything} from all of his words to fall to the ground”

The author is speaking as if **words** were physical objects that could **fall to the ground**. The suggestion is that Samuel’s words were never lost or ruined as things do that people drop or let fall, in other words, what he said always came true. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he made sure that everything Samuel said came true]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 3:19 (#1)

וַיִּגְדַּ֣ל שְׁמוּאֵ֔ל וַיהוָה֙ הָיָ֣ה עִמּ֔וֹ וְלֹא־הִפִּ֥יל מִכָּל־דְּבָרָ֖יו אָֽרְצָה

“And Samuel grew, and Yahweh was with him, and he did not cause {anything} from all of his words to fall to the ground”

Here and in the next two verses, the author is describing what happened at the end of the story of Samuel coming to know Yahweh. Your language may have its own way of presenting such information.

See: End of Story

1 Samuel 3:19 (#4)

וְלֹא־הִפִּ֥יל מִכָּל־דְּבָרָ֖יו

“and he did not cause {anything} from all of his words to fall”

The author is using the term **words** to represent what Samuel said by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [everything he said]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 3:20 (#1)

יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“Israel”

See the discussion in the Introduction to 1 Samuel of the use of the name of an ancestor to mean his descendants, and see how you translated this usage in 1:17. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 3:20 (#2)

מִדָּ֖ן וְעַד־בְּאֵ֣ר שָׁ֑בַע

“from Dan and unto Beersheba”

The author is speaking of two cities at the opposite ends of Israel’s territory in order to mean them and all the territory in between them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [across its entire territory]

See: Merism

1 Samuel 3:20 (#3)

נֶאֱמָ֣ן שְׁמוּאֵ֔ל לְנָבִ֖יא לַיהוָֽה

“Samuel was established as a prophet of Yahweh”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh had established Samuel as his prophet]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 3:20 (#4)

נֶאֱמָ֣ן

“was established”

See the discussion in the Introduction to chapter 2 of the term that the ULT translates as “faithful” in 2:35. That term could have the same meaning here. Alternate translation: [was faithful]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 3:21 (#1)

כִּ֤י

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces an explanation rather than a reason. Alternate translation: [This happened as]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 3:21 (#2)

בִּדְבַ֥ר יְהוָֽה

“by the word of Yahweh”

The author is using the term **word** to represent what Yahweh said by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [as he spoke to him]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel - Chapter 4 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the first section of the book, chapters 1–7, which describe Samuel as a religious leader of Israel. It begins a story that provides background for how Samuel helped the Israelites genuinely worship Yahweh again. This chapter describes two battles that the Israelites fought against the Philistines. In both battles, Israel was badly defeated, and in the second battle, the Philistines captured the Box of the Covenant.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did the Israelites think they would defeat the Philistines if they brought the Box of the Covenant with them into battle?

In 4:3, the elders of Israel conclude that the Philistines were able to defeat them because they did not bring the Box of the Covenant with them into battle. So they decide to bring the Box into the next battle. They may have been remembering that whenever the Israelites moved to a new place while traveling through the wilderness, when the priests would pick up the Box and begin to carry it, Moses would say, “Rise up, Yahweh, and may your enemies be scattered, and may those who hate you flee from your face” (Numbers 10:35). The elders may also have been remembering

how Yahweh had told them to carry the Box around the city of Jericho and how the walls of that city had collapsed, allowing the Israelites to conquer it (Joshua 5:6). The elders seem to believe mistakenly that the Box itself had power to help them. They say in 4:3 that "it will save us from the palm of our enemies." However, in the next battle, the Philistines defeat them again and capture the Box. Samuel tells the people in 7:3 the real reason why Yahweh was allowing the Philistines to defeat them. He says, "If you are going to return to Yahweh with all your heart, remove the gods of the foreigner and the Ashtoreths from your midst. And make firm your heart to Yahweh, and serve him alone, then he will rescue you from the hand of the Philistines." It was superstition for the Israelites to believe that a physical symbol of Yahweh had the power to help them. What they really needed to do was become wholeheartedly devoted to Yahweh, as Samuel ultimately led them to do.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Why do the Philistines say that the Egyptians were struck with plagues "in the wilderness" (4:8)?
In 4:8 the Philistines say, in response to the Box of the Covenant arriving in the Israelite military camp, "These are they, the gods who struck the Egyptians with every plague in the wilderness." This is historically inaccurate, since the ten plagues all happened in the land of Egypt, before the Israelites left and traveled across the wilderness. But the author may wish to show that the Philistines did not have accurate knowledge of the Israelites. By quoting them as saying "gods," he is showing that they did not know that the Israelites worshiped only the one true God, Yahweh. By quoting them further as saying that the plagues happened "in the wilderness," he may be showing that the Philistines also did not know the precise details of what Yahweh had done for the Israelites. (They just knew enough to be very afraid of what the Box of the Covenant represented.) So these inaccurate details are part of the author's characterization of the Philistines, and it would be appropriate to retain them in your translation.

1 Samuel 4:1 (#1)

וַיְהִי דְבַר־שְׁמוּאֵל לְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

"And the word of Samuel was to all of Israel"

See the discussion in the Introduction to this chapter of how you might format this sentence to show that it is part of the author's conclusion in 3:19–21 of the story of how Samuel became a prophet.

See: End of Story

1 Samuel 4:1 (#3)

יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיֵּצֵא יִשְׂרָאֵל׃

"Israel. Now Israel went out"

See the discussion in the Introduction to 1 Samuel of the use of the name of an ancestor to mean his descendants, and see how you translated this usage in 1:17. Alternate translation: [the Israelites. Now the Israelites went out]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 4:1 (#2)

וַיְהִי דְבַר־שְׁמוּאֵל לְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

"And the word of Samuel was to all of Israel"

The author is using the term **word** to represent what Samuel said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Samuel spoke messages to all Israel]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 4:2 (#5)

וַיַּכּוּ

"And they struck"

See the discussion of the term **struck** in the Introduction to 1 Samuel. Alternate translation: [And they killed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 4:2 (#1)

וַיִּנָּגֶף יִשְׂרָאֵל לִפְנֵי פְלִשְׁתִּים

"and Israel was struck to the face of the Philistines"

See the discussion of the term **face** in the Introduction to 1 Samuel, and see how you translated the similar expression in 1:12. Alternate translation: [and Israel was struck by the Philistines]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 4:2 (#3)

וַיִּנָּגֶף יִשְׂרָאֵל לִפְנֵי פְלִשְׁתִּים

"and Israel was struck to the face of the Philistines"

The word translated **was struck** here, meaning "was defeated," is different from the one in the next sentence translated **they struck**, meaning "they killed." Alternate translation: [and Israel was defeated by

the Philistines] or [and the Philistines defeated the Israelites]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 4:2 (#4)

וַיַּכּוּ

“And they struck”

The pronoun **they** refers to the Philistine soldiers. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the Philistines struck]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 4:2 (#2)

וַיִּנָּגֶף יִשְׂרָאֵל לִפְנֵי פְּלִשְׁתִּים

“and Israel was struck to the face of the Philistines”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the Philistines struck the Israelites]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 4:3 (#2)

מִכַּף אוֹיְבֵינוּ

“from the palm of our enemies”

See the discussion in the Introduction to 1 Samuel of the use of the word “hand” to represent power. The elders are using the word **palm** here to mean the same thing. Alternate translation: [from the power of our enemies]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 4:3 (#1)

לָמָּה נְגָפָנוּ יְהוָה הַיּוֹם לִפְנֵי פְּלִשְׁתִּים

“Why did Yahweh strike us today to the face of the Philistines”

There is an implicit answer to this question in what the elders decide to do the rest of this verse. They feel as if Yahweh himself has defeated them, and they believe the reason is that they did not bring the Box of the Covenant with them into battle. See the discussion in the Introduction to this chapter of why they believed this. The UST models one way to supply this implicit information.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 4:4 (#1)

וְשָׁם שְׁנֵי בְנֵי־עֵלִי עִם & חָפְנִי וּפִינְחָס

“And the two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, {were} there with”

The word **there** does not refer to Shiloh but to the place to which the Israelites brought the **Box of the Covenant**. Alternate translation: [And the two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, were accompanying]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 4:5 (#2)

וַיָּרִעוּ כָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל תְּרוּעָה גְדוֹלָה

“that all of Israel shouted a great shout”

For emphasis, the author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [that all of Israel shouted very loudly]

See: Poetry

1 Samuel 4:5 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“And it happened”

See how you translated the phrase “And it happened” in 1:12.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 4:6 (#2)

אֲרוֹן יְהוָה בָּבָא אֶל־הַמַּחֲנֶה

“the Box of Yahweh had come into the camp”

The author is speaking of **the Box of Yahweh** as if it were a living thing that could have **come into the camp** on its own. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Israelites had brought the Box of God into their camp]

See: Personification

1 Samuel 4:6 (#1)

אֶת־קוֹל הַתְּרוּעָה

“the sound of the shout”

It might seem that the expression **the sound of the shout** contains extra information that would not be

natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [the shout]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 4:7 (#1)

וַיִּרְאוּ הַפְּלִשְׁתִּים כִּי אָמְרוּ בָּבָא אֱלֹהִים אֶל־הַמַּחֲנֶה

“And the Philistines feared, for they said, “A god has come into the camp”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And the Philistines said, “A god has come into the camp!” and that thought made them very afraid]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 4:7 (#4)

אֶתְמוֹל שִׁלְשֹׁם

“yesterday {or} the third day”

In this culture, the current day was considered the first day, the previous day was considered the second day, and the day before that was considered **the third day**. In your translation, describe these days as your language and culture naturally would. Alternate translation: [yesterday or the day before]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 4:7 (#2)

בָּבָא אֱלֹהִים אֶל־הַמַּחֲנֶה

“A god has come into the camp”

The word that the ULT translates as **god** is plural, but the verb **has come** is singular. This suggests that as the author expresses the meaning of what the Philistines said in their own language, he is using the plural form to indicate greatness. Your language may be able to use a plural subject with a singular verb for this same purpose. If not, you could convey the meaning in another way. Alternate translation: [A great god has come into the camp]

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

1 Samuel 4:7 (#3)

אֲוֹי לָנוּ

“Woe to us”

The Philistines are using a phrase that expresses a strong feeling, fear. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this strong feeling. If not, you could say what the Philistines were feeling, or you could say what they were afraid of, here and in the next verse. Alternate translation: [Oh, no!] or [We are in great danger!]

See: Exclamations

1 Samuel 4:7 (#5)

אֶתְמוֹל שִׁלְשֹׁם

“yesterday {or} the third day”

The Philistines are using **yesterday or the third day** as a common expression of their culture to mean “at any time in the past.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in days gone by] or [ever in the past]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 4:8 (#7)

בַּמִּדְבָּר

“in the wilderness”

See the discussion of this phrase in the Introduction to this chapter.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 4:8 (#1)

מִמִּי יַצִּילֵנוּ מִיַּד הָאֱלֹהִים הָאַדִּירִים הָאֵלֶּה

“Who will deliver us from the hand of these mighty gods”

The Philistines are using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [We cannot imagine who could deliver us from the hand of these mighty gods!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 4:8 (#5)

הַמַּכִּים

“having struck”

The Philistine soldiers are speaking as if Yahweh had actually **struck** or hit the Egyptians with these plagues. If it would be helpful in your language, you

could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who afflicted]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 4:8 (#3)

הָאֱלֹהִים הָאַדִּירִים הָאֵלֶּה & הָאֱלֹהִים

“these mighty gods & the gods”

The word **gods** is plural in both instances, and the verb **struck** is also plural. This suggests that the author is showing that the Philistines were speaking here about multiple gods whom they mistakenly thought the Israelites worshiped. The Philistines apparently thought that one of these gods had come into the Israelite camp when the Box of the Covenant arrived. So it would be appropriate to use plural forms in your translation.

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

1 Samuel 4:8 (#6)

בְּכָל־מַכָּה

“with every plague”

The Philistines are making an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [with many terrible plagues]

See: Hyperbole

1 Samuel 4:8 (#2)

מִיַּד

“from the hand of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:3. Alternate translation: [from the power of]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 4:8 (#4)

אֵלֶּה הֵהֵם הָאֱלֹהִים הַמַּכִּים

“These are they, the gods having struck”

It might seem that the expression **These are they, the gods who struck** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [These are the same gods who struck]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 4:9 (#2)

הִתְחַזְּקוּ וִהְיוּ לַאֲנָשִׁים

“Strengthen yourselves and be men”

The Philistines are using the term **men** to represent people who are courageous. The implication is that strong, experienced, full-grown men would be courageous in situations where weaker, inexperienced boys and youths would not. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Strengthen yourselves and be courageous]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 4:9 (#1)

הִתְחַזְּקוּ וִהְיוּ לַאֲנָשִׁים פְּלִשְׁתִּים פֶּן תַּעַבְדוּ לְעִבְרִים כַּאֲשֶׁר עָבְדוּ לָכֶם

“Strengthen yourselves and be men, Philistines, lest you serve for the Hebrews, just as they have served for you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [So that you do not serve for the Hebrews, just as they have served for you, strengthen yourselves and be men, Philistines]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 4:9 (#3)

הִתְחַזְּקוּ וִהְיוּ לַאֲנָשִׁים

“Strengthen yourselves and be men”

These two phrases mean similar things. The Philistines are using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [Be very courageous]

See: Doublet

1 Samuel 4:9 (#4)

וְהִיִיתֶם לַאֲנָשִׁים וְנִלְחַמְתֶּם

“So be men and fight”

The phrase **be men and fight** expresses a single idea. The word **fight** tells more about what **men** would or should do in this situation. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [So fight courageously]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 4:10 (#1)

וַיִּלָּחֲמ֣וּ פְלִשְׁתִּ֔ים

“And the Philistines fought”

The author assumes that readers will know that by **fought**, he means that the Philistines fought courageously, as they told themselves they had to do. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [So the Philistines fought courageously]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 4:10 (#2)

וַיִּנָּגֶף֙ יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל וַיָּנֻ֖סוּ אִ֣ישׁ לְאָהָלָ֑יו

“and Israel was struck and fled, a man to his tent”

The author is using **a man to his tent** as a common expression of his culture to mean that the soldiers stopped their military campaign altogether and each of them went back to his home and family. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they defeated the Israelite soldiers, who fled from the battle and left the army and went home]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 4:10 (#3)

הַמַּכָּ֖ה גְּדוֹלָ֥ה מְאֹֽד

“a very great striking”

The word **striking** here is from the same root word as the verb that the ULT translates as “struck” in 4:2. See how you translated the verb there. Alternate translation: [a very great slaughter]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 4:10 (#4)

וַיִּפֹּ֣ל מִיִּשְׂרָאֵ֔ל שְׁלֹשִׁ֥ים אֶ֖לֶף רַגְלִֽי

“for 30,000 foot soldiers from Israel fell”

The author is using the term **fell** to mean that these soldiers were killed in the battle, to represent the way they fell to the ground when they died. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for 30,000 foot soldiers from Israel died]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 4:11 (#1)

וַאֲרוֹן֙ אֱלֹהִ֣ים נִלְקָ֔ח

“And the Box of God was taken”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the Philistines took the Box of God]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 4:12 (#1)

וּמַדָּ֖יו קְרֻעִ֑ים וַאֲדָמָ֖ה עַל־רֹאשֽׁוֹ

“And his clothes were torn, and earth was on his head”

Tearing his **clothes** and putting **earth** on his **head** were symbolic actions by which this man demonstrated his great distress over the news he was bringing. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [And he had torn his clothes and put earth on his head to show his great distress]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 4:13 (#5)

וַתִּזְעַ֖ק כָּל־הָעִֽיר

“and all of the city cried out”

The author is making an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [and people throughout the city cried out]

See: Hyperbole

1 Samuel 4:13 (#3)

הָיָ֥ה לִבּ֛וֹ חָרֵ֖ד

“his heart {was} afraid”

The author is using one part of Eli, his **heart**, to mean all of him in the act of feeling strongly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he was greatly afraid]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 4:13 (#1)

וְהִנֵּ֣ה

“and behold”

The author is using the term **behold** to call attention to what he is about to say. See how you translated

the similar expression in 2:31, where Yahweh uses the term in the same way.

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 4:13 (#2)

מְצַפֶּה

“watching”

Since the author explains in 4:15 that Eli was blind, he does not mean that Eli was literally **watching** the road to see whether any messengers were coming. He means that Eli was waiting for news and hoping to recognize a messenger from the sound of his arrival. Alternate translation: [waiting]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 4:13 (#4)

וַתִּזְעַק כָּל־הָעִיר

“and all of the city cried out”

The author is using the term **city** to represent the people of the city. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and all of the people of the city cried out]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 4:14 (#2)

מַהֵר וַיָּבֹא

“hurried and came”

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **hurried** tells in what way the messenger **came**. Alternate translation: [came hurriedly]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 4:14 (#1)

אֶת־קוֹל הַצְּעָקָה

“the sound of the outcry”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [the outcry]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 4:15 (#1)

בֶּן־תִּשְׁעִים וּשְׁמֹנֶה שָׁנָה

“was} a son of 98 years”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to state someone’s age. In your translation, express this in the way your culture would state someone’s age. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [was 98 years old]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 4:15 (#2)

וְעֵינָיו קָמָה וְלֹא יָכֹל לִרְאוֹת

“And his eyes had set, and he was not able to see”

The author is using the phrase **his eyes had set** to describe an eye condition that was most likely cataracts. He said of Eli in 3:2 that “his eyes had begun to be dim,” that is, he could see objects only faintly. Now the cataracts had advanced to the point where his eyes no longer moved. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could name this condition explicitly in your translation. Alternate translation: [And he had severe cataracts, so he was not able to see anything]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 4:16 (#2)

בְּנִי

“my son”

Eli is addressing the messenger with a polite and gentle expression. Use a comparable title or expression for addressing someone politely and gently in your language. Alternate translation: [young man]

See: Politeness

1 Samuel 4:16 (#1)

אָנֹכִי הַבָּבָא מִן־הַמַּעֲרָכָה וַאֲנִי מִן־הַמַּעֲרָכָה נַסְתִּי הַיּוֹם

“I {am} the one coming from the array, and I myself fled from the array today”

The messenger is using poetic language to introduce the solemn news that he must share. Following the conventions of Hebrew poetry, he is saying something and then repeating the idea in different words. It may be helpful in your translation to connect these phrases with a word other than **and** to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [I have just come from the battle lines, indeed, I myself fled from them today]

See: Parallelism

1 Samuel 4:17 (#1)

וַיֹּ֖אמֶר

“and said”

The expression **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this expression explicitly. Alternate translation: [And the one bringing news replied]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 4:17 (#2)

וַאֲרוֹן הָאֱלֹהִים נִלְקָחָה

“and the Box of God has been taken”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the Philistines have taken the Box of God]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 4:18 (#2)

וַתִּשָּׁבֵר מַפְרַקְתּוֹ וַיָּמָת כִּי־זָקֵן הָאִישׁ וְכָבֵד

“And his neck was broken, and he died, for the man {was} old and heavy”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And since the man was old and heavy, his neck was broken, and he died]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 4:18 (#4)

וְהוּא שָׁפַט אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל אַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה

“And he had judged Israel 40 years”

Here the author is presenting information that concludes the story of the life of Eli. This is the last mention of Eli in the book. Your language may have its own way of presenting such information.

See: End of Story

1 Samuel 4:18 (#3)

וַתִּשָּׁבֵר מַפְרַקְתּוֹ

“And his neck was broken”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And he broke his neck]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 4:18 (#1)

כְּהַזְכִּירָ֥ו ׀ אֶת־אֲרוֹן֮ הָאֱלֹהִים֒ וַיִּפֹּ֣ל & אֶחֹרַנְּי֗וֹת

“in his mentioning of the Box of God, that he fell backward”

The pronoun **his** refers to the messenger, while the pronoun **he** refers to Eli. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [when the messenger mentioned the Box of God, that Eli fell backward]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 4:19 (#4)

וַתִּכְרַ֥ע וַתֵּ֖לֶד כִּי־נֶהְפְּכ֣וּ עָלֶ֑יהָ צִרֶ֖יהָ

“And she knelt down and gave birth, for her pangs turned themselves upon her”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And her pangs turned themselves upon her, so she knelt down and gave birth]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 4:19 (#2)

אֶל־הֻלְּקָחַ֖ת אֲרוֹן֙ הָאֱלֹהִ֔ים

“about the Box of God being taken”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that the Philistines had taken the Box of God]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 4:19 (#3)

וּמֵ֣ת חָמִ֔יהָ וְאִישָׁ֑הּ

“and {that} her father-in-law had died and her husband”

It may be more natural in your language and culture to put the information about **her husband** before the information about **her father-in-law** as in the UST.

See: Information Structure

1 Samuel 4:19 (#5)

נֶהֶפְכוּ עָלֶיהָ צִרֶיהָ

“her pangs turned themselves upon her”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to describe childbirth. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [she abruptly went into labor]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 4:19 (#1)

וְכַלָּתְתּוֹ אֵשֶׁת־פִּינְחָסס הָרָה לָלֶדֶת

“Now his daughter-in-law, the wife of Phinehas, {was} pregnant, {about} to give birth”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 4:20 (#2)

וַתְּדַבֵּרְנָהּ הַנִּצָּבוֹת עָלֶיהָ

“then the ones standing over her said”

In the original language, the verbs **standing** and **said** are marked as feminine, indicating that this is a reference to women who were helping Phinehas’ wife deliver her baby. If your language does not mark verbs for gender, you may wish to indicate this explicitly in your translation. Alternate translation: [then the women standing over her said]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 4:20 (#4)

אַל־תִּירְאִי כִּי בֵן יָלָדְתְּ

“Do not fear, for you have borne a son”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since you have borne a son, do not fear]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 4:20 (#1)

וּכְעֵת מוּתָהּ

“And about the time of her dying”

The author assumes that readers will understand that because this childbirth was provoked by great grief and distress, it was very difficult, and it caused the death of the mother. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And unfortunately her delivery was so difficult that it would cause her to die, but as she was dying]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 4:20 (#3)

הַנִּצָּבוֹת עָלֶיהָ

“the ones standing over her”

The author is using the phrase **standing over her** by association to refer to the women who were helping Phinehas’ wife deliver her baby. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the women who were helping her deliver her baby]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 4:20 (#5)

וְלֹא עָנְתָה וְלֹא־שָׁתָה לִבָּהּ

“But she did not answer, for she did not set her heart”

Here the **heart** represents the thoughts and feelings. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But she did not answer, and she paid no attention to this]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 4:20 (#6)

וְלֹא עָנְתָה וְלֹא־שָׁתָה לִבָּהּ

“But she did not answer, for she did not set her heart”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [But since she did not set her heart, she did not answer] or [But she paid no attention to this, so she did not answer]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 4:21 (#1)

אִי־כָבוֹד

“Ichabod”

The name Ichabod means “no glory.” If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain this in a footnote.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 4:21 (#3)

אֶל־הִלָּקְחוֹ אֲרוֹן הָאֱלֹהִים

“about the Box of God being taken”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [about the Philistines taking of the Box of God]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 4:21 (#4)

וְאֶל־חָמְיָהּ וְאִישָׁהּ

“and about her father-in-law and her husband”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and about the deaths of her father-in-law and her husband]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 4:21 (#2)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

See the discussion of the term **saying** in the Introduction to 1 Samuel. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 4:21 (#5)

וְאֶל־חָמְיָהּ וְאִישָׁהּ

“and about her father-in-law and her husband”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:19. Alternate translation: [and about her husband and her father-in-law]

See: Information Structure

1 Samuel 4:22 (#2)

וַתֹּאמֶר גָּלְתָה כָבוֹד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל כִּֽי נִלְקְחָה אֲרוֹן הָאֱלֹהִים

“Now she said “the glory has departed from Israel” because the Box of God had been taken”

The quotation from Phinehas’s wife may extend to the end of the verse. Alternate translation: [And she said, “The glory has departed from Israel, for the Box of God had been taken!”]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Samuel 4:22 (#3)

נִלְקְחָה אֲרוֹן הָאֱלֹהִים

“the Box of God had been taken”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the Philistines had taken the Box of God]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 4:22 (#1)

וַתֹּאמֶר גָּלְתָה כָבוֹד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל כִּֽי נִלְקְחָה אֲרוֹן הָאֱלֹהִים

“Now she said “the glory has departed from Israel” because the Box of God had been taken”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand more specifically what has happened in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel - Chapter 5 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the first section of the book, chapters 1–7, which describe Samuel as a religious leader of Israel. It continues a story that provides background for how Samuel helped the Israelites genuinely worship Yahweh again. This chapter describes how Yahweh struck the people of Philistine cities with plagues when they put the Box of the Covenant in their idol temples.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The Box of the Covenant in Philistine cities

The Philistines took the Box of the Covenant to the city of Ashdod and put it in the temple of their idol Dagon. That was a way of claiming that Dagon had enabled them to defeat the Israelites and even that Dagon was stronger than Yahweh. However, the large statue of Dagon in the temple fell down in front of the Box as if it were a slave prostrating himself before his master. That showed that Yahweh was actually much greater and stronger than Dagon. The people of Ashdod also began getting tumors, and swarms of mice began

eating up their crops. So the people of Ashdod sent the Box to the city of Gath. But the same bad things happened to the people of Gath. So they sent the Box to the city of Ekron. The people there were so afraid of the Box that they did not want it there, and they asked their rulers to send it back to Israel.

1 Samuel 5:1 (#1)

וּפְלִשְׁתִּיִּם לָקְחוּ אֵת אֲרוֹן הָאֱלֹהִים וַיְבִאֻהוּ מֵאֶבֶן הָעֵזֶר אַשְׁדּוֹדָה

“Now the Philistines had taken the Box of God and brought it from Ebenezer to Ashdod”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 5:2 (#3)

וַיַּצִּיגוּ אֹתוֹ אֵצֶל דָּגוֹן

“And they placed it beside Dagon”

Placing the Box of Yahweh **beside Dagon** in his temple was a symbolic action by which the Philistines were asserting that Dagon had defeated Yahweh and thus his people, the Israelites. They were treating the Box of God as a trophy of victory. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [And they placed it beside Dagon to suggest that Dagon had defeated Yahweh]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 5:2 (#4)

דָּגוֹן

“Dagon”

The assumes that readers will know that by **Dagon**, he means the large statue of Dagon that was in the temple at Ashdod. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the large statue of Dagon in the temple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 5:2 (#1)

בֵּית דָּגוֹן

“the house of Dagon”

The author is speaking as if Dagon’s temple were a **house** in which he lived. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the temple of Dagon]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 5:2 (#2)

דָּגוֹן

“Dagon”

The word **Dagon** is the name of a false god that the Philistines worshiped.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 5:3 (#1)

וַיַּשְׁכִּמוּ אַשְׁדּוֹדִים & אֶת

“And the Ashdodites arose early & And”

Here the expression **arose early** does not necessarily mean that the Ashdodites got up earlier than usual in order to look inside the temple. While the author often does use the expression to mean that people got up earlier than usual in order to do an action he describes, for example, in 1:19 and 15:12, here and in the next verse it introduces what happened when the Ashdodites first got up. The UST models one way to express this meaning.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 5:3 (#2)

וְהִנֵּה דָגוֹן

“and behold, Dagon”

See how you translated the word “Behold” in 2:31. Alternate translation: [and they found that Dagon]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 5:3 (#3)

דָּגוֹן נֹפֵל לְפָנָיו אַרְצָה

“Dagon was fallen on his face to the ground”

In this culture, lying face down on the ground in front of someone was an action that symbolized submission. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [Dagon was submissively lying prostrate]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 5:3 (#4)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:12. Alternate translation: [before]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 5:4 (#1)

וְרֹ֣אשׁ דָּגוֹן֮ וּשְׁתֵּ֣י ׀ כַּפֹּתָיו֒ כְּרֻתוֹת֙

“And the head of Dagon and the two of the palms of his hands were cut off”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And it appeared that someone had cut off the head of Dagon and the two of the palms of his hands]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 5:4 (#2)

וְרֹ֣אשׁ דָּגוֹן֮ וּשְׁתֵּ֣י ׀ כַּפֹּתָיו֒ כְּרֻתוֹת֙

“And the head of Dagon and the two of the palms of his hands were cut off”

Cutting off the **head** and **hands** of Dagon was a symbolic action that indicated that this false god was not wise enough or strong enough to defend himself. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [And the head of Dagon and the two of the palms of his hands were cut off, demonstrating how helpless he actually was]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 5:4 (#6)

רַ֥ק דָּגוֹן֙ נִשְׁאַ֣ר עָלָֽיו

“Only Dagon was left on him”

The author assumes that his readers will understand that by **Dagon**, in this instance he means the part of the statute that looked like a fish. The name Dagon comes from the word for “fish.” Fish symbolized prosperity for the Philistines, who lived by the seacoast. Statues of Dagon had a human head and hands but the body of a fish. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [The only thing left of the statute was the part that looked like a fish]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 5:4 (#5)

אֶל־הַמִּפְתָּ֖ן

“on the threshold”

Leaving the **head** and **hands** of Dagon on the **threshold**, where people coming in and out of the temple would trample on them, was a symbolic action that expressed contempt for these symbols of Dagon’s supposed wisdom and power. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Someone had left them contemptuously on the threshold]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 5:4 (#3)

וּשְׁתֵּ֣י ׀ כַּפֹּתָיו֒

“and the two of the palms of his hands”

The word that the ULT translates as **hands** could indicate someone’s entire lower arms, so the author is clarifying what specific part of them had been **cut off**. Your language may be able to refer to this part more simply, and so this expression may seem to contain extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [and his hands]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 5:4 (#4)

אֶל־הַמִּפְתָּ֖ן

“on the threshold”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and they were lying on the threshold]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 5:5 (#1)

עַל־כֵּ֞ן לֹֽא־יִדְרְכוּ֣ כֹהֲנֵ֣י דָגוֹן֮ וְכָל־הַבָּאִים֒ בֵּ֣ית־דָּגוֹן֮ עַל־מִפְתַּ֣ן דָּגוֹן֒ בְּאַשְׁדּ֔וֹד עַ֖ד הַיּ֥וֹם הַזֶּֽה

“Therefore the priests of Dagon and all of the ones entering the house of Dagon do not tread on the threshold of Dagon in Ashdod to this day”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand how what happened in this story is the source of a cultural practice with which they may be familiar. In your translation, introduce

this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 5:5 (#2)

בֵּית־דָּגוֹן

“the house of Dagon”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:2.

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 5:5 (#3)

דָּגוֹן & מִפְתַּן

“the threshold of Dagon”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [the threshold of the temple of Dagon]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 5:5 (#4)

עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה

“to this day”

See the discussion of this phrase in the Introduction to 1 Samuel. The author is using this phrase to refer to the time when he was writing. In your translation, make clear that the phrase refers to a time that is now in the past. Avoid giving the impression the phrase means “to the present day.” Alternate translation: [right up to the time of this writing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 5:6 (#1)

וַתִּכְבַּד יַד־יְהוָה אֶל־הָאַשְׁדּוֹדִים

“And the hand of Yahweh was heavy on the Ashdodites”

See the discussion of the term **hand** in the Introduction to 1 Samuel, and see how you translated the term in 4:8. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh used his power greatly against the Ashdodites]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 5:6 (#3)

וַיַּךְ אֹתָם֙ בעפלים

“and struck them with tumors”

The word **tumors** refers to some kind of skin growth. The author distinguishes in 5:9 and 5:12 between people who were struck with this affliction and people who died, indicating that it was not immediately fatal. It could mean: (1) tumors, as in the ULT. (2) hemorrhoids. Alternate translation: [and struck them with hemorrhoids]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 5:6 (#4)

אֶת־אַשְׁדּוֹד וְאֶת־גְּבוּלֶיהָ

“Ashdod and its borders”

The author is using the name **Ashdod** to represent the people who lived in that city, and he is using the term **borders** to represent “territories,” since territories may be defined by their borders. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people of Ashdod and the surrounding territories]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 5:6 (#2)

וַיְשֹׁמֵֽם

“and he devastated them”

This seems to be an implicit reference to a plague that **devastated** the crops in the area. The description of the guilt offering in 6:4 indicates that this was a plague of mice that came in great numbers and devoured the crops. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and he sent a plague of mice that devoured their crops]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 5:7 (#1)

וַיִּרְאוּ אַנְשֵׁי־אַשְׁדּוֹד

“And the men of Ashdod saw”

Here the masculine term **men** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [And the people of Ashdod saw]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Samuel 5:7 (#2)

לְֽא־יֵשֵׁ֞ב אֲרוֹן֩ אֱלֹהֵ֨י יִשְׂרָאֵ֜ל עִמָּ֗נוּ כִּֽי־קָשְׁתָ֤ה יָדוֹ֙ עָלֵ֔ינוּ וְעַ֖ל דָּגֹ֣ון אֱלֹהֵ֑ינוּ

“The Box of the God of Israel should not stay with us, for his hand is severe against us and against Dagon our god”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since the hand of the God of Israel is severe against us and against Dagon our god, his Box should not stay with us]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 5:7 (#3)

כִּֽי־קָשְׁתָ֤ה יָדוֹ֙

“for his hand is severe”

See how you translated the similar expression in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [for he is using his power greatly]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 5:8 (#1)

גַּ֣ת יִסֹּ֔ב אֲרוֹן֙ אֱלֹהֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“Let the Box of the God of Israel go around {to} Gath”

The people of Ashdod are speaking of **the Box of the God of Israel** as if it were a living thing that could **go around to Gath** by itself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Have someone bring the Box of the God of Israel over to Gath]

See: Personification

1 Samuel 5:8 (#2)

וַיַּסֵּ֖בּוּ אֶת־אֲרֹ֣ון אֱלֹהֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“So they brought around the Box of the God of Israel”

It might seem that the expression **brought around** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [So they brought the Box of the God of Israel]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 5:8 (#3)

וַיַּסֵּ֖בּוּ אֶת־אֲרֹ֣ון אֱלֹהֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“So they brought around the Box of the God of Israel”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [So they brought the Box of the God of Israel to Gath]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 5:9 (#2)

וַתְּהִ֤י יַד־יְהוָה֙ ׀ בָּעִ֣ירָ֔

“that the hand of Yahweh was on the city”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:6. Alternate translation: [that Yahweh also used his power against that city]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 5:9 (#3)

מְהוּמָ֥ה גְדוֹלָ֖ה מְאֹֽד

“a very great tumult”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and this caused a very great tumult]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 5:9 (#5)

אֶת־אַנְשֵׁ֣י הָעִ֔יר

“the men of the city”

Here the masculine term **men** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [the people of the city]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Samuel 5:9 (#6)

מִקָּטֹ֥ן וְעַד־גָּדֹ֖ול

“from small and unto great”

The author is speaking of two groups of people in order to mean them and everyone in between. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Here the words **small** and **great** could mean either "young" and "old" or "weak" and "powerful," but the meaning would be basically the same either way. Alternate translation: [regardless of their social condition]

See: Merism

1 Samuel 5:9 (#1)

וַיְהִ֗י

"And it happened"

See how you translated this phrase in 1:12.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 5:9 (#4)

וַיַּ֤ךְ

"And he struck"

See the discussion of the term **struck** in the Introduction to 1 Samuel, and see how you translated the term in 4:2. Alternate translation: [And he killed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 5:9 (#7)

לָהֶ֔ם

"on them"

The pronoun **them** refers not to the **men** whom Yahweh **struck** but to other people in the city of Gath. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [on others of them] or [on other people in the city]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 5:10 (#1)

וַיְשַׁלְּח֖וּ

"So they sent"

The pronoun **they** refers to the people of Gath. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [So the people of Gath sent]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 5:10 (#5)

וְאֶת־עַמִּ֑י

"and my people"

By **people**, the Ekronites mean their families. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and my family]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 5:10 (#4)

הֵסַ֣בּוּ אֵלַ֗י אֶת־אֲרוֹן֙ אֱלֹהֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

"They have brought around to me the Box of the God of Israel"

Here the people of Ekron are not using the pronoun **they** to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [The Box of the God of Israel has been brought around to me] or [The Box of the God of Israel has been brought around to us]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 5:10 (#2)

לֵאמֹ֔ר

"saying"

See whether you chose to represent the term **saying** in 4:21, and if so, how you translated it.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 5:10 (#3)

הֵסַ֣בּוּ אֵלַ֗י אֶת־אֲרוֹן֙ אֱלֹהֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל לַהֲמִיתֵ֥נִי וְאֶת־עַמִּ֖י

"They have brought around to me the Box of the God of Israel to kill me and my people"

The author is describing what each one of the **Ekronites** said. But since he is referring to a group of people and ascribes this quotation to a plural subject, it may be more natural in your language to use plural pronouns within the quotation. Alternate translation: [They have brought around to us the Box of the God of Israel to kill all of us]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Samuel 5:11 (#2)

אוֹתִ֖י וְאֶת־עַמִּ֑י

"me and my people"

See how you translated the similar expression in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [me and my family] or [all of us]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Samuel 5:11 (#1)

וַיֹּאמְרוּ֙ שַׁלְּח֣וּ אֶת־אֲר֣וֹן אֱלֹהֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵל֮ וְיָשֹׁ֣ב לִמְקֹמ֒וֹ וְלֹא־יָמִ֤ית אֹתִ֙י֙ וְאֶת־עַמִּ֔י כִּֽי־הָיְתָ֥ה מְהוּמַת־מָ֖וֶת בְּכָל־הָעִ֑יר

“and they said, “Send away the Box of the God of Israel that it may return to its place, and it will not kill me and my people!” For there was a tumult of death in all of the city”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [and because there was a tumult of death in all of the city, they said, “Send away the Box of the God of Israel that it may return to its place, and it will not kill me and my people!”]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 5:11 (#3)

כָּבְדָ֛ה מְאֹ֖ד יַ֣ד הָאֱלֹהִ֑ים שָֽׁם

“The hand of God {was} very heavy there”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:9. Alternate translation: [God was using his power greatly there]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 5:12 (#3)

הָעִ֑יר

“the city”

The author is using the term **city** to represent the people who lived in the city. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language as in the UST.

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 5:12 (#1)

וְהָאֲנָשִׁ֣ים

“And the men”

Here the masculine term **term** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [And the people]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Samuel 5:12 (#2)

בעפלים

“with tumors”

See how you translated the term **tumors** in 5:6.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 5:12 (#4)

וַתַּ֥עַל שַׁוְעַ֖ת הָעִ֣יר הַשָּׁמָֽיִם

“And the cry of the city went up to the heavens”

The author is making an overstatement for emphasis. He is suggesting that this **cry** was so loud that it could be heard all the way up in the sky. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [And the cry of the city was so loud that it could be heard at a great distance]

See: Hyperbole

1 Samuel - Chapter 6 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the first section of the book, chapters 1–7, which describe Samuel as a religious leader of Israel. It concludes a story that provides background for how Samuel helped the Israelites genuinely worship Yahweh again. This chapter describes how the Philistines returned the Box of the Covenant to the Israelites in a way that confirmed that Yahweh had struck them with plagues to punish them for taking it.

The list of cities in 6:17

The list of cities in 1 Samuel 6:17 is similar to the list of kings in Joshua 12:9–24. If you have already translated the book of Joshua, see how you formatted that list. You may wish to format the list here similarly.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did the Philistines send the Box back to Israel on a cart drawn by cows?

The Philistine leaders asked their priests what they should do with the Box. The priests said to send it back with an offering that showed they were sorry for taking it. The Philistines put the Box on a cart. They had two cows pull the cart, and they let them go wherever they wanted. Even though the cows had just given birth and were nursing their calves, they left their calves behind and walked straight to Israel, to the town of Beth Shemesh. This convinced the Philistines that Yahweh had indeed been punishing them with plagues for taking his Box. The people of Beth Shemesh sacrificed the cows as an offering to thank Yahweh that the Box was back in Israel.

Why did Yahweh kill many Israelites in the town of Beth Shemesh?
Yahweh killed many people in the town of Beth Shemesh because they looked into the Box of the Covenant. Those people had violated the sacred boundary around holy things that the law of Moses commanded the Israelites to observe.

1 Samuel 6:1 (#1)

בִּשְׂדֵ֥ה פְלִשְׁתִּֽים

“in the field of the Philistines”

The author is using the term **field** to represent the territory of the Philistines. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the territory of the Philistines]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 6:3 (#5)

לֹא־תָסֻ֥ור יָדֹ֛ו מִכֶּ֖ם

“his hand has not turned from you”

See the discussion of the term **hand** in the Introduction to 1 Samuel, and see how you translated the several occurrences of the term in the previous chapter. Alternate translation: [he has not stopped using his power against you]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 6:3 (#4)

תֵּרָפְאוּ֙ וְנוֹדַ֣ע לָכֶ֔ם

“you will be healed, and it will be known to you”

If your language does not use these passive forms, you could express the ideas in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you will become healthy, and you will know]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 6:3 (#2)

הָשֵׁ֣שׁ תְּשִׁיבוּ

“returning, return”

The priests and diviners are repeating forms of the verb **return** in order to intensify their expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [be careful to return]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 6:3 (#3)

אָ֣ז תֵּרָפְאוּ֙ וְנוֹדַ֣ע לָכֶ֔ם לָ֥מָּה לֹא־תָסֻ֥ור יָדֹ֖ו מִכֶּֽם

“Then you will be healed, and it will be known to you why his hand has not turned from you”

While it sounds as if the priests and diviners are describing what will happen if the Philistines return the Box, they are actually stating a condition in which a second event will only take place if a first event takes place. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [If you are then healed, then it will be known to you why his hand has not turned from you]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

1 Samuel 6:3 (#7)

לֹא־תָסֻ֥ור יָדֹ֛ו מִכֶּ֖ם

“his hand has not turned from you”

The priests and diviners are speaking of Yahweh’s **hand** as if it were a living thing that could have **turned** away from the Philistines by itself. If you decide to retain the term “hand” in your translation, if it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he has not turned his hand from you] or [he has not withdrawn his hand from you]

See: Personification

1 Samuel 6:3 (#1)

רֵיקָ֖ם

“empty”

The priests and diviners assume that their listeners will know that by **empty**, they do not mean that the Philistines should put something inside the Box. They mean that the Philistines should send an offering along with the Box. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [without an accompanying offering]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 6:3 (#6)

לֹא־תָסֻ֥ור יָדֹ֛ו מִכֶּ֖ם

“his hand has not turned from you”

Since the priests and diviners are stating what the result would be if healing followed the return of the

Box, they mean that the Philistines would know why Yahweh's had continued to make them suffer before they returned it. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [his hand has not turned from you before this] or [he has continued to use his power against you until now]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 6:4 (#1)

מִסְפַּר֙ סַרְנֵ֣י פְלִשְׁתִּ֔ים חֲמִשָּׁ֖ה עפלי זְהָ֣ב וַחֲמִשָּׁ֣ה עַכְבְּרֵ֣י זָהָ֑ב כִּי־מַגֵּפָ֤ה אַחַת֙ לְכֻלָּ֣כֶם וּלְסַרְנֵיכֶֽם

"From the number of the lords of the Philistines, five tumors of gold and five mice of gold, for one plague was to all of them and to your lords"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since one plague was to all of them and to your lords, from the number of the lords of the Philistines, five tumors of gold and five mice of gold]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 6:4 (#2)

חֲמִשָּׁ֖ה עפלי זְהָ֣ב וַחֲמִשָּׁ֣ה עַכְבְּרֵ֣י זָהָ֑ב

"five tumors of gold and five mice of gold"

The priests and diviners are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [the offering should be five tumors of gold and five mice of gold]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 6:4 (#3)

לְכֻלָּ֣כֶם

"was to all of them"

The priests and diviners are using the word **them** to mean the people of Philistia. Since they are addressing those people directly, it may be more natural in your language to use a second-person pronoun rather than a third-person pronoun. Alternate translation: [was to all of you]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 6:5 (#1)

הַמַּשְׁחִיתִ֖ם אֶת־הָאָֽרֶץ

"the ones destroying the land"

The priests and diviners are using the term **land** to represent the crops that the land has produced. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the ones devouring your crops]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 6:5 (#3)

יָקֵ֤ל אֶת־יָדוֹ֙ מֵעֲלֵיכֶ֔ם וּמֵעַ֖ל אֱלֹהֵיכֶ֑ם וּמֵעַ֖ל אַרְצְכֶֽם

"he will lighten his hand from upon you and from upon your gods and from upon your land"

The priests and diviners are using the term **hand** to represent power. Alternate translation: [he will stop using his power so severely to punish you and your gods and your land]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 6:5 (#2)

וּנְתַתֶּ֥ם לֵאלֹהֵ֖י יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל כָּבֹ֔וד

"and you shall give glory to the God of Israel"

The expression **give glory to the God of Israel** means that by sending these gifts, the Philistines will vindicate the justice of Yahweh by acknowledging that it was wrong for them to take his Box and that he was justified in punishing them with these plagues for doing that. See the similar use of this phrase in Joshua 7:19. Alternate translation: [and in that way you will be admitting to the God of Israel that you did wrong and that he was justified in punishing you with these plagues]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 6:6 (#1)

וְלָמָ֣ה תְכַבְּד֗וּ אֶת־לְבַבְכֶם֙ כַּאֲשֶׁ֣ר כִּבְּד֔וּ מִצְרַ֖יִם וּפַרְעֹ֑ה אֶת־לִבָּ֣ם הֲלוֹא֩ כַּאֲשֶׁ֨ר הִתְעַלֵּ֜ל בָּהֶ֗ם וַיְשַׁלְּח֥וּם וַיֵּלֵֽכוּ

"And why do you make your heart heavy, just as the Egyptians and Pharaoh made their heart heavy? When he dealt severely with them, did they not send them away, and they went"

The priests and diviners are using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [So you should not make your

heart heavy, just as the Egyptians and Pharaoh made their heart heavy! When he dealt severely with them, they certainly sent them away, and they went!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 6:6 (#3)

וְלָמָּה תְכַבְּדוּ֙ אֶת־לְבַבְכֶ֔ם כַּאֲשֶׁ֥ר כִּבְּד֖וּ מִצְרַ֣יִם וּפַרְעֹ֑ה אֶת־לִבָּֽם

“And why do you make your heart heavy, just as the Egyptians and Pharaoh made their heart heavy”

The priests and diviners are speaking as if a person could actually make his **heart** more **heavy**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And why are you being stubborn, just as the Egyptians and Pharaoh were stubborn?] or [So you should not be stubborn, in the way that the Egyptians and Pharaoh were stubborn!]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 6:6 (#4)

הֲלוֹא֙ כַּאֲשֶׁ֣ר הִתְעַלֵּ֣ל בָּהֶ֔ם וַיְשַׁלְּח֖וּם וַיֵּלֵֽכוּ

“When he dealt severely with them, did they not send them away, and they went”

The pronoun **he** refers to Yahweh, the first instances of **them** and **they** refer to the Egyptians, and the second instances of **them** and **they** refer to the Israelites. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [When Yahweh dealt severely with the Egyptians, did the Egyptians not send the Israelites away, and the Israelites went?]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 6:6 (#2)

אֶת־לִבָּבְכֶ֔ם & אֶת־לִבָּֽם

“your heart & their heart”

Since the priests and diviners are referring to groups of people, the Philistines whom they are addressing and the Egyptians whom they are describing it might be more natural in your language to use the plural form of **heart** in both instances. Alternate translation: [your hearts ... their hearts]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Samuel 6:7 (#3)

קְח֞וּ וַעֲשׂ֣וּ

“take and make”

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **take** tells in what way the priests and diviners wanted the Philistines to **make** this cart. They do not mean that they want the Philistines to take it somewhere before making it. Rather, the word **take** has the sense of “undertake,” of taking measures to accomplish something. Alternate translation: [carefully make] or [prepare]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 6:7 (#4)

וּשְׁתֵּ֥י פָרוֹת֙ עָל֣וֹת

“and two nursing cows”

The priests and diviners are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and get two nursing cows]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 6:7 (#6)

הַבָּ֑יְתָה

“to the house”

While in this culture people sometimes did keep animals in a lower area of the house in which they lived, in this context, the term **house** probably refers to a stall or pen. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to their stalls]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 6:7 (#1)

וְעַתָּ֔ה

“And now”

The phrase translated as **And now** was an expression that speakers in this culture commonly used to introduce their main topic If your language has a comparable expression that it uses for this same purpose, you can use it in your translation. If not, you do not have to translate this phrase explicitly. You could indicate in some other way that this was the main point that the Philistine priests wanted to make. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 6:7 (#2)

קְחוּ֩ וַעֲשׂ֨וּ עֲגָלָ֜ה חֲדָשָׁ֗ה אֶחָ֙ת וּשְׁתֵּ֣י פָרוֹת֮ עָלוֹת֒ אֲשֶׁ֣ר לֹא־עָלְתָ֣ה עֲלֵיהֶ֔ם עֹ֔ל

“take and make a new cart, and two nursing cows upon which a yoke has not gone up”

Putting the sacred Box on a cart that had never been used for any other purpose, and having cows pull the cart that had never done pulling work before, were symbolic actions that treated the Box with special reverence. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of these actions. Alternate translation: [in order to treat the Box of the God of Israel with special reverence, take and make one new cart, and two nursing cows upon which a yoke has not gone up]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 6:7 (#5)

אֲשֶׁ֣ר לֹא־עָלְתָ֣ה עֲלֵיהֶ֔ם עֹ֔ל

“upon which a yoke has not gone up”

The priests and diviners are using a common expression of their culture. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that have never been yoked] or [that have never pulled a plow]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 6:8 (#1)

וְשַׁלַּחְתֶּ֥ם אֹתָ֖הּ וְהָלָֽךְ׃

“And you shall send it away, that it may go”

The pronoun **it** refers in both instances to the **cart**. But since the cart would not be able to **go** anywhere by itself, the priests and diviners mean that the Philistines are to let the cows pulling the cart go in any direction they wish. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a plural pronoun instead that would refer back to the cows described in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [And you shall send them away, that they may go]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 6:9 (#1)

אִם־דֶּ֣רֶךְ גְּבוּלָ֗וֹ יַעֲלֶ֤ה

“if it goes up the way of its border”

As in the previous verse, the pronoun **it** refers to the cart that the cows will be pulling, while the pronoun **its** refers to the Box of Yahweh. If you used plural pronouns in the previous verse to refer to the cows rather than the cart, you can do the same thing here. Alternate translation: [if they go up the way of its border] or [if the cows pull the cart back up to the place where the Box belongs]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 6:9 (#5)

לֹ֣א יָדוֹ֮ נָגְעָ֣ה בָּ֒נוּ֒

“his hand has not touched us”

The term **hand** has the same meaning here as in 6:3. See how you translated it there. Alternate translation: [he has not been using his power against us]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 6:9 (#3)

גְּבוּלֽוֹ׃

“its border”

The priests and diviners are using the term **border** to represent “territory,” since a territory is enclosed by borders. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [its territory]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 6:9 (#2)

אִם & יַעֲלֶ֣ה

“if it goes up”

As the author reports in his own language what the Philistine priests and diviners said, he characteristically marks this travel description for change in elevation by saying **up**. See the discussion of this in the Introduction to 1 Samuel, and see how you translated the comparable expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [if it goes] or [if they go]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 6:9 (#4)

וְאִם־לֹ֣א

“But if not”

The priests and diviners are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [But if it does not go up

the way of its border] or [But if the cows do not pull the cart back into the territory where the Box belongs]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 6:10 (#2)

בַּבָּֽיִת

“in the house”

See how you translated the term **house** in 6:7. Alternate translation: [in their stalls]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 6:10 (#1)

וַיִּקְחוּ֙ שְׁתֵּ֣י פָרוֹת֮ עָלֹ֣ות וַיַּאַסְרֻם֒ בָּעֲגָלָ֔ה

“for they took two nursing cows, and they harnessed them to the cart”

The author is leaving some information implicit that he assumes readers will understand. You could state this information explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [for they made a new cart, and they took two nursing cows, and they harnessed them to the cart]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 6:12 (#1)

וְגָעֹ֔ות

“and lowing”

The author assumes that readers will understand that the cows were **lowing** because they were upset about being separated from their calves. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 6:12 (#2)

יָמִ֥ין וּשְׂמֹ֖אול

“to} the right or {to} the left”

The author is speaking of two directions in order to mean them and everything in between. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in any direction]

See: Merism

1 Samuel 6:13 (#2)

וּבֵֽית שֶׁ֙מֶשׁ֙ קֹצְרִ֣ים קְצִיר־חִטִּ֔ים בָּעֵ֖מֶק

“Now Beth Shemesh was harvesting the harvest of wheat”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [Now Beth Shemesh was harvesting wheat]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 6:13 (#4)

וַיִּשְׂאוּ֙ אֶת־עֵינֵיהֶ֔ם

“And they lifted up their eyes”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean that the people of Beth Shemesh looked off into the distance. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And they looked off into the distance]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 6:13 (#5)

וַיִּשְׂאוּ֙ אֶת־עֵינֵיהֶ֔ם

“And they lifted up their eyes”

The author means that the people did this when they heard the cows mooing loudly as they pulled the cart down the road toward them. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And they heard cows mooing loudly as they pulled a cart, so they looked off into the distance to see what was happening]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 6:13 (#1)

וּבֵֽית שֶׁ֙מֶשׁ֙ קֹצְרִ֣ים קְצִיר־חִטִּ֔ים בָּעֵ֖מֶק

“Now Beth Shemesh was harvesting the harvest of wheat in the valley”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 6:13 (#3)

וּבֵֽית שֶׁ֙מֶשׁ֙ קֹצְרִ֣ים

“Now Beth Shemesh was harvesting”

As the plural pronouns in the next sentence show, the author is using the name **Beth Shemesh** to represent the people who lived in that town. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [Now the people of Beth Shemesh were harvesting]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 6:14 (#1)

יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בֵּית־הַשִּׁמְשִׁי

“Joshua the Bethshemite”

The word **Bethshemite** describes a person from the town of Beth Shemesh. Your language may have its own way of forming descriptive words from place names that you could use in your translation. You could also use plain language. The UST models one way to do that.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 6:14 (#2)

וְשָׁם אֶבֶן גְּדוֹלָה

“Now a great stone was there”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 6:15 (#2)

וַיָּשִׂשֵׂמוּ אֶל־הָאֶבֶן הַגְּדוֹלָה

“and they had set {them} on the great stone”

Setting the Box of Yahweh and the golden guilt offerings on this **great stone**, where they were presumably high above the people, was a symbolic action that showed honor to Yahweh. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [and they had set them on top of the great stone in order to lift them up high as a way of honoring Yahweh]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 6:15 (#3)

וַיִּזְבְּחוּ זְבָחִים

“and sacrificed sacrifices”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [and offered sacrifices]

See: Poetry

1 Samuel 6:15 (#1)

וְהַלְוִיִּם הוֹרִידוּ ׀ אֶת־אֲרוֹן יְהוָה וְאֶת־הָאַרְגַּז אֲשֶׁר־אִתּוֹ אֲשֶׁר־בּוֹ כְּלֵי־זְהָב וַיָּשִׂשֵׂמוּ אֶל־הָאֶבֶן הַגְּדוֹלָה

“Now the Levites had taken down the Box of Yahweh and the box that {was} with it, in which were the objects of gold, and they had set {them} on the great stone”

After making a summary statement in the last sentence of the previous verse, in this verse the author describes the same events in more detail in order to specify that the people of Beth Shemesh did not break up the cart with the Box of God still in it. In effect, he is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. In your translation, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. You could do that by creating a verse bridge. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Verse Bridges

1 Samuel 6:16 (#1)

רָאוּ

“saw”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [saw the Israelites do this]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 6:16 (#2)

וַיָּשֻׁבוּ עֶקְרוֹן בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא

“and they returned {to} Ekron on that day”

The author seems to mean that the lords of the Philistines had seen all they needed to see in order to be convinced that Yahweh had struck them with the plagues of mice and tumors for taking his sacred Box, and that was why they went back to their country **on that day**. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and having seen all they needed

to see to be convinced that Yahweh had caused the plagues, they returned to Ekron without staying in Israel any longer]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 6:17 (#2)

לְאַשְׁדּוֹד אֶחָד לְעַזָּה אֶחָד לְאַשְׁקְלוֹן אֶחָד לְגַת אֶחָד לְעֶקְרוֹן אֶחָד

“for Ashdod, one; for Gaza, one; for Ashkelon, one; for Gath, one; for Ekron, one”

Repeating the word **one** after the name of each of these cities might seem like extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can state the word only once. Alternate translation: [one each for Ashdod, Gaza, Ashkelon, Gath, and Ekron]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 6:17 (#1)

וְאֵלֶּה טְחֹרֵי הַזָּהָב אֲשֶׁר הֵשִׁיבוּ פְלִשְׁתִּים אָשָׁם לַיהוָה

“And these {are} the tumors of gold that the Philistines returned {as} a guilt offering to Yahweh”

In this verse and the next one, the author is providing a concluding summary of the story of how the Philistines captured and then returned the Box of Yahweh. Your language may have its own way of presenting such information.

See: End of Story

1 Samuel 6:18 (#3)

וְעַד ׀ אָבֵל הַגְּדוֹלָה

“and to the great Abel”

The author assumes that his readers will know that the “great stone” he first mentioned in 6:14 was later given the name **Abel**, which means “mourning.” The stone probably got that name because of the events that the author describes in the next verse, because of which, he says, the people “mourned.” You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and as far as the great stone that came to be called Abel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 6:18 (#4)

וְעַד ׀ אָבֵל הַגְּדוֹלָה

“and to the great Abel”

The context suggests that this stone marked the boundary between the territories of the Philistines and the Israelites. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and as far as their border with Israel at the great stone that came to be called Abel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 6:18 (#1)

מֵעִיר מִבְצָר וְעַד כְּפַר הַפְּרָזִי

“from the city of fortification and to the village of the countryside”

The author is not referring to a specific **city** or **village**. He means the Philistine cities and villages in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using plural forms. Alternate translation: [from the cities of fortification and to the villages of the countryside]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 6:18 (#2)

מֵעִיר מִבְצָר

“from the city of fortification”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **fortification**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [from the fortified cities]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 6:18 (#6)

עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה

“to this day”

See how you translated this phrase in 5:5. Alternate translation: [right up to the time of this writing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 6:18 (#5)

אֲשֶׁר הִנִּיחוּ עָלֶיהָ

“on which they rested”

The pronoun **they** refers to the Levites whom the author describes in 6:15. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [on which the Levites rested]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 6:19 (#2)

וַיַּךְ בְּאַנְשֵׁי בֵית־שֶׁמֶשׁ & וַיַּךְ בָּעָם שִׁבְעִים אִישׁ חֲמִשִּׁים אֶלֶף אִישׁ

“But he struck among the men of Beth Shemesh & And he struck among the people 70 men, 50, 000 men”

See how you translated the term **struck** in 4:2. Alternate translation: [But he killed some of the men of Beth Shemesh ... And he killed 70 men, 50,000 men, among the people]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 6:19 (#3)

שִׁבְעִים אִישׁ חֲמִשִּׁים אֶלֶף אִישׁ

“70 men, 50, 000 men”

Most Hebrew manuscripts, including the most ancient ones, have the reading that the ULT follows here. A few manuscripts read simply “70 men,” fits the Hebrew grammar better. It also suits the historical context better, since Beth Shemesh was only a town. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Samuel 6:19 (#1)

וַיַּךְ בְּאַנְשֵׁי בֵית־שֶׁמֶשׁ כִּי רָאוּ בַּאֲרוֹן יְהוָה

“But he struck among the men of Beth Shemesh because they looked into the Box of Yahweh”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [But because they looked into the Box of Yahweh, he struck among the men of Beth Shemesh]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 6:19 (#5)

בָּעָם מַכָּה גְדוֹלָה

“a great striking among the people”

For emphasis, the author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [had killed so many people]

See: Poetry

1 Samuel 6:19 (#4)

וַיִּתְאַבְּלוּ הָעָם כִּי־הִכָּה יְהוָה בָּעָם מַכָּה גְדוֹלָה

“And the people mourned because Yahweh had struck a great striking among the people”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And because Yahweh had struck a great striking among the people, the people mourned]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 6:20 (#2)

מִמִּי יוּכַל לַעֲמֹד לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“Who is able to stand to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:12. Alternate translation: [Who is able to stand in the presence of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 6:20 (#4)

וְאֶל־מִמִּי יַעֲלֶה מֵעָלֵינוּ

“And to whom will he go up from upon us”

The people of Beth Shemesh are using the pronoun **he**, meaning Yahweh, to represent the Box of Yahweh, in which they recognize him to be present in a special way. From their perspective, if they send the Box away, that will be like Yahweh leaving them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And to whom can we send Yahweh’s Box from here]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 6:20 (#1)

מִמִּי יוּכַל לַעֲמֹד לִפְנֵי יְהוָה הָאֱלֹהִים הַקָּדוֹשׁ הַזֶּה וְאֶל־מִמִּי יַעֲלֶה מֵעָלֵינוּ

“Who is able to stand to the face of Yahweh, this holy God? And to whom will he go up from upon us”

The people of Beth Shemesh are using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use that form for that purpose, you could translate these questions as statements or as excla-

mations. Alternate translation: [No one is able to stand to the face of Yahweh, this holy God! He must go up from us to someone else!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 6:20 (#3)

לַעֲמֹ֣ד

"to stand"

The context shows that here the term **stand** means "remain alive." You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to remain alive]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel - Chapter 7 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter concludes the section of the book that is dedicated primarily to describing Samuel as a leader of Israel. It has three main parts.

The first part continues a story that begins in 6:19. It includes 7:1–2. It tells the story of how the Box of Yahweh was moved from Beth Shemesh to Kiriath Jearim. (There is a chapter break in the middle of the story. However, the chapter divisions were added to the Bible many centuries after it was written, and they do not always correspond to the natural literary structure of its books. Be sure that it is clear in your translation that 6:19–7:2 is a single story.)

The second part, 7:3–14, then tells the story of how Samuel led the Israelites to rededicate themselves to Yahweh so that they could defeat the Philistines and recover territory that the Philistines had captured from them.

The third part, 7:15–17, then concludes the story of Samuel as the leader of Israel by giving a general summary of his activities.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Pouring out water on the ground

In 7:6, the Israelites draw water from a well and pour it onto the ground in the presence of Yahweh. This was a symbolic action, but its significance is not entirely clear, since this action occurs nowhere else in the Bible. It may have been symbolic of the Israelites pouring out their hearts to Yahweh in repentance. It may also have been a way in which the Israelites acknowledged their own weakness and powerlessness, portraying themselves as like "water spilled upon the ground, which cannot be gathered" up again (as the Bible says in 2 Samuel 14:14). Since the meaning is not clear, it would probably best not to suggest the significance of the action in the text of your translation. However, if it would be helpful to your readers, you could describe these possibilities in a footnote.

Sacrificing a young lamb

In 7:9, Samuel sacrifices a very young lamb as a whole burnt offering as he is praying and asking Yahweh to help the Israelites defeat the Philistines. The choice of this animal for a sacrifice seems to have been symbolic. Some interpreters have suggested that it represented the nation of Israel as if it were newborn as a result of its rededication to Yahweh. Other interpreters have suggested that a very young animal could represent a pure and innocent sacrifice. In this case as well, since the meaning is not clear, it would probably best not to suggest the significance of the action in the text of your translation. But if it would be helpful to your readers, you could describe these possibilities in a footnote.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

The significance of the name Beth Kar

In 7:11, the author says that the Israelites pursued and killed the fleeing Philistines "unto below Beth Kar." This suggests that suggests that Beth Kar was the name of a settlement that was built on a hill. The fleeing Philistine soldiers were apparently able to find safety on this height, and so the Israelites soldiers ended their pursuit there. The word "Kar" means "lamb" in Hebrew, and one possibility is that the Israelites gave the name Beth Kar, "House of the Lamb," to this place after the battle, alluding to the lamb that Samuel had sacrificed while asking Yahweh to help the Israelites defeat the Philistines. You could reflect this possibility in your translation by saying something like "as far as the bottom of the hill that the Israelites later called Beth Kar" and explaining the meaning of the name in a footnote. However, it is significant that while the author explains the meaning of the name Ebenezer in the next verse, he does not explain the meaning of the name Beth Kar here. Accordingly, you may wish simply to express the name Beth Kar in your translation, spelling it the way it sounds in your language, and not say anything about when the place got this name or what it means.

1 Samuel 7:1 (#1)

אֶל־בֵּ֣ית אֲבִינָדָ֔ב בַּגִּבְעָ֑ה

"to the house of Abinadab on the hill"

The men of Kiriath Jearim probably took the Box to this **house** on a **hill** in order to show honor and respect

to Yahweh through the symbolic action of placing his Box in a high and secure location. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [respectfully to the house of Abinadab on the hill, where it was high and secure]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 7:1 (#2)

בַּגִּבְעָה

“on the hill”

The author assumes that his readers will know that by **on the hill**, he means a certain hill within the city of Kiriath Jearim. Since modern readers would not recognize the identity of this hill, it may be more natural to speak of it in more general terms. Alternate translation: [which was on a hill]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 7:2 (#4)

כָּל־בֵּית יִשְׂרָאֵל

“all of the house of Israel”

The author is making an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [people throughout Israel]

See: Hyperbole

1 Samuel 7:2 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“And it happened”

The author is using this phrase to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 7:2 (#2)

וַיִּרְבּוּ הַיָּמִים וַיִּהְיוּ עֶשְׂרִים שָׁנָה

“that the days were many, and they were 20 years”

The author is using the term **days** to represent time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [that a long time passed, 20 years in fact]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 7:2 (#3)

כָּל־בֵּית יִשְׂרָאֵל

“all of the house of Israel”

Here, **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the house of Israel** figuratively means all the people descended from the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all of the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 7:3 (#4)

בְּכָל־לְבַבְכֶם אַתֶּם שָׁבִים אֶל־יְהוָה

“with all of your heart you are returning to Yahweh”

Samuel is speaking as if **returning to Yahweh** were traveling to a physical location. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you are sincerely recommitting yourselves to worshiping and obeying Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 7:3 (#6)

וְהָכִינוּ לְבַבְכֶם אֶל־יְהוָה

“and direct your heart toward Yahweh”

Samuel is speaking as if the **heart** of a person were something that he could **direct** toward something. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and commit yourselves to worshiping and obeying Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 7:3 (#7)

מִיַּד פְּלִשְׁתִּים

“from the hand of the Philistines”

The author is using the term **hand** to represent power. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from the power of the Philistines]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 7:3 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר שְׁמוּאֵל

“And Samuel spoke”

The author assumes that his readers will know that Samuel **spoke** these things as he traveled around the country, as 7:16 describes. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And as Samuel traveled around the country, he spoke]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 7:3 (#2)

כָּל־בֵּ֥ית יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל׃

“all of the house of Israel”

See how you translated the same expression in 7:2. Alternate translation: [all of the Israelites] or [people throughout Israel]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 7:3 (#5)

אֶת־אֱלֹהֵ֥י הַנֵּכָ֛ר

“the gods of the foreigner”

Samuel is not referring to a specific **foreigner**. He means foreigners in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using a plural form. Alternate translation: [the gods of foreigners] or [the gods that foreigners worship]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 7:3 (#3)

בְּכָל־לְבַבְכֶ֑ם & לְבַבְכֶ֑ם

“with all of your heart & your heart”

Since Samuel is referring to a group of people, it might be more natural in your language to use the plural form of **heart**. Alternate translation: [with all of your hearts ... your hearts]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Samuel 7:4 (#1)

בְּנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:28. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 7:5 (#1)

וַיֹּ֣אמֶר שְׁמוּאֵ֔ל

“And Samuel said”

The author assumes that his readers will know that Samuel likely **said** this to Israelite leaders, since they would have the authority to **Gather** the people together. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And Samuel told the Israelite leaders]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 7:6 (#2)

לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָֽה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:12. Alternate translation: [in the presence of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 7:6 (#3)

וַיָּצ֣וּמוּ בַיּ֣וֹם הַה֔וּא

“And they fasted on that day”

This was a symbolic action that showed the Israelites were humble and repentant before Yahweh. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [And they showed their sorrow for their sins by not eating any food that day]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 7:6 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁאֲבוּ־מַ֖יִם וַיִּשְׁפְּכ֣וּ ׀ לִפְנֵ֣י יְהוָ֑ה

“and they drew water and poured {it} to the face of Yahweh”

See the discussion in the Introduction to this chapter of the possible significance of this action.

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 7:6 (#4)

וַיֹּ֣אמְר֔וּ שָׁ֖ם חָטָ֥אנוּ לַיהוָ֑ה

“and they said there, “We have sinned against Yahweh”

It may be more natural in your language to have an indirect quotation here. Alternate translation: [and they confessed there that they had sinned against Yahweh]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Samuel 7:7 (#1)

וַיַּעֲלוּ סַרְנֵי־פְלִשְׁתִּים אֶל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“and the lords of the Philistines went up against Israel”

See the discussion in the Introduction to 1 Samuel of how Hebrew speakers and writers marked travel for change in elevation, and see how you translated the comparable expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [and the lords of the Philistines invaded Israel]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 7:7 (#2)

וַיִּרְאוּ מִפְּנֵי פְלִשְׁתִּים

“and they feared from the face of the Philistines”

In this context, the author, speaking of the Philistines collectively, seems to be using one part of a person, his **face**, to mean the entire person in the act of approaching. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they were afraid of the Philistines, who were approaching]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 7:8 (#2)

מִיַּד פְּלִשְׁתִּים

“from the hand of the Philistines”

The author is using the term **hand** to represent power. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from the power of the Philistines]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 7:8 (#1)

אַל־תַּחֲרַשׁ מִמֶּנּוּ מִזְּעֹק אֶל־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ

“Do not cease from crying out for us to Yahweh our God”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the negative particle **not** and the verb **cease**, which is negative in this context. Alternate translation: [Keep crying out for us to Yahweh our God]

See: Double Negatives

1 Samuel 7:9 (#2)

טְלֵה חָלָב אֶחָד

“a lamb of milk”

See the discussion in the Introduction to this chapter of the possible significance of Samuel’s choice of such a young lamb as a sacrifice.

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 7:9 (#1)

טְלֵה חָלָב אֶחָד

“a lamb of milk”

The author is using the term **milk** to represent a lamb that was still young enough to be nursing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [a nursing lamb]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 7:10 (#1)

וַיְהִי שְׁמוּאֵל מַעֲלֶה הָעוֹלָה וּפְלִשְׁתִּים נִגְּשׁוּ לַמִּלְחָמָה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל

“And Samuel was offering the burnt offering, and the Philistines approached for battle with Israel”

The author is using the words **And … and** to indicate that the Philistines **approached for battle** at the same time as when Samuel **was offering the burnt offering**. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could describe the time relationship more explicitly. Alternate translation: [While Samuel was offering the burnt offering, the Philistines approached to attack Israel]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

1 Samuel 7:10 (#3)

וַיִּנָּגְפוּ לִפְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“and they were struck to the face of Israel”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the Israelites defeated them]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 7:10 (#2)

וַיִּנָּגְפוּ לִפְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“and they were struck to the face of Israel”

The author is using one part of a person, his **face**, to mean the entire person in the act of fighting. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the

meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they were beaten by the Israelite soldiers]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 7:11 (#1)

וַיַּכֻּם

“and they struck them”

See the discussion of the term **struck** in the Introduction to 1 Samuel, and see how you translated the term in 4:2. Alternate translation: [and they killed them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 7:12 (#4)

וַיִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמָהּ

“And he called its name”

It might seem that the expression **called its name** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [And he called it]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 7:12 (#2)

הַשֵּׁשֵׁן

“Shen”

The word **Shen** means “crag” in Hebrew, and this could be a reference to a geographic feature rather than to a named settlement. Alternate translation: [the crag near the city]

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 7:12 (#3)

וַיִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמָהּ אֶבֶן הָעֶזֶר וַיֹּאמַר עַד־הֵנָּה עֲזָרָנוּ יְהוָה

“And he called its name Ebenezer, for he said, “Unto here has Yahweh helped us”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. You may find it helpful to make the quotation indirect. Alternate translation: [In acknowledgment of how Yahweh had helped the Israelites up to that point, Samuel called the stone Ebenezer]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 7:12 (#5)

אֶבֶן הָעֶזֶר

“Ebenezer”

The name **Ebenezer** means “stone of help.” You could explain that in a footnote if it would be helpful to your readers.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 7:12 (#1)

וַיִּקַּח שְׁמוּאֵל אֶבֶן אַחַת וַיָּשֶׂם

“And Samuel took a stone and set {it} up”

This was a symbolic action that created a memorial to help people remember what Yahweh had done in this place. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [And Samuel took a stone and set it up as a memorial]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 7:13 (#2)

וַיִּכָּנְעוּ הַפְּלִשְׁתִּים

“So the Philistines were subdued”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [So Yahweh subdued the Philistines]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 7:13 (#1)

וַיִּכָּנְעוּ הַפְּלִשְׁתִּים וְלֹא־יָסְפוּ עוֹד לָבוֹא בִּגְבוּל יִשְׂרָאֵל

“So the Philistines were subdued, and they did not resume again to enter into the border of Israel”

Here the author is saying what happened at the end of the story of how Yahweh helped the Israelites defeat the Philistines. Your language may have its own way of presenting such information.

See: End of Story

1 Samuel 7:13 (#3)

בִּגְבוּל יִשְׂרָאֵל

“into the border of Israel”

The author is using the term **border** to represent the territory of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [into Israelite territory]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 7:13 (#4)

וְתְהִיָ יַד־יְהוָהׇ בַּפְּלִשְׁתִּים

“And the hand of Yahweh was against the Philistines”

The author is using the term **hand** to represent power. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh used his power against the Philistines]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 7:13 (#5)

כׇּל יְמֵי שְׁמוּאֵל

“all of the days of Samuel”

The author is using the term **days** to represent a specific time, the lifetime of Samuel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [throughout Samuel’s lifetime]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 7:14 (#1)

וַתָּשֹׁבְנָה הֶעָרִים אֲשֶׁר לָקְחוּ־פְלִשְׁתִּים מֵאֵת יִשְׂרָאֵל ׀ לְיִשְׂרָאֵל

“And the cities that the Philistines had taken from Israel returned to Israel”

The author is speaking of **cities** as if they were living things that could return to their owner. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the Israelites regained control of the cities that the Philistines had captured]

See: Personification

1 Samuel 7:14 (#2)

גְּבוּלָן

“their border”

Since the author is referring to multiple areas around different cities, it might be more natural in your language to use the plural form of **border**. Alternate translation: [their borders]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Samuel 7:14 (#3)

מִיַּד

“from the hand of”

The author is using the term **hand** to represent control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from the control of]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 7:14 (#5)

הָאֱמֹרִי

“the Amorite”

The author is not referring to a specific **Amorite**. He means Amorites in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using a plural form as in the UST.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 7:14 (#4)

וַיְהִיָ שָׁלוֹם בֵּין יִשְׂרָאֵל וּבֵין הָאֱמֹרִי

“And peace was between Israel and between the Amorite”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And the Israelites and Amorites lived peacefully with each other]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 7:16 (#1)

מִדֵּי שָׁנָה בְּשָׁנָה

“according to year by year”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean that Samuel did this each year. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [annually]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 7:17 (#1)

וּתְשׁוּבָתוֹ הָרָמָתָה כִּי־שָׁם בֵּיתוֹ

“And his return was to Ramah, for his house was there”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And since Samuel’s house was in Ramah, he always returned there]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel - Chapter 8 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter begins a new part of the story. The focus of the book shifts from Samuel, who led Israel as a prophet and judge, to Saul, who led Israel as its first king. This section includes chapters 8–15. Chapter 8 describes how the people of Israel asked Samuel to appoint a king for them and Yahweh told him to agree. But Yahweh also told Samuel that the people's request showed a lack of trust in him and that he should warn the people about how the king would exploit them.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The kingship in Israel

The law of Moses provided for Israel to have a king. Deuteronomy 17:14–20 described what kind of person this king needed to be and how he had to behave. But in these circumstances, the people had asked for a king for reasons other than the ones for which the law provided for one. 1 Samuel 12:12 shows that the Israelites were afraid because the army of the Ammonite king Nahash was trying to conquer their territories. They asked Samuel for a king who would "go out ... and fight our battles." They wanted a king who was physically powerful and aggressive. Samuel warned them that a king of that kind would oppress them. But the people still wanted a king to lead their armies. They no longer trusted God to deliver them from their enemies, as he had done repeatedly during the time of Joshua and the judges. So while the kingship was not wrong in itself, the people's motives for asking for this kind of king in these circumstances were wrong.

1 Samuel 8:1 (#1)

וַיְהִ֔י

"And it happened"

See how you translated this phrase in 1:12.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 8:2 (#2)

מִשְׁנֵ֑הוּ

"his second"

If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you can use a cardinal number here or an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [Samuel's son number two]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Samuel 8:2 (#1)

וְשֵׁ֣שֶׁם מִשְׁנֵ֗הוּ אֲבִיָּה֙ שֹׁפְטִ֣ים בִּבְאֵ֔ר שָׁבַֽע

"and the name of his second, Abijah, judges in Beersheba"

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the name of his second son was Abijah, and they both served as judges in Beersheba]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 8:3 (#1)

וְלֹא־הָלְכ֥וּ בָנָ֛יו בדרכו

"But his sons did not walk in his ways"

The author is speaking as if **ways** were paths that Samuel's sons could walk on. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But his sons did not live the way he had lived]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 8:3 (#3)

שֹׁ֖חַד

"a bribe"

The author is not referring to a specific **bribe**. He means bribes in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using a plural form as in the UST.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 8:3 (#2)

וַיִּטּ֣וּ אַחֲרֵ֣י הַבָּ֔צַע

"for they turned aside after dishonest gain"

The author is speaking as if Samuel's sons were walking on a path but **turned** off it in order to go in the direction where **dishonest gain** was. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [instead, they tried to get money dishonestly]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 8:3 (#4)

וַיַּטּ֖וּ מִשְׁפָּ֑ט

"and they turned aside justice"

The author is speaking as if **justice** were something that Samuel's sons could have caused to leave a path that it was walking on. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they did not judge cases fairly]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 8:5 (#3)

לִשְׁפְּטֵנוּ

"to judge us"

By **us**, the Israelite elders mean themselves but perhaps not Samuel, since they are speaking of what they want the situation to be for themselves after he dies. So it may be appropriate to use the exclusive form of "us" in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

1 Samuel 8:5 (#1)

הִנֵּה

"Behold"

See how you translated this term in 2:31.

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 8:5 (#2)

וּבָנֶיךָ לֹא הָלְכוּ בִּדְרָכֶיךָ

"and your sons do not walk in your ways"

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:3. Alternate translation: [and your sons do not live the way you have lived]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 8:6 (#1)

וַיֵּרַע הַדָּבָר בְּעֵינֵי שְׁמוּאֵל

"And the thing was bad in the eyes of Samuel"

See the discussion in the Introduction to 1 Samuel of this use of the expression "in the eyes of." The author is using this common expression of his culture to refer to the judgment or opinion of Samuel. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Samuel considered this request to be wrong]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 8:7 (#1)

שְׁמַע בְּקוֹל הָעָם

"Listen to the voice of the people"

See the discussion of the term "listen" in the Introduction to 1 Samuel, and see how you translated the similar expression in 2:25. Alternate translation: [Obey the voice of the people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 8:7 (#2)

שְׁמַע בְּקוֹל הָעָם

"Listen to the voice of the people"

The author is using the term **voice** to represent what the people asked for by using their collective voice. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Do what the people have asked for]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 8:7 (#3)

כִּי

"For"

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but a further observation. Alternate translation: [In fact]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 8:8 (#1)

מִיּוֹם

"from the day"

The author is using the term **day** in this phrase to represent a specific time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from the time]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 8:9 (#2)

שְׁמַע בְּקוֹלָם

"listen to their voice"

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:7. Alternate translation: [do what they are asking for]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 8:9 (#1)

וְעַתָּה

“And now”

See how you translated the expression “And now” in 6:7. Alternate translation: [So this is what I want you to do]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 8:9 (#3)

הָעֵ֤ד תָּעִיד֙ בָּהֶ֔ם

“warning, you shall warn them”

Yahweh is repeating forms of the verb **warn** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [you must warn them very strongly]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 8:10 (#1)

אֵ֚את כָּל־דִּבְרֵ֣י יְהוָ֔ה

“all of the words of Yahweh”

The author is using the term **words** to represent what Yahweh said by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [everything that Yahweh had told him]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 8:11 (#1)

עֲלֵיכֶ֖ם אֶת־בְּנֵיכֶ֑ם

“over you & your sons”

The words **you** and **your** are plural here and through verse 18 because Samuel is addressing the Israelite elders, so use plural forms in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Samuel 8:11 (#2)

בְּמֶרְכַּבְתֹּתָ֔ו

“in his chariot”

Samuel is not referring to a specific **chariot**. He means chariots in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using a plural form. Alternate translation: [to drive his chariots]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 8:11 (#4)

לִפְנֵ֥י מֶרְכַּבְתֹּ֖ו

“to the face of his chariot”

See the discussion of the phrase “to the face” in the Introduction to 1 Samuel, and see how you translated the phrase in 1:12. Alternate translation: [ahead of his chariot]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 8:11 (#3)

וְרָצ֖וּ לִפְנֵ֥י מֶרְכַּבְתֹּֽו

“and they will run to the face of his chariot”

This was a symbolic action that showed the king’s power and authority by having servants run ahead of his chariot to clear the way and announce his coming. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [and they will run ahead of his chariot to show everyone how important he is]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 8:12 (#1)

וְלַחֲרֹ֣שׁ חֲרִישׁ֔וֹ וְלִקְצֹ֖ר קְצִירֹ֑ו וְלַעֲשֹׂ֣ות כְּלֵי־מִלְחַמְתֹּ֔ו וּכְלֵ֖י רִכְבֹּֽו

“and to plow his plowing, and to harvest his harvest, and to make the implements of his war and the implements of his chariot”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and he will force some of them to plow his fields and harvest his crops, and he will force others to make weapons for his army and equipment for his chariots]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 8:12 (#3)

רִכְבֹּֽו

“his chariot”

Samuel is not referring to a specific **chariot**. He means chariots in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using a plural form as in the UST.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 8:12 (#2)

וְלַחֲרֹ֥שׁ חֲרִישׁ֖וֹ וְלִקְצֹ֣ר קְצִירֹ֑ו

“and to plow his plowing, and to harvest his harvest”

For emphasis, Samuel is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [and to do all his plowing and all his harvesting]

See: Poetry

1 Samuel 8:13 (#1)

לְרַקָּחֹ֖ות

“for perfumers”

A **perfumer** is someone who makes substances such as oils that give off pleasant smells. If your readers would not be familiar with what a perfumer is, in your translation you could use the name of a similar occupation that your readers would recognize, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [for people who make sweet-smelling oils]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 8:14 (#1)

וְאֶת־שְׂדֹתֵיכֶ֣ם וְאֶת־כַּרְמֵיכֶ֗ם וְזֵיתֵיכֶם֙ הַטֹּובִ֣ים יִקָּ֔ח וְנָתַ֖ן לַעֲבָדָֽיו

“And your fields and your vineyards and your olive trees, the best {ones}, he will take and give to his servants”

It may be more natural in your language to put the word **best**, which provides information about what kind of fields, vineyards, and olive trees the king will take, at the start of the verse with the information that he will take them. Alternate translation: [And he will take your best fields and vineyards and olive trees and give them to his servants]

See: Information Structure

1 Samuel 8:16 (#1)

וְאֶת־עַבְדֵיכֶם֙ וְאֶת־שִׁפְחֹותֵיכֶ֔ם וְאֶת־בַּחוּרֵיכֶ֥ם הַטֹּובִ֖ים
וְאֶת־חֲמֹורֵיכֶ֑ם יִקָּ֔ח וְעָשָׂ֖ה לִמְלַאכְתֹּֽו

“And your {male} servants and your maidservants and your young men, the best {ones}, and your donkeys, he will take and use for his work”

It may be more natural in your language to put the word **best**, which provides information about what kind of servants, young men, and donkeys the king will take, at the start of the verse with the information that he will take them. Alternate translation: [And he will take your best male servants and female servants and young men and donkeys and use them for his work]

See: Information Structure

1 Samuel 8:17 (#1)

וְאַתֶּ֖ם תִּהְיוּ־לֹ֥ו לַעֲבָדִֽים

“and you yourselves will be to him for servants”

Samuel is speaking as if the Israelites would literally become slaves to the king. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and in the end, it will be as if you are his slaves]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 8:18 (#2)

מִלִּפְנֵ֣י מַלְכְּכֶ֔ם

“from to the face of your king”

Samuel is using the term **face** to represent the presence of the king, which, as he has described, will be highly intrusive and oppressive. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for relief from the oppression of your king]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 8:18 (#1)

בַּיֹּ֥ום הַה֖וּא & בַּיֹּ֥ום הַהֽוּא

“on that day & on that day”

Samuel is using the term **day** to represent a specific time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [at that time ... at that time]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 8:18 (#3)

וְלֹא־יַעֲנֶ֥ה יְהוָ֛ה אֶתְכֶ֖ם

“but Yahweh will not answer you”

See the discussion of the term “answer” in the Introduction to 1 Samuel, and see how you translated the similar expression “listen to” in 8:7. Alternate translation: [but Yahweh will not do what you ask]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 8:19 (#1)

בְּקוֹל שְׁמוּאֵל

“to the voice of Samuel”

The author is using the term **voice** to represent what Samuel said by using his voice. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to what Samuel told them]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 8:20 (#1)

וְיָצָא לְפָנֵינוּ וְנִלְחַם אֶת־מִלְחַמֹתֵנוּ

“and go out to our face and fight our battles”

The author is using the term **face** to represent the front of the army in battle. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and go out ahead of us and fight our battles] or [and lead us into battle]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 8:20 (#2)

וְיָצָא לְפָנֵינוּ וְנִלְחַם אֶת־מִלְחַמֹתֵנוּ

“and go out to our face and fight our battles”

The elders are speaking of one person who would **fight** their **battles**, the king, to represent the whole army that would do this. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and go out ahead of our army as it fights its battles]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 8:21 (#2)

בְּאָזְנֵי יְהוָה

“in the ears of Yahweh”

The author is using the term **ears** to represent hearing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for Yahweh to hear]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 8:21 (#1)

אֵת כָּל־דִּבְרֵי הָעָם

“all of the words of the people”

The author is using the term **words** to represent what the people said by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [everything that the people had said]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 8:22 (#4)

לְכוּ אִישׁ לְעִירוֹ

“Go, a man to his city”

The author assumes that his readers will know that Samuel is dismissing the elders because he has agreed to do what they are asking. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [You can all go home now, because I will do what you are asking]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 8:22 (#6)

אִישׁ לְעִירוֹ

“a man to his city”

Samuel is not referring to a specific **man**. He means all of the men he is addressing. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using a plural form. Alternate translation: [all of to your own cities]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 8:22 (#3)

וַיֹּאמֶר שְׁמוּאֵל אֶל־אַנְשֵׁי יִשְׂרָאֵל לְכוּ אִישׁ לְעִירוֹ

“And Samuel said to the men of Israel, “Go, a man to his city”

It may be more natural in your language to have an indirect quotation here. Alternate translation: [And Samuel told the men of Israel to return to their cities]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Samuel 8:22 (#5)

לְכוּ

“Go”

The implied “you” in the imperative **Go** is plural because Samuel is addressing the group of elders, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Samuel 8:22 (#1)

שְׁמַ֥ע בְּקוֹלָ֖ם

“Listen to their voice”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:7. Alternate translation: [Do what they are asking for]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 8:22 (#2)

אַנְשֵׁ֥י יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל

“the men of Israel”

The author assumes that his readers will know that by **the men of Israel**, he means the elders who had come to speak with Samuel. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the elders of Israel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel - Chapter 9 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the section of the book about Saul. It describes how Yahweh led Saul to come to the city where Samuel lived so that Samuel could tell him that Yahweh had chosen him to be the king of Israel.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The locations of Shalishah and Shaalim

Saul came to Samuel’s city because he had looking for some donkeys that belonged to his father and had wandered away. In 9:4, the author describes Saul passing through “the land of Shalishah” and “the land of Shaalim” as he searches for these donkeys. The locations of these places are no longer certain. We recommend that you simply use these names in your translation, spelling them the way they sound in your language, without suggesting any further identifying information about these places.

1 Samuel 9:1 (#3)

גִּבּ֥וֹר חָֽיִל

“mighty of valor”

While in many biblical contexts this expression describes a soldier who can fight powerfully and effectively, the terms can also describe a great man of wealth, and many interpreters consider that to be the implicit meaning in this context. The UST models one way to express this meaning.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 9:1 (#2)

אִ֣ישׁ יְמִינִ֑י

“a man, a Benjaminite”

This expression could mean the same thing as **a man from Benjamin** earlier in the verse. In that case, the author would be repeating this information for emphasis. However, this expression could also mean that Kish was not only a member of the tribe of Benjamin by descent but that he was also still living within the territory of that tribe. The UST models one way to express that meaning.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 9:1 (#1)

וַיְהִי־אִ֥ישׁ מִבֶּן־יְמִ֖ין

“Now {there} was a man from Benjamin”

The author is using this phrase to introduce Saul as a new participant in the story, beginning in this verse by providing information about his father Kish and his ancestry. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Samuel 9:2 (#2)

וְאֵ֣ין אִ֔ישׁ מִבְּנֵ֖י יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל טֹ֥וב מִמֶּ֖נּוּ

“and no man from the sons of Israel {was} better than him”

The author is making an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [In fact, he was exceptionally handsome among the Israelite men]

See: Hyperbole

1 Samuel 9:2 (#1)

בָּח֥וּר וְטֽוֹב

“a youth and good”

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **good** tells what kind of **youth** Saul was. Alternate translation: [a good-looking young man]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 9:2 (#3)

מִשִּׁכְמ֖וֹ וָמַ֑עְלָה גָּבֹ֖הַּ מִכָּל־הָעָֽם

“From his shoulder and upward {he was} taller than all of the people”

The author is using a common expression of his culture, **From his shoulder and upward** to mean that Saul was significantly taller than other Israelite men. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [He was a head taller than anyone else] or [He was significantly taller than other Israelite men]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 9:3 (#2)

אֲבִ֥י שָׁא֖וּל

“the father of Saul”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information about Kish that would not be natural to express in your language, since the author reminds readers that Saul was **his son** in the next sentence. If so, you do not need to reflect this expression in your translation.

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 9:3 (#3)

וְקוּם

“and arise”

See how you translated the term “arose” in 1:9. The verb has a similar meaning here. Alternate translation: [and take action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 9:3 (#1)

וַתֹּאבַ֜דְנָה הָאֲתֹנֹ֗ת לְקִ֙ישׁ֙ אֲבִ֣י שָׁא֔וּל

“Now the female donkeys of Kish, the father of Saul, became lost”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 9:4 (#1)

וַיַּ֣עֲבֹ֔ר & וַיַּעֲבֹ֖ר & וַיַּעֲבֹֽר

“And he passed through & and he passed through & And he passed through”

The author is using Saul alone to represent both himself and his servant in the action of traveling. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Saul and the servant passed through ... and they passed through ... And they passed through]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 9:4 (#2)

וָאַ֥יִן

“but nothing”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but they found nothing there]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 9:4 (#3)

יְמִינִֽי

“the Benjaminite”

The author is not referring to a specific **Benjaminite**. He means the Benjaminites in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using a plural form. Alternate translation: [the Benjaminites]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 9:5 (#1)

בְּאֶ֣רֶץ צ֔וּף

“into the land of Zuph”

The **land of Zuph** was southwest of Benjamin. Presuming that the donkeys had not crossed the Jordan River or gone up into the mountains, Saul and his servant had made a circuit to look in the areas northwest, west, and southwest of their home. So the implication is that Zuph was the final place where they could have hoped to find the donkeys. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could state this explicitly in your translation. Alternate translation: [into the land of Zuph, which was the final place where they could hope to find the donkeys]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 9:5 (#2)

מִן־הָאֲתֹנֹת & יֶחְדַּל

“cease from the female donkeys”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [cease from being concerned about the female donkeys]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 9:6 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר לֹו

“And he said to him”

The pronoun **he** refers to the servant, and the pronoun **him** refers to Saul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the servant said to Saul]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 9:6 (#5)

כֹּל אֲשֶׁר־יְדַבֵּר בֹּוא יָבֹוא

“All that he speaks, coming, it comes”

The servant is repeating forms of the verb “come” in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [Everything that he says is going to happen actually does happen]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 9:6 (#2)

הִנֵּה

“Behold”

See how you translated this term in 2:31.

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 9:6 (#3)

בָּעִיר הַזֹּאת

“is} in this city”

The implication from the narrative is that **this city** means Ramah, the home of Samuel. The author says in 7:17 that Samuel stayed there except when he was making his annual circuit as a judge, and the author indicates in 1:1 that this Ramah was in the region of Zuph. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [lives here in the city of Ramah]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 9:6 (#4)

וְהָאִישׁ נִכְבָּד

“and the man is honored”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people honor the man]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 9:6 (#6)

אֶת־דַּרְכֵּנוּ אֲשֶׁר־הָלַכְנוּ עָלֶיהָ

“our way on which we have gone”

The servant is speaking of the **way** on which he and Saul have gone to represent the purpose for which the two of them have been traveling. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [how we can successfully achieve the purpose of our trip]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 9:7 (#1)

וּמַה־נָּבִיא לָאִישׁ

“but what shall we bring to the man”

Bringing something to Samuel was a symbolic action that showed respect for him as a **man of God** before consulting him. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [but what can we bring as a gift to show respect for this man of God]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 9:7 (#2)

הַלֶּחֶם

“the bread”

Saul is using one kind of food, **bread**, to represent food in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you

could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all of the food]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 9:8 (#1)

נִמְצָא בְיָדִי רֶבַע שֶׁקֶל כָּסֶף

“one fourth of a shekel of silver has been found in my hand”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I have found one fourth of a shekel of silver in my hand]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 9:8 (#3)

נִמְצָא בְיָדִי רֶבַע שֶׁקֶל כָּסֶף

“one fourth of a shekel of silver has been found in my hand”

The servant is speaking of his **hand** to represent his possession of the silver. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I have one fourth of a shekel of silver in my possession]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 9:8 (#4)

וְנָתַתִּי לְאִישׁ הָאֱלֹהִים וְהִגִּיד לָנוּ אֶת־דַּרְכֵּנוּ

“And I will give {it} to the man of God, and he will declare to us our way”

Be sure that it is clear in your translation that the silver was a courteous gift that showed respect to Samuel as a prophet of God. It was not simply a fee. It would not be appropriate to suggest that this was a payment in exchange for which Samuel provided a service. Alternate translation: [And I will give it to him to honor him as a man of God, which we should do if we want to consult him, and he will declare to us our way]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 9:8 (#2)

נִמְצָא בְיָדִי רֶבַע שֶׁקֶל כָּסֶף

“one fourth of a shekel of silver has been found in my hand”

The servant is using the term **found** in a way characteristic of his language and culture to mean that this piece of silver could be found, that is, that it was there. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I have one fourth of a shekel of silver in my hand]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 9:9 (#4)

הַיּוֹם

“today”

In keeping with the conventions of his language and culture, the author is using the term **today** to mean “at the present time.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [currently]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 9:9 (#3)

כִּי לְנָבִיא הַיּוֹם יִקָּרֵא לְפָנִים הָרֹאֶה

“For the prophet today was called the seer previously”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [For people previously called someone a seer whom they call a prophet today]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 9:9 (#2)

Since the background information that the author provides in this verse relates to what happens in verse 11, if it would be helpful to your readers, you could create a verse bridge for verses 9–11 and put the content of verse 9 at the end of it. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Verse Bridges

1 Samuel 9:9 (#1)

לְפָנִים ׀ בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל כֹּה־אָמַר הָאִישׁ בְּלֶכְתּוֹ לִדְרֹשׁ אֱלֹהִים לְכוּ וְנֵלְכָה עַד־הָרֹאֶה כִּי לְנָבִיא הַיּוֹם יִקָּרֵא לְפָנִים הָרֹאֶה

“Previously in Israel, a man said thus in his going to seek God: “Come, and let us go to the seer.” For the prophet today was called the seer previously”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 9:10 (#1)

טֹוב דְּבָרְךָ

“Your word is good”

Saul is speaking of the servant’s **word** to represent what the servant said by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [What you are suggesting is good]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 9:10 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר־שָׁם אִישׁ הָאֱלֹהִים

“where the man of God was there”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [where the man of God was]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 9:11 (#1)

וְהֵמָּהּ מָצְאוּ

“and they found”

The author does not mean that Saul and the servant were looking for **young women** whom they could ask about Samuel and that they **found** some. He means that they met or encountered them. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and they met]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 9:12 (#2)

מַהֵר ׀ עַתָּה כִּי־הַיּוֹם בָּא לָעִיר כִּי־זֶבַח הַיּוֹם לָעָם בַּבָּמָה

“Hurry now, for he has come to the city today because the sacrifice of the day {is} to the people at the high place”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since the sacrifice of the day is to the people at the high place, he has come to the city today, so you should hurry now]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 9:12 (#1)

לְפָנֶיךָ

“to your face”

The young women are speaking of Saul’s **face** to represent what is in front of him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language as in the UST.

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 9:12 (#3)

זֶבַח הַיּוֹם לָעָם

“the sacrifice of the day {is} to the people”

The young women are using this possessive form not to describe a daily sacrifice but to describe a special sacrifice that Samuel was going to offer on that day. Alternate translation: [there is going to be a special sacrifice today for the people]

See: Possession

1 Samuel 9:13 (#1)

כְּבֹאֲכֶם הָעִיר כֵּן תִּמְצְאוּן אֹתֹו בְּטֶרֶם יַעֲלֶה הַבָּמָתָה לֶאֱכֹל כִּי לֹא־יֹאכַל הָעָם עַד־בֹּאֹו כִּי־הוּא יְבָרֵךְ הַזֶּבַח & כִּי & לְאַחַר יֹאכְלוּ הַקְּרֻאִים

“In your entering the city, thus you will find him, before he goes up to the high place to eat. For the people will not eat until he comes, for he himself will bless the sacrifice”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since he himself will bless the sacrifice, the people will not eat until he comes, so in your entering the city, thus you will find him, before he goes up to the high place to eat]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 9:13 (#6)

כְּהַיּוֹם

“according to today”

The young women are using a common expression of their culture to refer to the present moment. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [right away] or [just at this time]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 9:13 (#3)

הַקְּרֻאִֽים

“the invited {ones”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [those whom someone has invited]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 9:13 (#5)

כִּֽי & אֹתְתֹו כְּהַיּ֥וֹם תִּמְצְאֻ֖ון אֹתֹ֑ו

“for him, according to today you will find him”

The women are repeating the pronoun **him** for emphasis. If your language can repeat pronouns for emphasis, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [for you will find the very man you are looking for according to today]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 9:13 (#2)

בְּטֶרֶם֩ יַעֲלֶ֨ה הַבָּמָ֜תָה לֶֽאֱכֹ֗ל & לֹֽא־יֹאכַ֤ל הָעָם֙ עַד־בֹּאֹ֔ו כִּֽי־הֹוא֙ יְבָרֵ֣ךְ הַזֶּ֔בַח & כִּ֥י

“before he goes up to the high place to eat. For the people will not eat until he comes, for he himself will bless the sacrifice”

The fact that the people will not eat before Samuel comes is not in itself a logical reason why Samuel will still be at the entrance to the city. There is a further step in the logic. The young women mean that the people are still preparing the feast so that Samuel can bless it and that is why he has not gone up to the festival yet. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [because he has not yet gone up to the high place to eat, since the people are still preparing the feast so that he can bless it. For the people will not eat until he comes and does that]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 9:13 (#4)

וְעַתָּ֣ה

“And now”

Speakers in this culture used the expression **And now** to introduce their main point. See how you translated it in 6:7. Alternate translation: [So this is what you should do]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 9:14 (#1)

שְׁמוּאֵל֙ יֹצֵ֣א לִקְרָאתָ֔ם לַֽעֲלֹ֖ות הַבָּמָֽה

“Samuel was coming out to meet them to go up {to} the high place”

The author is using the phrase **to meet them** not to describe the purpose for which Samuel was **coming out** of the city but to describe the result of him doing that. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Samuel was coming out to go up to the high place and he met them on his way there]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 9:15 (#2)

גָּלָ֥ה אֶת־אֹ֖זֶן שְׁמוּאֵ֑ל

“had uncovered the ear of Samuel”

The author is using a common expression of this culture to mean that Yahweh had revealed something to Samuel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [had revealed something to Samuel]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 9:15 (#1)

וַֽיהוָ֗ה גָּלָ֤ה אֶת־אֹ֙זֶן֙ שְׁמוּאֵ֔ל יֹ֖ום אֶחָ֑ד לְפָנֵ֣י בֹּ֔וא־שָׁא֖וּל לֵאמֹֽר

“Now Yahweh had uncovered the ear of Samuel one day before the coming of Saul, saying”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 9:16 (#1)

אֶשְׁלַ֤ח אֵלֶ֙יךָ֙ אִ֣ישׁ מֵאֶ֣רֶץ בִּנְיָמִ֔ן

“I will send to you a man from the land of Benjamin”

Yahweh means that he will cause this **man** to arrive from the **land of Benjamin**. He does not mean that he will actively **send** Saul to Samuel by commanding Saul to go. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [I will cause a man to come to you from the land of Benjamin]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 9:16 (#3)

מִיַּד פְּלִשְׁתִּים

“from the hand of the Philistines”

Yahweh is speaking of the **hand** of the Philistines to represent their power. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from the power of the Philistines]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 9:16 (#4)

רָאִ֣יתִי׀ אֶת־עַמִּ֗י כִּֽי־בָ֥אָה צַעֲקָתָ֖ו אֵלָֽי

“I have seen my people, for its cry has come to me”

Yahweh is saying that he has **seen** his **people** to represent that he has noticed with concern the situation of his people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I have noticed with concern how my people have been suffering]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 9:16 (#2)

כָּעֵ֣ת ׀ מָחָ֗ר & עַמִּ֗י & כִּֽי־רָאִ֣יתִי׀ & כִּֽי־בָ֥אָה צַעֲקָתָ֖ו אֵלָֽי

“About {this} time tomorrow & my people & For I have seen & for its cry has come to me”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of the last two phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Since the two phrases together give the reason for what Yahweh says in the preceding part of the verse, you could then move them to the beginning of the verse. Alternate translation: [The cry of my people has come to me, and so I have considered their situation, and as a result, about this time tomorrow]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 9:16 (#5)

בָּ֥אָה צַעֲקָתָ֖ו אֵלָֽי

“its cry has come to me”

Yahweh is speaking of the **cry** of his people as if it were a living thing that could travel to him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I have heard them crying out to me for help]

See: Personification

1 Samuel 9:17 (#1)

וַיהוָ֖ה עָנָ֑תָה

“and Yahweh answered him”

The author does not mean that Samuel asked a question that Yahweh then **answered**. He means that Yahweh spoke the words he quotes in response to Samuel seeing Saul. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh said in response]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 9:17 (#2)

הִנֵּ֣ה הָאִ֔ישׁ אֲשֶׁ֥ר אָמַ֖רְתִּי אֵלֶֽיךָ

“Behold the man {about} whom I spoke to you”

In this instance, the expression **Behold** does not primarily call attention to what a speaker is about to say. Yahweh is using the term more literally to indicate that Samuel can see before him the man about whom he spoke. Alternate translation: [You can see before you the man about whom I spoke to you] or [The man about whom I spoke to you is standing right in front of you]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 9:18 (#1)

אֵי־זֶ֖ה בֵּ֣ית הָרֹאֶֽה

“where {is} this, the house of the seer”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [where is the house of the seer]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 9:19 (#2)

עֲלֵ֤ה & וְאָכַלְתֶּ֨ם & וְשִׁלַּחְתִּ֜יךָ & בְּלִבָּבְךָ֗ & לָךְ

“Go up & and you shall eat & And I will send you away & to you & is} in your heart”

The implied “you” in the imperative **Go**, the second and third instances of the pronoun **you**, and the pronoun **your** are singular because Samuel is addressing Saul. However, the first instance of the pronoun **you** is plural because Samuel is inviting both Saul and the servant to the feast. So use the corresponding

forms in your translation if your language marks this distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Samuel 9:19 (#1)

וַיֹּ֥אמֶר

“and said”

The expression **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this expression explicitly. Alternate translation: [And Samuel replied to Saul]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 9:19 (#3)

וְשִׁלַּחְתִּ֣יךָ בַבֹּ֔קֶר וְכֹ֖ל אֲשֶׁ֣ר בַּלְבָבְךָ֑ אַגִּ֖יד לָֽךְ

“And I will send you away in the morning, and I will declare to you all that {is} in your heart”

The author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. In your translation, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they would happen. Alternate translation: [And I will declare to you all that is in your heart, and then I will send you away in the morning]

See: Order of Events

1 Samuel 9:20 (#5)

וּלְמִ֤י כָל־חֶמְדַּ֙ת יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל הֲלֹ֥וא לְךָ֖ וּלְכֹ֥ל בֵּ֖ית אָבִֽיךָ

“Now to whom is all of the desire of Israel? {Is it} not to you and to all of the house of your father”

Samuel is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate these questions as statements or exclamations. Alternate translation: [Consider to whom is all of the desire of Israel. It is to you and to all of the house of your father!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 9:20 (#2)

אַל־תָּ֥שֶׂם אֶת־לִבְּךָ֖ לָהֶ֑ם כִּ֥י נִמְצְא֖וּ

“do not set your heart to them, for they have been found”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [they have been found, so do not set your heart to them]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 9:20 (#3)

אַל־תָּ֥שֶׂם אֶת־לִבְּךָ֖ לָהֶ֑ם

“do not set your heart to them”

Samuel is using a common expression of his culture to mean that Saul should not be concerned about the donkeys. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [do not be concerned about them]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 9:20 (#4)

נִמְצְא֖וּ

“they have been found”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone has found them]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 9:20 (#6)

וּלְכֹ֥ל בֵּ֖ית אָבִֽיךָ

“and to all of the house of your father”

Your language may have its own term or expression for this relationship. Alternate translation: [and to your entire extended family]

See: Kinship

1 Samuel 9:20 (#1)

הַיּ֔וֹם שְׁלֹשֶׁ֥ת הַיָּמִ֖ים

“today, three days”

Samuel is expressing this time reference in the characteristic terms of his culture, which considered today to be the first day, yesterday the second day, and the day before yesterday the third day. Express this time reference in the terms that your own culture would use. Alternate translation: [the day before yesterday]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 9:21 (#2)

הֲלֹ֣וא בֶן־יְמִינִ֞י אָנֹכִ֗י מִקְּטַנֵּ֙י שִׁבְטֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל וּמִשְׁפַּחְתִּ֖י הַצְּעִרָ֑ה מִכֹּ֖ל־מִשְׁפְּחֹ֥ות שִׁבְטֵ֛י בִּנְיָמִ֖ן וְלָמָּה־ דִּבַּ֥רְתָּ אֵלַ֖י כַּדָּבָ֥ר הַזֶּֽה

“Am} I not a Benjamite, from the smallest of the tribes of Israel, and {is not} my clan the least of all of the clans of the tribe of Benjamin? So why have you spoken to me according to this word”

Saul is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I am only a Benjamite, from the smallest of the tribes of Israel, and my clan is the least of all the clans of the tribe of Benjamin. So you should not have spoken to me according to this word.]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 9:21 (#3)

וְלָמָּה דִּבַּרְתָּ אֵלַי כַּדָּבָר הַזֶּה

“So why have you spoken to me according to this word”

Saul assumes that Samuel will understand that he feels the king of Israel should come from a great clan within a large tribe. That is why Saul is questioning what Samuel is telling him. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers, using a statement form instead of a question form. Alternate translation: [So you should not have spoken to me according to this word, since I do not have the social standing to become king of Israel] or [So you should not have spoken to me according to this word, since I do not have the social status to become king of Israel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 9:21 (#4)

כַּדָּבָר הַזֶּה

“according to this word”

Saul is using the term **word** to represent what Samuel has said by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and said these things]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 9:21 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר

“and said”

See whether you represented the expression **and said** in 9:19. Alternate translation: [And Eli replied] or [And Saul replied]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 9:22 (#3)

וְהֵמָּה כִּשְׁלֹשִׁים אִישׁ

“Now they {were} about 30 men”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand that Samuel was honoring Saul in front of many important people. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 9:22 (#1)

וַיִּתֵּן לָהֶם מָקוֹם בְּרֹאשׁ הַקְּרוּאִים

“And he gave to them a place at the head of the invited {ones”

Seating Saul and his servant in this **place** was a symbolic action by which Samuel was honoring them as his special guests. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [And he honored them by giving them a place at the head of the invited {ones}]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 9:22 (#2)

מָקוֹם בְּרֹאשׁ הַקְּרוּאִים

“a place at the head of the invited {ones”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean the most important place at the feast. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the most important place among the guests]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 9:23 (#1)

תְּנָה אֶת־הַמָּנָה אֲשֶׁר נָתַתִּי לָךְ

“Give the portion that I gave to you”

Giving Saul a special portion of meat that Samuel had saved for him was a symbolic action by which Samuel was showing Saul further honor. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [Honor him by giving him the portion that I gave to you]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 9:24 (#1)

וְהָעָלָיֶהָ

“and the {thing} on it”

This could mean: (1) some further meat that was attached to the **thigh**. Alternate translation: [and the meat that was attached to it]; (2) some sauce, broth, or seasoning that the cook had put on the thigh. Alternate translation: [and the sauce he had put on it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 9:24 (#6)

שָׁמוּר

“it has been} kept”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [we have kept it]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 9:24 (#7)

לֵאמֹר הָעָם ׀ קָרָאתִי

“saying, ‘I have invited the people”

It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning with an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [ever since I told the cook that I had invited these people]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Samuel 9:24 (#3)

וַיֹּאמֶר

“And he said”

The pronoun **he** refers to Samuel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Samuel said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 9:24 (#2)

לִפְנֵי שָׁאוּל

“to the face of Saul”

The author is using the term **face** to represent what was in front of Saul. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of Saul] or [at Saul’s place at the table]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 9:24 (#4)

הַנִּשְׁאָר שִׂים־לְפָנֶיךָ

“the reserved {thing} is set to your face”

If your language does not use these passive forms, you could express the ideas with active forms or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [we have set in front of you the thing that we reserved]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 9:24 (#5)

אֱכֹל כִּי לַמּוֹעֵד שָׁמוּר־לְךָ לֵאמֹר הָעָם ׀ קָרָאתִי

“Eat, for {it has been} kept for you for the appointed time, saying, ‘I have invited the people”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [This has been kept for you since I called the people to come at this appointed time, so eat]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 9:25 (#1)

וַיֵּרְדוּ & וַיְדַבֵּר

“And they came down & And he spoke”

The pronoun **they** refers primarily to Samuel and Saul, although it may also apply to the other guests. The pronoun **he** refers to Samuel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Samuel and Saul came down … And Samuel spoke]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 9:25 (#2)

וַיְדַבֵּר עִם־שָׁאוּל עַל־הַגָּג

“And he spoke with Saul on the roof”

The author assumes that his readers will understand that Samuel brought Saul up onto the **roof** of his house to speak with him so that he could do that privately. (Flat roofs were common in this culture and people could sit and talk on them.) You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And he spoke with Saul privately on the roof]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 9:26 (#1)

וַיַּשְׁכִּ֖ימוּ

“And they arose early”

The author assumes that his readers will understand that Samuel and Saul arose early so that they could speak further privately before too many other people were up and around. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And they arose early so that they could speak further privately]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 9:26 (#2)

וַיְהִ֔י

“And it happened”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:12. The author is using it here to introduce a new development that begins in this verse and continues through to the end of the next chapter.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 9:26 (#3)

כַּעֲלֹ֥ות הַשַּׁ֖חַר

“as the dawn came up”

The author is using the term **dawn** to represent the sun. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as the sun came up] or [at sunrise]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 9:26 (#4)

לֵאמֹ֑ר

“saying”

See whether you chose to represent the term **saying** in 4:21, and if so, how you translated it.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 9:26 (#5)

קוּמָ֗ה וַאֲשַׁלְּחֲךָ֙

“Arise, and I will send you away”

The second clause explains the purpose for the action that the first phrase describes. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use a connecting word or phrase that more specifically shows the relationship between these clauses. Alternate translation: [Arise so that I can send you away]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

1 Samuel 9:27 (#2)

כַּיּ֥וֹם

“according to today”

Samuel is using a common expression of his culture to refer to the present moment. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [right away] or [just at this time]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 9:27 (#3)

אֶת־דְּבַ֥ר אֱלֹהִ֖ים

“the word of God”

Samuel is using the term **word** to represent what God would have him say to Saul on his behalf by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [what God has to say to you]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 9:27 (#1)

וּשְׁמוּאֵ֗ל אָמַ֙ר אֶל־שָׁא֔וּל אֱמֹ֥ר לַנַּ֖עַר וְיַעֲבֹ֣ר לְפָנֵ֑ינוּ וַיַּעֲבֹ֔ר

“and Samuel said to Saul, “Speak to the servant, that he may pass on to our face” (and he passed on”

It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning with an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [and Samuel told Saul to tell the servant to walk some distance in front of them. So the servant went ahead, and then Samuel told Saul]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Samuel - Chapter 10 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the section of the book about Saul. It describes how Samuel told Saul in advance several things that would happen to him. Samuel did that to show Saul that Yahweh genuinely had instructed him to appoint Saul as king. The chapter also describes how Samuel gathered all of the Israelites together at the city of Mizpah to demonstrate, through the casting of lots, that Yahweh had chosen Saul as king.

1 Samuel 10:1 (#2)

עַל־רֹאשׁ֑וֹ

“on his head”

The pronoun **his** refers to Saul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [on Saul’s head]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 10:1 (#3)

וַיִּשָּׁקֶ֥ק

“and he kissed him”

This was a symbolic action that showed Samuel’s respect and loyalty to Saul as the new king. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. If your readers would find it embarrassing if your translation said that one man kissed another man, you could translate the expression in a more general way. Alternate translation: [and Samuel kissed Saul to show his loyalty and respect for him as king] or [and Samuel gave Saul a sign of respect that showed his loyalty to him as king]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 10:1 (#5)

נַחֲלָתֹֽו

“his inheritance”

Samuel is speaking as if the people of Israel were something that Yahweh had inherited as a lasting possession. He means that the Israelites belong to Yahweh perpetually. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his chosen people]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 10:1 (#4)

הֲלֹ֣וא כִֽי־מְשָׁחֲךָ֣ יְהוָ֗ה עַל־נַחֲלָתֹו֙ לְנָגִ֔יד

“Is it} not that Yahweh has anointed you as ruler over his inheritance”

Samuel is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Know for certain that Yahweh has anointed you as ruler over his inheritance!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 10:1 (#1)

וַיִּקַּ֨ח שְׁמוּאֵ֜ל אֶת־פַּ֣ךְ הַשֶּׁ֗מֶן וַיִּצֹ֤ק עַל־רֹאשֹׁו֙

“And Samuel took a flask of oil and poured {it} on his head”

Pouring oil on Saul’s head was a symbolic action by which Samuel indicated that God was appointing Saul as king. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [Samuel took a flask of oil and poured it on Saul’s head to show that God had chosen him to be king]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 10:2 (#7)

מָ֣ה אֶֽעֱשֶׂ֔ה לִבְנִ֖י

“What shall I do about my son”

The author assumes that his readers will know that by this question, Kish is asking how he can find his son. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [How can I find my son]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 10:2 (#1)

בִּגְבֻ֥ול בִּנְיָמִ֖ן

“in the border of Benjamin”

The author is using the term **border** to represent the territory of the tribe of Benjamin. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the territory of Benjamin]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 10:2 (#2)

וְאָמְר֣וּ אֵלֶ֗יךָ נִמְצְא֤וּ הָֽאֲתֹנֹות֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר הָלַ֔כְתָּ לְבַקֵּ֑שׁ וְהִנֵּ֤ה נָטַ֙שׁ אֲבִ֣יךָ֔ אֶת־דִּבְרֵ֥י הָֽאֲתֹנֹ֖ות וְדֹאֵ֣ג לָכֶ֑ם לֵאמֹ֗ר מָ֚ה אֶֽעֱשֶׂ֣ה לִבְנִֽי

“And they will say to you, ‘The female donkeys that you went to seek have been found. And behold, your father has abandoned the matters of the female donkeys and has become concerned about you, saying, “What shall I do about my son”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And they will tell you that the female donkeys that you went to seek have been found, but now your father has abandoned the matters of the female donkeys and has become concerned about you and is asking what he shall do about you]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 10:2 (#3)

אֶת־דִּבְרֵ֣י הָאֲתֹנֹ֔ת

“the matters of the female donkeys”

The people speaking to Saul are using the plural form **matters** because they are referring to several **donkeys**. Your language may use plural forms in the same way. If not, you could use a singular form here. Alternate translation: [the matter of the female donkeys]

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

1 Samuel 10:2 (#4)

נִמְצְא֣וּ הָאֲתֹנ֗וֹת אֲשֶׁ֤ר הָלַ֙כְתָּ֙ לְבַקֵּ֔שׁ

“The female donkeys that you went to seek have been found”

The expression **have been found** is a passive verbal form. If your language does not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone has found the female donkeys that you went to look for]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 10:2 (#5)

וְהִנֵּ֨ה

“And behold”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:31.

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 10:2 (#6)

לֵאמֹ֑ר

“saying”

See whether you chose to represent the term **saying** in 4:21, and if so, how you translated it.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 10:3 (#2)

וּמְצָא֣וּךָ שָׁ֔ם שְׁלֹשָׁ֥ה אֲנָשִׁ֖ים עֹלִ֣ים אֶל־הָאֱלֹהִ֑ים בֵּ֥ית־אֵֽל

“And three men going up to God {at} Bethel will find you there”

See how you translated the word **found** in 9:11. Alternate translation: [And three men going up to God at Bethel will meet you there] or [And there you will meet three men going up to God at Bethel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 10:3 (#3)

עֹלִ֣ים אֶל־הָאֱלֹהִ֔ים בֵּ֥ית־אֵ֖ל

“going up to God {at} Bethel”

See the discussion in the Introduction to 1 Samuel of how Hebrew speakers and writers marked travel for change in elevation, and see how you translated the comparable expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [going to Bethel to worship God]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 10:3 (#4)

נֹשְׂאִ֣ים ׀ שְׁלֹשָׁ֣ה גְדָיִ֗ים

“carrying three young goats”

The verb that the ULT translates as **carrying** here does not necessarily mean that this man had lifted these goats off the ground and was holding them in his arms as he walked. That is the meaning in the case of the **loaves of bread**, but in the case of these goats, the verb probably means that the man was leading them along. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [leading three young goats]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 10:3 (#1)

מִשָּׁ֑ם וְהָהָ֣לְאָה

“from there and farther”

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **farther** tells in what way Saul would go **from there**. Alternate translation: [farther from there]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 10:4 (#2)

מִיָּדָ֔ם

“from their hand”

Samuel is using one part of these men, their **hand**, to mean all of them in the act of giving. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from them]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 10:4 (#3)

מִיָּדָם

“from their hand”

In this verse, the word **hand** is singular in form, but since Samuel is referring to a group of people, if you retain this expression in your translation, it may be more natural in your language to use the plural form. Alternate translation: [from their hands]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Samuel 10:4 (#1)

וְשָׁאֲלוּ לְךָ לְשָׁלוֹם

“And they will ask about you regarding peace”

Here the abstract noun **peace** indicates the idea of “welfare.” If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And they will ask you if you are doing well and inquire whether there is anything they can do to help you]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 10:5 (#1)

גִּבְעַ֣ת הָאֱלֹהִ֑ים

“to} Gibeah of God”

The context suggests that **Gibeah of God** is the name of the same city that the author calls “Gibeah of Saul” in 11:4 and 15:34. This was Saul’s home city, and people gave it that name later when he became famous as king. But at this point people distinguished this city from others by the same name by referring to the high place near it. That is why Samuel calls it **Gibeah of God** in this context. We recommend that you use that name here in your translation.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 10:5 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר־שָׁ֣ם נְצִבֵ֣י פְלִשְׁתִּ֔ים

“where the garrisons of the Philistines {are} there”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [where the garrisons of the Philistines are]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 10:5 (#3)

וְלִפְנֵיהֶ֗ם נֵ֚בֶל וְתֹ֣ף וְחָלִ֔יל וְכִנּ֖וֹר

“And to their face {will be} a harp and a tambourine and a flute and a lyre”

Here the author is using **to their face** to represent being in front of the group. He is also using the names of musical instruments to mean people playing those instruments. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express these meanings plainly. Alternate translation: [And at the front of the group will be people playing harps and tambourines and flutes and lyres]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 10:6 (#1)

וְנֶהְפַּכְתָּ֖ לְאִ֣ישׁ אַחֵֽר

“And you will be changed into another man”

Samuel is speaking as if the Spirit of Yahweh would actually turn Saul **into another man**. He means that the Spirit will transform Saul’s character. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And you will become a different kind of person]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 10:7 (#1)

כִּֽי־תבאינה הָאֹתֹ֥ת הָאֵ֖לֶּה לָ֑ךְ

“when these signs come to you”

Samuel is speaking of these **signs** as if they were living things that could **come** to a person on their own. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when you see these things occur]

See: Personification

1 Samuel 10:7 (#2)

עֲשֵׂ֣ה לְךָ֔ אֲשֶׁ֥ר תִּמְצָ֖א יָדֶ֑ךָ כִּ֥י הָאֱלֹהִ֖ים עִמָּֽךְ

“do for yourself what your hand finds, for God is with you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [because God is with you, do for yourself what your hand finds]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 10:7 (#3)

עֲשֵׂה לְךָ֖ אֲשֶׁ֣ר תִּמְצָ֑א יָדֶ֥ךָ

“do for yourself what your hand finds”

Samuel is using a common expression of his culture that means to do whatever seems best in a situation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [do whatever you believe is best to do]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 10:8 (#3)

לִזְבֹּ֥חַ זִבְחֵ֖י שְׁלָמִֽים

“to sacrifice sacrifices of peace offerings”

Samuel is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [to offer sacrifices of peace offerings]

See: Poetry

1 Samuel 10:8 (#1)

וְיָרַדְתָּ֣

“But go down”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:3, where travel was also marked for change in elevation. Alternate translation: [But go]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 10:8 (#2)

לְפָנַ֑יו

“to my face”

Samuel is using the expression **to my face** to mean “before” or “previous to.” He is telling Saul to go to Gilgal before he arrives there. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [ahead of me]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 10:9 (#3)

וַיַּהֲפָךְ־לוֹ֙ אֱלֹהִ֣ים לֵ֔ב אַחֵ֖ר

“that God changed to him another heart”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [that God changed him and gave him another heart]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 10:9 (#4)

וַיַּהֲפָךְ־לוֹ֙ אֱלֹהִ֣ים לֵ֔ב אַחֵ֖ר

“that God changed to him another heart”

The author is speaking as if God had actually replaced Saul’s physical **heart**. He means that God transformed Saul’s attitudes, desires, and character. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that God profoundly changed the way Saul thought and felt]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 10:9 (#2)

כְּהַפְנֹתֹ֥ו שְׁכֶ֖מוֹ

“as he turned his shoulder”

The author is using one part of a Saul, his **shoulder** to mean Saul himself in the action of turning his whole body around. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as he turned around]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 10:9 (#5)

וַיָּבֹ֕אוּ כָּל־הָאֹתֹ֖ות הָאֵ֑לֶּה

“And all of these signs came”

The author is speaking of these **signs** as if they were living things that **came** on their own. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And all of these things happened]

See: Personification

1 Samuel 10:9 (#1)

וְהָיָ֣ה

“And it happened”

See how you translated the phrase “And it happened” in 1:12.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 10:10 (#1)

וַיָּבֹ֥אוּ שָׁ֖מָּה הַגִּבְעָ֑תָה

“And they came there to Gibeah”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [And they came to Gibeah]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 10:10 (#2)

וַיָּבֹאוּ & לִקְרָאתָתוֹ

“And they came & met him”

The pronoun **they** refers to Saul and his servant, while the pronoun **him** refers to Saul alone. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Saul and his servant came ... met Saul]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 10:11 (#4)

הֲגַם שָׁאוּל בַּנְּבִיאִים

“Is} Saul also among the prophets”

The people are using the question form to express surprise and amazement. If speakers of your language would not use a question for this purpose, you could translate this as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [It is hard to believe that Saul has become one of the prophets!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 10:11 (#2)

וְהִנֵּה

“and behold”

In this context, the word **behold** both calls attention to what the author is about to describe and indicates that what the people **saw** was surprising to them. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [much to their surprise]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 10:11 (#1)

מֵאֶתְמוֹל שִׁלְשִׁשֹׁם

“from yesterday and the third day”

The author is using a common expression of his culture. See how you translated this in 4:7. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [previously] or [in the past]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 10:11 (#3)

אִישׁ אֶל־רֵעֵהוּ

“a man to his neighbor”

The author is using a common expression of his culture that describes individuals speaking to one another. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to one another]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 10:12 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר

“and said”

The expression **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this expression explicitly. Alternate translation: [And a man from there responded]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 10:12 (#3)

עַל־כֵּן הָיְתָה לְמָשָׁל הֲגַם שָׁאוּל בַּנְּבִאִים

“Therefore it became a proverb, “Is Saul also among the prophets”

The author is describing the origin of a short popular saying of this culture that expressed a great deal of meaning in a few words. He is indicating that people applied this saying to comparable situations in which a person did something that was surprising in light of his upbringing or family of origin. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Proverbs

1 Samuel 10:12 (#2)

וּמִי אֲבִיהֶם

“And who {is} their father”

The man is using the question form to get his listeners to reflect. He does not want them to tell him who the fathers of these prophets are. If speakers of your

language would not use a question for this purpose, you could translate this as a statement, expressing the understanding that the man hopes his listeners will reach upon reflection. Alternate translation: [It is God who makes a person a prophet, not his father]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 10:13 (#1)

וַיָּבֹא

“and he came”

In this context, your language might say “went” instead of **came**. Alternate translation: [and he went]

See: Go and Come

1 Samuel 10:14 (#3)

וַנָּבֹוא אֶל־שְׁמוּאֵל

“so we came to Samuel”

In this context, your language might say “went” instead of **came**. Alternate translation: [so we went to Samuel]

See: Go and Come

1 Samuel 10:14 (#2)

וַנַּרְאֶה כִּי־אַיִן

“And we saw that {they were} not”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And we saw that they were not in any of the places where we looked]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 10:14 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר

“And he said”

The pronoun **he** refers to Saul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Saul said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 10:16 (#2)

נִמְצְאוּ הָאֲתֹנֹות

“the female donkeys had been found”

The expression **had been found** is a passive verbal form. If your language does not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone had found the female donkeys]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 10:16 (#1)

הַגֵּד הִגִּיד לָנוּ

“Declaring, he declared to us”

Saul is repeating forms of the verb “declare” in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [He told us definitely]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 10:16 (#3)

דְּבַר הַמְּלוּכָה & אֲשֶׁר אָמַר שְׁמוּאֵל

“the word of the kingship that Samuel had said”

The author is using the term **word** to represent what Samuel had said by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [what Samuel had said about the kingship]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 10:17 (#1)

אֶל־יְהוָה

“to Yahweh”

The author assumes that his readers will know that when he says that Samuel summoned the people **to Yahweh**, he means that Samuel called them to gather in Yahweh’s presence so that Yahweh could speak to them. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to meet together in the presence of Yahweh so that Yahweh could speak to them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 10:18 (#6)

מִיַּד & וּמִיַּד

“from the hand of & and from the hand of”

Here, **hand** represents power and control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equiva-

lent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from the control of ... and from the power of]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 10:18 (#2)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:28. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 10:18 (#3)

אָנֹכִי הֶעֱלֵיתִי אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל מִמִּצְרָיִם וָאַצִּיל אֶתְכֶם מִיַּד מִצְרַיִם וּמִיַּד כָּל־הַמַּמְלָכוֹת הַלֹּחֲצִים אֶתְכֶם

“I myself brought up Israel from Egypt. And I delivered you from the hand of the Egyptians and from the hand of all of the kingdoms oppressing you”

The author assumes that his readers will understand that Yahweh is giving a reason why the Israelites should have remained loyal to him as their ruler. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I myself brought up Israel from Egypt. And I delivered you from the hand of the Egyptians and from the hand of all of the kingdoms oppressing you. So you ought to have remained loyal to me as your ruler]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 10:18 (#1)

אֶל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“to the sons of Israel”

Yahweh is speaking about the Israelites in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [to you Israelites]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 10:18 (#4)

כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אָנֹכִי הֶעֱלֵיתִי אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל מִמִּצְרָיִם וָאַצִּיל אֶתְכֶם מִיַּד מִצְרַיִם וּמִיַּד כָּל־הַמַּמְלָכוֹת הַלֹּחֲצִים אֶתְכֶם

“Thus says Yahweh, the God of Israel: ‘I myself brought up Israel from Egypt. And I delivered you from the hand of the Egyptians and from the hand of all of the kingdoms oppressing you”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh, the God of Israel, says that he himself brought you Israelites up from Egypt and that he delivered you from the hand of the Egyptians and from the hand of all the kingdoms oppressing you]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 10:18 (#5)

אֶתְכֶם & אֶתְכֶם

“you & you”

The word **you** is plural here because Yahweh is addressing all of the assembled Israelites. So use plural forms in your translation if your language marks that distinction, here and in the next verse.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Samuel 10:19 (#2)

וַתֹּאמְרוּ לֹוֹ כִּי־מֶלֶךְ תָּשִׂים עָלֵינוּ

“And you have said to him that ‘you shall set a king over us”

It may be more natural in your language to express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [And you have told him that he should set a king over you]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Samuel 10:19 (#3)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָֹה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:12. Alternate translation: [in the presence of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 10:19 (#4)

וּלְאַלְפֵיכֶם

“and according to your thousands”

The author is probably using the term **thousands** as a customary way of referring to parts of a tribe, the clans, rather than to a specific number. Alternate translation: [and according to your clans]

See: Numbers

1 Samuel 10:19 (#1)

מִכָּל־רָעוֹתֵיכֶם וְצָרֹתֵיכֶם

“from all of your calamities and your distresses”

The terms **calamities** and **distresses** mean similar things. The author is using them together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [every kind of trouble that you encounter]

See: Doublet

1 Samuel 10:20 (#3)

וַיִּלָּכֵד שֵׁבֶט בִּנְיָמִן

“and the tribe of Benjamin was taken”

The expression **was taken** is a passive verbal form. If your language does not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh indicated through the lot that he had chosen the tribe of Benjamin]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 10:20 (#1)

אֵת כָּל־שִׁבְטֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“all of the tribes of Israel”

The author is speaking of **tribes** as a whole to represent one part of them, their leaders. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [leaders from all of the tribes of Israel]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 10:20 (#2)

וַיִּלָּכֵד שֵׁבֶט בִּנְיָמִן

“and the tribe of Benjamin was taken”

The author assumes that his readers will understand that this was done by casting lots to determine Yahweh’s choice. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the tribe of Benjamin was chosen by lot]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 10:21 (#2)

הַמַּטְרִי

“the Matrite”

The author is not referring to a specific **Matrite**. He means the Matrites in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using a plural form. Alternate translation: [the Matrites]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 10:21 (#1)

וַתִּלָּכֵד מִשְׁפַּחַת הַמַּטְרִי וַיִּלָּכֵד שָׁאוּל בֶּן־קִישׁ

“and the clan of the Matrite was taken. And Saul, the son of Kish, was taken”

The expression **was taken** is a passive verbal form. If your language does not use these passive forms, you could express the ideas in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. See how you translated similar expressions in 10:20. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh indicated through the lot that he had chosen the clan of the Matrites, and then that he had chosen Saul, son of Kish]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 10:21 (#3)

וְלֹא נִמְצָא

“but he was not found”

The expression **was not found** is a passive verbal form. If your language does not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but they could not find him]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 10:22 (#1)

אֶל־הַכֵּלִים

“among the bags”

The author assumes that his readers will know that these were the **bags** in which the people had brought supplies with them to this gathering, which they had apparently put in one location and piled up high enough for Saul to hide among them. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [among the bags of supplies you have piled up over there]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 10:23 (#1)

וַיִּגְבַּהּ מִכָּל־הָעָם מִשִּׁכְמוֹ וָמָעְלָה

“And he was taller than any of the people from his shoulder and upward”

See how you translated the same expression, **from his should and upward** in 9:2. Alternate translation: [And

he was a head taller than anyone else] or [And he was significantly taller than other Israelite men]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 10:24 (#2)

כִּֽי־אֵ֥ין כָּמֹ֖הוּ בְּכָל־הָעָֽם

“For {there is} no one like him among all of the people”

Here the word **For** introduces an explanation of why the people should recognize Saul as Yahweh’s choice. It does not introduce the reason why Yahweh chose Saul. Alternate translation: [After all, there is no one else among all the people who is as tall and impressive as he is]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 10:24 (#4)

יְחִ֥י הַמֶּֽלֶךְ

“May the king live”

The people are using a common expression of their culture to show their acceptance of and loyalty to their new king. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [Long live the king!] or [We want our king to live a long time and rule over us well!]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 10:24 (#3)

וַיָּרִ֥יעוּ כָל־הָעָ֖ם וַיֹּאמְרֻ֑ו

“And all of the people shouted and said”

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **shouted** tells in what way the people **said** this. Alternate translation: [And all the people said loudly]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 10:24 (#1)

הַרְאִיתֶם֮ אֲשֶׁ֣ר בָּחַ֣ר־בּ֔וֹ יְהוָ֑ה

“Do you see upon whom Yahweh has chosen”

Samuel is using the question form to draw attention to Saul as Yahweh’s choice. If speakers of your language would not use a question for this purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Look at the man whom Yahweh has chosen!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 10:25 (#1)

וַיַּנַּ֖ח

“and he made {it} rest”

The author is speaking of the book as if it were a living thing that could be made to **rest**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he stored it]

See: Personification

1 Samuel 10:25 (#3)

אִ֥ישׁ לְבֵיתֽוֹ

“a man to his house”

The author is speaking of one kind of dwelling, a **house** to represent homes of all kinds. (Some Israelites continued to live in tents.) If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression in 4:10. Alternate translation: [each one to his own home]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 10:25 (#2)

לִפְנֵ֖י יְהוָֽה

“to the face of Yahweh”

Here, **to the face of Yahweh** represents some place where the Israelites considered Yahweh to be present. The author probably means either Kiriath Jearim, where the ark was at this time, or Shiloh, where the sacred tent was at this time. Alternate translation: [in a place where Yahweh was present]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 10:26 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר־נָגַ֥ע אֱלֹהִ֖ים בְּלִבָּֽם

“whom God had touched upon their hearts”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean God had influenced these men to be loyal to Saul. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [whom God had influenced to be loyal to Saul]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 10:26 (#1)

הַחַ֣יִל

“the mighty”

The author is using the adjective **mighty** as a noun to mean men who were powerful soldiers. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [some powerful soldiers]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 10:27 (#3)

וְלֹא־הֵבִ֥יאוּ לוֹ֙ מִנְחָ֔ה

“and they did not bring a gift to him”

Not bringing a gift to Saul was a symbolic action that showed these men did not accept him as their king. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [and to show that they rejected his authority, they refused to bring him the customary gifts that subjects bring to their king]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 10:27 (#1)

וּבְנֵ֣י בְלִיַּ֔עַל

“But some sons of wickedness”

The author is using a common expression of his culture that refers to people who characteristically do what is wrong. See how you translated this expression in 2:12. Alternate translation: [But some very wicked men]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 10:27 (#2)

מַה־יֹּשִׁיעֵ֥נוּ זֶ֖ה

“How shall this {one} save us”

These men are using the question form to express their contempt for Saul. If speakers of your language would not use a question for this purpose, you could translate this as a statement. Alternate translation: [This man will not able to save us!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 10:27 (#4)

וַיְהִ֖י כְּמַחֲרִֽישׁ

“But he was like one being silent”

The point of this comparison is that just as **one being silent**, meaning in this context a deaf person, would not have heard this insult and so would not have responded, so Saul did not respond. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [But Saul did not respond to their insults, just as if he had not heard them]

See: Simile

1 Samuel - Chapter 11 Introduction

Structure and Formatting
This chapter continues the story of King Saul by telling how Yahweh inspired him to lead the Israelites to a first victory in war.

1 Samuel 11:1 (#4)

וַיֹּ֤אמְרוּ֙ כָּל־אַנְשֵׁ֣י יָבֵ֔ישׁ

“And all of the men of Jabesh said”

The author is using the whole population of **Jabesh**, **all of the men** of the city, to represent one part of the population, the city’s leaders, who conducted these negotiations with Nahash. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the leaders of Jabesh went to Nahash and said]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 11:1 (#2)

וַיַּ֤עַל נָחָשׁ֙ הָעַמּוֹנִ֔י וַיִּֽחַן

“Now Nahash the Ammonite came up and camped”

The author is using one person who was involved in this military campaign, **Nahash**, the king and commander of the Ammonite army, to mean everyone who was involved. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Now Nahash the Ammonite came up with his army and they camped]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 11:1 (#5)

כְּרָת־לָ֥נוּ בְרִ֖ית

“Cut a covenant for us”

The men are using **Cut a covenant** as a common expression of their culture to mean “make a covenant.” The word “cut” was used because in some covenant ceremonies, the participants would cut up animals and then walk between the pieces. This was to indicate, “If I break this covenant, may I be destroyed in this same way.” It is not necessary to understand this background to covenant ceremonies in order to

understand the action in this chapter, so you do not have to use the term "cut" in your translation. You could simply say "make," or you could use an expression from your own language and culture. Alternate translation: [Make a covenant with us]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 11:1 (#1)

וַיַּ֤עַל נָחָשׁ֙ הָעַמּוֹנִ֔י וַיִּחַ֖ן עַל־יָבֵ֣שׁ גִּלְעָ֑ד

"Now Nahash the Ammonite came up and camped against Jabesh Gilead"

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 11:1 (#3)

וַיַּ֤עַל נָחָשׁ֙ הָעַמּוֹנִ֔י

"Now Nahash the Ammonite came up"

See the discussion in the Introduction to 1 Samuel of how Hebrew speakers and writers marked travel for change in elevation, and see how you translated the comparable expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [Now Nahash the Ammonite came]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 11:2 (#1)

אֶכְרֹ֥ת לָכֶ֖ם

"I will cut for you"

Nahash is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [I will cut a covenant for you]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 11:2 (#2)

בְּנָקֹ֖ר לָכֶ֑ם כָּל־עַ֣יִן יָמִ֔ין

"in the gouging of every right eye of you"

The act of **gouging** out the **right eye** was, for one thing, a military measure that would make the men of Jabesh Gilead less effective warriors, since they would have difficulty seeing to aim weapons. However, as Nahash himself explains, it would also be a symbolic action that would show other nations that the Israelites had not been able to defend their own people. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [in the disgraceful and disabling gouging of every right eye of you]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 11:2 (#3)

וְשַׂמְתִּ֥יהָ חֶרְפָּ֖ה עַל־כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

"And I will set it {as} a disgrace against all of Israel"

Nahash assumes that the elders of Jabesh Gilead will understand that by gouging out the eyes of the people of one Israelite city, Nahash would humiliate the entire nation. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And this will show all other nations how powerless the Israelites are]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 11:3 (#1)

גְּבֻל֣וֹת יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

"the border of Israel"

The elders of Jabesh Gilead are using the term **border** to represent the territory that this border encloses. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the territory of Israel]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 11:3 (#2)

וְיָצָ֥אנוּ אֵלֶ֖יךָ

"then we will go out to you"

In this context, your language might say "come" instead of **go**. Alternate translation: [then we will come out to you]

See: Go and Come

1 Samuel 11:4 (#1)

גִּבְעַ֣ת שָׁא֑וּל

"to} Gibeah of Saul"

See how you translated the name of this city in 10:5. Alternate translation: [to the city named Gibeah where Saul lived]

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 11:4 (#5)

וַיִּשְׂאוּ כָל־הָעָם אֶת־קוֹלָם וַיִּבְכּוּ

“And all of the people lifted up their voice and wept”

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The expression **lifted up their voice** tells in what way the people **wept**. Alternate translation: [And all of the people wept loudly]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 11:4 (#2)

וַיְדַבְּרוּ הַדְּבָרִים בְּאָזְנֵי הָעָם

“and they spoke the words in the ears of the people”

The author is using the term **words** to represent what the messengers said by using words, and he is using the **ears of the people** to represent them hearing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they had the people listen to their message]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 11:4 (#4)

וַיִּשְׂאוּ כָל־הָעָם אֶת־קוֹלָם וַיִּבְכּוּ

“And all of the people lifted up their voice and wept”

In this verse, the word **voice** is singular in form, but the author is referring to a group of people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of **voice**. Alternate translation: [And all of the people lifted up their voices and wept]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Samuel 11:4 (#3)

וַיִּשְׂאוּ כָל־הָעָם אֶת־קוֹלָם וַיִּבְכּוּ

“And all of the people lifted up their voice and wept”

The author is speaking as if a **voice** were an object that the people could have **lifted up**. He means that the people increased the volume of their voices. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And all of the people increased the volume of their voices and wept]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 11:5 (#2)

וַיְסַפְּרוּ־לוֹ

“And they recounted to him”

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And someone recounted to him] or [And he was told]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 11:5 (#1)

וְהִנֵּה

“And behold”

The author is using this phrase to introduce a new development in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 11:5 (#3)

אֶת־דִּבְרֵי אַנְשֵׁי יָבֵישׁ

“the words of the men of Jabesh”

The author is using the term **words** to represent the message that the messengers from Jabesh Gilead communicated by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all that the messengers from Jabesh Gilead told them]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 11:6 (#2)

וַיִּֽחַר אַפּוֹ מְאֹד

“And his nose burned greatly”

The author is using **his nose burned greatly** as a common expression of his culture to mean “he became very angry.” Your culture may also associate anger with heat or with a particular part of the body, and if so, you could use its characteristic expression in your translation. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he became steaming mad] or [And he became very angry]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 11:6 (#1)

וַתִּצְלַח רוּחַ־אֱלֹהִים עַל־שָׁאוּל

“And the Spirit of God rushed upon Saul”

The author is using **the Spirit of God rushed upon** as a common expression of his culture to mean that the Spirit of God empowered Saul. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the Spirit of God filled Saul] or [Then the Spirit of God came and empowered Saul]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 11:7 (#4)

גְּבוּל יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the border of Israel”

The author is using the term **border** to represent the territory that this border encloses. See how you translated this term in 11:3. Alternate translation: [the territory of Israel]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 11:7 (#7)

וַיִּפֹּל פַּחַד־יְהוָה עַל־הָעָם

“And the fear of Yahweh fell on the people”

The author is speaking as if **fear** had been an object that **fell** on people. He means that the people were motivated by respect for Yahweh, recognizing that his anointed king was summoning them urgently into battle and that Yahweh expected them to obey. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And great respect for Yahweh motivated the people]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 11:7 (#3)

וַיְשַׁלַּח

“and he sent”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and he sent the pieces of the cattle]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 11:7 (#6)

אַחֲרֵי שָׁאוּל

“behind Saul”

Saul is speaking about himself in the third person in order to make an official pronouncement. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [behind me]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 11:7 (#8)

כְּאִישׁ אֶחָד

“as one man”

The author is using **as one man**, as a common expression of his culture to mean that the people acted together with entire unity of purpose. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [united in purpose] or [all together]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 11:7 (#1)

וַיְנַתְּחֵהוּ

“and cut it into pieces”

Since the author is referring to a **pair of cattle**, the form of the pronoun **it** would be dual here, if your language uses that form. Otherwise, the word would be plural, as modeled in the UST.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Dual/Plural

1 Samuel 11:7 (#5)

אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יֵצֵא אַחֲרֵי שָׁאוּל וְאַחֲרֵי שְׁמוּאֵל

“Whoever is not going out behind Saul and behind Samuel”

Saul is using the expression **going out behind** to represent going into battle under the command of him and Samuel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Whoever does not go into battle under the command of Saul and Samuel]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 11:7 (#2)

וַיְשַׁלַּח בְּכָל־גְּבוּל יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּיַד הַמַּלְאָכִים

“and he sent through all of the border of Israel by the hand of the messengers”

The author is using one part of the messengers, their **hand**, to represent all of them in the act of carrying these pieces throughout Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he sent the messengers to carry these pieces through all the border of Israel]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 11:8 (#2)

וַיִּהְיוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל֙ שְׁלֹ֣שׁ מֵא֔וֹת אֶ֖לֶף וְאִ֣ישׁ יְהוּדָ֑ה שְׁלֹשִׁ֖ים אָֽלֶף

“And the sons of Israel were 300, 000, and the men of Judah {were} 30, 000”

See the discussion in the Introduction to this chapter of why the author gives a separate total of the soldiers who came from the tribe of **Judah**.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 11:8 (#1)

וַיִּהְיוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל֙

“And the sons of Israel were”

See the discussion of the phrase “sons of” in the Introduction to 1 Samuel. In this context, the phrase **the sons of Israel** describes not the Israelites generally but the Israelite men (not from Judah) who served as soldiers. Alternate translation: [And the soldiers who came from the other tribes of Israel]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 11:9 (#4)

בחם הַשָּׁמֶשׁ

“at the heat of the sun”

The author is using the term **heat of the sun** to represent the time of day by which the sun has become hot. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [by mid-morning]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 11:9 (#1)

וַיֹּאמְר֖וּ

“And they said”

The pronoun **they** refers to Saul and Samuel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Saul and Samuel said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 11:9 (#2)

כֹּ֤ה תֹאמְרוּן֙ לְאִישֵׁ֣י יָבֵ֣ישׁ גִּלְעָ֔ד מָחָ֖ר תִּהְיֶה־לָּכֶ֣ם תְּשׁוּעָ֑ה בְּחֹם֙ הַשָּׁ֔מֶשׁ

“Thus you shall say to the men of Jabesh Gilead, ‘Tomorrow deliverance will be for you, at the heat of the sun”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Tell the men of Jabesh Gilead that deliverance will be for them tomorrow at the heat of the sun]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 11:9 (#3)

תִּהְיֶה־לָּכֶ֥ם תְּשׁוּעָֽה

“deliverance will be for you”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **deliverance**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [we will deliver you]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 11:10 (#3)

נֵצֵ֖א אֵלֵיכֶ֑ם

“we will go out to you”

In this context, your language might say “come” instead of **go**. See how you translated this in 11:3. Alternate translation: [we will come out to you]

See: Go and Come

1 Samuel 11:10 (#4)

כְּכָל־הַטּ֥וֹב בְּעֵינֵיכֶ֖ם

“according to all of the good in your eyes”

See how you translated **in your eyes** similar expression in 1:18. Alternate translation: [as you see fit] or [according to what you consider right]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 11:10 (#1)

וַיֹּאמְרוּ֙ אַנְשֵׁ֣י יָבֵ֔ישׁ

“And the men of Jabesh said”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language.

Alternate translation: [And the men of Jabesh said to Nahash]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 11:10 (#2)

וַיֹּאמְרוּ֙ אַנְשֵׁ֣י יָבֵ֔ישׁ

“And the men of Jabesh said”

The author refers to all **the men of Jabesh** to represent one part of them, the leaders who were conducting these negotiations. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the leaders of Jabesh said]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 11:11 (#4)

עַד־חֹ֥ם הַיּ֖וֹם

“until the heat of the day”

The author is using the term **heat of the day** to represent the time when the sun becomes hot. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [until midday]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 11:11 (#1)

וַיְהִ֣י

“And it happened”

The author is using this phrase to introduce a new development in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 11:11 (#3)

וַיַּכּ֣וּ אֶת־עַמּ֔וֹן

“and they struck Ammon”

See the discussion of the term struck in the Introduction to 1 Samuel. Alternate translation: [and they killed many of the Ammonite soldiers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 11:11 (#5)

הַנִּשְׁאָרִ֑ים וַיָּפֻ֙צוּ֙ וְלֹ֣א נִשְׁאַר־בָּ֔ם שְׁנַ֥יִם יָחַ֖ד

“that the {ones} being left scattered, and two among them were not left together”

The expression **being left** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the survivors scattered, and two among them did not remain together]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 11:11 (#6)

וְלֹ֣א נִשְׁאַר־בָּ֔ם שְׁנַ֥יִם יָחַ֖ד

“and two among them were not left together”

The author is making an overstatement to emphasize how completely the Israelites defeated the Ammonites. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [and the surviving Ammonite soldiers fled in complete disarray]

See: Hyperbole

1 Samuel 11:11 (#2)

בְּאַשְׁמֹ֣רֶת הַבֹּ֔קֶר

“during the watch of the morning”

The **watch of the morning** was the last of three periods into which the Israelites divided the night. It lasted from about 2:00 to 6:00 AM. The significant thing in this context is that this watch ended at sunrise. If your readers would not be familiar with this time reference, you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [before sunrise]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 11:12 (#1)

מִמְּי֙ הָאֹמֵ֔ר שָׁא֖וּל יִמְלֹ֣ךְ עָלֵ֑ינוּ

“Who {are} the {ones} having said, ‘Shall Saul reign over us”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Who are the ones who said that Saul should not reign over us]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 11:12 (#2)

שָׁא֖וּל יִמְלֹ֣ךְ עָלֵ֑ינוּ

“Shall Saul reign over us”

These people are using the question form to express their opposition to Saul becoming king. If speakers of your language would not use a question for this

purpose, you could translate this as a statement. Alternate translation: [Saul should not reign over us!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 11:13 (#1)

לֹא־יוּמַת אִישׁ בַּיּוֹם הַזֶּה כִּי הַיּוֹם עָשָׂה־יְהוָה תְּשׁוּעָה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל

“A man shall not be made to die on this day. For today Yahweh has done deliverance in Israel”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Because Yahweh has done deliverance in Israel today, a man shall not be made to die on this day]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 11:13 (#2)

לֹא־יוּמַת אִישׁ

“A man shall not be made to die”

The expression **made to die** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [We shall not make a man die] or [We are not going to kill anyone]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 11:13 (#3)

עָשָׂה־יְהוָה תְּשׁוּעָה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל

“Yahweh has done deliverance in Israel”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **deliverance**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Yahweh has delivered Israel]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 11:14 (#1)

וְנְחַדֵּשׁ שָׁשָׁם הַמְלוּכָה

“and let us renew the kingship there”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **kingship**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and there let us formally recognize Saul as king once again]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 11:15 (#4)

שְׁלָמִים

“peace offerings”

In this context, the term **peace offerings** describes sacrifices that the Israelites offered to Yahweh to acknowledge that he was the one who had enabled them to defeat the Ammonites. Sacrificing animals that provided the meat for a feast, and burning up some of the animals as Yahweh’s share, was therefore a symbolic action. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [peace offerings to express their gratitude to Yahweh]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 11:15 (#2)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:12. Alternate translation: [in the presence of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 11:15 (#3)

וַיִּזְבְּחוּ־שָׁשָׁם זְבָחִים

“And there they sacrificed sacrifices”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [And there they offered sacrifices]

See: Poetry

1 Samuel 11:15 (#1)

וַיַּמְלִכוּ שָׁשָׁם אֶת־שָׁאוּל לִפְנֵי יְהוָה בַּגִּלְגָּל

“and there they caused Saul to reign to the face of Yahweh at Gilgal”

It might seem that this statement contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [and there they caused Saul to reign to the face of Yahweh]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel - Chapter 12 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the story of King Saul by telling how Samuel addressed the assembled Israelites at Gilgal to talk about the kingship with them. Samuel told them that even though they should not have asked for a king for the reasons they did, Yahweh had nevertheless given them a king, and Yahweh would bless them and their king if they were devoted and obedient to him.

This chapter serves as a type of farewell address. In this culture, leaders gave instructions to their followers before they left or died. Joshua does something similar in Joshua 23 and 24, using similar language. If you have already translated the book of Joshua, see how you translated his farewell address, and translate Samuel's address here similarly.

1 Samuel 12:1 (#2)

שָׁמַעְתִּי בְקֹלְכֶם לְכֹל אֲשֶׁר־אֲמַרְתֶּם לִי

"I have listened to your voice according to all of what you said to me"

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [I have listened to everything you said to me]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 12:1 (#1)

הִנֵּה

"Behold"

See how you translated this term in 2:31. Alternate translation: [Now listen]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 12:1 (#3)

שָׁמַעְתִּי בְקֹלְכֶם לְכֹל אֲשֶׁר־אֲמַרְתֶּם לִי

"I have listened to your voice according to all of what you said to me"

See the discussion of the term "listen" in the Introduction to 1 Samuel, and see how you translated the similar expression in 2:25. Alternate translation: [I have done everything you asked me to do]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 12:2 (#1)

הַמֶּלֶךְ ׀ מִתְהַלֵּךְ לִפְנֵיכֶם & וַאֲנִי הִתְהַלַּכְתִּי לִפְנֵיכֶם

"the king is walking to your faces & Now I myself have walked to your faces"

Samuel is speaking as if the Israelites were actually traveling on a path and **the king** was **walking** ahead of them, and as if he had **walked** ahead of them himself. He is using this image to represent leadership. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the king is leading you ... Now I have been leading you]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 12:2 (#3)

מִנְּעֻרַי עַד־הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה

"from my youth to this day"

Samuel is referring to all of life by naming two extremes, **my youth** and **this day**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for my entire life]

See: Merism

1 Samuel 12:2 (#2)

וַאֲנִי זָקַנְתִּי וָשֵׂיבָתִי

"Now I myself have aged and have become gray-headed"

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The first phrase makes a general statement, and the second phrase gives a specific example that confirms it. It may be clearer in your language to connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the idea in the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Now I myself have aged, indeed, I have become gray-headed]

See: Parallelism

1 Samuel 12:3 (#2)

מְשִׁיחוֹ

"his anointed"

Samuel is using the adjective **anointed** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [his anointed king]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 12:3 (#4)

וְאַעְלִים עֵינַי בּוֹ

“and I veiled my eyes with it”

Samuel is speaking as if a bribe were something with which he could have **veiled** his **eyes**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and I ignored wrongdoing as a result]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 12:3 (#3)

וּמִיַּד־מִי לָקַחְתִּי כֹפֶר

“or from the hand of whom have I taken a bribe”

Samuel is using one part of a person, his **hand**, to mean all of that person in the act of giving a bribe. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [or from whom have I taken a bribe]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 12:3 (#1)

הִנֶּנִּי

“Behold me”

See how you translated this same expression in 3:4. This was a courteous expression that a person in this culture would use to indicate his availability for a task. In this case, Samuel is indicating that he is available to answer any charges against his conduct as a judge. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [I am making myself available]

See: Politeness

1 Samuel 12:3 (#5)

וְאָשִׁיב לָכֶם

“And I will restore {it} to you”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Tell me, and I will restore it to you]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 12:4 (#1)

מְאוּמָה

“anything”

The Israelites mean that Samuel has not taken any bribes. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [any bribes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 12:4 (#2)

מִיַּד־אִישׁ

“from the hand of a man”

The Israelites are using one part of a person, his **hand**, to mean all of him in the act of offering a bribe. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from a briber]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 12:5 (#3)

בְּיָדִי

“in my hand”

Samuel assumes that his listeners will know that he is referring to things that do not belong to him. He does not mean that he has no possessions of his own. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in my possession that belongs to someone else]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 12:5 (#4)

וַיֹּאמֶר

“And he said”

Even though the author is referring to a group of people here, the pronoun **he** is singular. If the singular form of this pronoun would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural form in your translation. Alternate translation: [And they said]

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

1 Samuel 12:5 (#5)

עֵד

“Witness”

The Israelites are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order

to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [We agree that Yahweh is a witness and that the king is a witness]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 12:5 (#1)

וְעֵד מְשִׁיחוֹ

“and his anointed {is} a witness”

See how you translated the expression **his anointed** in 12:3. Alternate translation: [and his anointed king is a witness]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 12:5 (#2)

בְּיָדִי

“in my hand”

Samuel is using the word **hand** to represent possession. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in my possession]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 12:6 (#1)

עָשָׂה אֶת־מֹשֶׁה וְאֶת־אַהֲרֹן

“made Moses and Aaron”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [made Moses and Aaron leaders]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 12:6 (#2)

אֶת־אֲבֹתֵיכֶם

“your fathers”

Samuel is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your ancestors]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 12:6 (#3)

אֶת־אֲבֹתֵיכֶם

“your fathers”

Samuel is speaking in the second person of people who were his ancestors as well. It may be natural in your language to use a first-person plural pronoun here that would also include him. Alternate translation: [our fathers]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 12:7 (#2)

וְאִשָּׁפְטָה אִתְּכֶם

“and let me be judged with you”

The expression **be judged** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and let us judge which of us was right]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 12:7 (#1)

וְעַתָּה

“And now”

Speakers in this culture used the expression **And now** to introduce their main point. See how you translated this expression in 6:7. Alternate translation: [Now this is the main thing I want us to do today:]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 12:7 (#3)

וְאִשָּׁפְטָה אִתְּכֶם

“and let me be judged with you”

Samuel assumes that these Israelites will know that he is referring to their request for a king. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and let us judge whether you were right to ask for a king or I was right to say that you should not have asked]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 12:7 (#4)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated a similar expression in 1:12. Alternate translation: [here in the presence of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 12:7 (#6)

אֵת כָּל־צִדְקֹת יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר־עָשָׂה אִתְּכֶם וְאֶת־אֲבוֹתֵיכֶם

“with all of the righteousness of Yahweh that he has done with you and with your fathers”

Samuel assumes that his listeners will know that by **righteousness**, he means specifically how Yahweh delivered them and their ancestors from their enemies and oppressors. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [considering all the things that Yahweh has done to deliver you and your fathers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 12:7 (#7)

אֲבוֹתֵיכֶם

“with your fathers”

See how you translated this expression in 12:6. Alternate translation: [your ancestors] or [our ancestors]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 12:7 (#5)

אֵת כָּל־צִדְקֹת יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר־עָשָׂה אִתְּכֶם וְאֶת־אֲבוֹתֵיכֶם

“with all of the righteousness of Yahweh that he has done with you and with your fathers”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **righteousness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [in light of all of the righteous deeds of Yahweh that he has done with you and with your fathers]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 12:8 (#1)

כַּאֲשֶׁר־בָּבָא יַעֲקֹב מִצְרָיִם

“When Jacob had entered Egypt”

See the discussion in the Introduction to 1 Samuel of the use of the name of an ancestor to mean his descendants. Alternate translation: [When the Israelites were living in Egypt]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 12:8 (#2)

אֲבוֹתֵיכֶם׃

“your fathers”

See how you translated this expression in 12:6. Alternate translation: [your ancestors] or [our ancestors]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 12:9 (#2)

וַיִּמְכֹּר אֹתָם בְּיַד סִיסְרָא׀ שַׂר־צְבָא חָצֹור וּבְיַד־פְּלִשְׁתִּים וּבְיַד׀ מֶלֶךְ מוֹאָב

“So he sold them into the hand of Sisera, the commander of the army of Hazor, and into the hand of the Philistines, and into the hand of the king of Moab”

Samuel is speaking as if Yahweh had literally **sold** the Israelites as slaves. He is using this image to mean that Yahweh allowed these enemies to oppress them. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [So he allowed foreigners to oppress them as if they had been their slaves, including Sisera, the commander of the army of Hazor; the Philistines; and the king of Moab]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 12:9 (#3)

וַיִּלָּחֲמוּ בָם

“And they fought with them”

The pronoun **they** refers to the foreign enemies, and the pronoun **them** refers to the Israelites. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And these foreigners all attacked the Israelites with their armies]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 12:9 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכְּחוּ אֶת־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיהֶם

“But they forgot Yahweh their God”

Samuel is speaking as if the ancestors of these Israelites actually **forgot** about Yahweh. He is using this image to mean that they stopped worshiping him. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But they stopped worshiping Yahweh as their God]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 12:10 (#2)

אֶת־יְהוָה

“Yahweh”

The Israelites are speaking directly to Yahweh, but they are referring to him in the third person. If it would be more natural in your language, you could translate this in the second person. Alternate translation: [you]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 12:10 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר חָטָאנוּ כִּי עָזַבְנוּ אֶת־יְהוָה וַנַּעֲבֹד אֶת־הַבְּעָלִים וְאֶת־הָעַשְׁתָּרוֹת וְעַתָּה הַצִּילֵנוּ מִיַּד אֹיְבֵינוּ וְנַעַבְדֶךָּ

“and said, ‘We have sinned, for we have forsaken Yahweh and have served the Baals and the Ashtoreths. And now, deliver us from the hand of our enemies, and we will serve you”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and admitted that they had sinned by forsaking him and serving the Baals and the Ashtoreths, and they told him that if he would deliver them from the hand of their enemies, they would serve him]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 12:10 (#3)

מִיַּד

“from the hand of”

The author is using the term **hand** to represent power or control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from the power of] or [from the domination of]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 12:11 (#3)

בָּטַח

“in security”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **security**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [securely]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 12:11 (#1)

וְאֶת־שְׁמוּאֵל

“and Samuel”

Samuel is speaking about himself in the third person. If it would be more natural in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [and me]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 12:11 (#2)

מִיַּד

“from the hand of”

The author is using the term **hand** to represent power or control. See how you translated this expression in 12:10. Alternate translation: [from the power of]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 12:12 (#4)

עָלֵינוּ

“over us”

If your language marks a distinction between exclusive and inclusive forms of “us,” see which form you decided to use in the comparable expression in 8:5, to which Samuel is referring here.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

1 Samuel 12:12 (#1)

בְּנֵי־עַמּוֹן

“the sons of Ammon”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:28. Alternate translation: [the Ammonites]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 12:12 (#2)

וַתֹּאמְרוּ לִי לֹא כִּי־מֶלֶךְ יִמְלֹךְ עָלֵינוּ וַיהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם מַלְכְּכֶם

“and you said to me, ‘No, but a king shall reign over us,’ though Yahweh your God {was} your king”

It may be more natural in your language to put the information about Yahweh being their king before the information about their request for a human king. Alternate translation: [and even though Yahweh your God was your king, you said to me, ‘No, but a king shall reign over us’]

See: Information Structure

1 Samuel 12:12 (#3)

וַתֹּאמְרוּ לִי לֹא כִּי־מֶלֶךְ יִמְלֹךְ עָלֵינוּ

“and you said to me, ‘No, but a king shall reign over us”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and you told me that you wanted a king to reign over you even]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 12:13 (#1)

וְעַתָּה הִנֵּה הַמֶּלֶךְ אֲשֶׁר בְּחַרְתֶּם אֲשֶׁר שְׁאֲלְתֶּם וְהִנֵּה נָתַן יְהוָה עֲלֵיכֶם מֶלֶךְ

“But now, behold the king whom you have chosen, whom you have requested. And behold, Yahweh has given a king over you”

Samuel is describing one event (the people seeing their king) before describing another event that preceded it (Yahweh giving them a king). If it would be helpful your language, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [And behold, Yahweh has given a king over you. So now, behold the king whom you have chosen, whom you have requested]

See: Order of Events

1 Samuel 12:13 (#2)

וְהִנֵּה

“And behold”

In the earlier instance of the term **behold** in this verse, Samuel actually does want the people to look at their king. But in this second instance, Samuel is using the term **behold** to call attention to and emphasize what he is about to say. Alternate translation: [And in fact]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 12:14 (#1)

וּשְׁמַעְתֶּם בְּקֹלוֹ וְלֹא תַמְרְרוּ אֶת־פִּי יְהוָה

“listen to his voice and do not rebel against the mouth of Yahweh”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The first phrase states the idea positively, and the second phrase restates it negatively. If it would be clearer in your language, you could combine these phrases. Alternate translation: [and obey what Yahweh commands]

See: Parallelism

1 Samuel 12:14 (#4)

פִּי יְהוָה

“the mouth of Yahweh”

Samuel is using the term **mouth** to represent the commands that Yahweh will speak with his mouth. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the commands of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 12:14 (#2)

וּשְׁמַעְתֶּם בְּקֹלוֹ

“listen to his voice”

See the discussion of the term “listen” in the Introduction to 1 Samuel, and see how you translated the similar expression in 2:25. Samuel assumes that his listeners will understand that by **listen**, he means “obey.” You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and obey what he tells you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 12:14 (#3)

וּשְׁמַעְתֶּם בְּקֹלוֹ

“listen to his voice”

The author is using the term **voice** to represent what Yahweh says. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and listen to what he says]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 12:14 (#5)

וְהְיִתֶם גַּם־אַתֶּם וְגַם־הַמֶּלֶךְ אֲשֶׁר מָלַךְ עֲלֵיכֶם אַחֲרֵי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם

“then you will be, both you and the king who reigns over you, after Yahweh your God”

Samuel is speaking as if the Israelites and their **king** would actually be walking **after** or behind Yahweh. He is using this image to mean that Yahweh would lead and protect them. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [then Yahweh will go lead you and the king who reigns over you] or [then Yahweh will deliver you and the king who reigns over you]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 12:15 (#1)

וְאִם־לֹא תִשְׁמְעוּ בְּקוֹל יְהוָה וּמְרִיתֶם אֶת־פִּי יְהוָה

“But if you do not listen to the voice of Yahweh and you rebel against the mouth of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 12:14. Alternate translation: [But if you do not obey what Yahweh commands]

See: Parallelism

1 Samuel 12:15 (#2)

וְהָיְתָה יַד־יְהוָה

“then the hand of Yahweh will be”

Samuel is using the term **hand** to represent power. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [then Yahweh will use his power]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 12:15 (#4)

וּבַאֲבֹתֵיכֶם

“and against your fathers”

See how you translated this expression in 12:6. Alternate translation: [our ancestors]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 12:15 (#3)

וּבַאֲבֹתֵיכֶם

“and against your fathers”

Here the word **and** introduces a comparison, not something additional. Alternate translation: [as it was against your fathers]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 12:16 (#1)

לְעֵינֵיכֶם

“before your eyes”

Samuel is using one part of the Israelites, their **eyes**, to mean all of them in the act of seeing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [before you] or [for you to see]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 12:17 (#8)

לִשְׁאוֹל לָכֶם מֶלֶךְ

“to request a king for yourselves”

Samuel assumes that his listeners will understand that he means that requesting a king was evil. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [that is, to have requested a king for yourselves]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 12:17 (#3)

הֲלֹוא קְצִיר־חִטִּים הַיּוֹם

“Is it} not the harvest of wheat today”

Samuel means that since it is the time of the wheat harvest, it would not ordinarily rain. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [You know that at this time of the wheat harvest, it does not ordinarily rain]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 12:17 (#5)

וּדְעוּ וּרְאוּ

“And know and see”

In this context, Samuel is using **know and see** as a common expression of his culture to mean “consider carefully.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Then face it] or [Then consider carefully]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 12:17 (#2)

הֲלֹוא קְצִיר־חִטִּים הַיּוֹם

“Is it} not the harvest of wheat today”

Samuel is using the question form for emphasis to remind the people that this is the dry season when it does not normally rain. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You know that this is the time of the wheat harvest.]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 12:17 (#4)

קֹלֹת וּמָטָר

“thunder and rain”

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **thunder** tells what kind of **rain** event this will be. Alternate translation: [a thunderstorm]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 12:17 (#6)

רַעַתְכֶם & אֲשֶׁר עֲשִׂיתֶם

“your evil that you have done”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in

your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [the evil that you have done]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 12:17 (#7)

בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָֹה

“in the eyes of Yahweh”

See the discussion in the Introduction to 1 Samuel of this use of the expression “in the eyes of.” The author is using this common expression of his culture to refer to the judgment or opinion of Yahweh. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in Yahweh’s judgment]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 12:17 (#1)

הֲלֹוא קְצִיר־חִטִּים הַיּוֹם

“Is it} not the harvest of wheat today”

Samuel is using the term **today** to refer to the time when people harvest wheat. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Is this not the time of the wheat harvest]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 12:19 (#1)

הִתְפַּלֵּל בְּעַד־עֲבָדֶיךָ אֶל־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ וְאַל־נָמוּת כִּי־יָסַפְנוּ עַל־כָּל־חַטֹּאתֵינוּ רָעָה לִשְׁאֹל לָנוּ מֶלֶךְ

“Pray for your servants to Yahweh your God, that we may not die. For we have added evil onto all of our sins by the requesting of a king for ourselves”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the request that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [We have added evil onto all of our sins by requesting a king for ourselves. So pray for your servants to Yahweh your God, so that we may not die]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 12:19 (#2)

עֲבָדֶיךָ

“your servants”

The Israelites are speaking of themselves in the third person as a sign of humility. If it would be more natural in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [us, your servants]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 12:19 (#4)

רָעָה

“evil”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evil**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [this evil act]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 12:19 (#3)

יָסַפְנוּ עַל־כָּל־חַטֹּאתֵינוּ רָעָה

“we have added evil onto all of our sins”

The Israelites are speaking as if **evil** were an object that could be **added** onto something. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [we have committed this evil act in addition to all of our other sins]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 12:20 (#1)

אַתֶּם עֲשִׂיתֶם אֵת כָּל־הָרָעָה הַזֹּאת

“You, you have done all of this evil”

In this context, Samuel is using the word **all** to express certainty rather than entirety. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You yourselves have certainly done this evil]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 12:20 (#2)

אַתֶּם עֲשִׂיתֶם

“You, you have done”

Samuel is stating the pronoun **You** separately, even though the verb translated as **you have done** already includes this meaning. He is doing that in order to emphasize the personal role of the people in doing the **evil** that he describes. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [You have personally done]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 12:20 (#3)

אַ֗ךְ אַל־תָּסֻ֙רוּ֙ מֵאַחֲרֵ֣י יְהוָ֔ה

“but do not turn aside from after Yahweh”

Samuel is speaking as if the Israelites were walking on a path behind Yahweh but might **turn aside**, or leave that path. He is using this image to mean that they should not stop being devoted to Yahweh. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but do not stop being devoted to Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 12:20 (#4)

בְּכָל־לְבַבְכֶֽם

“with all of your heart”

Here, the **heart** represents a person’s feelings or commitment. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with total devotion] or [in complete sincerity]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 12:21 (#1)

וְלֹ֤א תָסֻרוּ֙ כִּֽי־ אַחֲרֵ֣י הַתֹּ֔הוּ אֲשֶׁ֥ר לֹא־יוֹעִ֖ילוּ וְלֹ֣א יַצִּ֑ילוּ כִּֽי־תֹ֥הוּ הֵֽמָּה

“And do not turn aside, for after the nothingness that does not profit and does not deliver, for they {are} nothingness”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the command that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And since that would be giving your devotion to something that has no substance, do not worship idols instead of Yahweh]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 12:21 (#2)

וְלֹ֤א תָסֻרוּ֙ כִּֽי־ אַחֲרֵ֣י הַתֹּ֔הוּ

“And do not turn aside, for after the nothingness”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And do not turn aside from Yahweh, for that would be to go after the nothingness]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 12:21 (#4)

הַתֹּ֔הוּ אֲשֶׁ֥ר לֹא־יוֹעִ֖ילוּ וְלֹ֣א יַצִּ֑ילוּ

“the nothingness that does not profit and does not deliver”

Samuel assumes that his listeners will understand that by **nothingness**, he means idols that represent non-existent gods. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [idols that represent non-existent gods, which do not profit and cannot deliver]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 12:21 (#3)

וְלֹ֤א תָסֻרוּ֙ כִּֽי־ אַחֲרֵ֣י הַתֹּ֔הוּ

“And do not turn aside, for after the nothingness”

Samuel is speaking as if the Israelites might **turn aside** and leave a path to follow **after** something that has no substance. He is using this image to mean they might stop worshiping Yahweh and worship idols instead. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And do not worship idols instead of Yahweh, for that would be giving your devotion to something that has no substance]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 12:22 (#2)

שְׁמ֑וֹ הַגָּדֽוֹל

“his great name”

Samuel is using the term **name** to represent Yahweh’s reputation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. (However, be sure it is clear in your translation that Samuel is not saying that Yahweh is motivated by what people think of him and that he tries to do what makes a good impression on people. He means that Yahweh has a well-deserved reputation for being a faithful God, and they can be sure he will live up to it by not abandoning them.) Alternate translation: [his great reputation]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 12:22 (#1)

כִּֽי־לֹא־יִטֹּשׁ יְהוָה֙ אֶת־עַמּ֔וֹ בַּעֲבֻ֖ר שְׁמ֑וֹ הַגְּדָל֙וֹל כִּֽי הוֹאִ֣יל יְהוָ֔ה לַעֲשׂ֥וֹת אֶתְכֶ֖ם לֹ֥ו לְעָֽם

“For Yahweh will not forsake his people, because of his great name. For Yahweh was pleased to make you into a people for himself”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the action that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since Yahweh was pleased to make you into a people for himself, because of his great name, Yahweh will not forsake his people]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 12:23 (#1)

חָלִ֨ילָה לִ֜י מֵֽחֲטֹ֤א לַיהוָה֙

“profane to me from sinning against Yahweh”

Samuel is using a common expression of his culture, **profane to me**, to express his horror at the idea of not praying for the people as Yahweh wants him to. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. See how you translated the similar expression in 2:30. Alternate translation: [God forbid that I should sin against Yahweh] or [I hope it never happens that I sin against Yahweh]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 12:23 (#2)

בְּדֶ֣רֶךְ הַטּוֹבָ֔ה וְהַיְשָׁרָֽה

“in the good and straight way”

Samuel is speaking as if he were going to indicate to the Israelites a road (**way**) that they could walk on that was well-maintained (**good**) and led directly to their destination (**straight**). If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [about how to live properly]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 12:24 (#4)

רְא֗וּ

“see”

Samuel is speaking as if the people could visually **see** or observe past events. He is using this image to mean they should think about these things. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [consider]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 12:24 (#1)

יְרֵ֣אוּ אֶת־יְהוָ֔ה וַעֲבַדְתֶּ֥ם אֹת֛וֹ בֶּאֱמֶ֖ת בְּכָל־לְבַבְכֶ֑ם כִּֽי־רְא֗וּ אֵ֚את אֲשֶׁר־הִגְדִּ֣יל עִמָּכֶֽם

“fear Yahweh and serve him in faithfulness with all of your heart. For see what he has made great with you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the command that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [see what Yahweh has made great with you, and as a result, fear and serve him in faithfulness with all of your heart]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 12:24 (#2)

בֶּאֱמֶ֖ת

“in faithfulness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **faithfulness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [faithfully]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 12:24 (#3)

בְּכָל־לְבַבְכֶ֑ם

“with all of your heart”

Samuel is speaking using the **heart** to represent feeling and commitment. See how you translated this expression in 12:20. Alternate translation: [with complete devotion] or [in complete sincerity]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 12:24 (#5)

אֵ֚את אֲשֶׁר־הִגְדִּ֣יל עִמָּכֶֽם

“what he has made great with you”

Samuel is using **make great with** as a common expression of his culture to describe significant actions. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what great things he has done for you]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 12:25 (#2)

גַּם־אַתֶּם גַּם־מַלְכְּכֶם תִּסָּפּוּ

“both you and your king will be swept away”

The expression **be swept away** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will sweep away both you and your king]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 12:25 (#3)

גַּם־אַתֶּם גַּם־מַלְכְּכֶם תִּסָּפּוּ

“both you and your king will be swept away”

Samuel is speaking as if the people and their king would be **swept away** as even large objects and structures are by floodwaters. He is using this image to mean that Yahweh would judge and powerfully punish them. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [both you and your king will be destroyed]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 12:25 (#1)

וְאִם־הָרֵעַ תָּרֵעוּ

“But if doing wickedly, you do wickedly”

Samuel is repeating forms of the verb translated as **do wickedly** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [But if you indeed do wickedly]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel - Chapter 13 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the story of King Saul by telling how, when he felt threatened by an invading Philistine army, he disobeyed a direct command from Yahweh. Samuel told him that as a consequence, Yahweh would not allow him to have a dynasty. That is, none of his descendants would succeed him as king. Instead, Yahweh would choose “a man according to his heart” to become the next king. So this chapter looks forward to the transition that the book later makes from King Saul to King David. But more immediately, it also begins an account that continues through the next chapter of a war between the Israelites and Philistines.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

How many chariots did the Philistines have?

The traditional Hebrew text says in 13:5 that the Philistines invaded Israel with 30,000 chariots and 6,000 horsemen. This statement is problematic because ancient armies always had more horsemen than chariots and because no armies in the ancient world, even those of great empires, are attested to have had nearly that many chariots. One plausible explanation for the reading is that during the process of transmission, the singular word “three” was copied in the plural, which meant “thirty” in Hebrew. Some ancient versions do read “3,000” here, suggesting that this was the original reading. An army of 3,000 chariots and 6,000 horsemen would suit the cultural context. Many modern versions adopt that reading, and you may wish to do so in your own translation.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

A standard way of describing a king’s reign

The statement in 13:1, “Saul {was} a son of a year in his becoming king, and he reigned over Israel two years,” is the first instance of a standard description that occurs repeatedly in this history of Israel that extends through 1–2 Samuel and 1–2 Kings. At the start of the account of each king’s reign, the history tells how old that man was when he became king and for how long he reigned. (There are problems with the numbers in 13:1; see the two discussions just below.) In your translation, be sure to translate this description consistently in each of its occurrences (here and in 2 Samuel 2:10 and 2 Samuel 5:4, etc.) so that your readers will recognize how the history is using it.

How old was Saul when he became king?

A number appears to have dropped out of 13:1 during the process of the transmission of the traditional Hebrew text, since that verse says that Saul was one year old when he became king. In ancient manuscripts, scribes did not write out numbers. They used letters to represent them. There are other examples where it seems evident that a letter has dropped out of the traditional text, and since 13:1 does not make sense in its present form, that seems to be what has happened. While, as a result, we probably cannot be certain how old Saul was when he became king, some ancient versions say that he was 30 years old, and you may find that to be a reasonable number to use in your translation.

How long did Saul reign?
The traditional Hebrew text says in 13:1 that Saul "reigned over Israel two years." However, the narrative in 1 Samuel describes extensive events of his reign, suggesting that it lasted much longer than that. There are further indications of this in Scripture. Paul says in Acts 13:21 that Saul reigned for 40 years. (This could be a round number, meaning about 40 years.) 2 Samuel 2:10 records that Saul's son Ishbosheth was 40 years old when he began to reign. Since he is not listed in 1 Samuel 14:49 as one of the sons whom Saul had when he became king, many interpreters believe that he was born after the beginning of Saul's reign, suggesting that his reign was at least 40 years long. All things considered, it seems probable that a number written as a single letter has dropped out from this verse and that it originally said that Saul reigned over Israel for 42 years. You may wish to use that number in your translation.

1 Samuel 13:1 (#1)

בֶּן־שָׁנָה שָׁאאוּל בְּמָלְכוֹ וּשְׁתֵּתֵי שָׁנִים מָלַךְ עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

"Saul {was} a son of a year in his becoming king, and he reigned over Israel two years"

The author is using this statement to re-introduce Saul as a participant in the story, now as Israel's king. Your language may have its own way of reintroducing participants that you can use in your translation. See the discussion in the Introduction to this chapter of the form of this statement, which marks the reigns of kings throughout the books of 1 and 2 Samuel and 1 and 2 Kings.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Samuel 13:1 (#2)

בֶּן־שָׁנָה שָׁאאוּל בְּמָלְכוֹ

"Saul {was} a son of a year in his becoming king"

The phrase **a son of** was a common expression in this culture that described a person's age. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this in the way your culture describes someone's age. (But see the discussion of this statement in the Introduction to this chapter.) Alternate translation: [Saul was one year old when he became king]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 13:2 (#1)

וַיִּבְחַר־לוֹ שָׁאאוּל שְׁלֹשֶׁת אֲלָפִים מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל

"And Saul chose for himself 3,000 from Israel"

The author is introducing a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 13:2 (#2)

שְׁלֹשֶׁת אֲלָפִים & אַלְפַּיִם & וְאֶלֶף

"3,000 & 2,000 & and 1,000"

The author is leaving out some words that in many languages a sentence would need to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [3,000 soldiers ... And 2,000 of these soldiers ... and 1,000 of these soldiers]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 13:2 (#5)

שִׁלַּח אִישׁ לְאׇהָלָיו

"he sent away, a man to his tent"

The author is using **a man to his tent** as a common expression of his culture to mean that the soldiers stopped their military campaign altogether and each of them went back to his home and family. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he released from military service and sent away]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 13:2 (#3)

יְוׇנָתָן

"Jonathan"

Here the author is introducing Jonathan as a new participant in the story. He introduces him more fully as "Saul's son" in 13:16. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use here in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Samuel 13:2 (#4)

הָעָם

"the people"

The author assumes that readers will recognize that in this context, the term **people** refers to the men of Israel who were able to fight as soldiers. That is also the meaning in the frequent occurrences of this term

in the rest of the chapter (except for in 13:4). Alternate translation: [the soldiers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 13:3 (#1)

וַיַּךְ יוֹנָתָן

“And Jonathan struck”

See the discussion of the term “struck” in the Introduction to 1 Samuel, and see how you translated the term in 4:2. Since the author describes in 13:16 how Saul and Jonathan soon occupied this strategic position in **Geba** themselves, it should be understood that Jonathan destroyed the Philistine garrison there. Alternate translation: [And Jonathan destroyed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 13:3 (#4)

וְשָׁאוּל֙ תָּקַ֣ע בַּשּׁוֹפָ֔ר

“And Saul blew upon a shofar”

The author is using Saul’s name to represent him and the messengers he sent to bring news to the other Israelites. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Saul had messengers blow shofars]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 13:3 (#5)

וְשָׁאוּל֙ תָּקַ֣ע בַּשּׁוֹפָ֔ר

“And Saul blew upon a shofar”

This was a symbolic action that indicated that the messengers were bringing important and urgent news that the Israelites should listen and respond to. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [And Saul had messengers blow shofars to indicate that they had urgent news]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 13:3 (#3)

פְּלִשְׁתִּ֖ים & וַיִּשְׁמְעוּ

“and the Philistines heard”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the Philistines heard about this attack]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 13:3 (#2)

וַיַּךְ יוֹנָתָן

“And Jonathan struck”

The author is using Jonathan to represent him and the soldiers under his command. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Jonathan and his soldiers destroyed]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 13:4 (#6)

וַיִּצָּעֲקוּ֙ הָעָ֔ם אַחֲרֵ֖י שָׁא֑וּל הַגִּלְגָּֽל

“And the people were summoned after Saul {to} Gilgal”

The author is speaking as if Saul were walking somewhere and he wanted these Israelite solders to walk **after** or behind him. He is using this image to mean they were under his command. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Saul summoned the other Israelite soldiers to come to Gilgal and serve under his command]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 13:4 (#2)

הִכָּ֣ה שָׁא֔וּל

“Saul has struck”

The author is using Saul’s name to represent his army. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Saul’s army has struck]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 13:4 (#5)

וַיִּצָּעֲקוּ֙ הָעָ֔ם אַחֲרֵ֖י שָׁא֑וּל הַגִּלְגָּֽל

“And the people were summoned after Saul {to} Gilgal”

The expression **were summoned** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And Saul summoned the people after him to Gilgal]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 13:4 (#1)

וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל֙ שָׁמְע֣וּ לֵאמֹ֔ר

“And all of Israel heard, saying”

The term **saying** introduces a direct quotation, but it is a quotation of what Saul’s messengers were saying, not what the Israelites were saying in response. You may wish to indicate this in your translation, using a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [And all of Israel heard the messengers saying]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 13:4 (#4)

נִבְאַ֣ש יִשְׂרָאֵ֗ל בַּפְּלִשְׁתִּ֔ים

“Israel has made itself stink among the Philistines”

The author is speaking as if the Israelites actually **stink**, making themselves smell so bad that they were offensive to the Philistines. He is using this image to mean that Israel had provoked the Philistines. Your language may have a comparable image that you could use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [Israel has made itself detestable among the Philistines] or [Israel has provoked the Philistines]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 13:4 (#3)

הִכָּ֤ה שָׁאוּל֙

“Saul has struck”

See how you translated this expression in 13:3. Alternate translation: [Saul’s army has destroyed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 13:5 (#3)

וַיַּֽעֲל֥וּ

“And they went up”

See the discussion in the Introduction to 1 Samuel of how Hebrew speakers and writers marked travel for change in elevation, and see how you translated the comparable expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [And they went]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 13:5 (#1)

שְׁלֹשִׁ֣ים אֶ֔לֶף רֶ֖כֶב

“30,000 chariots”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and they had 30,000 chariots]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 13:5 (#4)

וַיַּֽעֲל֥וּ

“And they went up”

In a context such as this, your language might say “came” instead of **went**. Alternate translation: [And they came]

See: Go and Come

1 Samuel 13:5 (#2)

וְעָ֣ם כַּחol֔ אֲשֶׁ֖ר עַל־שְׂפַ֣ת־הַיָּ֑ם לָרֹ֣ב

“and people like the sand that is on the shore of the sea for abundance”

The point of this comparison is that just as there is a seemingly countless number of grains of sand on a seashore, so it seemed that there were too many Philistine soldiers to count. You could make this point explicitly in plain language. Alternate translation: [and a seemingly countless number of soldiers]

See: Simile

1 Samuel 13:6 (#1)

וְאִ֣ישׁ יִשְׂרָאֵ֗ל רָא֤וּ כִֽי־צַר־לֹו֙ כִּֽי נִגַּ֣שׂ הָעָ֔ם

“And a man of Israel saw that it was narrow to him, for the people were distressed”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And because the people were distressed, a man of Israel saw that it was narrow to him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 13:6 (#2)

וְאִ֣ישׁ יִשְׂרָאֵ֗ל רָא֤וּ כִֽי־צַר־לֹו֙

“And a man of Israel saw that it was narrow to him”

The author is not referring to a specific **man of Israel**. He means in general the Israelite men who were fighting in Saul’s army. If it would be helpful to your

readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the men of Israel saw that it was narrow to them]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 13:6 (#4)

נִגַּשׂ הָעָם

“the people were distressed”

The expression **were distressed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the Philistines were distressing the people]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 13:6 (#3)

צַר־לוֹ

“it was narrow to him”

The author is using **it was narrow to him** as a common expression of his culture to mean “he was in a dangerous situation.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he was in a tight spot] or [he was in very dangerous circumstances]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 13:7 (#1)

וְכָל־הָעָם חָרְדְּוּ אַחֲרָיו

“and all of the people trembled after him”

The author is speaking as if the people were physically walking behind Saul and shaking with fear as they did so. He is using this image to mean they were still under his command but were very afraid. See how you translated the term “after” in 13:4. Alternate translation: [and all of the people still following him trembled] or [and all of the soldiers who remained there under his command trembled]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 13:7 (#2)

חָרְדְּוּ

“trembled”

The author assumes that readers will understand that he means the people were trembling from fear. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [trembled with fear]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 13:8 (#1)

אֲשֶׁשָׂר שְׁמוּאֵל

“that Samuel”

The phrase **that Samuel** is a translation of the written Hebrew text. Some part of the original text seems to be missing, however. You may want to follow the fuller reading of the ancient Greek translation. Alternate translation: [that Samuel had set]

See: Alternative Readings

1 Samuel 13:9 (#1)

הַגִּישׁוּ אֵלַי הָעֹלָה וְהַשְּׁלָמִים

“Bring the burnt offering and the peace offerings to me”

The author assumes that readers will understand that Saul intended to offer these sacrifices himself, even though Samuel had told him to wait for him to come and offer them himself. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Bring the burnt offering and the peace offerings to me, and I will sacrifice them myself]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 13:10 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“And it happened”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:12.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 13:10 (#2)

וְהִנֵּה

“that, behold”

See how you translated the term **behold** in 4:13.

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 13:10 (#3)

לְבָרֵכוֹ

“to bless him”

The author assumes that readers will understand that by **bless**, he means that Saul intended to greet or

welcome Samuel. While this may have involved Saul wishing publicly that Yahweh would bless Samuel (that is, do good things for him), as in 15:13, the focus is on Saul greeting or welcoming Samuel. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [so that he could welcome him] or [so that he could welcome him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 13:11 (#1)

מֶּה עָשִׂ֖יתָ

“What have you done”

Samuel is using the question form for emphasis to express his strong disapproval of what Saul has done. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You should not have done this!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 13:11 (#2)

וְאַתָּה֙ לֹא־בָ֣אתָ

“and you, you had not come”

Saul is stating the pronoun **you** separately, even though the verb translated as **you had not come** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that, in his view, Samuel has not done what he said he would do. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing what Saul means here. Alternate translation: [You actually had not come]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 13:12 (#2)

אֵלַ֑י

“against me”

Saul is using himself to represent all of the Israelite soldiers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly and use a plural pronoun. Alternate translation: [against us]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 13:12 (#1)

וָאֹמַ֗ר עַתָּ֤ה יֵרְד֙וּ פְּלִשְׁתִּ֣ים אֵלַ֔י הַגִּלְגָּ֖ל וּפְנֵ֣י יְהוָ֑ה לֹ֥א חִלִּ֖יתִי

“then I said, ‘Now the Philistines will come down against me {at} Gilgal, but I have not entreated the face of Yahweh”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [then I told myself that the Philistines would soon come down against me at Gilgal and that I had not entreated the face of Yahweh]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 13:12 (#3)

וּפְנֵ֣י יְהוָ֑ה לֹ֥א חִלִּ֖יתִי

“but I have not entreated the face of Yahweh”

Saul is using one part of Yahweh, his **face**, to represent all of him in the act of being **entreated**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but I have not entreated Yahweh]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 13:13 (#1)

לֹ֣א שָׁמַ֔רְתָּ אֶת־מִצְוַ֖ת יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֑יךָ אֲשֶׁ֣ר צִוָּ֔ךְ כִּֽי־עַתָּ֗ה הֵכִ֤ין יְהוָה֙ אֶת־מַמְלַכְתְּךָ֔ אֶל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל עַד־עוֹלָֽם

“You have not kept the command of Yahweh your God that he commanded you. For now Yahweh would have established your kingdom over Israel forever”

If the connection between the first statement and the second statement is not clear, you may want to use different connecting words to show how these statement relate to each other. Alternate translation: [If you had kept the command of Yahweh your God that he commanded you, then Yahweh would have established your kingdom over Israel forever]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 13:13 (#2)

לֹ֣א שָׁמַ֔רְתָּ אֶת־מִצְוַ֖ת יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֑יךָ אֲשֶׁ֣ר צִוָּ֔ךְ

“You have not kept the command of Yahweh your God that he commanded you”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [You have not kept the command of Yahweh your God] or [You have not done what Yahweh your God commanded you]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 13:13 (#3)

עַתָּה֙ הֵכִ֣ין יְהוָ֔ה אֶת־מַמְלַכְתְּךָ֖ אֶל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל עַד־עוֹלָֽם

“now Yahweh would have established your kingdom over Israel forever”

Samuel assumes that his readers will understand that this would have happened if Saul had obeyed. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh would have established your kingdom over Israel forever at this time if you had obeyed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 13:14 (#3)

כִּלְבָבֹ֔ו

“according to his heart”

Samuel is using Yahweh’s **heart** to represent his desires and values. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who shares his values] or [who wants what he wants]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 13:14 (#2)

בִּקֵּ֤שׁ יְהוָה֙

“Yahweh has sought”

Samuel is using one part of the process of finding something, seeking it, to represent that entire process. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh has found]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 13:14 (#4)

וַיְצַוֵּ֥הוּ יְהוָ֖ה לְנָגִ֣יד עַל־עַמּ֑וֹ כִּ֚י לֹ֣א שָׁמַ֔רְתָּ אֵ֥ת אֲשֶׁר־צִוְּךָ֖ יְהוָֽה

“and Yahweh has commanded him to {be} ruler over his people, for you have not kept what Yahweh commanded you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the action that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [and since you have not kept what Yahweh commanded you, Yahweh has commanded him to be ruler over his people]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 13:14 (#1)

מַמְלַכְתְּךָ֖ לֹא־תָקֹ֑ום

“your kingdom will not stand”

Samuel is speaking of Saul’s **kingdom** as if it were a living thing that could **stand** on its own. He is using this image to mean that Saul’s dynasty would not continue. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your descendants will not rule after you]

See: Personification

1 Samuel 13:15 (#3)

אֶת־הָעָ֖ם הַנִּמְצְאִ֥ים עִמֹּֽו

“the people being found with him”

The term **found** in this context means “present” or “available.” See how you translated this term in 9:8. Alternate translation: [the soldiers who were still with him]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 13:15 (#4)

כְּשֵׁ֣שׁ מֵא֔וֹת אִ֑ישׁ

“about 600 men”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and he determined that there were about 600 men]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 13:15 (#1)

וַיָּ֥קָם שְׁמוּאֵ֛ל

“And Samuel arose”

Here the term **arose** means that Samuel took action. It does not mean merely that he stood up from a sitting or reclining position. If this expression does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Samuel resolutely left]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 13:15 (#2)

אֶת־הָעָ֖ם הַנִּמְצְאִ֥ים עִמֹּֽו

“the people being found with him”

The expression **being found** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the people whom he found with him]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 13:16 (#3)

וְהָעָם֙ הַנִּמְצָ֣א עִמָּ֔ם

“and the people being found with them”

The expression **being found** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. See how you translated this expression in 13:15. Alternate translation: [and the soldiers who were still with them]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 13:16 (#1)

וְשָׁא֨וּל וְיוֹנָתָ֤ן בְּנוֹ֙ וְהָעָם֙ הַנִּמְצָ֣א עִמָּ֔ם יֹשְׁבִ֖ים בְּגֶ֣בַע בִּנְיָמִ֑ן וּפְלִשְׁתִּ֖ים חָנְנ֥וּ בְמִכְמָֽשׂ

“Now Saul and Jonathan his son and the people being found with them were staying in Geba of Benjamin, and the Philistines had camped at Michmash”

The author is providing background information about the locations of the opposing forces to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 13:16 (#2)

וְיוֹנָתָ֤ן בְּנוֹ֙

“and Jonathan his son”

The author is reintroducing Jonathan as a participant here, having introduced him initially in 13:2. He identifies him more fully here as Saul’s son. Your language may have a way that you can use in your translation of providing further information to reintroduce participants.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Samuel 13:17 (#2)

וַיֵּצֵ֖א הַמַּשְׁחִֽית

“And the destroyer went out”

In this verse, the word **destroyer** is singular in form, but it refers to groups of soldiers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form. Alternate translation: [And the destroyers went out] or [And ravaging bands of soldiers went out]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Samuel 13:17 (#1)

וַיֵּצֵ֖א הַמַּשְׁחִֽית מִמַּחֲנֵ֣ה פְלִשְׁתִּ֑ים שְׁלֹשָׁ֥ה רָאשִֽׁים

“And the destroyer went out from the camp of the Philistines, three companies”

It may be more natural in your language to put the information about the number of companies with the statement that these companies **went out**. Alternate translation: [And three companies of destroyers went out from the camp of the Philistines]

See: Information Structure

1 Samuel 13:18 (#1)

הַגְּבוּל֙ הַנִּשְׁקָ֣ף עַל־גֵּ֔יא הַצְּבֹעִֽים

“the border looking down upon the Valley of Zeboim”

The author is speaking of this **border** as if it were a living thing that could look down from a height. He is using this image to mean that this border was on higher ground than the **valley** below. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the border above the Valley of Zeboim]

See: Personification

1 Samuel 13:18 (#2)

הַגְּבוּל֙ הַנִּשְׁקָ֣ף עַל־גֵּ֔יא הַצְּבֹעִֽים

“the border looking down upon the Valley of Zeboim”

Here the word **border** could mean: (1) “territory.” Alternate translation: [the territory above the valley of Zeboim]; (2) some specific border, most likely the one between the territories of Judah and Benjamin. Alternate translation: [the border between Judah and Benjamin, which runs along the crest of the valley of Zeboim]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 13:19 (#1)

וְחָרָשׁ֙ לֹ֣א יִמָּצֵ֔א בְּכֹ֖ל אֶ֣רֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל כִּֽי־אמר פְּלִשְׁתִּ֗ים פֶּן־ יַֽעֲשׂ֤וּ הָעִבְרִים֙ חֶ֣רֶב א֔וֹ חֲנִֽית

“Now a blacksmith was not found in all of the land of Israel. For the Philistines had said, “Lest the Hebrews make a sword or a spear”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Now since the Philistines had said, “Lest the Hebrews make a sword or a spear,” a blacksmith was not found in all of the land of Israel]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 13:19 (#3)

וְחָרָשׁ֙ לֹ֣א יִמָּצֵ֔א

“Now a blacksmith was not found”

See how you translated the term **found** in 13:15. Alternate translation: [Now there were no blacksmiths]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 13:19 (#4)

אמר פְּלִשְׁתִּ֔ים פֶּ֥ן יַעֲשׂ֛וּ הָעִבְרִ֖ים חֶ֣רֶב א֑וֹ חֲנִֽית

“the Philistines had said, “Lest the Hebrews make a sword or a spear”

The author is summarizing, in the form of a direct quotation, the reason why the Philistines decided not to allow Israelites to be blacksmiths. The Philistines may not have spoken these actual words to one another, so you could translate this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [the Philistines had decided that they did not want the Hebrews to be able to make swords or spears]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Samuel 13:19 (#5)

חֶ֣רֶב א֑וֹ חֲנִֽית

“a sword or a spear”

The Philistines are not referring to a specific **sword** or **spear**. They mean such weapons in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using plural forms. Alternate translation: [swords or spears]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 13:19 (#2)

וְחָרָשׁ֙ לֹ֣א יִמָּצֵ֔א בְּכֹ֖ל אֶ֣רֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“Now a blacksmith was not found in all of the land of Israel”

The author is providing further background information to help readers understand what will happen next in the story. In the next chapter, he will describe a remarkable victory despite starting with basically no weapons. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 13:20 (#2)

וְאֶת־אִתּ֔וֹ & וְאֵ֖ת מַחֲרֵשָׁתֽוֹ

“and his pick & and his sickle”

A **pick** was a pointed tool that people in this culture used to break up hard ground. A **sickle** was a curved blade attached to a handle, which people in this culture used to cut grain stalks during harvest. If your readers would not be familiar with what these tools were, in your translation you could use the names of similar tools that your readers would recognize, or you could use general expressions. Alternate translation: [and his digging tool ... and his harvesting blade]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 13:20 (#1)

אִ֣ישׁ

“a man”

The author is not referring to a specific **man**. He means each Israelite who needed to have someone sharpen his tools. Alternate translation: [each man]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 13:21 (#3)

הַדָּרְבָּ֑ן

“the goad”

The author is not referring to a specific **goad** (a pointed stick used to guide cattle). He means such tools in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using a plural form. Alternate translation: [goads]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 13:21 (#1)

פִּפִּ֔ים

“a pim”

A **pim** was a weight of silver equivalent to about eight grams or about a quarter of an ounce. You could try to express this in terms of modern money values, but

if you did, that could cause your Bible translation to become outdated and inaccurate, since those values can change over time. Instead, you could either give the equivalent weight or use the biblical term in the text and explain the weight in a note.

See: Biblical Weight

1 Samuel 13:21 (#2)

וְלַשְּׁלֹשָׁ קֹלְשֹׁשָׁן

“and for a three-fork”

A **three-fork** was a tool with three pointed prongs, similar to what the author calls “a fork with three prongs” in 2:13. See how you translated the name of this tool there. Alternate translation: [and for a trident] or [and for a three-pronged fork]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 13:22 (#4)

בְּיַד

“in the hand of”

The author is using the term **hand** to represent possession or ownership. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the possession of]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 13:22 (#3)

וְלֹא נִמְצָא חֶרֶב וַחֲנִית֙ & וַתִּמָּצֵ֣א לְשָׁא֔וּל וּלְיוֹנָתָ֖ן בְּנֽוֹ

“a sword or spear {was} not found & but one was found for Saul and for his son Jonathan”

Since the author is referring to weapons in general, it might be more natural in your language to use plural forms. Alternate translation: [there were no swords or spears ... but Saul and his son Jonathan did have weapons]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Samuel 13:22 (#1)

בְּיוֹם מִלְחָמָֽת

“on the day of battle that”

The author is using the term **day** to represent a specific time, the time of this conflict. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [at the time of this conflict]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 13:22 (#2)

וְלֹא נִמְצָא חֶרֶב וַחֲנִית֙ & וַתִּמָּצֵ֣א לְשָׁא֔וּל וּלְיוֹנָתָ֖ן בְּנֽוֹ

“a sword or spear {was} not found & but one was found for Saul and for his son Jonathan”

See how you translated the term **found** in 13:15 and 13:19. Alternate translation: [there was no sword or spear ... but Saul and his son Jonathan each had one]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 13:23 (#2)

וַיֵּצֵא֙ מַצַּ֣ב פְּלִשְׁתִּ֔ים אֶל־מַעְבַּ֖ר מִכְמָֽשׂ

“Now a garrison of the Philistines went out to the pass of Michmash”

The author assumes that readers will understand that the Philistines sent this garrison out to guard this strategic location. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And the Philistines sent out a garrison to guard the pass of Michmash]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 13:23 (#1)

וַיֵּצֵא֙ מַצַּ֣ב פְּלִשְׁתִּ֔ים אֶל־מַעְבַּ֖ר מִכְמָֽשׂ

“Now a garrison of the Philistines went out to the pass of Michmash”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel - Chapter 14 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the story of Saul by describing how the Israelites under his command, particularly through the exploits of his son Jonathan, won a great victory over the Philistines.

1. Jonathan and his armor bearer defeat a Philistine garrison, causing panic among the entire Philistine army. (1–15)
2. All of the Israelites mobilize and defeat the Philistines. (16–23)

3. Saul causes trouble for the Israelites by cursing any one of them who eats on the day of the battle. (24–46)
4. A summary of Saul's lineage, family, and activities as king. (47–52)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The name "Hebrews"
As the Introduction to chapter 13 discusses, the name "Hebrews" was a term of contempt that the Philistines used for the Israelites. That is why the Philistines use it in 14:11 as they speak disparagingly of the Israelites "coming out from the holes where they hid themselves." In 14:21, the author uses the term "Hebrews" for Israelite solders who had defected to the Philistines. As in 13:7, where the author refers to Israelite soldiers who fled across the Jordan from the Philistine army, he may be using the term in 14:21 to suggest that these deserters also deserved to be called by a contemptuous name. Whatever the explanation, since "Hebrews" is the actual term that these characters and the author use in the biblical text, you should use that same term in your translation.

Did Jonathan pass between the cliffs of Bozez and Seneh, or did he climb up and over them?
In 14:4–5, the author describes and names two cliffs or rock faces that were either in or beside the route that Jonathan envisioned taking from Geba over to the Philistine garrison near Michmash. Many versions of the Bible suggest or state in verse 4 that these cliffs were on either side of Jonathan's route, so that he passed between them. However, since the author explains in verse 5 that one cliff was on the north side of the valley that Jonathan was crossing and the other cliff was on the south side, and since Michmash was on the north side of the valley and Geba was on the south side, it does not appear that Jonathan passed between these cliffs. Rather, he had to climb over them in order to reach the Philistines. They had apparently blocked all of the other, more accessible routes through the valley. So the author is relating a feat of strength that Jonathan and his armor bearer performed, in addition to their feat of daring in attacking the Philistine garrison. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region that says that Jonathan passed between these cliffs, you will have to consider whether to follow its reading, but we recommend that you indicate in your translation that he climbed up and over them.

Why did Saul make the soldiers not eat anything on the day of the battle?
The author describes in 14:24 how Saul put a curse on any soldier who ate anything during the day when the Israelite army was fighting the Philistines. As the rest of the story shows, that led to the soldiers becoming weak from hunger and thus less effective fighters. It ultimately led to them desperately slaughtering and eating meat from animals they had plundered from the Philistines without draining the blood first, which was a violation of the law of Moses. So forbidding eating was not a good thing for Saul to do. Why, then, did he do it? It may be that, in practical terms, he did not want the soldiers to spend time away from fighting in order to prepare and eat meals. Since going without food was also a sign of devotion to God, Saul may also have had religious reasons for giving this command. He may have wanted the soldiers to demonstrate their devotion to Yahweh in this way, perhaps to seek Yahweh's favor and help in the battle. Whatever the reasons, as Jonathan said when he heard about this, Saul's curse caused trouble for the Israelites.

1 Samuel 14:1 (#3)

וְנַעְבְּרָה֙ אֶל־מַצַּ֣ב פְּלִשְׁתִּ֔ים אֲשֶׁ֖ר מֵעֵ֣בֶר הַלָּ֑זֶה

"and let us cross over to the garrison of the Philistines that {is} across from here"

The author expects readers to understand that Jonathan is suggesting that he and his armor-bearer cross the valley from Geba to the top of the cliff where the Philistine garrison was, based on the author's statements in 13:16 that the Israelites were occupying a position in Geba and in 13:23 that the Philistines had sent a detachment of soldiers to guard the pass of Michmash. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and let us cross over from here in Geba to attack the Philistine garrison that is on top of the cliff opposite us]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:1 (#1)

וַיְהִ֗י

"And it happened"

The author is using this phrase to introduce a new event in the story. See how you translated it in 1:12.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 14:1 (#2)

הַנַּ֣עַר נֹשֵׂ֣א כֵלָ֔יו

“the young man, the carrier of his equipment”

The expression **the carrier of his equipment** refers to a soldier who, in ancient warfare, carried the weapons and armor of a superior soldier and who fought alongside that soldier. Your language may have a term that your readers would recognize for a person in a similar role. Alternate translation: [the young man who was Jonathan’s armor-bearer]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 14:2 (#1)

וְשָׁאוּל֙ יוֹשֵׁב֙ בִּקְצֵ֣ה הַגִּבְעָ֔ה

“Now Saul was staying at the edge of Gibeah”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 14:2 (#2)

תַּ֣חַת הָרִמּ֑וֹן

“under the pomegranate tree”

Sitting under this **tree** was a symbolic action that showed Saul was acting as judge and military leader. There is a similar example in 22:6 of Saul sitting under a different kind of tree for this same purpose. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [sitting regally under the pomegranate tree]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 14:2 (#3)

וְהָעָ֖ם

“And the people”

The author assumes that readers will understand that by **people** here and throughout this chapter, he means men of Israel who were able to fight as soldiers, as in the previous chapter. See how you translated the term there. Alternate translation: [And the soldiers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:3 (#1)

וַאֲחִיָּ֣ה בֶן־אֲחִיטֽוּב׀ אְחִ֣י אִיכָבֹ֗וד ׀ בֶּן־פִּינְחָ֣ס בֶּן־עֵלִ֣י כֹּהֵ֣ן ׀ יְהוָ֗ה בְּשִׁלֹ֛ו נֹשֵׂ֥א אֵפֹ֖וד

“and Ahijah, the son of Ahitub, the brother of Ichabod, the son of Phinehas, the son of Eli, the priest of Yahweh at Shiloh, wearing an ephod”

The author means that Ahijah was the son of Ahitub, that Ahitub was the brother of Ichabod, that Ichabod (and Ahitub) were sons of Phinehas, that Phinehas was the son of Eli, that Eli had been the priest of Yahweh at Shiloh, and that Ahijah was wearing an ephod. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers, using the kinship terms of your language and culture. The UST models one way to do that. (Since the author indicates in 4:19–22 that Phinehas and his wife died on the same day, the day she gave birth to Ichabod, it is clear that Ahitub was the older brother of Ichabod. Your language may mark that distinction.)

See: Kinship

1 Samuel 14:4 (#2)

שֵׁן־הַסֶּ֥לַע & וְשֵׁן־הַסֶּ֖לַע

“were} the tooth of a rock & and the tooth of a rock”

The author is using this possessive form to mean a **rock** that had the appearance of a **tooth**, similar to how some languages might say “a giant of a man” to mean “a giant man.” If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the meaning using a different form. Alternate translation: [were a rock that looked like a large tooth ... and another rock that looked like a large tooth] or [were a tall rock ... and a tall rock]

See: Possession

1 Samuel 14:4 (#1)

הַֽמַּעְבְּרֹ֔ות

“the passes”

The context suggests that Jonathan was planning to cross the valley by a single route that went down into the valley and back up the other side. The author seems to be using the plural form, in keeping with the conventions of his language and culture, because this was the way both from Geba to Michmash and from Michmash to Geba. It may be more natural in your language to use a singular form. Alternate translation: [the passageway]

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

1 Samuel 14:4 (#3)

מֵהָעֵ֣בֶר׀ מִזֶּ֗ה & מֵהָעֵ֥בֶר מִזֶּ֛ה

“on the side from that & on the side from this”

The author is describing the location of one place relative to another in the way that is characteristic of his culture. The further explanation in the next verse helps to clarify the meaning here. In your translation, express this in the way your culture describes the relative location of places. Alternate translation: [on the far side of the valley ... on the near side of the valley] or [on the other side of the valley ... on his side of the valley]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 14:5 (#1)

הַשֵּׁשֶׁן הָאֶחָד מָצְפוֹן מִמּוּל מִכְמָשׂ וְהָאֶחָד מִנֶּגֶב מִמּוּל גָּבַע

“The tooth of the one {was} a pillar from the north before Michmash, and the {other} one {was} from the south before Geba”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [The tooth of the one was a pillar from the north before Michmash, and the tooth of the other one was a pillar from the south before Geba]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 14:5 (#2)

מָצְצוּק

“was} a pillar”

The author is speaking of each of the rocks as if they were a **pillar**, that is, a tall supporting column in a buildings. He is using this image to mean that they were tall and straight. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [was a vertical face] or [was tall and straight]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 14:6 (#3)

כִּֽי

“for”

Here the word **for** introduces not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [After all,]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 14:6 (#1)

וַיֹּ֨אמֶר יְהוֹנָתָ֜ן אֶל־הַנַּ֣עַר ׀ נֹשֵׂ֣א כֵלָ֗יו לְכָ֤ה וְנַעְבְּרָה֙

“And Jonathan said to the young man, the carrier of his equipment, “Come, and let us cross over”

The author is resuming the story of Jonathan after providing extensive background information in verses 2–5. He is repeating what Jonathan said to his armor-bearer, which he first reported in verse 1. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for resuming a story after providing background information.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 14:6 (#5)

בְּרַ֥ב א֖וֹ בְּמְעָֽט

“by many or by few”

Jonathan is using the adjectives **many** and **few** as nouns to mean groups of soldiers. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [by many soldiers or by few soldiers]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 14:6 (#2)

הָֽעֲרֵלִ֔ים הָאֵ֑לֶּה

“these uncircumcised”

Jonathan is using the adjective **uncircumcised** as a noun to mean people who do not worship Yahweh. He is using this as a term of derision, suggesting that since the Philistines do not worship Yahweh and obey his laws, they will not be formidable opponents. Your language may have a comparable term of derision that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [these uncircumcised Philistines] or [these heathen]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 14:6 (#4)

אֵ֥ין לַֽיהוָ֖ה מַעְצֹ֑ור לְהֹושִׁ֥יעַ בְּרַ֖ב א֥וֹ בִמְעָֽט

“there is} no hindrance to Yahweh to save by many or by few”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the negative particle **no** and the negative word **hindrance**. Alternate translation: [Yahweh is perfectly able to save by many or by few]

See: Double Negatives

1 Samuel 14:7 (#3)

נְטֵה לְּךָ & עִמְּךָ

“Turn yourself & with you”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Turn yourself in whatever direction you wish … I am with you]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 14:7 (#5)

עִמְּךָ

“with you”

The armor-bearer is using **with you** as a common expression of his culture. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression in 3:19. Alternate translation: [I will help you]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 14:7 (#4)

נְטֵה לְּךָ

“Turn yourself”

The armor-bearer is using **turn yourself** as a common expression of his culture to mean “take whatever course of action you consider best.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Go ahead] or [Take whatever course of action you consider best]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 14:7 (#1)

בִּלְבָבֶךָ

“is} in your heart”

The armor-bearer is speaking of Jonathan’s **heart** as if it were a container for his thoughts and desires. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you want to do]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 14:7 (#2)

כִּלְבָבֶךָ

“according to your heart”

Here, the **heart** represents where a person’s thoughts and desires exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in whatever you want to do]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 14:7 (#6)

הִנֵּנִי

“behold me”

The armor-bearer is using a polite expression to express his willingness to serve. See how you translated similar expressions in 3:4 and 12:3. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [I am at your service] or [I am making myself available]

See: Politeness

1 Samuel 14:8 (#1)

הִנֵּנוּ

“Behold”

See how you translated the term **Behold** in 2:31, and consider how you would translate it in this context. Alternate translation: [All right]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 14:8 (#2)

הָאֲנָשִׁים

“the men”

The author assumes that readers will understand that by **the men** Jonathan means the Philistine soldiers in the detachment opposite them. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [those Philistine soldiers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:9 (#2)

וְעָמַדְנוּ תַּחְתֵּיהֶם

“then we will stand under us”

Jonathan is using a common expression of his culture that indicates “we will stand on the ground that is under us.” Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [then we will stay in place] or [then we will stay right here]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 14:9 (#1)

אִם־כֹּ֣ה יֹאמְר֗וּ אֵלֵ֙ינוּ֙ דֹּ֣מּוּ עַד־הַגִּיעֵ֥נוּ אֲלֵיכֶ֖ם

“If thus they say to us, ‘Wait until we reach you”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [If they tell us to wait until they reach us]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 14:10 (#1)

וְאִם־כֹּ֣ה יֹאמְר֔וּ עֲל֥וּ אֵלֵ֖ינוּ

“But if thus they say, ‘Come up to us”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [But if they tell us to come up to them]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 14:10 (#2)

וְעָלִ֣ינוּ כִּֽי־נְתָנָ֗ם יְהוָה֙ בְּיָדֵ֔נוּ וְזֶה־לָּ֥נוּ הָאֽוֹת

“then we will go up, for Yahweh has given them into our hand, and this {will be} the sign for us”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [then this will be a sign for us that Yahweh has given them into our hand, so we will go up]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 14:10 (#3)

נְתָנָ֗ם יְהוָה֙ בְּיָדֵ֔נוּ

“Yahweh has given them into our hand”

Jonathan is using the past tense to describe something that he believes would certainly happen in the future. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use the future tense. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will give them into our hand]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

1 Samuel 14:10 (#4)

בְּיָדֵ֔נוּ

“into our hand”

Jonathan is using the term **hand** to represent power or control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [into our power]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 14:11 (#1)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר הִתְחַבְּא֖וּ־שָֽׁם

“where they have hidden themselves there”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [where they have hidden themselves]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 14:12 (#4)

יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“Israel”

Jonathan is using the name **Israel** to represent Israelite soldiers, and specifically himself and his armor-bearer. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [us Israelite soldiers]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 14:12 (#1)

וַיַּעֲנ֣וּ׀ אַנְשֵׁ֣י הַמַּצָּבָ֗ה

“And the men of the garrison answered”

Here the author is using **answered** to express that the Philistine soldiers were responding to seeing Jonathan and his armor-bearer rather than to something that Jonathan had asked. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And the men of the garrison responded when they saw]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:12 (#2)

וַיֹּאמְר֔וּ

“and said”

The term **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 14:12 (#3)

וְנוֹדַ֣יעָה אֶתְכֶ֔ם דָּבָ֖ר

“and let us make you know a thing”

The Philistines are using a common expression of their culture to assert that they will prove they are better fighters than Jonathan and his armor bearer. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [and we will teach you a lesson] or [and we will prove that we are better fighters than you are]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 14:13 (#1)

וַיַּ֤עַל יוֹנָתָן֙ עַל־יָדָ֣יו וְעַל־רַגְלָ֔יו

“And Jonathan went up on his hands and on his feet”

The author assumes that readers will understand that Jonathan had to climb this way because the cliff was extremely steep. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [The cliff was so steep that Jonathan had to go up it on his hands and on his feet]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:13 (#2)

וַיַּ֤עַל יוֹנָתָן֙ עַל־יָדָ֣יו וְעַל־רַגְלָ֔יו

“And Jonathan went up on his hands and on his feet”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to describe a way of climbing. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [And Jonathan went up on all fours] or [And Jonathan climbed up using his hands as well as his feet]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 14:13 (#4)

וְיִפְּל֥וּ לִפְנֵ֖י יוֹנָתָ֑ן

“And they fell to the face of Jonathan”

The author is using the term **fell** to represent that these soldiers died in battle, as in 4:10. He is using the term **face** to represent that these soldiers were in front of Jonathan, as is discussed in the Introduction to 1 Samuel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use equivalent expressions or plain language. Alternate translation: [And they died as Jonathan attacked the soldiers who were in front of him]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 14:13 (#3)

וְיִפְּל֥וּ

“And they fell”

The pronoun **they** refers to the Philistine soldiers who were defending this position. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the Philistine soldiers fell]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 14:14 (#2)

הִכָּ֔ה

“struck”

See the discussion of the term struck in the Introduction to 1 Samuel. Alternate translation: [slaughtered]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:14 (#3)

כְּבַחֲצִ֥י מַעֲנֶ֖ה צֶ֣מֶד שָׂדֶֽה

“in} about half of a furrow {of} a yoke of a field”

The author is expressing a distance in terms of his culture. A **yoke of a field** means a field that a pair of oxen could plow in a day (about an acre or 0.4 hectares). This **furrow** would be one side of that (about 210 feet or 65 meters), so **half a furrow** would mean about 100 feet or 30 meters. Jonathan and his armor-bearer penetrated this far into the Philistine camp, killing any soldiers who tried to stop them. Alternate translation: [over a distance of about 30 meters] or [over a distance of about 100 feet]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 14:14 (#1)

וַתְּהִ֗י הַמַּכָּ֤ה הָרִאשֹׁנָה֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר הִכָּ֔ה יוֹנָתָ֖ן וְנֹשֵׂ֣א כֵלָ֑יו

“And the first striking that Jonathan and the carrier of his equipment struck was”

The author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. See how you translated the term **striking** in 4:10. Alternate translation: [And the first slaughter that Jonathan and his armor-bearer made was]

See: Poetry

1 Samuel 14:15 (#1)

בַּמַּחֲנֶה בַּשָּׂדֶה וּבְכָל־הָעָם

“in the camp in the field and among all of the people”

The author assumes that readers will understand that **the camp in the field** means the Philistine outpost that Jonathan attacked, while **all of the people** means the soldiers of the main Philistine army at Michmash. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [not only in the detachment that was guarding the pass but also among all of the soldiers in the main Philistine army at Michmash]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:15 (#3)

לְחֶרְדַּת אֱלֹהִים

“a trembling of God”

The expression **a trembling of God** could be: (1) a common expression of his culture that the author is using that described something as very great by saying it belongs to God. Alternate translation: [a very great trembling]; (2) an indication that God caused this trembling. Alternate translation: [a trembling caused by God]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 14:15 (#2)

הַמַּצָּב וְהַמַּשְׁחִית

“The garrison and the destroyer”

Since the author says that **even** these groups **trembled** in addition to the detachment and the main army, he is likely referring to other garrisons the Philistines had set up and to the raiding bands he described in 13:17. Since he is referring to multiple groups in each case, it may be more natural in your language to use plural forms. Alternate translation: [The garrisons and the destroyers] or [The soldiers in the other outposts that the Philistines had set up and in the raiding bands that they were sending out]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Samuel 14:16 (#1)

הֶהָמוֹן נָמֹגֹ

“the multitude was being melted”

The author is speaking of this **multitude**, meaning the Philistine army, as if it were a solid substance that was becoming liquid and flowing away. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Philistine army was breaking up in confusion]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 14:16 (#2)

וַיֵּלֶךְ וָהֹלֹם

“and went, even here”

The author is using **and went, even here** as a common expression of his culture to mean that the Philistine soldiers were going in many different directions. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [and was going here and there] or [and was scattering in many directions]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 14:18 (#2)

הַגִּישָׁה אֲרוֹן הָאֱלֹהִים

“Bring near the Box of God”

The author assumes that readers will understand that Saul wanted Ahijah to bring the Box so that he could use it to consult Yahweh about what to do in this situation. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Bring near the Box of God so that I can use it to consult Yahweh about what to do about this situation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:18 (#3)

בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא

“on that day”

The author is using the term **day** to represent a specific time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [during that time]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 14:18 (#1)

אֲרוֹן הָאֱלֹהִים כִּי־הָיָה אֲרוֹן הָאֱלֹהִים בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא וּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the Box of God.” For the Box of God was with the sons of Israel on that day”

The ULT follows the reading of the traditional Hebrew text. One ancient version reads instead “the ephod” and “For he wore the ephod in those days before the sons of Israel.” This suits the context, since the author mentions in 14:3 that Ahijah was present and wearing an ephod, while the narrative indicates in 7:2 that the Box stayed in Kiriath Jearim for many years. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

1 Samuel 14:19 (#1)

וַיֵּלֶךְ הָלוֹךְ וָרָב

“that going, it went and became great”

The author is repeating forms of the verb “go” to intensify his expression of the idea it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [that it went continually and became great]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 14:19 (#2)

וַיֵּלֶךְ הָלוֹךְ וָרָב

“that going, it went and became great”

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two verbal phrases connected with “and.” The phrase **going, it went** tells in what way the tumult **became great**. Alternate translation: [that it became great continually] or [that it kept increasing]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 14:19 (#3)

אֱסֹף יָדֶךָ

“Withdraw your hand”

Saul is using the term **hand** to represent the activity that Ahijah was performing with his hands. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Cease your activity]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 14:20 (#1)

וַיִּזָּעֵק שָׁאוּל וְכָל־הָעָם אֲשֶׁר אִתּוֹ

“And Saul and all of the people who {were} with him were called together”

The expression **were called** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And Saul called together all of the soldiers who were with him]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 14:20 (#2)

הָיְתָה חֶרֶב אִישׁ בְּרֵעֵהוּ

“the sword of a man was against his fellow”

The author is speaking of a **sword** as if it were a living thing that could act on its own. He means that the Philistine soldiers were using their swords to attack one another. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Philistine soldiers were attacking one another with their swords]

See: Personification

1 Samuel 14:20 (#3)

מְהוּמָה גְּדוֹלָה מְאֹד

“a very great tumult”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [so that there was a very great tumult]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 14:21 (#1)

הָיִו לַפְּלִשְׁתִּים כְּאֶתְמוֹל שִׁלְשׁוֹם

“were to the Philistines according to yesterday and the third day”

See how you translated the expression **yesterday and the third day** in 4:7. Alternate translation: [had previously deserted to the Philistines]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 14:21 (#2)

יִשְׂרָאֵל אֲשֶׁר עִם

“Israel who {was} with”

The author is using the name **Israel** to represent Israelite soldiers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the Israelite soldiers who were with]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 14:22 (#1)

וַיַּדְבְּקוּ גַם־הֵמָּה אַחֲרֵיהֶם

“and they pursued after them, they too”

The author is repeating the pronoun **they** for emphasis. Your language might more naturally express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [and even they pursued after them]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 14:22 (#2)

וַיַּדְבְּקוּ גַם־הֵמָּה אַחֲרֵיהֶם

“and they pursued after them, they too”

The pronoun **they** refers to the Israelites who had been hiding, and the pronoun **them** refers to the fleeing Philistine soldiers. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and even these Israelites who had been hiding joined in pursuing the Philistines]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 14:23 (#1)

וְהַמִּלְחָמָה עָבְרָה אֶת־בֵּית אָוֶן

“And the battle passed over Beth Aven”

The author is speaking of **the battle** as if it were a living thing that could pass over a city on its own. He means that the Israelites pursued and fought the Philistines all the way to the city of Beth Aven and beyond it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the Israelites continued pursuing and fighting the Philistines as far as Beth Aven and beyond]

See: Personification

1 Samuel 14:24 (#5)

לֶחֶם

“bread”

Saul is using one kind of food, **bread**, to represent food in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [anything]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 14:24 (#2)

וְאִישׁ־יִשְׂרָאֵל נִגַּשׂ & אָרוּר הָאִישׁ

“But the men of Israel were distressed & Cursed {is} the man”

The expressions **were distressed** and **Cursed is** are in the passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express these ideas in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [But Saul had distressed the men of Israel ... May Yahweh curse the man]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 14:24 (#3)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

See whether you chose to represent the term **saying** in 4:21, and if so, how you translated it.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 14:24 (#4)

אָרוּר הָאִישׁ

“Cursed {is} the man”

Saul is speaking about the people he is addressing in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the second person. Alternate translation: [Cursed is any one of you]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 14:24 (#6)

עַד־הָעֶרֶב וְנִקַּמְתִּי מֵאֹיְבָי

“until the evening and I have taken vengeance on my enemies”

The word that the ULT translates as **and** indicates that **the evening** would be the time by when Saul would **have taken vengeance** on his **enemies**. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could describe the time relationship more explicitly. Alternate translation: [until the evening, when I will have taken vengeance on my enemies]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

1 Samuel 14:24 (#1)

וְאִישׁ־יִשְׂרָאֵל נִגַּשׂ בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא וַיֹּאֶל֣שָׁאוּל אֶת־הָעָ֑ם

“But the men of Israel were distressed on that day, for Saul had adjured the people”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [But because Saul had made the people swear, the men of Israel were distressed on that day]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 14:25 (#1)

וְכָל־הָאָ֖רֶץ

“And the whole land”

The author is using the term **land** to represent the people who lived in it. He means specifically the Israelite men who were serving as soldiers. Many of them were coming from other parts of the land, as 14:22 describes. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And all the Israelite soldiers]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 14:25 (#2)

פְּנֵ֥י הַשָּׂדֶֽה

“the face of the ground”

The author is using the term **face** to mean the surface of the **ground**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the surface of the ground]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 14:26 (#1)

וְאֵין־מַשִּׁ֥יג יָד֛וֹ אֶל־פִּ֖יו

“But no one was reaching his hand to his mouth”

The author is using the action of bringing food to the mouth to represent eating. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [But no one ate any of it]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 14:27 (#1)

הַמַּטֶּה

“the staff”

By **staff**, the author may be referring to a spear that Jonathan was carrying, as he describes in 13:22. The term he uses can have that meaning, and the focus here may be on the wooden shaft of the spear, which Jonathan would have used to reach for this honey, rather than on the metal point. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers as modeled in the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:27 (#4)

ותראנה עֵינָיו

“and his eyes brightened”

The author is using the brightening of Jonathan’s eyes to represent that eating the honey restored his strength. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and this restored some of his strength]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 14:27 (#2)

וַיִּטְבֹּ֤ל אוֹתָהּ֙ בְּיַעְרַ֣ת הַדְּבָ֔שׁ

“and he dipped it into a comb of honey”

The author seems to mean that Jonathan reached up into a tree to get honey from a honeycomb, since Jonathan could simply have picked up honey off the ground with his hands. Alternate translation: [and he reached up into a tree and used it to scoop some honey out of one of the honeycombs]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:27 (#3)

וַיָּ֥שֶׁב יָד֖וֹ אֶל־פִּֽיו

“And he returned his hand to his mouth”

The author seems to mean that Jonathan used his **hand** to bring the end of his staff back to his mouth so that he could eat the honey it had collected, as Jonathan himself says in 14:43. To eat the honey, Jonathan would have held the staff with his hand near the honey-covered end of it, so in that sense he was returning his hand to his mouth. Alternate translation: [And he pulled the staff back and ate some honey off the end of it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:28 (#2)

וַיֹּ֥אמֶר

“and said”

The term **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 14:28 (#4)

לֶ֖חֶם

“bread”

The man is using the term **bread** to represent food in general, as Saul did in his oath. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [anything]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 14:28 (#3)

הַשְׁבֵּעַ֨ הִשְׁבִּ֤יעַ אָבִ֙יךָ֙

“Adjuring, your father adjured”

The man is repeating forms of the verb “adjure” to intensify his communication of the fact that Saul had made the people agree with his oath. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [Your father certainly adjured]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 14:28 (#1)

וַיַּ֥עַן אִ֛ישׁ מֵהָעָ֖ם

“And a man from the people answered”

Here the author is using **answered** to express that the man was responding to seeing Jonathan eat the honey rather than to something that Jonathan had asked. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And a man from the people responded]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:29 (#1)

אֶת־הָאָ֑רֶץ

“the land”

See how you translated this same expression in 14:25. Alternate translation: [us Israelite soldiers]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 14:29 (#3)

אֹ֣רוּ עֵינַ֔י כִּֽי־טָעֲמְתִ֥י מְעַ֖ט דְּבַ֣שׁ הַזֶּ֑ה

“my eyes have brightened because I have tasted a little of this honey”

Jonathan assumes that this soldier will understand that he means that the brightening of his eyes shows that eating the honey has restored some of his strength. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [my eyes have brightened, showing that eating the honey has restored some of my strength]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:29 (#2)

אֹ֣רוּ עֵינַ֔י כִּֽי־טָעֲמְתִ֥י מְעַ֖ט דְּבַ֣שׁ הַזֶּ֑ה

“my eyes have brightened because I have tasted a little of this honey”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [because I have tasted a little of this honey, my eyes have brightened]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 14:30 (#3)

כִּֽי

“For”

Jonathan is using the word translated **For** to indicate a contrast between what could have happened and what actually happened. Alternate translation: [But instead] or [By contrast]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

1 Samuel 14:30 (#4)

מַכָּ֥ה בַפְּלִשְׁתִּ֖ים

“the striking against the Philistines”

See how you translated the term **striking** in 4:10. Alternate translation: [the slaughter among the Philistines]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:30 (#1)

אַ֠ף כִּֽי לוּאא֨ אָכֹ֜ל אָכַ֤ל הַיּוֹם֙ הָעָ֔ם מִשְּׁלַ֖ל

“How much more that if eating, the people had eaten today from the plunder of”

Jonathan is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [How much more would all of us have remained strong if eating, the people had eaten today from the plunder of]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 14:30 (#2)

אָכֹ֜ל אָכַ֤ל & הָעָ֔ם

“eating, the people had eaten”

Jonathan is repeating forms of the verb “eat” to intensify the expression of his wish that the people had eaten. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [the people had surely eaten]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 14:31 (#1)

וַיַּכּ֥וּ בַיּ֛וֹם הַה֖וּאא

“And on that day they struck”

See the discussion of the term **struck** in the Introduction to 1 Samuel. Alternate translation: [And on that day they attacked]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:32 (#1)

ויעש הָעָ֣ם אֶל־הַשָּׁלָ֑ל

“QUOTE_NOT_FOUND: ויעש הָעָ֣ם אֶל־הַשָּׁלָ֑ל”

The author is speaking of the people as if they had **swooped down** like birds of prey diving for food. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the people rushed desperately to take some of the plunder]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 14:32 (#3)

אֶ֣רְצָה

“on the ground”

The author assumes that readers will understand that by slaughtering animals **on the ground**, the people were not hanging them up to let the blood drain out, as the law of Moses required. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [on the ground, rather than hanging them up so that the blood would drain out]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:32 (#4)

עַל־הַדָּ֖ם

“with the blood”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [the meat with the blood still in it]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 14:32 (#2)

וּבְנֵ֥י בָקָ֛ר

“and sons of the herd”

The author is using **sons of the herd** as a common expression of his culture to mean young cattle. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation as modeled in the UST.

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 14:33 (#1)

וַיַּגִּ֥ידוּ לְשָׁא֖וּל

“Then they declared to Saul”

Here the author is using the pronoun **they** in a general sense, not to refer to specific people. Alternate translation: [Then someone declared to Saul] or [Then Saul was told]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 14:33 (#3)

בָּגַדְתֶּ֔ם

“You have acted unfaithfully”

Saul means that the people have not been faithful to their covenant with Yahweh, which forbade eating meat with blood still in it. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [You have not been

faithful to our covenant with Yahweh, which forbids us to eat meat with blood still in it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:33 (#2)

לֶאֱכֹל֙ עַל־הַדָּ֔ם

“by eating with the blood”

The Israelite soldiers are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [by eating meat with the blood still in it]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 14:34 (#2)

הַגְּגִ֤ישׁוּ אֵלַי֙ אִ֣ישׁ שׁוֹר֔וֹ וְאִ֥ישׁ שֵׂיֵ֖הוּ

“Bring to me, a man his ox and a man his sheep”

Saul is using a common expression of his culture that means each person should bring his own animal. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Let each person bring to me the ox or sheep that he wants to eat]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 14:34 (#1)

פֻּצ֣וּ בָעָ֗ם וַאֲמַרְתֶּ֤ם לָהֶם֙ הַגְּגִ֤ישׁוּ אֵלַי֙ אִ֣ישׁ שׁוֹר֔וֹ וְאִ֥ישׁ שֵׂיֵ֖הוּ וּשְׁחַטְתֶּ֣ם בָּזֶ֔ה וַאֲכַלְתֶּ֖ם וְלֹא־תֶחֱטְא֣וּ לַיהוָ֔ה לֶאֱכֹ֖ל אֶל־הַדָּֽם

“Disperse among the people and say to them, ‘Bring to me, a man his ox and a man his sheep, and slaughter {them} here and eat. But you shall not sin against Yahweh by eating with the blood”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Disperse among the people and tell them that each person must bring his ox or sheep to me and slaughter it here and eat it, but they must not sin against Yahweh by eating meat with blood still in it]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 14:34 (#4)

שׁוֹר֔וֹ

“his ox”

The author is using one kind of animal to mean any animal that the soldiers had seized as plunder to mean all kinds of these animals. The author states in 14:32 that the people also seized sheep and calves. If it would be helpful in your language, you could indicate that he means all of these animals. Alternate translation: [his ox or cow or calf]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 14:34 (#3)

אֶל־הַדָּ֔ם

“with the blood”

Saul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [meat with the blood still in it]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 14:34 (#5)

שָׁ֑ם

“there”

The author assumes that readers will understand that by **there**, he means on the great stone that Saul had ordered to be brought, where blood from slaughtered animals would drain out properly. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [on the great stone, so that the blood would drain out]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:35 (#1)

וַיִּבֶן שָׁא֥וּל מִזְבֵּ֖חַ לַיהוָ֑ה

“And Saul built an altar to Yahweh”

This was a symbolic action by which Saul was thanking and honoring Yahweh for enabling the Israelites to win this victory over the Philistines. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [And Saul built an altar to Yahweh to thank and honor him for enabling the Israelites to win this victory over the Philistines]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 14:35 (#2)

אֹתָ֥ו הֵחֵ֖ל לִבְנֹ֥ות מִזְבֵּ֖חַ לַיהוָֽה

“He began to build it, an altar to Yahweh”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean this was the first time Saul had done this. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [This was the first altar he built to Yahweh]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 14:36 (#1)

נֵרְדָה

“Let us go down”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:3, where travel was also marked for change in elevation. Alternate translation: [Let us go]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 14:36 (#2)

כָּל־הַטּוֹב בְּעֵינֶיךָ עֲשֵׂה

“Do all of the good in your eyes”

See how you translated this similar expression in 1:18. Alternate translation: [Do what you think is best]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 14:36 (#3)

נִקְרְבָה & אֶל־הָאֱלֹהִים

“Let us draw near to God”

The priest is speaking of consulting God as if it were physically approaching him. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Let us consult God]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 14:36 (#4)

הֵלֹם

“here”

The priest means that they should consult God before taking any further action. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [before we do anything else] or [before we decide to pursue the Philistines]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:37 (#1)

וְלֹא עָנָהוּ

“But he did not answer him”

The pronoun **he** refers to Yahweh, and the pronoun **him** refers to Saul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [But Yahweh did not answer Saul]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 14:37 (#2)

בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא

“on that day”

The author is using the term **day** to represent this specific time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [at that time]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 14:38 (#1)

כֹּל פִּנּוֹת הָעָם

“all of the cornerstones of the people”

Saul is speaking of the leaders of the people as if the people of Israel were a building and they were its **cornerstones**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all the leaders of the people]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 14:38 (#2)

כֹּל פִּנּוֹת הָעָם

“all of the cornerstones of the people”

Saul is speaking about the people he is addressing in the third person. If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this in the second person. Alternate translation: [all you leaders of the people]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 14:38 (#3)

וּדְעוּ וּרְאוּ

“And know and see”

The terms **know** and **see** mean similar things. Saul is using them together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [And make sure to find out]

See: Doublet

1 Samuel 14:39 (#1)

כִּֽי

“For”

Saul is using the word **For** not to introduce a reason but to introduce further information about his intentions. Alternate translation: [I can assure you that]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 14:39 (#2)

חַי־יְהוָ֗ה הַמוֹשִׁ֥יעַ אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵ֛ל

“the life of Yahweh, the one having saved Israel”

Following the conventions of his culture, Saul is swearing an oath by guaranteeing it by something he holds sacred. Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. Alternate translation: [I swear by Yahweh, the one having saved Israel]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Samuel 14:39 (#3)

מָ֣וֹת יָמֻ֔ת

“dying, he shall die”

Saul is repeating forms of the verb **die** to intensify his expression of how certainly he will execute the guilty person. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [he shall surely die]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 14:40 (#1)

אַתֶּ֣ם תִּהְיוּ֮ לְעֵ֣בֶר אֶחָ֒ד וַאֲנִ֣י וְיוֹנָתָ֗ן בְּנִ֛י נִהְיֶ֥ה לְעֵ֖בֶר אֶחָֽד

“You will be to one side, and I and Jonathan my son will be to one side”

Saul means that they will cast lots to determine who has sinned. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [We will cast lots to determine who has sinned. You will stand on one side, and Jonathan and I will stand on the other side]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:40 (#2)

הַטּ֥וֹב בְּעֵינֶ֖יךָ עֲשֵׂ֑ה

“Do the good in your eyes”

See how you translated this similar expression in 1:18. Alternate translation: [Do what seems right to you]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 14:41 (#1)

הָ֣בָה תָמִ֔ים

“Give a perfect {one”

This is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. Alternate translation: [Please give a perfect one]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

1 Samuel 14:41 (#2)

הָ֣בָה תָמִ֔ים

“Give a perfect {one”

Saul is using the adjective **perfect** as a noun to describe a particular type of object, a thrown lot of perfect accuracy. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [Please make this lot accurately indicate the guilty person]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 14:41 (#3)

וַיִּלָּכֵ֥ד יוֹנָתָ֖ן וְשָׁא֑וּל

“And Jonathan and Saul were taken”

The expression **were taken** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the lot pointed to Jonathan and Saul]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 14:41 (#4)

וְהָעָ֖ם יָצָֽאוּ

“but the people went out”

The author is using **the people went out** as a common expression of his culture to mean that the lot did not indicate the people. Alternate translation: [but the lot did not indicate any of the other soldiers]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 14:42 (#2)

וַיִּלָּכֵ֥ד יוֹנָתָֽן

“And Jonathan was taken”

The expression **was taken** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the lot pointed to Jonathan]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 14:42 (#1)

הַפִּ֤ילוּ בֵינִי֙ וּבֵ֣ין יוֹנָתָ֔ן בְּנִ֖י

“Cause it to fall between me and between Jonathan my son”

Saul is using a common expression of his culture, **Cause it to fall**, that means to use a lot to make a choice. Alternate translation: [Use the lot to choose between me and Jonathan my son]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 14:43 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר֙

“and said”

The term **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 14:43 (#2)

טָעֹ֥ם טָעַ֖מְתִּי

“Tasting, I tasted”

Jonathan is repeating forms of the verb “taste” to emphasize that he only ate **a little honey**. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [I only tasted]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 14:43 (#3)

הִנְנִ֥י

“Behold me”

See how you translated this expression in 12:3. Alternate translation: [I surrender myself]

See: Politeness

1 Samuel 14:44 (#1)

כֹּֽה־יַעֲשֶׂ֤ה אֱלֹהִים֙ וְכֹ֣כָה יוֹסִ֔ף

“May God do thus, and may he add thus”

Following a common practice of his culture, Saul is swearing an oath by stating only one part of a condition. In this case, he is stating the second part (“then”) but not the first part (“if”). If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explicitly state the first part of this condition. Alternate translation: [If I do not execute you, may God kill me, and may God do even worse than that to me]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Samuel 14:44 (#2)

מָ֥וֹת תָּמ֖וּת

“dying, you shall die”

Saul is repeating forms of the verb **die** to emphasize his commitment to this assertion. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [you shall certainly die]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 14:45 (#1)

הֲיוֹנָתָ֣ן ׀ יָמ֗וּת אֲשֶׁ֤ר עָשָׂה֙ הַיְשׁוּעָ֣ה הַגְּדוֹלָ֔ה הַזֹּ֖את בְּיִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“Shall Jonathan die, who has done this great salvation in Israel”

The people are using the question form for emphasis to express their strong opposition to executing Jonathan. If speakers of your language would not use a question for this purpose, you could translate this as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Jonathan, who has brought this great victory to Israel, shall not die!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 14:45 (#2)

הֲיוֹנָתָ֣ן ׀ יָמ֗וּת אֲשֶׁ֤ר עָשָׂה֙ הַיְשׁוּעָ֣ה הַגְּדוֹלָ֔ה הַזֹּ֖את בְּיִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“Shall Jonathan die, who has done this great salvation in Israel”

The people are not distinguishing this man named **Jonathan** from another man by the same name who has not **done this great salvation**. They are reminding Saul what this man has done. Be sure that this is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [Jonathan has done this great salvation in Israel. Shall he die?] or

[Jonathan has done this great salvation in Israel. He shall not die!]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

1 Samuel 14:45 (#5)

אִם־יִפֹּ֗ל מִשַּׂעֲרַ֥ת רֹאשׁ֛וֹ אַ֖רְצָה

“if from the hair of his head should fall to the ground”

The people are using one small part of Jonathan, implicitly a single strand from his **hair**, to emphasize that they will not allow any harm to come to him at all. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [no one shall harm him in the slightest way]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 14:45 (#4)

חַי־יְהוָה

“The life of Yahweh”

See how you translated this same expression in 14:39. Alternate translation: [I swear by Yahweh]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Samuel 14:45 (#7)

וַיִּפְדְּ֣וּ הָעָ֔ם אֶת־יוֹנָתָ֖ן

“So the people redeemed Jonathan”

The author is speaking as if the other soldiers had **redeemed** Jonathan by paying a price to buy him out of slavery or captivity. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [So the people rescued Jonathan]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 14:45 (#3)

חָלִ֑ילָה

“Profane”

The people are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need to be complete. See how you translated the similar expressions in 2:30 and 12:23. Alternate translation: [That would be profane to us] or [Far be it from us to let that happen]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 14:45 (#6)

עִם־אֱלֹהִ֥ים עָשָׂ֖ה

“he has done with God”

The people are using a common expression of their culture, **done with God**, that means God helped Jonathan accomplish something. Alternate translation: [God has helped him as he acted]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 14:46 (#3)

וַיַּ֥עַל שָׁא֖וּל מֵאַחֲרֵ֣י פְּלִשְׁתִּ֑ים

“Then Saul went up from after the Philistines”

The author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. In your translation, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [Then Saul stopped pursuing the Philistines and returned home to Gibeah]

See: Order of Events

1 Samuel 14:46 (#1)

וַיַּ֥עַל שָׁא֖וּל מֵאַחֲרֵ֣י פְּלִשְׁתִּ֑ים וּפְלִשְׁתִּ֖ים הָלְכ֥וּ לִמְקוֹמָֽם

“Then Saul went up from after the Philistines. And the Philistines went to their place”

Here the author is concluding the story of this battle with the Philistines. Your language may have its own way of ending an episode of a story.

See: End of Story

1 Samuel 14:46 (#2)

וַיַּ֥עַל שָׁא֖וּל מֵאַחֲרֵ֣י פְּלִשְׁתִּ֑ים

“Then Saul went up from after the Philistines”

The author assumes that readers will understand that Saul returned to his home city of Gibeah. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Then Saul went up to Gibeah from after the Philistines] or [Then Saul stopped pursuing the Philistines and returned home to Gibeah]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:47 (#2)

וּבִבְנֵי־עַמּ֖וֹן

“and with the sons of Ammon”

See how you translated this expression in 2:28. Alternate translation: [and with the Ammonites]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 14:47 (#3)

יַרְשִׁיעַ

“he inflicted punishment”

The author assumes that readers will understand that Saul was retaliating against these nations for attacking and oppressing the Israelites. (In the process, by fighting against them and defeating them, he was limiting their capacity to attack Israel again.) You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [he inflicted punishment on them for having attacked and oppressed the Israelites] or [he fought against and defeated them for having attacked and oppressed the Israelites, and he thereby limited them from doing that again]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 14:47 (#1)

וְשָׁאוּל לָכַד הַמְלוּכָה עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Now Saul had taken the kingship over Israel”

Starting in this verse and continuing through to the end of the chapter, the author is providing background information, apart from the main story line, about Saul’s lineage, family, and activities as king. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your language.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 14:48 (#3)

מִיַּד

“from the hand of”

The author is using the term **hand** to represent power and control. Alternate translation: [from the control of]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 14:48 (#2)

אֶת־עֲמָלֵק

“Amalek”

The author is using the term **Amalek** to represent the Amalekite people, using the name of their ancestor. Alternate translation: [the Amalekites]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 14:48 (#1)

וַיַּעַשׂ חָיִל

“And he did valor”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **valor**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And he acted valiantly]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 14:49 (#1)

וְשֵׁמוֹת שְׁתֵּתָי בְנֹתָיו שֵׁשֵׁם הַבְּכִירָה מֵרַב וְשֵׁשֵׁם הַקְּטַנָּה מִיכָל

“And the names of the two of his daughters {were}: the name of the firstborn, Merab, and the name of the younger, Michal”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [And he had two daughters, the firstborn named Merab and the younger named Michal]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 14:49 (#2)

הַבְּכִירָה & הַקְּטַנָּה

“the firstborn & the younger”

Express these kinship relationships in terms that would be natural in your culture. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Kinship

1 Samuel 14:50 (#1)

אֲחִימָעַץ

“Ahimaaz”

The word **Ahimaaz** is the name of a man, the father of Saul’s wife Ahinoam.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 14:50 (#2)

בֶּן־נֵר דֹּד שָׁאוּל

“the son of Ner, the uncle of Saul”

The author means that **Abner** was the son of **Ner** and that **Ner** was the uncle of **Saul**. Express these kinship relationships in your culture’s own terms for them. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Kinship

1 Samuel 14:51 (#1)

בֶּן־אֲבִיאֵל

“were} the son of Abiel”

Since the author is referring to two men, Kish and Ner, it may be more natural in your language to use the plural form. Alternate translation: [were the sons of Abiel]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Samuel 14:51 (#2)

אֲבִיאֵֽל

“Abiel”

The word **Abiel** is the name of a man, the father of both Kish and Ner.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 14:52 (#2)

כֹּ֖ל יְמֵ֣י שָׁא֑וּל

“all of the days of Saul”

The author is using the phrase **all the days** to represent the entire time when Saul was king. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [throughout Saul’s reign]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 14:52 (#3)

וְכָל־בֶּן־חַ֥יִל

“or any son of valor”

In certain contexts, the biblical text uses the expression **son of** to indicate that a person shares the qualities of something. In this case, the author is referring to a person who was characterized by **valor**. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [or any valiant man]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 14:52 (#1)

וַתְּהִ֥י הַמִּלְחָמָ֛ה חָזָקָ֖ה עַל

“And the battle was strong against”

The author is speaking of **the battle** as if it were a living thing that could be **strong**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And there was intense warfare with]

See: Personification

1 Samuel - Chapter 15 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter concludes the section of the book that describes how Saul became king (8–15). It relates how Saul disobeyed a direct command from Yahweh for a second time and so forfeited the kingship itself.

Some translations set each line of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with the poetry in 15:22–23 and 15:33.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did Samuel become angry when Yahweh said he was sorry he had made Saul king?

While the author does not say specifically why Samuel became angry when Yahweh said he was sorry he had made Saul king (15:11), this seems to have been because Samuel had anointed Saul and still believed that he could be a good king. However, this was before Samuel went to Gilgal and discovered how badly Saul had disobeyed Yahweh. The author is not suggesting that there was anything sinful about Samuel feeling this emotion. It reflected Samuel’s accurate understanding of what a good king Saul could have been if he had obeyed Yahweh (as he suggested in 12:20–25).

When Saul repented of his sin, why did Samuel at first refuse to go with him to worship?

In 15:14–23, Samuel chastises Saul for disobeying Yahweh and plundering the best of the Amalekites’ animals rather than destroying all of them. At first Saul makes excuses, but in 15:24–25 he finally admits that he has sinned and asks for forgiveness. Even so, Samuel at first refuses to go back with him to where the other Israelite soldiers are and worship Yahweh. In general, the Bible promises that if people admit that they have sinned and ask forgiveness, God will forgive their sin and restore them to a condition in which they can freely worship him again. However, in this context, it appears that Saul wanted Samuel to preside at the sacrifice of the animals the soldiers had kept from the Amalekite plunder. If Samuel had done that, for one thing, he would have been implicitly approving the act of keeping those animals. Beyond that, since Yahweh had rejected Saul as king, Samuel apparently did not want to endorse his kingship any longer. So he refused to return with Saul. However, after Saul pleaded with him, “please honor me before the elders of my people and before Israel,” Samuel agreed. It appears that Samuel recognized that the Israelite people still needed to honor and respect the king they had until Yahweh appointed another one. So he did return with Saul. However, while 15:31 says that

then “Saul worshiped Yahweh,” it does not say that Samuel offered any sacrifices using the animals that the Israelite soldiers had disobediently plundered.

“devote”
In this chapter, Yahweh (in 15:3) and the author (in 15:8) use a term that the ULT translates as “devote” and “devoted.” This was a specialized term that described the cultural practice of giving something over to Yahweh so that humans would no longer be able to use it. Depending on the context, this term could indicate either “destroy” or “preserve but set apart.” The context must determine the meaning, and in the context of this chapter, the term describes total destruction.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

“to the mouth of the sword”
Biblical authors often use the expression “to the mouth of the sword” in connection with the term “devoted.” That was a common expression of this culture that referred to destroying something completely. When it appears, it helps clarify what the term “devoted” means in a specific context.

“the Glory of Israel”
In 15:29, Samuel refers to Yahweh as the “Glory of Israel.” Interpreters are not entirely sure what this phrase means. The term that the ULT translates as “Glory” refers to a bright object in the distance that provides an orientation point towards which someone travels constantly. The focus could therefore be either on the brightness or on the constancy. Some versions translate this as the “Glory of Israel” or the “Splendor of Israel,” while other versions translate it with phrases such as “the Enduring One of Israel.” In context, this could be a reference either to Yahweh as glorious and divine, and therefore someone whom Saul should not have disobeyed, or to Yahweh as constant and unchanging, which is a theme in the rest of the verse. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to follow the interpretation that it does. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to follow the interpretation of the ULT.

1 Samuel 15:1 (#1)

וְעַתָּה

“And now”

See how you translated this expression in 6:7. Alternate translation: [So now]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 15:1 (#3)

דִּבְרֵי יְהוָה

“the words of Yahweh”

Samuel is using the term **words** to represent the message that Yahweh wants him to communicate to Saul by using words. Alternate translation: [this message from Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 15:1 (#2)

שְׁמַע לְקוֹל

“listen to the voice of”

See how you translated the expression **listen to the voice** in 2:25. Alternate translation: [obey]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 15:2 (#1)

כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת פָּקַדְתִּי

“Thus says Yahweh of Armies, ‘I observed”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh of Armies says that he observed]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 15:2 (#2)

שָׂשָׂם לוֹ בַּדָּרֶךְ

“he set against him in the way”

The author is using a common expression of his culture. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [waylaid him] or [blocked his way]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 15:3 (#3)

אֶת־עֲמָלֵק & לוֹ & עָלָיו

“Amalek & is} to him & on him”

The author is speaking of the Amalekite people group as if it were a single person, their ancestor Amalek. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Amalekites ... is to them ... on them]

See: Personification

1 Samuel 15:3 (#7)

מִשּׁוֹר וְעַד־שֶׂה מִגָּמָל וְעַד־חֲמוֹר

“from ox and to sheep, from camel and to donkey”

The author is speaking of two basic types of animals in order to mean all the animals that the Amalekites owned. Alternate translation: [and kill all of their herd animals and beasts of burden] or [and kill all of the animals they own]

See: Merism

1 Samuel 15:3 (#1)

עַתָּה֙ לֵ֣ךְ & וְלֹ֥א תַחְמֹ֖ל & וְהַמַּתָּ֑ה

“Now go & and do not have compassion & but kill”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [He wants you to go ... and not to have compassion ... but to kill]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 15:3 (#4)

וְהַחֲרַמְתֶּ֣ם

“and devote”

See the discussion of the term **devote** in the Introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [and get rid of them and everything they own]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 15:3 (#5)

וְלֹ֥א תַחְמֹ֖ל עָלָ֑יו

“and do not have compassion on him”

Yahweh is using the expression **have compassion** to represent “spare,” as someone would do who actually had compassion. Alternate translation: [and do not spare him]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 15:3 (#6)

מֵאִ֥ישׁ עַד־אִשָּׁ֖ה מֵעֹלֵ֣ל וְעַד־יוֹנֵ֑ק

“from man to woman, from child and to infant”

Yahweh is speaking of two basic types of people and of one extreme of age in order to mean all people. Alternate translation: [all of the people, regardless of their age or sex]

See: Merism

1 Samuel 15:3 (#2)

וְהִכִּיתָ֣ה

“and strike”

See how you translated the similar term “striking” in 4:10. Alternate translation: [and slaughter]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 15:4 (#4)

וַֽעֲשֶׂ֣רֶת אֲלָפִ֔ים אֶת־אִ֖ישׁ יְהוּדָֽה

“and 10,000 men of Judah”

See the discussion in the Introduction to chapter 11 of why the author gives a separate total of the soldiers who came from the tribe of **Judah**.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 15:4 (#1)

וַיְשַׁמַּ֥ע שָׁא֖וּל אֶת־הָעָ֑ם

“And Saul made the people hear”

The author is using the term **hear** to represent that Saul summoned and gathered the people. Alternate translation: [And Saul gathered the people]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 15:4 (#2)

בַּטָּלְאִֽים

“at Telaim”

The word **Telaim** could be: (1) the name of a city within the territory of Judah that is called by the similar name Telem in Joshua 15:24. (2) a description of an open area where shepherds collected their lambs from the surrounding pastures at the end of the grazing season. (The word “telaim” means “lambs” in Hebrew.) Alternate translation: [in a large open area]

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 15:4 (#3)

אֶת־הָעָ֔ם

“the people”

See how you translated the term “people” in 13:2 and in its frequent occurrences in chapter 13 and chapter 14. The author assumes that readers will understand that in this, the term means the fighting men of Israel. It has this same meaning throughout this chapter, except in verses 8 and 30. Alternate translation: [the fighting men of Israel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 15:5 (#1)

שָׁאוּל & וַיֶּאֱרֹב

“Saul & and he lay in ambush”

The author is using **Saul** to represent him and his entire army. Alternate translation: [Saul and the Israelite army ... they lay in ambush]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 15:5 (#2)

עִיר עֲמָלֵק

“the city of Amalek”

Since the author describes in 15:8 how the Israelites captured the king of Amalek, he seems to mean here that this was the royal city or capital city of the Amalekites. Alternate translation: [the royal city of the Amalekites]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 15:6 (#6)

וַאֲתָּה עָשִׂיתָ חֶסֶד עִם־כָּל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“For you, you did kindness with all of the sons of Israel”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **kindness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [For you yourself treated all of the sons of Israel kindly]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 15:6 (#1)

לְכוּ סֻרוּ רְדוּ מִתּוֹךְ עֲמָלֵקִי פֶּן־אַסְפְּךָ עִמּוֹ וְאַתָּה עָשִׂיתָ חֶסֶד עִם־כָּל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בַּעֲלוֹתָם מִמִּצְרָיִם

“Go, depart, go down from the midst of the Amalekite, lest I remove you with him. For you, you did kindness with all of the sons of Israel in their coming up from Egypt”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since you yourself did kindness with all of the sons of Israel in their coming up from Egypt, go, depart, go down from the midst of the Amalekite, lest I remove you with him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 15:6 (#3)

אַסְפְּךָ עִמּוֹ וְאַתָּה עָשִׂיתָ חֶסֶד

“I remove you with him. For you, you did kindness”

Since the author is describing Saul addressing a generic **Kenite**, the pronouns **you** and **yourself** are singular. However, since Saul is actually addressing a group of people, the implied “you” in the imperatives **Go**, **depart**, and **go down** is plural. If you decide to translate the singular names of people groups in this verse as plurals, it may be natural in your language to use plural second-person pronouns here, if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Samuel 15:6 (#8)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated this phrase in 2:28. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 15:6 (#2)

אֶל־הַקֵּינִי & עֲמָלֵקִי & עִמּוֹ & וַיֶּסַר קֵינִי

“to the Kenite & the Amalekite & with him & And the Kenite departed”

The author is not referring to a specific **Kenite** or **Amalekite**. He means the members of these people groups in general. It may be more natural in your language to use plural forms. Alternate translation: [to the Kenites ... the Amalekites ... with them ... And the Kenites]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 15:6 (#4)

לְכוּ סֻרוּ רְדוּ מִתּוֹךְ

“Go, depart, go down from the midst of”

These three expressions mean similar things. (A doublet can consist of more than two terms.) Saul is using these expressions together to convey emphasis and urgency. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the meaning with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [Be sure that you immediately get entirely away from]

See: Doublet

1 Samuel 15:6 (#7)

וְאַתָּ֣ה עָשִׂ֔יתָה חֶ֖סֶד

“For you, you did kindness”

Saul is stating the pronoun **you** separately, even though the verb translated as **you did** already includes this meaning. He is doing that in order to contrast the actions of the Kenites, who were kind to the Israelites, with the actions of the Amalekites, who attacked them. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [After all, for your part, you did kindness]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 15:6 (#5)

רְד֣וּ

“go down”

See how you translated the expression **go down** in 10:8. Alternate translation: [go]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 15:7 (#3)

פְּנֵ֥י מִצְרָֽיִם

“the face of Egypt”

The term **face** has a similar sense here as in 14:25. Alternate translation: [the border of Egypt]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 15:7 (#1)

בּוֹאֲךָ֖

“to} your coming”

Since the author is addressing an individual reader, the pronoun **your** is singular. So use the singular form in your translation if your language marks that distinction. Some languages may find it more natural to use a different pronoun. Alternate translation: [to where one comes]

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Samuel 15:7 (#2)

וַיַּ֥ךְ שָׁא֖וּל

“And Saul struck”

See the discussion of the term **struck** in the Introduction to 1 Samuel. Alternate translation, as in the UST: [And Saul slaughtered]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 15:8 (#2)

וַיִּתְפֹּ֣שׂ & וְאֶת & הֶחֱרִֽים

“Now he seized & but he devoted”

The author is using Saul to represent him and his entire army. Alternate translation: [Now Saul and his army seized ... but they devoted]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 15:8 (#1)

וַיִּתְפֹּ֣שׂ אֶת־אֲגַ֔גמֶ֖לֶךְ־עֲמָלֵ֑ק חָ֣י

“Now he seized Agag, the king of Amalek, alive”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your language.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 15:8 (#3)

וְאֶת & הֶחֱרִֽים

“but he devoted”

To translate the term **devoted** here and in the rest of this chapter, see how you decided to translate it in 15:3.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 15:8 (#4)

לְפִי־חָ֖רֶב

“to the mouth of the sword”

See the discussion of this phrase in the Introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [by destroying them completely]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 15:9 (#2)

וְהַמִּשְׁנִ֔ים

“and the second ones”

This could mean: (1) second-born animals, which people in this culture considered to be superior. Alternate translation: [and the second-born animals] or [and

the superior animals]; (2) fattened animals. Alternate translation: [and the fatlings]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 15:9 (#4)

וְעַל & כָּל־הַטּוֹב

“and on all of the good”

The author is using the adjective **good** as a noun to mean a certain kind of thing. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [and on everything else that was good]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 15:9 (#6)

וְכָל־הַמְּלָאכָה נִמְבְּזָה וְנָמֵס

“But all of the despised and weakened property”

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **weakened** tells why this property was **despised**. Alternate translation: [But all of the despicably weak livestock] or [But all of the livestock that people despised because it was weak]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 15:9 (#1)

וַיַּחְמֹל֨וּ שָׁא֜וּל וְהָעָ֗ם עַל

“But Saul and the people had compassion on”

See how you translated the expression “have compassion on” in 15:3. Alternate translation: [But Saul and the people spared]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 15:9 (#5)

וְכָל־הַמְּלָאכָה נִמְבְּזָה וְנָמֵס

“But all of the despised and weakened property”

In this context, the term **property** refers to animals that people domesticate and raise. Alternate translation: [But all of the despised and weakened livestock]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 15:9 (#3)

הַכָּרִים֙ וְעַל

“and on the lambs”

The term translated as **lambs** here refers specifically to lambs that have grazed in pastures and whose meat would therefore be particularly flavorful. Your language may have an expression that you could use in your translation to convey this meaning. Alternate translation: [and on the free-range lambs] or [and on the pasture-fed lambs]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 15:10 (#2)

לֵאמֹֽר

“saying”

See whether you chose to represent the term **saying** in 4:21 and, if so, how you translated it.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 15:10 (#1)

וַיְהִי֙ דְּבַר־יְהוָ֔ה אֶל־שְׁמוּאֵ֖ל

“And the word of Yahweh was to Samuel”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean that Yahweh spoke a message to Samuel. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh spoke a message to Samuel]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 15:11 (#3)

שָׁבַ֤ב מֵאַחֲרַי֙

“he has turned from after me”

Yahweh is speaking as if Saul had been physically following him but had **turned** away. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he has stopped obeying me]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 15:11 (#4)

וְאֶת־דְּבָרַ֖י לֹ֣א הֵקִֽים

“and has not raised up my words”

Yahweh is speaking as if his words were objects that Saul could have **raised up**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and has not accomplished what I told him to do]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 15:11 (#5)

וַיִּ֣חַר לְשְׁמוּאֵ֔ל

“And it was hot to Samuel”

The author is using a common expression of his culture that describes a person becoming extremely angry. Your culture may also associate anger with heat or with some other phenomenon, and if so, you could use its characteristic expression in your translation. You could also use plain language. See how you translated the similar expression in 11:6. Alternate translation: [And Samuel became very angry]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 15:11 (#2)

שָׁ֚בַ֣ב מֵאַחֲרַ֔י וְאֶת־דְּבָרַ֖י לֹ֣א הֵקִ֑ים

“he has turned from after me and has not raised up my words”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The first expresses the idea positively and the second expresses it negatively. If it would be clearer in your language, you could combine them. Alternate translation: [he has completely stopped obeying me]

See: Parallelism

1 Samuel 15:11 (#1)

נִחַ֙מְתִּי֙ כִּֽי־הִמְלַ֣כְתִּי אֶת־שָׁא֔וּל לְמֶ֖לֶךְ כִּֽי־שָׁ֚בַ֣ב מֵאַחֲרַ֔י וְאֶת־דְּבָרַ֖י לֹ֣א הֵקִ֑ים

“I regret that I have made Saul reign as king, for he has turned from after me and has not raised up my words”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Because Saul has turned from after me and has not raised up my words, I regret that I have made him king]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 15:12 (#2)

יָ֑ד

“a hand”

The person speaking to Samuel is using the term **hand** to represent a monument. He may be doing this because: (1) ancient monuments may have had an image of a hand engraved or sculpted on them as a symbol of power and strength. (2) monuments called attention to an achievement, as a gesturing hand would do. Alternate translation: [a monument]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 15:12 (#1)

וַיֻּגַּ֥ד לִשְׁמוּאֵ֖ל

“And it was declared to Samuel”

The expression **was declared** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And someone declared to Samuel]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 15:13 (#1)

בָּר֣וּךְ אַתָּ֔ה לַיהוָ֖ה

“May} you {be} blessed by Yahweh”

The expression **be blessed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language as modeled in the UST.

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 15:13 (#2)

בָּר֣וּךְ אַתָּ֔ה לַיהוָ֖ה

“May} you {be} blessed by Yahweh”

Saul is greeting Samuel with a customary, courteous expression of good wishes. In your translation, you can use a comparable expression from your language and culture.

See: Politeness

1 Samuel 15:13 (#3)

הֲקִימֹ֥תִי אֶת־דְּבַ֖ר יְהוָֽה

“I have raised up the word of Yahweh”

Saul is speaking as if Yahweh’s **word** were an object that he could have **raised up**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression in 15:11. Alternate translation: [I have done what Yahweh commanded]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 15:14 (#1)

וּמֶ֣ה קוֹל־הַצֹּ֗אן הַזֶּ֙ה֙ בְּאָזְנָ֔י וְקֹ֥ול הַבָּקָ֖ר אֲשֶׁ֥ר אָנֹכִ֖י שֹׁמֵֽעַ

“Then what {is} this sound of a flock in my ears? And the sound of cattle that I am hearing”

Samuel is using the question form for emphasis, in order to challenge what Saul has just said. If speakers of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement. Alternate translation: [That cannot be true, because I hear the sound of a flock and the sound of cattle]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 15:14 (#2)

בְּאָזְנָ֔י

“in my ears”

Samuel is using the term **ears** to represent hearing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [that I am hearing]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 15:15 (#3)

חָמַל & עַל

“had compassion on”

See how you translated this expression in 15:3. Alternate translation: [spared]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 15:15 (#1)

מֵעֲמָלֵקִ֑י הֶֽבִיאוּם֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר חָמַ֤ל הָעָם֙ עַל־מֵיטַ֣ב הַצֹּ֔אן וְהַבָּקָ֖ר לְמַ֣עַן זְבֹ֔חַ לַיהוָ֖ה אֱלֹהֶ֑יךָ

“They have brought them from the Amalekite. For the people had compassion on the best of the flock and the cattle, to sacrifice {them} to Yahweh your God”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Because the people had compassion on the best of the flock and cattle, to sacrifice them to Yahweh your God, they have brought them from the Amalekite]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 15:15 (#2)

מֵעֲמָלֵקִ֑י

“from the Amalekite”

Saul is not referring to a specific **Amalekite**. He means the Amalekite people in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using a plural form. Alternate translation: [from the Amalekites]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 15:15 (#4)

מֵיטַ֣ב

“the best of”

Saul is using the adjective **best** as a noun to mean a certain kind of animal. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the best animals among]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 15:15 (#5)

אֱלֹהֶ֑יךָ

“your God”

Saul may be using the pronoun **your** in order to acknowledge Samuel as a man of God. However, since he is referring to Yahweh, the God of all the Israelites, it may be more natural in your language to use a plural first-person pronoun. Alternate translation: [our God]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 15:16 (#1)

ויאמרו לֵ֖לוֹ

“And he said to him”

The pronoun **he** refers to Saul, while the pronoun **him** refers to Samuel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Saul said to Samuel]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 15:17 (#6)

רֹ֣אשׁ

“are} the head of”

Samuel is using the term **head** to represent leadership. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the leader of]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 15:17 (#1)

הֲלֹוֹא אִם־קָטֹן אַתָּה בְּעֵינֶיךָ רֹאשׁ שִׁבְטֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אָתָּה

“Is it} not, if you {were} small in your eyes, you {are} the head of the tribes of Israel”

Samuel is using the question form for emphasis. If speakers of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement. Alternate translation: [You must acknowledge that even though you were small in your eyes, you are the head of the tribes of Israel]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 15:17 (#2)

הֲלֹוֹא

“Is it} not”

Samuel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Is it not the case that]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 15:17 (#5)

רֹאשׁ שִׁבְטֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אָתָּה וַיִּמְשָׁחֲךָ יְהוָה לְמֶלֶךְ עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“you {are} the head of the tribes of Israel? For Yahweh has anointed you as king over Israel”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [since Yahweh has anointed you as king over Israel, you are the head of the tribes of Israel]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 15:17 (#3)

אִם־קָטֹן אַתָּה

“if you {were} small”

Samuel is speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, then you could translate this as a confident statement. Alternate translation: [though you were small]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

1 Samuel 15:17 (#4)

בְּעֵינֶיךָ

“in your eyes”

See how you translated this similar expression in 1:18. (Samuel is referring here to Saul’s protest in 9:21 that he was from the smallest clan of the smallest tribe.) Alternate translation: [in your own regard]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 15:18 (#3)

בְּדָרֶךְ

“on your way”

Samuel is speaking as if Saul’s task were a physical path he could follow. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to do a specific task]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 15:18 (#4)

אֶת־עֲמָלֵק & בּוֹ

“Amalek & with him”

Samuel is using the name of the ancestor of this people group to represent the people group itself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the Amalekites … with them]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 15:18 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁלָחֲךָ יְהוָה בְּדָרֶךְ וַיֹּאמֶר לֵךְ וְהַחֲרַמְתָּה אֶת־הַחַטָּאִים אֶת־עֲמָלֵק וְנִלְחַמְתָּ בּוֹ עַד כַּלּוֹתָם אֹתָם

“And Yahweh sent you on your way, and he said, ‘Go, and you shall devote the sinners, Amalek. And you shall fight with him until the finishing of them”

Samuel is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. In your translation, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh said, ‘Go, and you shall devote the sinners, Amalek, and you shall fight with him until the finishing of them,’ and he sent you on your way]

See: Order of Events

1 Samuel 15:18 (#2)

וַיֹּאמֶר לֵךְ וְהַחֲרַמְתָּה אֶת־הַחַטָּאִים אֶת־עֲמָלֵק וְנִלְחַמְתָּ בּוֹ עַד כַּלּוֹתָם אֹתָם

“and he said, ‘Go, and you shall devote the sinners, Amalek. And you shall fight with him until the finishing of them”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and he told you to go and devote the sinners, Amalek, and to fight with him until you had finished them]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 15:19 (#3)

וַתַּ֣עַט אֶל־הַשָּׁלָ֔ל

“But you swooped down on the plunder”

Samuel is speaking as if Saul and his men were birds of prey that had **swooped down** on their victims. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression in 14:32. Alternate translation: [But you rushed desperately to seize plunder for yourself]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 15:19 (#4)

הָרַ֖ע

“evil”

Samuel is using the adjective **evil** as a noun to mean a certain kind of action. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [an evil thing]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 15:19 (#2)

וְלָ֣מָּה לֹא־שָׁמַ֗עְתָּ בְּקֹ֙ול יְהוָ֔ה

“So why did you not listen to the voice of Yahweh”

See how you translated the expression **listen to the voice** in 15:1. Alternate translation: [So why did you not obey Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 15:19 (#1)

וְלָ֣מָּה לֹא־שָׁמַ֗עְתָּ בְּקֹ֙ול יְהוָ֔ה

“So why did you not listen to the voice of Yahweh”

Samuel is using the question form for emphasis. If speakers of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [So you ought to have listened to the voice of Yahweh!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 15:19 (#5)

בְּעֵינֵ֖י יְהוָֽה

“in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 8:6. Alternate translation: [in Yahweh’s regard]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 15:20 (#1)

שָׁמַ֣עְתִּי׀ בְּקֹ֣ול יְהוָ֗ה וָאֵלֵ֙ךְ֙ בַּדֶּ֣רֶךְ אֲשֶׁר־שְׁלָחַ֔נִי יְהוָ֑ה

“I have listened to the voice of Yahweh, and I have gone on the way that Yahweh sent me”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. If it would be clearer in your language, you could combine them. Alternate translation: [I have obeyed Yahweh by carrying out the task he gave me]

See: Parallelism

1 Samuel 15:20 (#2)

וָאָבִ֗יא אֶת־אֲגַג֙ מֶ֣לֶךְ עֲמָלֵ֔ק וְאֶת־עֲמָלֵ֖ק הֶחֱרַ֥מְתִּי

“And I have brought Agag, the king of Amalek, and I have devoted Amalek”

Saul is using the words that the ULT translates as **And ... and** to indicate that while his first statement is true, at the same time, his second statement is equally true. Alternate translation: [While I have brought Agag, the king of Amalek, I have also devoted Amalek]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

1 Samuel 15:20 (#3)

עֲמָלֵֽק

“Amalek”

Saul is using the name of the ancestor of this people group to represent the people group itself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the Amalekites] or [the rest of the Amalekites]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 15:21 (#1)

רֵאשִׁ֣ית

“the first of”

In this context, the term **first** does not refer to animals that the Israelite soldiers encountered before encountering other animals. It means first in terms of quality. Alternate translation: [the best of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 15:21 (#2)

הַחֵרֶם

“the devoted thing”

Since Saul is referring to a group of animals, it may be more natural in your language to use the plural form. Alternate translation: [the devoted things]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Samuel 15:21 (#3)

אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“your God”

See how you translated the same expression in 15:15. Alternate translation: [our God]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 15:22 (#2)

הַחֵפֶץ לַיהוָה בְּעֹלוֹת וּזְבָחִים כִּשְׁמֹעַ בְּקוֹל יְהוָה

“Is} the delight of Yahweh in burnt offerings and sacrifices as in listening to the voice of Yahweh”

Samuel is using the question form for emphasis. If speakers of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh does not delight so much in burnt offerings and sacrifices as in listening to the voice of Yahweh!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 15:22 (#3)

לַיהוָה & כִּשְׁמֹעַ בְּקוֹל

“as in listening to the voice of Yahweh”

See how you translated the expression **listen to the voice** in 15:1. Alternate translation: [as in people obeying him]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 15:22 (#5)

לְהַקְשִׁיב

“to pay attention”

Samuel is using the term **pay attention** to represent obedience. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to comply]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 15:22 (#1)

הַחֵפֶץ לַיהוָה בְּעֹלוֹת וּזְבָחִים כִּשְׁמֹעַ בְּקוֹל יְהוָה

“Is} the delight of Yahweh in burnt offerings and sacrifices as in listening to the voice of Yahweh”

Samuel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Is the delight of Yahweh as much in burnt offerings and sacrifices as in listening to the voice of Yahweh?]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 15:22 (#4)

שְׁמֹעַ מִזֶּבַח טוֹב לְהַקְשִׁיב מֵחֵלֶב אֵילִים

“listening {is} better than sacrifice, to pay attention than the fat of rams”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Samuel is speaking poetically here, and Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition. It would be good to show this to your readers by including both phrases in your translation rather than combining them. It may be clearer in your language to connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [listening is better than sacrifice, indeed, to pay attention is better than the fat of rams]

See: Parallelism

1 Samuel 15:22 (#6)

מֵחֵלֶב אֵילִים

“than the fat of rams”

Samuel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [than burning the fat of rams on the altar to please Yahweh]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 15:23 (#2)

חַטַּאת־קֶ֖סֶם מֶ֑רִי וְאָ֥וֶן וּתְרָפִ֖ים הַפְצֵ֑ר

“rebellion {is} the sin of divination, and to insist {is} iniquity and teraphim”

Samuel is speaking as if **rebellion** and stubborn insistence were actually the same things as **divination** and **teraphim**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [rebellion is like the sin of divination, and to insist is like iniquity and teraphim] or [rebellion is as bad as the sin of divination, and to insist is as bad as iniquity and teraphim]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 15:23 (#6)

אֶת־דְּבַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה

“the word of Yahweh”

Samuel is using the term **word** to represent what Yahweh commanded by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the command of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 15:23 (#1)

כִּ֣י

“For”

Here the word **For** provides not a reason but a further explanation. Alternate translation: [After all]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 15:23 (#3)

וְאָ֥וֶן & הַפְצֵֽר

“and to insist {is} iniquity”

Samuel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and to insist that you are right when Yahweh has said that you are wrong]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 15:23 (#4)

וְאָ֥וֶן וּתְרָפִ֖ים הַפְצֵֽר

“and to insist {is} iniquity and teraphim”

The term **teraphim** describes idols that people in this culture kept in their homes. If your readers would not be familiar with what these were, in your translation you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [and to insist is iniquity and household idols]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 15:23 (#5)

וְאָ֥וֶן וּתְרָפִ֖ים הַפְצֵֽר

“and to insist {is} iniquity and teraphim”

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **teraphim** tells what kind of **iniquity** this is. Alternate translation: [and to insist is the iniquity of worshiping idols] or [and to insist is the sin of idolatry]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 15:24 (#2)

עָבַ֖רְתִּי

“I have crossed over”

Saul is speaking as if Yahweh’s commands were a boundary that he had physically **crossed**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [I have gone beyond] or [I have disobeyed]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 15:24 (#1)

חָטָ֙אתִי֙ כִּֽי־עָבַ֣רְתִּי אֶת־פִּי־יְהוָ֔ה וְאֶת־דְּבָרֶ֖יךָ כִּ֣י יָרֵ֑אתִי אֶת־הָעָ֖ם וָאֶשְׁמַ֥ע בְּקוֹלָֽם

“I have sinned. For I have crossed over the mouth of Yahweh and your words, because I feared the people and listened to their voice”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Because I feared the people and listened to their voice, I have crossed over the mouth of Yahweh and your words, and so I have sinned]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 15:24 (#3)

אֶת־פִּי־יְהוָ֔ה וְאֶת־דְּבָרֶ֖יךָ

“the mouth of Yahweh and your words”

Saul is using the terms **mouth** and **words** to represent what Yahweh commanded by using his mouth, which Samuel relayed by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [what Yahweh told me to do and what you said I should do]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 15:24 (#4)

וָאֶשְׁמַ֖ע בְּקוֹלָֽם

“and listened to their voice”

See how you translated the similar expression in 15:1. Alternate translation: [and did what they urged me to do]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 15:25 (#2)

וְשׁ֥וּבָה עִמִּ֖י וְאֶשְׁתַּחֲוֶ֥ה לַיהוָֽה

“and return with me so I may worship Yahweh”

Saul seems to be asking Samuel to sacrifice some of the plundered animals himself in order to lead him and his soldiers in **worship**. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 15:25 (#1)

שָׂ֣א & אֶת־חַטָּאתִ֔י

“take away my sin”

Saul is speaking as if **sin** were an object that could be physically removed. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [pardon my sin] or [ask Yahweh to forgive my sin]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 15:26 (#1)

לֹ֣א אָשׁ֔וּב עִמָּ֑ךְ כִּֽי־מָאַ֙סְתָּה֙ אֶת־דְּבַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה וַיִּמְאָסְךָ֥ יְהוָ֖ה מִהְיֹ֥ות מֶ֛לֶךְ עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“I will not return with you. For you have rejected the word of Yahweh, so Yahweh has rejected you from {being} king over Israel”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Because you have rejected the word of Yahweh, Yahweh has rejected you from being king over Israel, so I will not return with you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 15:26 (#2)

אֶת־דְּבַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה

“the word of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 15:23. Alternate translation: [the command of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 15:27 (#1)

וַיַּחֲזֵ֖ק בִּכְנַף־מְעִילֹ֑ו

“but he seized the edge of his robe”

The pronoun **he** refers to Saul, while the pronoun **his** refers to Samuel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [but Saul seized the edge of Samuel’s robe]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 15:27 (#2)

וַיִּקָּרַֽע

“and it was torn”

The expression **was torn** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the robe tore] or [and Saul tore it]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 15:28 (#1)

קָרַ֨ע יְהוָ֜ה אֶת־מַמְלְכ֤וּת יִשְׂרָאֵל֙ מֵעָלֶ֔יךָ הַיֹּ֖ום וּנְתָנָ֑הּ לְרֵעֲךָ֖

“Yahweh has torn the kingdom of Israel from upon you today, and he has given it to your fellow”

Samuel is using the past tense to describe something that is going to happen in the future in order to show that the event will certainly happen. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use the future tense. Alternate translation: [Yahweh has decided today to tear the kingdom of Israel from upon you, and he is going to give it to your fellow]

See: Predictive Past

1 Samuel 15:28 (#2)

קָרַ֨ע יְהוָ֜ה אֶת־מַמְלְכ֤וּת יִשְׂרָאֵל֙ מֵעָלֶ֔יךָ

“Yahweh has torn the kingdom of Israel from upon you”

Samuel is speaking as if the kingdom were a garment that could be **torn** away from Saul. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh has taken the kingdom of Israel away from you]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 15:29 (#1)

נֵ֣צַח יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“the Glory of Israel”

Samuel is using the term that the ULT translates as **Glory** to represent God. See the discussion of this term in the Introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [the glorious God of Israel] or [the unchanging God of Israel]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 15:29 (#2)

וְגַם֙

“For indeed”

Here the word **For** provides not a reason but a further explanation. Alternate translation: [After all]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 15:30 (#1)

וַיֹּ֖אמֶר

“And he said”

The pronoun **he** refers to Saul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Saul said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 15:30 (#2)

כַּבְּדֵ֨נִי & נָ֜א נֶ֣גֶד זִקְנֵי־עַמִּ֗י וְנֶ֙גֶד֙ יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל וְשׁ֖וּב עִמִּ֑י וְהִשְׁתַּחֲוֵ֥יתִי לַיהוָ֖ה אֱלֹהֶֽיךָ

“honor me before the elders of my people and before Israel, and return with me so I may worship Yahweh your God”

Saul is describing something in the second clause that will have the result he describes in the first clause. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate this in your translation. Alternate translation: [honor me before the elders of my people and before Israel by returning with me so I may worship Yahweh your God]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 15:30 (#3)

יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“Israel”

Saul is using the name of the ancestor of his people group to represent the people group itself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the other Israelites]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 15:32 (#1)

וַיֵּ֥לֶךְ & אֲגַ֖ג

“And Agag went”

In this context, your language might say “came” instead of **went**. Alternate translation: [And Agag came]

See: Go and Come

1 Samuel 15:32 (#4)

סָ֣ר

“has turned aside”

Agag is speaking as if death were a traveler who had **turned aside** from his path. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [is no longer something I need to be concerned about]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 15:32 (#2)

מַ֣עֲדַנֹּ֔ת

“in} bonds”

The term that the ULT translates as **{in} bonds** could describe: (1) how the Israelites had bound Agag as a prisoner. Alternate translation: [tied up]; (2) the attitude of Agag, which interpreters understand in various ways. Alternate translation: [cheerfully] or [confidently] or [hesitantly] or [trembling]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 15:32 (#3)

מַר־הַמָּוֶת

“the bitterness of death”

Agag is using this possessive form to describe death as something that has **bitterness** associated with it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this with a different expression that does not use a possessive form. Alternate translation: [the bitter experience that is death]

See: Possession

1 Samuel 15:33 (#1)

שִׁכְלָ֥ה נָשִׁ֖ים חַרְבֶּ֑ךָ

“your sword has made women childless”

Samuel is speaking of Agag’s **sword** as if it were a living thing that could have **made women childless** by itself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you have killed the children of many women with your sword]

See: Personification

1 Samuel 15:33 (#3)

לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָ֖ה

“to the face of Yahweh”

Samuel is using the term **face** to represent presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the presence of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 15:33 (#2)

שִׁכְלָ֥ה נָשִׁ֖ים חַרְבֶּ֑ךָ

“your sword has made women childless”

Samuel is using the **sword** of one of the Amalekites, their king and commander Agag, to represent all of them in the act of killing people with their swords. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with your swords, you and the Amalekites you have commanded have made women childless]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel - Chapter 16 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter begins the part of the book that describes how David became king (chapters 16–31). Several years passed between the time when Samuel anointed David, as this chapter describes, and the time when David finally became king. In the meantime, Saul continued to reign. So this part of the book also continues to describe what Saul did as king.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Did Yahweh tell Samuel to lie?

In 16:1, Yahweh tells Samuel to go to Bethlehem and anoint one of Jesse’s sons to be the next king. Samuel replies in 16:2 that if Saul hears about this, he will kill him. Yahweh tells Samuel in 16:3 that he should tell the people of Bethlehem, “I have come to sacrifice to Yahweh.” Was Yahweh telling Samuel to lie by saying that he had come for one reason when he had really come for a different reason?

Yahweh is actually telling Samuel not to say anything more than he needs to. As the author explains in 7:16, Samuel would regularly go about the Israelite cities and towns in his role as a judge. As 9:13 shows, Samuel would also offer sacrifices and invite people to join him in eating the meat of those animals as a feast in order to thank and honor Yahweh and to enjoy fellowship together. So Samuel could have gone to Bethlehem anyway as part of his regular duties, and his trip there actually did involve holding a feast for the elders of the town. But it also included a private visit with Jesse’s family, during which he anointed David. So Yahweh was not telling him to lie, he was advising him, for his own safety, to keep the private part of his visit private.

Why did the elders of Bethlehem tremble with fear when Samuel arrived?

The author says in 16:4 that when Samuel arrived in Bethlehem, “the elders of the city trembled to meet him.” The author does not state specifically why the elders were afraid. One possibility is that they thought that someone in their town, or the whole town collectively, had done something wrong and that Samuel had come to denounce them and declare that Yahweh was going to punish them. Another possibility is that the elders of Bethlehem knew that Samuel had had a bitter dispute with Saul and was no longer seeing him in person, as 15:35 states. They may have been very leery about potentially being drawn into this dispute between their longtime judge and the man who was now their king. However, since the author does not say specifically why the elders were afraid, we recommend

that you do not suggest a reason in the text of your translation. In this case, say no more than the biblical text does.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Did Yahweh send a "bad" spirit or an "evil" spirit to Saul?
The author relates in 16:13–14 that when Samuel anointed David, the Spirit of Yahweh rushed upon David, but the Spirit of Yahweh turned away from Saul and instead a "bad" spirit from Yahweh terrified him. Some versions of the Bible translate this as an "evil" spirit. The Hebrew term can have either meaning, depending on the context. The term should be understood to mean "bad" in this context. The Bible as a whole makes clear that God does not use evil means to accomplish his purposes. Moreover, the term "bad" may describe the effects of this spirit rather than its character. The spirit made Saul feel bad, and this may be because it made him mindful of how he had willfully disobeyed Yahweh and forfeited the kingship. Saul may have been terrified of how Yahweh would fulfill the judgment that Samuel had pronounced against him: "Yahweh has torn the kingdom of Israel from upon you today, and he has given it to your fellow, one better than you."

1 Samuel 16:1 (#2)

עַד־מָתַי֙ אַתָּ֣ה מִתְאַבֵּ֔ל אֶל־שָׁא֖וּל וַאֲנִ֣י מְאַסְתִּ֑יו מִמְּלֹךְ֙ עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

"Until when will you be mourning for Saul, since I myself have rejected him from {being} king over Israel"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since I myself have rejected Saul from being king over Israel, you should not continue to mourn for him.]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 16:1 (#3)

מַלֵּ֤א קַרְנְךָ֙ שָׁ֔מֶן

"Fill your horn {with} oil"

Yahweh assumes that Samuel will know that he is to use this oil to anoint a new king. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Fill your horn with oil so that you can anoint a new king]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 16:1 (#1)

עַד־מָתַי֙ אַתָּ֣ה מִתְאַבֵּ֔ל אֶל־שָׁא֖וּל וַאֲנִ֣י מְאַסְתִּ֑יו מִמְּלֹךְ֙ עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

"Until when will you be mourning for Saul, since I myself have rejected him from {being} king over Israel"

Yahweh is using the question form for emphasis. If speakers of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement. Alternate translation: [You should not continue to mourn for Saul, since I myself have rejected him from being king over Israel.]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 16:1 (#4)

אֶשְׁלָחֲךָ֙ אֶל־יִשַׁ֣י בֵּית־הַלַּחְמִ֔י כִּֽי־רָאִ֥יתִי בְבָנָ֖יו לִ֥י מֶֽלֶךְ

"I am sending you to Jesse the Bethlehemite, for I have seen among his sons a king for me"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Because I have seen among the sons of Jesse the Bethlehemite a king for me, I am sending you to him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 16:2 (#2)

וְשָׁמַ֥ע שָׁא֖וּל

"If Saul hears"

Samuel is not stating his full meaning explicitly, but it is clear from the context. You could indicate it explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [If Saul hears that I have gone to anoint a different king]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 16:2 (#3)

בְּיָדֶ֔ךָ

"in your hand"

Yahweh is using one part of Samuel, his **hand**, to mean all of him in the act of bringing something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with you]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 16:2 (#4)

וְאָמַרְתָּ֣ לִזְבֹּ֤חַ לַיהוָה֙ בָּאתִי

“and say, ‘I have come to sacrifice to Yahweh”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and say that you have come to sacrifice to Yahweh]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 16:2 (#1)

אֵ֣יךְ אֵלֵ֔ךְ

“How shall I go”

Samuel is using the question form for emphasis. If speakers of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I cannot go!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 16:4 (#1)

וַיֶּחֶרְדוּ֙ זִקְנֵ֣י הָעִ֔יר

“And the elders of the city trembled”

The author means that the elders of Bethlehem **trembled** with fear when they saw Samuel coming. See the discussion in the Introduction to this chapter of why they may have done so. Alternate translation: [And the elders of the city trembled with fear]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 16:4 (#2)

שָׁלֹ֖ם בּוֹאֶֽךָ

“Is} your coming {in} peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **coming**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Have you come here peaceably] or [Is this a friendly visit]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 16:5 (#1)

שָׁלֹ֑ום

“In} peace”

Samuel is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [I have come in peace]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 16:5 (#2)

וַיְקַדֵּ֥שׁ אֶת־יִשַׁ֛י וְאֶת־בָּנָ֖יו וַיִּקְרָ֣א לָהֶ֑ם לַזָּֽבַח

“And he consecrated Jesse and his sons, and he invited them to the sacrifice”

The author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. In your translation, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [And he invited Jesse and his sons to the sacrifice, and he consecrated them]

See: Order of Events

1 Samuel 16:6 (#1)

וַיְהִ֗י

“And it happened”

See how you translated this phrase in 1:12. Here the author is using it to introduce a new development in this episode. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 16:6 (#2)

בְּבוֹאָ֔ם וַיַּ֖רְא

“in their coming, that he saw”

The pronoun **their** refers to Jesse and his sons, while the pronoun **he** refers to Samuel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [when Jesse and his sons arrived, that Samuel saw]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 16:6 (#4)

נֶ֥גֶד יְהוָ֖ה

“is} before Yahweh”

Samuel is using the expression **before Yahweh** to represent in his presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [is here in Yahweh’s presence]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 16:6 (#3)

מְשִׁיחֹ֖ו

“his anointed one”

Samuel is using the past tense to describe something that is going to happen in the future. He is doing this because he believes that the event will certainly happen. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use the future tense. Alternate translation: [the one I will anoint for him]

See: Predictive Past

1 Samuel 16:7 (#3)

מְאַסְתִּתְיֻהוּ

“I have rejected him”

Yahweh does not mean that he has previously considered Eliab and **rejected** him. Instead, he means that he has not chosen Eliab, as he says about the other sons in 16:8–10. You could indicate that in your translation if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I have not chosen him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 16:7 (#6)

לְעֵינַיִם

“at the eyes”

Yahweh is using the term **eyes** to represent what eyes can see. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [at what the eyes can see] or [at the outward appearance]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 16:7 (#7)

לַלֵּבָב

“at the heart”

Yahweh is speaking as if a person’s character were their physical **heart**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at a person’s character]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 16:7 (#2)

וְאֶל־גְּבֹהַ קוֹמָתוֹ

“or on the height of his stature”

It might seem that the expression **the height of his stature** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [or on his great height]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 16:7 (#1)

אַל־תַּבֵּט אֶל־מַרְאֵהוּ וְאֶל־גְּבֹהַ קוֹמָתוֹ כִּי מְאַסְתִּתְיֻהוּ

“Do not look on his appearance or on the height of his stature, for I have rejected him”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since I have rejected him, do not look on his appearance or on the height of his stature]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 16:7 (#5)

כִּֽי הָאָדָם֙ יִרְאֶ֔ה

“for man looks”

Here the word **for** provides not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [Specifically, man looks]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 16:7 (#4)

לֹ֣א אֲשֶׁ֔ר יִרְאֶה֙ הָאָדָ֔ם

“not what man sees”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [I do not see what man sees] or [I do not look at things the way humans do]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 16:8 (#2)

וַיֹּ֖אמֶר

“but he said”

The pronoun **he** refers to Samuel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [but Samuel said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 16:8 (#1)

לִפְנֵי שְׁמוּאֵל

“to the face of Samuel”

See how you translated the term **face** in 2:11. Alternate translation: [in front of Samuel]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 16:9 (#1)

וַיַּעֲבֵ֣ר יִשַׁ֔י שַׁמָּ֖ה

“Then Jesse made Shammah pass over”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Then Jesse called for his next son, Shammah, and made him pass over in front of Samuel]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 16:10 (#1)

שִׁבְעַ֥ת בָּנָ֖יו

“seven of his sons”

The author means that this was a total of seven sons. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [a total of seven of his sons]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 16:11 (#2)

שְׁלְחָ֥ה וְקָחֶ֖נּוּ כִּ֣י לֹא־נָסֹ֑ב עַד־בֹּאֹ֖ו פֹּֽה

“Send and get him, for we will not go around until he comes here”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since we will not go around until he comes here, send and get him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 16:11 (#3)

לֹא־נָסֹ֑ב

“we will not go around”

Samuel means that they will not **go around** the table to sit down to eat. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [we will not go around the table] or [we will not sit down to eat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 16:11 (#1)

וְהִנֵּ֥ה

“but behold”

See how you translated the term **behold** in 2:31. Alternate translation: [but this is the situation]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 16:12 (#2)

וְהָה֣וּא אַדְמֹונִ֔י

“Now he {was} ruddy”

The author is referring to the **ruddy** or reddish appearance of David’s face to mean that David was evidently healthy. His face was swarthy from exposure to the outdoors, and he had good circulation because of his vigorous lifestyle. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Now he had a healthy glow about him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 16:12 (#3)

קֻ֥ום מָשְׁחֵ֖הוּ כִּי־זֶ֥ה הֽוּא

“Arise, anoint him, for this {is} he”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since this is he, arise, anoint him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 16:12 (#4)

קֻ֥ום

“Arise”

Here Yahweh is using the term **Arise** to mean that he wants Samuel to take action. He does not mean merely that he wants Samuel to stand up from a sitting or reclining position. See how you translated the similar expressions in 1:9 and 13:15. Alternate translation: [Take action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 16:12 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁלַ֖ח וַיְבִיאֵ֑הוּ

“So he sent and brought him”

The first pronoun **he** refers to Jesse, while the second pronoun **him** refers to David. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [So Jesse sent and brought David] or [So Jesse sent someone to bring David]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 16:13 (#2)

מֵהַיּוֹם הַהוּא וָמָעְלָה

“from that day and onward”

The author is using the term **day** to represent a specific time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from that moment on]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 16:13 (#1)

אֶחָיו׃

“his brothers”

Jesse makes clear in 16:11 that David is his youngest son, so these were David’s older **brothers**. If your language marks that distinction, you may have an appropriate kinship term that you can use here in your translation.

See: Kinship

1 Samuel 16:14 (#3)

וּבְעָתַתְהוּ רוּחַ־רָעָה מֵאֵאת יְהוָה

“and a bad spirit from with Yahweh terrified him”

See the discussion of this phrase in the Introduction to this chapter.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 16:14 (#4)

וּבְעָתַתְהוּ

“and & terrified him”

The author means that this bad spirit came and terrified Saul. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and … came and terrified him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 16:14 (#2)

וְרוּחַ יְהוָה סָרָה מֵעִם שָׁאוּל

“Now the Spirit of Yahweh turned from with Saul”

The author is speaking as if the Spirit of Yahweh had physically **turned** away from Saul. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Now the Spirit of Yahweh stopped helping Saul]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 16:14 (#1)

וְרוּחַ יְהוָה סָרָה מֵעִם שָׁאוּל וּבְעָתַתְהוּ רוּחַ־רָעָה מֵאֵאת יְהוָה

“Now the Spirit of Yahweh turned from with Saul, and a bad spirit from with Yahweh terrified him”

The author is introducing a new development in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method here that is natural in your language for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 16:16 (#1)

יֹאמַר־נָא אֲדֹנֵינוּ עֲבָדֶיךָ

“May our master please say to your servants”

The servants are humbly addressing Saul in the third person and also humbly speaking about themselves in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this using the second person for Saul and the first person for the servants. Alternate translation: [May you our master please say to us your servants]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 16:16 (#3)

בָּהְיוֹת עָלֶיךָ

“when & is upon you”

The servants are speaking as if the spirit were physically on top of Saul. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when … is troubling you] or [when … is making you afraid]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 16:16 (#2)

לְפָנֶיךָ יְבַקְשׁוּ אִישׁ יֹדֵעַ מְנַגֵּן בַּכִּנּוֹר

“to your face, ‘Seek a man knowing playing upon the lyre”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [to your face that we should seek a man who knows how to play the lyre]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 16:16 (#4)

וְנִגֵּן בְּיָדוֹ

“that he will play by his hand”

It might seem that the expression **by his hand** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [that he will strum]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 16:16 (#5)

וְטוֹב לָךְ

“and it will be good for you”

The servants are using a common expression of their culture. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and this will make you feel better]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 16:18 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר

“and said”

The expression **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this expression explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 16:18 (#5)

וַיהוָה עִמּוֹ

“And Yahweh {is} with him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:19. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh helps him]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 16:18 (#2)

וְגִבּוֹר חַיִל וְאִישׁ מִלְחָמָה & וְאִישׁ

“and mighty of valor and a man of war & and a man”

The young man is using these possessive forms to mean that David is very strong and a good soldier. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this using different expressions that do not use possessive forms. Alternate translation: [and very strong and a good soldier ... and a man]

See: Possession

1 Samuel 16:18 (#3)

וּנְבוֹן דָּבָר

“and discerning of word”

The young man is using the term **word** to represent what David says by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and discerning in what he says]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 16:18 (#4)

וְאִישׁ & וְאִישׁ תֹּאַר

“and a man of & and a man of appearance”

The young man means that David has a handsome **appearance**. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and a man of ... and a man of handsome appearance]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 16:19 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר

“And he said”

The author is using one person who was involved in communicating this message to Jesse, Saul, who sent the messengers, to represent everyone who was involved. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate this in your translation. Alternate translation: [And he said through them] or [And they conveyed this message on his behalf]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 16:19 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר בַּצֹּאן

“who {is} with the flock”

It is not clear how Saul knew that David was tending his father’s **flock** at this time. The servant who spoke in 16:18 did not provide that information. The narrative suggests that Saul made some further inquiries before sending for David. You could indicate this in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [who I understand is with your flock]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 16:19 (#2)

שְׁלְחָה אֵלַי אֶת־דָּוִד בִּנְךָ אֲשֶׁר בַּצֹּאן

“Send to me David your son, who {is} with the flock”

Saul is not distinguishing one of Jesse’s sons named **David** from another of his sons by the same name who is not **with the flock**. He is acknowledging David’s responsibilities at home but nevertheless requesting his presence at the royal court. Be sure that this is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [Your son David is with the flock, but send him to me]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

1 Samuel 16:20 (#1)

וּגְדִי עִזִּים אֶחָד

“and one kid of goats”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean a young goat. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and a young goat]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 16:20 (#3)

בְּיַד־דָּוִד

“by the hand of David”

The author is using one part of David, his **hand**, to mean all of him in the act of bringing something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with David]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 16:20 (#2)

וַיִּשְׁלַח

“and he sent {them”

Sending the bread, wine, and goat to Saul was a symbolic action by which Jesse showed his respect for him as Israel’s king. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [and he sent them respectfully as a gift]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 16:21 (#3)

וַיְהִי־לוֹ נֹשֵׂא כֵלִים

“and he became to him a carrier of equipment”

See how you translated the expression **carrier** of **equipment** in 14:1 and throughout chapter 14. Alternate translation: [and he became his armor-bearer]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 16:21 (#1)

וַיַּעֲמֹד לְפָנָיו

“and he stood to his face”

The author is using a common expression of his culture. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he became one of his servants]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 16:21 (#2)

וַיֶּאֱהָבֵהוּ

“And he loved him”

The pronoun **he** refers to Saul, while the pronoun **him** refers to David. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Saul loved David]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 16:22 (#4)

יַעֲמָד־נָא דָוִד לְפָנָי

“Please let David stand to my face”

Saul means that he wants David to become one of his regular servants. The implication is that David came initially on a temporary or provisional basis. You could indicate Saul’s meaning more explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Please let David continue to be one of my servants] or [Please let David become one of my regular servants]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 16:22 (#5)

מָמָצָא חֵן בְּעֵינָי

“he has found favor in my eyes”

See how you translated this similar expression in 8:6. Alternate translation: [I view him favorably]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 16:22 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁלַח שָׁאוּל

“And Saul sent”

The author is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And Saul sent messengers]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 16:22 (#2)

יַעֲמָד־נָ֣א דָוִד֮ לְפָנַ֒י כִּי־מָצָ֣א חֵ֔ן בְּעֵינָֽי

“Please let David stand to my face, for he has found favor in my eyes”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since David has found favor in my eyes, please let him stand to my face]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 16:22 (#3)

יַעֲמָד־נָ֣א דָוִד֮ לְפָנָֽי

“Please let David stand to my face”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean that someone became a servant. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Please let David become one of my servants]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 16:23 (#1)

וְנִגֵּ֖ן בְּיָדֽוֹ

“and played {it} by his hand”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [and strummed it]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 16:23 (#3)

וְסָ֣רָה מֵעָלָ֔יו רוּחַ֙ הָרָעָ֔ה

“and the bad spirit turned away from upon him”

The author is speaking as if the spirit were physically on top of Saul and could **turn away** from him. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the bad spirit stopped troubling him]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 16:23 (#2)

וְרָוַ֥ח לְשָׁא֖וּל

“And it breathed to Saul”

The author is using a common expression of his culture. He means that Saul **breathed** more deeply and slowly after the spirit left him, indicating that he felt relief. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [And Saul breathed easy] or [And Saul felt relief]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel - Chapter 17 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the part of the book that describes how David became king (chapters 16–31). It describes how he fought and killed a Philistine giant named Goliath. This shows that even as a young man, David had strong faith in God and great courage. David was motivated by a desire for the glory of God. He said that when he killed Goliath, “all of the earth will know that there is a God to Israel,” in other words, that the God of Israel is the only true God.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Single combat

In this chapter, Goliath, a great Philistine warrior, challenges any Israelite to fight him in single combat in order to determine the outcome of the war between the two peoples. Single combat between warrior champions like this was a significant practice in ancient warfare. It served both practical and symbolic purposes. Rather than risk heavy casualties in a full battle, armies would sometimes agree to let individual warriors fight as representatives of their armies. The outcome of this combat would often determine the larger conflict, with the losing side agreeing to surrender or accept terms. This practice helped reduce overall casualties while still establishing military dominance. Champions who participated in single combat were typically the most skilled and physically imposing warriors, chosen to represent their army’s strength. The practice also had important cultural and religious significance, as the outcome was often seen as indicating which army’s god was greater and stronger. So David’s confrontation with Goliath

was not just military combat, it was also a spiritual contest between the God of Israel and the gods of the Philistines, which Yahweh, the God of Israel, won decisively.

Why does Goliath refer to the Israelites as "servants of Saul"?
In 17:8, Goliath challenges the army of Israel to send a champion down into the Valley of Elah to fight with him in single combat. He says, "Am I not the Philistine, and you, servants of Saul? Choose for yourselves a man, and let him come down to me." It is likely that by calling himself "the Philistine," he is identifying himself as the designated warrior champion of the Philistines. The implications of what he is saying is that Saul ought to come and fight with him as the Israelite champion. Saul was much taller than other Israelites (although not nearly as tall as Goliath), and the Israelites had wanted someone like him as their king specifically so that he would lead them into battle. So we would expect Goliath to have said something like, "Am I not the Philistine, and is not Saul the Israelite? Choose him as a man for yourselves" (that is, as your champion) "and let him come down to me." However, by saying something slightly different, Goliath may be implicitly suggesting that Saul would be afraid to fight him, and so he is willing to fight any other Israelite. In ancient single combat, warrior champions would usually only fight opposing warriors of equal rank and status. Some interpreters infer from the context that Goliath was a prince among the Philistines; some suggest that he could have been the king of the city of Gath. In any event, he was a great warrior of high standing. But by addressing the Israelites as "servants of Saul," he is indicating that if Saul will not come down and fight him (as he tauntingly suggests he will not), he will fight any Israelite, even a mere "servant." His words might be understood to mean, "Even though I am the Philistine champion, and you are only servants of Saul, nevertheless, choose for yourselves a man, and let him come down to me, and I will fight with him in single combat, no matter what his rank or status." Goliath would be boasting that he could defeat any soldier in the Israelite army. But since this meaning is already discernible in the narrative, and since this interpretation is probable but not certain, it may be best to represent Goliath's actual words in your translation and not interpret them by using an expression such as "even though ... nevertheless."

What was the "evil" that Eliab believed was in David's "heart"
In 17:28, David's eldest brother Eliab tells him that he knows "the evil" of David's "heart." Eliab is at least accusing David of abandoning his family responsibilities in order to have the thrill of watching a battle ("for you have come down in order to see the battle"). However, his reference to the "evil" in David's "heart" may suggest something further. Some interpreters believe that Eliab thinks David has been going around asking about the reward for killing Goliath in order to get some soldier or another to take up Goliath's challenge in the hopes of getting the reward. If that happened, then David would be able to "see" a "battle" between two warrior champions.

Why did David choose smooth stones?
David chose five smooth stones from a nearby brook because that type of stone would fly freely, directly, and forcefully when he slung it. It turned out that he only needed to use one stone to knock Goliath unconscious so that he could run over to him and cut off his head with his own sword.

1 Samuel 17:1 (#1)

וַיֵּאָסְפוּ פְלִשְׁתִּים אֶת־מַחֲנֵיהֶם לַמִּלְחָמָה

"Now the Philistines gathered their camps for battle"

The author is introducing a new development in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method here that is natural in your language for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 17:1 (#2)

אֶת־מַחֲנֵיהֶם

"their camps"

The author is using the term **camps** to represent the soldiers who were in these camps. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [their forces] or [their troops]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:1 (#3)

וַיֵּאָסְפוּ

"and they were gathered"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in an active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and they gathered them]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 17:2 (#1)

וְשָׁאוּל וְאִישׁ־יִשְׂרָאֵל֙ נֶאֱסָפ֔וּ

“And Saul and the men of Israel were gathered”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in an active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And Saul and the men of Israel gathered themselves] or [And Saul gathered the men of Israel]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 17:3 (#2)

וְיִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל

“and Israel”

The author is using the name of the nation to represent its army. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:3 (#1)

הָהָר֙ מִזֶּ֔ה & אֶל־הָהָ֥ר מִזֶּ֖ה

“the mountain from this & on the mountain from that”

The author is using a common expression of his culture. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a mountain on one side of the valley ... a mountain on the other side of the valley]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 17:4 (#2)

שֵׁ֣שׁ אַמּ֔וֹת וָזָ֖רֶת

“was} six cubits and a span”

These **cubits** were an ancient unit of measurement corresponding to the distance between an average person’s elbow and middle fingertip, or about 46 centimeters or 18 inches. A **span**, sometimes called a “hand’s breadth,” was an ancient unit of measurement corresponding to the distance between the tip of the thumb and the tip of the little finger of an average person’s spread hand, or about 23 centimeters or 9 inches. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express Goliath’s height in modern measurements, either in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [was three meters] or [was nine feet and nine inches]

See: Biblical Distance

1 Samuel 17:4 (#1)

וַיֵּצֵ֣א אִישׁ־הַבֵּנַ֔יִם

“And a man of the betweens came out”

The author is using a common expression of his culture. He is using the dual form **betweens** to mean the space that was between the Philistines and Israelites and also between the Israelites and the Philistines. (Compare the similar usage in 14:4.) A **man of the betweens** was a warrior champion who would come into this space in order to fight in single combat against an enemy champion. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And a warrior champion]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 17:5 (#3)

וּמִשְׁקַל֙ הַשִּׁרְיוֹן֙ חֲמֵ֣שֶׁת־אֲלָפִ֔ים שְׁקָלִ֖ים נְחֹ֑שֶׁת

“And the weight of the coat {was} 5,000 shekels of bronze”

These **shekels** each weighed about 11 grams or about a third of an ounce. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this in terms of modern measurements, either in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And the coat was made of bronze, and it weighed over 50 kilograms] or [And the coat was made of bronze, and it weighed 125 pounds]

See: Biblical Weight

1 Samuel 17:5 (#1)

וְשִׁרְיוֹן֙ קַשְׂקַשִּׂ֔ים הוּא֙ לָבֻ֔ושׁ

“and he was clothed {with} a coat of scales”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in an active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and he was wearing a coat of scales]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 17:5 (#2)

וְשִׁרְיוֹן֙ קַשְׂקַשִּׂ֔ים

“with} a coat of scales”

A **coat of scales** was a type of armor made of overlapping metal plates sewn onto a leather garment. If your readers would not be familiar with what this is, in your translation you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [with armor made of metal plates]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 17:6 (#1)

וּמִצְחַ֣ת נְחֹ֔שֶׁת עַל־רַגְלָ֖יו

“And greaves of bronze {were} on his legs”

These **greaves** were pieces of armor that protected the lower legs. If your readers would not be familiar with greaves, in your translation you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [And he wore bronze armor on his legs]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 17:6 (#2)

וְכִידֹ֥ן

“and a curved sword of”

The term that the ULT translates as **curved sword** could also be describing a small spear. Alternate translation: [and a javelin of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:7 (#3)

כְּמְנ֣וֹר אֹרְגִ֔ים

“was} like a beam of weavers”

The point of this comparison is that just as a weaver’s beam was very thick and strong, so was the shaft of Goliath’s spear. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [was as thick and strong as a weaver’s beam]

See: Simile

1 Samuel 17:7 (#4)

וְלַהֲבַ֥ת חֲנִיתֹ֖ו

“and the flame of his spear”

The author is using the term **flame** to represent the pointed metal tip of the spear, which flashed in the sunlight. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and the head of his spear]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:7 (#2)

כְּמְנ֣וֹר אֹרְגִ֔ים

“was} like a beam of weavers”

A **beam of weavers** was the thick, strong beam on which weavers hung their fabric. If your readers would not be familiar with this, in your translation you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [was like the thick, strong beam on which weavers hang their fabric]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 17:7 (#5)

שֵׁשׁ־מֵא֥וֹת שְׁקָלִ֖ים בַּרְזֶ֑ל

“was} 600 iron shekels”

See how you translated the term **shekel** in 17:5. Alternate translation: [weighed seven kilograms] or [weighed 15 pounds]

See: Biblical Weight

1 Samuel 17:7 (#1)

וְעֵ֥ץ חֲנִיתֹ֖ו

“And the wood of his spear”

The author is using the term **wood** to represent the long pole part of the spear that was made of wood. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And the shaft of his spear]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:7 (#6)

לְפָנָ֑יו

“to his face”

See how you translated the term **face** in 2:11. Alternate translation: [in front of him]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:8 (#4)

וְאַתֶּ֣ם עֲבָדִ֔ים לְשָׁא֖וּל

“and you, servants of Saul”

Goliath is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and are you not servants of Saul]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 17:8 (#2)

לָמָּה תֵצְאוּ לַעֲרֹךְ מִלְחָמָה הֲלוֹא אָנֹכִי הַפְּלִשְׁתִּי וְאַתֶּם עַבָדִים לְשָׁאוּל

“Why have you come out to array for battle? {Am} I not the Philistine, and you, servants of Saul”

Goliath is using these questions for emphasis. If speakers of your language would not use questions for that purpose, you could translate these as statements or exclamations. Alternate translation: [You did not have to come out to array for battle! After all, I am the Philistine, and you, servants of Saul!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 17:8 (#3)

הַפְּלִשְׁתִּי

“the Philistine”

Goliath could mean either: (1) that he is the Philistine warrior champion, and in that role, as he says in the next verse, he is prepared to do single combat with an Israelite champion. Alternate translation: [the Philistine warrior champion]; (2) that he is a great Philistine warrior with whose exploits and reputation the Israelite soldiers are familiar. The term translated as **the** can have this sense. This would also be a claim that he is a suitable champion to represent all of the Philistines in single combat. Alternate translation: [the great Philistine warrior of whom you have all heard]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:8 (#1)

וַיַּעֲמֹד

“And he stood”

As the phrase “a man of the betweens” in 17:4 suggests, and as the phrase **come down** in this verse indicates, Goliath was standing in the space between the Philistine and Israelite battle lines, that is, in the Valley of Elah. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And he stood in the Valley of Elah] or [And he stood between the two battle lines]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:9 (#1)

וְהִכָּנִי & וְהִכִּיתִיו

“and he strikes me & and I strike him”

See how you translated the similar term “struck” in 4:2. Alternate translation: [and he kills me ... and I kill him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:9 (#2)

וְאִם־אֲנִי אוּכַל־לוֹ

“But if I am able against him”

Goliath is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [But if I am able to fight successfully against him] or [But if I prevail against him]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 17:9 (#3)

וְהְיִיתֶם לָנוּ לַעֲבָדִים וַעֲבַדְתֶּם אֹתָנוּ

“then you will become servants to us, and you will serve us”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. If it would be clearer in your language, you could combine them. Alternate translation: [then you will become our servants]

See: Parallelism

1 Samuel 17:10 (#2)

אֶת־מַעַרְכוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the arrays of Israel”

Goliath is using the term **arrays** to represent the soldiers who were in these battle lines. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all of you Israelite soldiers]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:10 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר הַפְּלִשְׁתִּי

“And the Philistine said”

See how you translated the term **the Philistine** in 17:8. Alternate translation: [And the Philistine warrior champion said]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:10 (#3)

וְנִלָּחֲמָה

“and let us fight”

By **us**, Goliath means himself and any Israelite soldier who will answer his challenge. If a soldier does answer his challenge, then this pronoun would not include the rest of the soldiers. However, until someone does answer the challenge, it potentially includes all of them. If your language marks a distinction between exclusive and inclusive forms of “us,” decide which one would be appropriate here.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

1 Samuel 17:11 (#1)

אֶת־דִּבְרֵי הַפְּלִשְׁתִּי הָאֵלֶּה

“these words of the Philistine”

The author is using the term **words** to represent what Goliath said by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the Philistine saying these things]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:11 (#2)

וַיֵּחַתּוּ

“and they were dismayed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in an active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and this dismayed them]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 17:12 (#2)

וְהָאִישׁ בִּימֵי שָׁאוּל

“And in the days of Saul the man”

The author is using the term **days** to represent a certain time period. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And by the time Saul had become king, the man]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:12 (#1)

וְדָוִד בֶּן־אִישׁ אֶפְרָתִי הַזֶּה מִבֵּית לֶחֶם יְהוּדָה וּשְׁמוֹ יִשַׁי

“Now David {was} the son of this Ephrathite man from Bethlehem {in} Judah, and his name {was} Jesse”

The author is reintroducing David as a participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of reintroducing participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Now there was a young man named David who was the son of a certain Ephrathite man named Jesse who lived in Bethlehem in Judah]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Samuel 17:12 (#3)

בָּבָא

“having come”

The author seems to be using a shorter form of a common expression that people in this culture used to describe a person who was very old. Compare the fuller form in Joshua 13:1, for example, “Now Joshua had aged, he had come into days.” You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [having come into days] or [having lived a long time]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 17:13 (#1)

וַיֵּלְכוּ שְׁלֹשֶׁת בְּנֵי־יִשַׁי הַגְּדֹלִים הָלְכוּ

“And the oldest three of the sons of Jesse went, they went”

Following the conventions of his language, the author is repeating the verb **went** to indicate that this action preceded the action he has just described, that of Goliath challenging the Israelites. Express this using the appropriate verbal form in your language. Alternate translation: [And the oldest three of the sons of Jesse had gone]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

1 Samuel 17:14 (#1)

הָלְכוּ אַחֲרֵי שָׁאוּל

“went after Saul”

The author means that Jesse’s three oldest sons stayed with Saul’s army. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [stayed with Saul’s army]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:16 (#1)

הַשְׁכֵּם וְהַעֲרֵב

“when} it was early and {when} it was getting dark”

The author is speaking of when it **was early** and when it **was getting dark** to represent the times of day when these things were happening. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the morning and in the evening] or [at the start and end of each day]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:17 (#1)

אֵיפַ֥ת

“an ephah of”

See how you chose to represent the quantity **ephah** in 1:24. This **ephah** was equivalent to 22 liters or nearly six gallons. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this in terms of modern measurements, either in the text or in a footnote.

See: Biblical Volume

1 Samuel 17:17 (#2)

לְאַחֶ֖יךָ

“to your brothers”

See how you translated this relationship in 16:13. Alternate translation: [to your older brothers]

See: Kinship

1 Samuel 17:18 (#2)

חֲרִצֵ֣י הֶחָלָ֔ב

“cuts of cheese”

Jesse is referring to hunks of cheese that have been cut from a large round. Your language may naturally refer to these more simply. Alternate translation: [cheeses]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 17:18 (#3)

לִשְׁלֹ֑ום

“about peace”

Jesse is using the term **peace** to mean that he wants David to inquire about his brothers’ well-being. That was one thing the term could mean. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [with regard to their well-being] or [to see how they are doing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:18 (#4)

וְאֶת־עֵרְבָּתָ֖ם תִּקָּ֑ח

“and take their pledge”

This could mean: (1) that Jesse wants David to bring back some token from each of his brothers to show that they are alive and well. In this culture, this might have been, for example, a lock of hair. Alternate translation: [and bring something back from each of them to show that they are alive and well]; (2) that Jesse wants David to settle any debts his brothers might have incurred, such as by giving a garment in pledge in exchange for food. Alternate translation: [and settle any debts they may have incurred]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:18 (#1)

וְאֶת־עֲשֶׂ֥רֶת חֲרִצֵ֛י הֶחָלָ֥ב הָאֵ֖לֶּה תָּבִ֑יא

“And bring these ten cuts of cheese”

See what you said in the similar instance in 16:20. Alternate translation: [And bring these ten cuts of cheese respectfully as a gift]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 17:19 (#1)

וְשָׁא֣וּל וְהֵ֗מָּה וְכָל־אִ֤ישׁ יִשְׂרָאֵל֙ בְּעֵ֣מֶק הָאֵלָ֔ה נִלְחָמִ֖ים עִם־פְּלִשְׁתִּֽים

“Now Saul and they and all of the men of Israel {are} in the Valley of Elah, fighting with the Philistines”

It is possible that this sentence is not part of Jesse’s instructions to David, telling him where to find his brothers, but instead a statement by the author that resumes the action at the scene of the battle. If you follow that interpretation in your translation, end the direct quotation at the end of the previous verse and say “were” instead of **are** here.

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Samuel 17:20 (#1)

וַיִּשָּׂ֑א

“And he carried”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the

context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And he carried the grain, bread, and cheese]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 17:20 (#2)

הַמַּעְגָּלָה

“to} the wagon-track”

The author is using the term **wagon-track** to represent the defensive circle of supply wagons that the Israelites had created around their camp. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to the defensive circle of supply wagons around the camp]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:22 (#1)

עַל־יַד

“in the hand of”

The author is using the term **hand** to represent custody or care. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the custody of]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:22 (#2)

לְשָׁלוֹם

“about peace”

See how you translated this expression in 17:18. Alternate translation: [how they were doing] or [if they were well]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:23 (#5)

גָּלְיָתָ֨ת הַפְּלִשְׁתִּ֜י

“Goliath the Philistine”

See how you translated this name in 17:8. Alternate translation: [Goliath, the Philistine warrior champion]

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 17:23 (#3)

אִ֣ישׁ הַבֵּנַ֗יִם

“the man of the betweens”

See how you translated this expression in 17:4. Alternate translation: [a warrior champion]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 17:23 (#1)

וְהוּא ׀ מְדַבֵּ֣ר עִמָּ֗ם וְהִנֵּ֨ה אִישׁ֩ הַבֵּנַ֜יִם עוֹלֶ֗ה

“And he was speaking with them, and behold, the man of the betweens was coming up”

The words that the ULT translates as **And ... and** indicate that these events happened at the same time. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could describe the time relationship more explicitly. Alternate translation: [And while he was speaking with them, behold, the man of the betweens came up]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

1 Samuel 17:23 (#2)

וְהִנֵּ֨ה

“and behold”

See how you translated the term **behold** in 2:31. The author is using this term to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say.

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 17:23 (#4)

עוֹלֶ֗ה

“was coming up”

The author may mean that Goliath had come down from the Philistine camp on the opposite hill down into the valley and was now **coming up** the slope of the hill toward the Israelite camp, symbolically demonstrating that he was not afraid of any of the Israelite soldiers. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [was tauntingly coming up the slope toward the Israelite camp]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 17:23 (#6)

כַּדְּבָרִ֣ים הָאֵ֔לֶּה

“like these words”

The author is using a common expression of his culture. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as he had before]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 17:24 (#1)

וַיָּנֻ֖סוּ מִפָּנָ֑יו וַיִּירְא֖וּ מְאֹֽד

“then they fled from his face and feared greatly”

The author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. In your translation, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [then they feared greatly and fled from his face]

See: Order of Events

1 Samuel 17:25 (#2)

יַעְשְׁרֶ֥נּוּ & עֹ֖שֶׁר גָּד֑וֹל

“will make him wealthy {with} great wealth”

For emphasis, the soldiers are using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [will make him fabulously wealthy]

See: Poetry

1 Samuel 17:25 (#1)

הֲרִאיתֶ֖ם הָאִ֣ישׁ הָעֹלֶ֑ה הַזֶּ֔ה

“Have you seen this man coming up”

The soldiers are using the question form for emphasis. If speakers of your language would not use questions for this purpose, you could translate this as a statement or exclamation. Alternate translation: [Look at this man who is coming up!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 17:25 (#3)

וְאֶת־בִּתּ֖וֹ יִתֶּן־לֽוֹ

“and he will give his daughter to him”

The soldiers mean that Saul would give his daughter in marriage. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and he will give his daughter to him in marriage] or [and he will give his daughter to him as a wife]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:25 (#4)

וְאֶת֨ בֵּ֤ית אָבִיו֙ יַעֲשֶׂ֣ה חָפְשִׁ֔שִׁי

“and he will make the house of his father free”

The soldiers are using a common expression of their culture to mean that someone’s family would be exempt from taxes and service. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he will exempt him and the members of his family from paying taxes and doing obligatory service]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 17:26 (#5)

הַפְּלִשְׁתִּ֥י הֶֽעָרֵ֖ל הַזֶּ֑ה

“is} this uncircumcised Philistine”

See how you translated this expression in 14:6. Alternate translation: [this heathen Philistine]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:26 (#1)

מַה־יֵּעָשֶׂ֔ה

“What will be done”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in an active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [What will the king do]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 17:26 (#3)

כִּ֣י

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces a further consideration. Alternate translation: [After all]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 17:26 (#4)

מִ֠י הַפְּלִשְׁתִּ֨י הֶֽעָרֵ֜ל הַזֶּ֗ה כִּֽי־חֵרֵ֙ף֙ מַעַרְכ֣וֹת אֱלֹהִ֔ים חַיִּֽים

“who {is} this uncircumcised Philistine, that he should taunt the arrays of the living God”

David is using the question form for emphasis. If speakers of your language would not use questions for this purpose, you could translate this as a statement or exclamation. Alternate translation: [this uncircumcised Philistine cannot rightfully taunt the arrays of the living God!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 17:26 (#2)

וְהֵסִ֥יר חֶרְפָּ֖ה מֵעַ֣ל יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“and turns away the disgrace from upon Israel”

David is speaking as if disgrace were a physical object that someone could turn **away** from the Israelites. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [so that we Israelites are not disgraced any more]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 17:27 (#1)

הָעָֽם

“the people”

See how you translated the term “people” in 13:2 and in its frequent occurrences in chapter 13, chapter 14, and chapter 15. Alternate translation: [the soldiers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:27 (#2)

כַּדָּבָ֣ר הַזֶּ֔ה

“like this word”

See how you translated the similar expression in 17:23. Alternate translation: [as the others had]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 17:27 (#3)

יֵעָשֶׂ֖ה

“it will be done”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in an active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the king will do]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 17:28 (#1)

וַיִּֽחַר־אַ֤ף אֱלִיאָב֙ בְּדָוִ֔ד

“And the nose of Eliab burned against David”

See how you translated the similar expression in 11:6. Alternate translation: [And Eliab became very angry with David]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:28 (#5)

וְאֵ֖ת רֹ֣עַ לְבָבֶ֑ךָ

“and the evil of your heart”

Eliab is speaking using David’s **heart** to represent his intentions. The context suggests that Eliab is not accusing David of planning an outright crime but of meddling with bad motives. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and how naughty your intentions are]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 17:28 (#2)

לָמָּה־זֶּ֥ה יָרַ֖דְתָּ וְעַל־מִ֣י נָטַ֗שְׁתָּ מְעַ֛ט הַצֹּ֥אן הָהֵ֖נָּה בַּמִּדְבָּ֑ר

“Why {is} this, you have come down? And with whom have you left those few sheep in the wilderness”

Eliab is using these questions for emphasis. If speakers of your language would not use questions for this purpose, you could translate these as statements or exclamations. Alternate translation: [You have no good reason for coming here! And it was irresponsible of you to leave those few sheep alone in the wilderness!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 17:28 (#3)

וְעַל־מִ֣י נָטַ֗שְׁתָּ מְעַ֛ט הַצֹּ֥אן הָהֵ֖נָּה בַּמִּדְבָּ֑ר

“And with whom have you left those few sheep in the wilderness”

In order to make David look and feel insignificant, Eliab is deliberately exaggerating how **few sheep** their father Jesse has. (The fact that Jesse has been able to spare ten cheeses as a gift to Eliab’s commander suggests that he actually has a substantial flock of sheep.) If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [Your responsibilities caring for our father’s sheep are not significant, but you should still not have left his sheep alone in the wilderness]

See: Hyperbole

1 Samuel 17:28 (#4)

אֶת־זְדֹנְךָ֖

“your presumption”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **presumption**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [how you presume that you can go to places where you really have no right to be]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 17:28 (#7)

לְמַעַן רְאֹות הַמִּלְחָמָה יָרַדְתָּ

“you have come down in order to see the battle”

See the discussion of this statement in the Introduction to this chapter.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:28 (#6)

כִּי

“for”

Here the word **for** introduces a further consideration. Alternate translation: [after all]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 17:29 (#1)

מֶה עָשִׂיתִי עָתָּה הֲלֹוא דָבָר הִוא

“What have I done now? {Was} it not a word”

David is using these questions for emphasis. If speakers of your language would not use questions for that purpose, you could translate these as statements. Alternate translation: [I did not do anything wrong just now. It was only a word.]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 17:29 (#2)

דָּבָר

“a word”

David is using the term **word** to represent what he said to the other soldiers by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [a question]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:30 (#1)

וַיִּסֹּב מֵאֶצְלוֹ

“And he turned from beside him”

The pronoun **he** refers to David, while the pronoun **him** refers to Eliab. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And David turned from beside Eliab] or [And David turned away from Eliab]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 17:30 (#2)

אֶל־מִמּוּל אַחֵר

“toward the front of another”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean to face someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to face another soldier]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 17:30 (#3)

וַיֹּאמֶר כַּדָּבָר הַזֶּה וַיְשִׁבֻהוּ הָעָם דָּבָר כַּדָּבָר הָרִאשׁוֹן

“and he spoke like this word. And the people returned to him a word like the first word”

See how you translated the similar expression in 17:23. Alternate translation: [and he asked him the same question that he had asked others. And that man and the soldiers around him answered David the same way the other soldiers had]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 17:31 (#4)

וַיִּקָּחֻהוּ

“and he got him”

The pronoun **he** refers to Saul, while the pronoun **him** refers to David. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and Saul got David] or [and Saul sent someone to get David]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 17:31 (#1)

וַיִּשָּׁמְעוּ

“And they heard”

Here the author is not using the pronoun **they** to refer to specific people, although the context shows that it refers to people who had access to Saul. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And people heard] or [And some officers heard]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 17:31 (#2)

הַדְּבָרִים אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר דָּוִד

“the words that David spoke”

The author is using the term **words** to represent the question David was asking by using words. If it

would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the question that David was asking]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:31 (#3)

וַיַּגִּדוּ לִפְנֵי־שָׁאוּל

“And they declared to the face of Saul”

The author is using one part of Saul, his **face**, to mean all of him in the act of receiving this report personally. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And they told Saul personally]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 17:32 (#1)

אַל־יִפֹּל לֵב־אָדָם עָלָיו

“Do not let the heart of a man fall because of him”

David is speaking as if a person’s **heart** could physically **fall**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [No one should lose heart because of him] or [No one should be terrified of him]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 17:32 (#2)

עַבְדְּךָ

“Your servant”

David is speaking humbly about himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [I, your servant,]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 17:33 (#1)

לֹא תוּכַל לָלֶכֶת אֶל־הַפְּלִשְׁתִּי הַזֶּה לְהִלָּחֵם עִמּוֹ כִּי־נַעַר אַתָּה וְהוּא אִישׁ מִלְחָמָה מִנְּעֻרָיו

“You are not able to go against this Philistine to fight with him. For you {are} a youth, but he, a man of war from his youth”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Because you are a youth and he has been a man of war from his youth, you are not able to go against this Philistine to fight with him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 17:33 (#2)

וְהוּא אִישׁ מִלְחָמָה מִנְּעֻרָיו

“but he, a man of war from his youth”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but he has been a man of war from his youth]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 17:34 (#1)

רֹעֶה הָיָה עַבְדְּךָ לְאָבִיו בַּצֹּאן

“Your servant has been tending the flock for his father”

David is speaking about himself humbly in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [I, your servant, have been tending the flock for my father]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 17:35 (#1)

וְהִצַּלְתִּי מִפִּיו

“and delivered from its mouth”

David is using the term **mouth** to represent that the lion or bear wanted to devour the sheep that it carried away. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and delivered the sheep that it wanted to devour]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:35 (#3)

וְהִכֹּתִיו & וְהִכְּתִתָיו

“and struck it & and strike it”

The context shows that here the terms **struck** and **strike** refer to hitting a lion or bear, at first to get it to release a sheep, and then, if necessary, repeatedly in order to kill it. David probably means that he hit these animals with his shepherd’s staff; 17:40 suggests that he was used to using this staff as a weapon. Alternate

translation: [and hit it with my staff ... and hit it repeatedly]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:35 (#2)

בְּזְקָנּוֹ

“its beard”

David is using the term **beard** to represent the lower jaw where the beard grows. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [its lower jaw]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:36 (#5)

הַפְּלִשְׁתִּי הֶעָרֵל הַזֶּה

“this uncircumcised Philistine”

See how you translated this expression in 14:6. Alternate translation: [this heathen Philistine]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:36 (#2)

הִכָּה

“has struck”

Here the context shows that the term **struck** means “killed,” as it often does elsewhere in the book. Alternate translation: [has killed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:36 (#1)

הִכָּה עַבְדֶּךָ

“Your servant has struck”

David is speaking about himself humbly in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [I, your servant, have struck]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 17:36 (#3)

גַּם אֶת־הָאֲרִי גַּם־הַדֹּב

“both the lion and the bear”

David is not referring to specific animals. He means such animals in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using plural forms. Alternate translation: [both lions and bears]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 17:36 (#4)

וְֽהָיָה הַפְּלִשְׁתִּי הֶעָרֵל הַזֶּה כְּאַחַד מֵהֶם כִּי חֵרֵף מַעַרְכֹת אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים

“and this uncircumcised Philistine will be like one of them, for he has taunted the arrays of the living God”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [and since this uncircumcised Philistine has taunted the armies of the living God, he will be like one of them]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 17:37 (#1)

מִיַּד הָאֲרִי וּמִיַּד הַדֹּב & מִיַּד הַפְּלִשְׁתִּי הַזֶּה

“from the hand of the lion and from the hand of the bear & from the hand of this Philistine”

David is using the term **hand** to represent power. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from the power of the lion and from the power of the bear ... from the power of this Philistine]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:37 (#2)

וְיהוָה יִהְיֶה עִמָּךְ

“and may Yahweh be with you”

See how you translated the similar expression in 3:19. Alternate translation: [and may Yahweh help you]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 17:38 (#1)

מַדָּיו

“with} his garments”

The author assumes that his readers will know that by **garments**, he means clothing that was designed for soldiers to wear under armor. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [with his military tunic]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:38 (#2)

שִׁרְיֹון

“with} a coat”

See how you translated this expression in 17:5, where the author uses the fuller expression “a coat of scales.” Alternate translation: [with armor made of metal plates]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:39 (#2)

וַיֹּ֣אֶל לָלֶ֔כֶת כִּֽי־לֹ֥א נִסָּ֖הוּ & לֹ֣א אוּכַ֑ל לָלֶ֣כֶת בָּאֵ֔לֶּה כִּ֥י לֹ֖א נִסִּ֥יתִי

“and he tried to walk, for he had not tested {them & I am not able to walk with these, for I have not tested {them”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [and because he had not tested them, he tried to walk … because I have not tested them, I am not able to walk with these]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 17:39 (#1)

אֶת־חַ֨רְבּ֜וֹ מֵעַ֣ל לְמַדָּ֗יו

“his sword over his garments”

The first pronoun **his** refers to Saul, while the second **his** refers to David. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Saul’s sword over the garments he was wearing]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 17:40 (#1)

בִּכְלִ֣י הָרֹעִ֗ים אֲשֶׁר־לֹ֛ו וּבַיַּלְקוּט֖

“in the bag of shepherds that {was} to him, even in the pouch”

Recognizing that his readers might not be familiar with the kind of **bag** that **shepherds** carried, the author explains this with a term that he feels they are likely to recognize, **pouch**. That term describes a small leather bag that people in this culture would use to carry provisions and personal belongings when they went on a journey. To help your own readers understand what a **bag of shepherds** was, you could indicate how the author is defining it here. Alternate translation: [in his shepherd’s bag, which was a small leather pouch]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 17:41 (#1)

וַיֵּ֤לֶךְ הַפְּלִשְׁתִּי֙ הֹלֵ֣ךְ וְקָרֵ֔ב אֶל־דָּוִ֖ד

“And the Philistine came, coming and near to David”

Following the conventions of his language, the author is repeating forms of the verb “came” to indicate progressive action. Express this using the appropriate verbal form in your language. Alternate translation: [And the Philistine kept coming nearer to David]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

1 Samuel 17:41 (#2)

וַיֵּ֤לֶךְ הַפְּלִשְׁתִּי֙ הֹלֵ֣ךְ וְקָרֵ֔ב אֶל־דָּוִ֖ד

“And the Philistine came, coming and near to David”

There could be a suggestion here that Goliath had to walk slowly and deliberately because of the heavy armor he was wearing, in contrast to the way David “ran … to meet him” in 17:48. Alternate translation: [And the Philistine lumbered slowly toward David]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:41 (#3)

הֹלֵ֣ךְ וְקָרֵ֔ב

“coming and near”

This expression conveys a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **near** tells for what purpose Goliath was **coming**. Alternate translation: [coming near] or [approaching]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 17:41 (#4)

לְפָנָֽיו

“was} to his face”

See how you translated this expression in 17:7. Alternate translation: [was in front of him]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:42 (#2)

וַיַּבֵּ֥ט הַפְּלִשְׁתִּ֖י וַיַּרְא֣ אֶת־דָּוִ֑ד כִּֽי־הָיָ֥ה נַ֙עַר֙ וְאַדְמֹנִ֣י עִם־יְפֵ֔ה מַרְאֶֽה

“and he despised him, for he was a youth, and ruddy with a beautiful appearance”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [and because he was a youth, and ruddy with a beautiful appearance, he despised him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 17:42 (#1)

וַיַּבֵּט הַפְּלִשְׁתִּי וַיִּרְאֶה אֶת־דָּוִד

“And the Philistine looked and saw David”

The terms **looked** and **saw** mean similar things. The author is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [And the Philistine looked David over]

See: Doublet

1 Samuel 17:43 (#1)

הֲכֶלֶב אָנֹכִי כִּי־אַתָּה בָא־אֵלַי בַּמַּקלוֹת

“Am} I a dog, that you are coming to me with sticks”

Goliath is using the question form for emphasis. If speakers of your language would not use questions for this purpose, you could translate this as a statement or exclamation. Alternate translation: [You seem to think that you can defeat me with just a stick, as if I were a dog!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 17:44 (#3)

לְעוֹף הַשָּׁמַיִם וּלְבֶהֱמַת הַשָּׂדֶה

“to the bird of the heavens and to the beast of the field”

Goliath is not referring to specific animals. He means these animals in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using plural forms. Alternate translation: [to the birds of the sky and the wild animals]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 17:44 (#1)

אֶת־בְּשָׂרְךָ

“your flesh”

Goliath is using one part of David, his **flesh**, to mean all of him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your body]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 17:44 (#2)

אֶת־בְּשָׂרְךָ

“your flesh”

Goliath means that he will give David’s flesh as food to the birds and animals. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [your flesh as food]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:44 (#4)

לְעוֹף הַשָּׁמַיִם

“to the bird of the heavens”

This phrase describes birds that fly in the **heavens**, that is, the sky. In this context, it refers specifically to scavenger birds that would circle in the sky looking for dead animals or people to eat. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to scavenger birds]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:45 (#1)

בְּשֵׁם

“in the name of”

Here the term **name** could mean: (1) authority. David could be indicating that as a soldier representing the **arrays of Israel**, which **Yahweh** ultimately commands, he is fighting Goliath with a commission from Yahweh, as if Yahweh had authorized him to use his name in order to invoke his authority. Alternate translation: [with the authority of]; (2) reputation. David could be indicating that by defeating Goliath, he will be defending the reputation of Yahweh as the all-powerful God, whom no other god can defeat. (Goliath has just called on his gods to defeat David.) Alternate translation: [to uphold the reputation of]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:45 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר חֵרַפְתָּ

“which you have taunted”

The context suggests that David is saying that Goliath has **taunted** the **arrays of Israel**, since that is what Goliath himself says in 17:10, what the Israelite soldiers say in 17:25, and what David says in 17:26 and in 17:36. However, David could also be saying that Goliath has taunted **Yahweh of Armies, the God of the arrays of Israel**, since to say that his armies cannot win is to say that Yahweh is not able to make them win. If you follow that interpretation, use a personal pronoun here. Alternate translation: [whom you have taunted]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:46 (#1)

יְסַגֶּרְךָ֨ & בְּיָדִ֜י

“will enclose you in my hand”

David is speaking as if Goliath were an object that could be enclosed in his hand. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will give you into my power] or [will enable me to overpower you]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 17:46 (#2)

וְנָ֨תַתִּ֜י

“And & I will give”

David is using himself to represent all the Israelite soldiers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And ... we will give] or [And ... we Israelite soldiers will give]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 17:46 (#5)

לְעֹ֣וף הַשָּׁמַ֗יִם וּלְחַיַּ֥ת הָאָ֛רֶץ

“to the bird of the heavens and to the animal of the earth”

See how you translated the similar expression in 17:44. Alternate translation: [to the birds of the sky and the wild animals]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 17:46 (#6)

וְיֵדְעוּ֙ כָּל־הָאָ֔רֶץ

“And all of the earth will know”

David is using the term **earth** to represent the people living on the earth. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And all of the people on earth will know]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:46 (#8)

יֵ֣שׁ אֱלֹהִ֔ים לְיִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל

“there is a God to Israel”

David means that Israel has the one true God. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Israel has a real God] or [the only true God is the God of Israel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:46 (#3)

פֶּ֚גֶר

“the corpse of”

David is not referring to a specific corpse. He means corpses in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using a plural form. Alternate translation: [the corpses of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 17:46 (#4)

מַחֲנֵ֣ה פְלִשְׁתִּ֔ים

“the camp of the Philistines”

The author is using the term **camp** to represent the army that is staying in the camp. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the army of the Philistines]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:46 (#7)

וְיֵדְעוּ֙ כָּל־הָאָ֔רֶץ

“And all of the earth will know”

David is making a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [And people all over the world will know]

See: Hyperbole

1 Samuel 17:47 (#1)

כִּֽי

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces a further consideration. Alternate translation: [After all]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 17:47 (#2)

אֶתְכֶ֔ם

“you”

The word **you** is plural here because David is using it to mean all of the Philistine soldiers, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Samuel 17:47 (#3)

בְּיָדֵ֑נוּ

“into our hand”

David is using the term **hand** to represent power or control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [into our power]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:48 (#2)

קָ֣ם

“arose”

See how you translated this expression in 1:9. Alternate translation: [took action]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 17:48 (#3)

וַיֵּ֣לֶךְ וַיִּקְרַ֗ב & וַיְמַהֵ֛ר & וַיָּ֥רָץ

“and went and approached & that & hurried and ran”

These expressions each convey a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **approached** tells for what purpose Goliath **went**, and the word **hurried** tells in what David **ran**. Alternate translation: [and came closer ... that ... ran hurriedly]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 17:48 (#1)

וְהָיָה֙

“And it happened”

The author is using this phrase to introduce a new development in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method here that is natural in your language for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 17:50 (#3)

וַיַּ֤ךְ אֶת־הַפְּלִשְׁתִּי֙ וַיְמִיתֵ֔הוּ

“And he struck the Philistine and killed him”

The author is introducing a new development in the story. He is telling what happened after the end of the fight between David and Goliath. Use a word, phrase, or other method here that is natural in your language for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 17:50 (#4)

הַפְּלִשְׁתִּ֖י

“the Philistine”

See how you translated this expression in 17:8. Alternate translation: [the Philistine warrior champion]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:50 (#1)

וַיֶּחֱזַ֥ק דָּוִ֛ד מִן־הַפְּלִשְׁתִּ֖י בַּקֶּ֣לַע וּבָאֶ֑בֶן

“So David was stronger than the Philistine with the sling and with the stone”

Here the author is offering a concluding summary of the fight between David and Goliath. Your language may have its own way of presenting such information.

See: End of Story

1 Samuel 17:50 (#5)

וְחֶ֖רֶב אֵ֥ין בְּיַד־דָּוִֽד

“Now no sword {was} in the hand of David”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what he describes next. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 17:50 (#2)

וַיֶּחֱזַ֥ק דָּוִ֖ד מִן־הַפְּלִשְׁתִּ֑י

“So David was stronger than the Philistine”

The author is using the phrase **was stronger than** to represent that David, through greater force (since Yahweh was helping him to defend his own glory), prevailed over Goliath in this battle. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [So David prevailed over the Philistine]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:51 (#1)

וַיִּקַּ֣ח אֶת־חַרְבּ֗וֹ וַיִּשְׁלְפָ֙הּ֙ מִתַּעְרָ֔הּ וַיְמִתֻ֖הוּ וַיִּכְרֹ֣ת־בָּ֑הּ אֶת־רֹאשׁ֔וֹ

“and took his sword and drew it from its sheath and killed him and cut off his head with it”

In two cases here, the author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. In your translation, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [and drew his sword from its sheath and took it and cut off his head with it and killed him]

See: Order of Events

1 Samuel 17:52 (#4)

וַיִּפְּל֥וּ חַלְלֵ֛י פְּלִשְׁתִּ֖ים

“And the pierced of the Philistines fell”

The author is using the term **pierced** to represent killed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And the Philistines whom the Israelites had killed with their swords]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:52 (#1)

וַיָּקֻ֖מוּ

“And & arose”

See how you translated this expression in 1:9. Alternate translation: [And ... took action]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 17:52 (#2)

וַיָּרִ֣עוּ וַיִּרְדְּפ֔וּ

“and they shouted and pursued”

This expression conveys a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **shouted** tells in what way they **pursued**. Alternate translation: [and they pursued shoutingly] or [and they pursued with battle cries]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 17:52 (#3)

וַיִּפְּל֥וּ חַלְלֵ֛י פְּלִשְׁתִּ֖ים

“And the pierced of the Philistines fell”

The author is using the adjective **pierced** as a noun to mean Philistines who were pierced with swords. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [And the Philistines whom the Israelites had pierced with their swords]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 17:53 (#1)

וַיָּשֻׁ֖בוּ בְּנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“And the sons of Israel returned”

See how you translated this phrase in 2:28. Alternate translation: [And the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 17:54 (#1)

וַיִּקַּ֣ח דָּוִד֮ אֶת־רֹאשׁ֣ הַפְּלִשְׁתִּי֒ וַיְבִאֵ֣הוּ יְרוּשָׁלִָ֔ם וְאֶת־כֵּלָ֖יו שָׂ֣ם בְּאָהֳלֽוֹ

“And David took the head of the Philistine, and he brought it {to} Jerusalem, and he put his equipment in his tent”

Here the author is saying what happened at the end of the story of David’s victory over Goliath. Your language may have its own way of presenting such information.

See: End of Story

1 Samuel 17:54 (#2)

וַיְבִאֵ֣הוּ יְרוּשָׁלִָ֔ם

“and he brought it {to} Jerusalem”

This could mean: (1) that David later brought Goliath’s head to Jerusalem, once he had become king and captured the city. He apparently put it in Yahweh’s sanctuary as a trophy of war, commemorating how Yahweh had enabled him and the Israelites to win this victory. Alternate translation: [and he later brought it to Jerusalem and put it in Yahweh’s sanctuary as a trophy of war]; (2) that at this time David brought

Goliath's head to a place near Jerusalem, specifically to Nob, where the sacred tent was at this time. The story indicates in 21:9 that Goliath's sword was there, similarly as a war trophy, and David may also have brought or sent Goliath's head there. Alternate translation: [and he brought it to Nob, near Jerusalem, where the sacred tent was]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 17:54 (#3)

וְאֶת־כֵּלָ֖יו שָׂ֥ם בְּאָהֳלֽוֹ

"and he put his equipment in his tent"

This could mean: (1) that David brought Goliath's **equipment** (that is, his armor and weapons) home with him when he returned to Bethlehem. There is no indication that David had a **tent** among the Israelite soldiers who had camped by the Valley of Elah. The story says that he was usually tending his father's flock in Bethlehem but occasionally went to the battle lines to bring provisions to his brothers and to bring back news from them. But he may well have had a tent of his own within his father's compound. Alternate translation: [and he brought Goliath's armor and weapons back home with him]; (2) that David put Goliath's equipment in Yahweh's tent, that is, the sacred tent at Nob. The story indicates in 21:9 that Goliath's sword was there. Alternate translation: [and he put his equipment in Yahweh's sacred tent]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 17:55 (#2)

חֵי־נַפְשְׁךָ֣ הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ אִם־יָדָ֖עְתִּי

"The life of your soul, O king, if I know"

Following the custom of his culture, Abner is swearing an oath by guaranteeing it by something he holds sacred. Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. Alternate translation: [I swear by your life, O King, that I do not know]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Samuel 17:55 (#1)

חֵי־נַפְשְׁךָ֣ הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ אִם־יָדָ֖עְתִּי

"The life of your soul, O king, if I know"

Abner is using one part of Saul, his **soul**, to mean all of him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Your life, O king, if I know]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 17:57 (#1)

לִפְנֵ֖י שָׁא֑וּל

"to the face of Saul"

The author is using the term **face** to represent presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [into the presence of Saul]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:57 (#2)

וְרֹ֣אשׁ הַפְּלִשְׁתִּ֔י בְּיָדֽוֹ

"And the head of the Philistine {was} in his hand"

The author is using the term **hand** to represent possession or control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And the head of the Philistine {was} in his possession] or [And he was holding the head of the Philistine]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 17:58 (#1)

בֶּן

"The son of"

David is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [I am the son of]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel - Chapter 18 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the part of the book that describes how David became king (chapters 16–31). It describes how Saul became jealous of David's success as a military leader and how Saul became suspicious that David was the person whom Yahweh had chosen to become king instead of him. It relates how Saul tried to kill David both directly, by throwing his spear at him, and indirectly, by getting him to fight the Philistines in dangerous situations. But Yahweh protected David and made him successful, so Saul became even more jealous and suspicious.

Some translations set each line of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with the poetic song in 18:7.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Jonathan's love for David
The author says in 18:1 that Jonathan "loved" David. If your language has more than one term for "love," be sure not to use a term that describes sexual attraction. Biblical Hebrew has specific language for sexual desire, and the author does not use that language here. Rather, he says that "the soul of Jonathan was bound with the soul of David." By this he means that Jonathan recognized that David was a man who was like him in terms of character, and so he wanted to be his friend. (As a traditional saying puts it, "A friend is another self.") Jonathan had demonstrated bold faith and strong trust in Yahweh by attacking the Philistine garrison in chapter 14, and David had demonstrated the same things by fighting Goliath in chapter 17. So Jonathan recognized David as a man of courage and daring, and he knew that if they were friends, they would encourage each other to trust Yahweh and continue to do bold exploits. If your language has a word for friendship-love, it would be appropriate to use that word here in your translation. You could also use a word for unselfish love. (One ancient Greek version uses the verb here from which the New Testament writers developed the noun agape for unselfish love.)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"I am lightly esteemed" (18:23)
In 18:23, when Saul's servants tell David that Saul will allow him to marry his daughter Michal, David replies, "I am a poor man, and I am lightly esteemed." Since the servants tell David in 18:22 that they all love him, and the author says in 18:16 that all the Israelites loved David, it seems unlikely that David means that he is lightly esteemed by people in general or by the people in Saul's court specifically. Instead, David may be referring implicitly to the way Saul previously promised to allow him to marry his other daughter Merab but then allowed a different man, Adriel the Meholathite, to marry her instead. In other words, David may mean, "I am lightly esteemed by King Saul." (Some interpreters suggest that Adriel may have offered a large bride-price for Merab and that is why Saul let him marry her. This would explain why David says he is "a poor man" himself.) However, in this culture, a person would not complain explicitly that the king had treated him with disrespect or disregard. That is why David makes what seems to be an indirect statement to that effect. You may find a way to suggest this meaning implicitly in your translation.

1 Samuel 18:1 (#2)

כְּכַלֹּתוֹ לְדַבֵּר

"when he finished speaking"

The pronoun **he** refers to David. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [when David finished speaking]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 18:1 (#3)

וְנֶפֶשׁ יְהוֹנָתָן נִקְשְׁרָה בְּנֶפֶשׁ דָּוִד

"that the soul of Jonathan was bound with the soul of David"

The author is speaking as if souls could be physically **bound** together. He means that Jonathan formed a very close friendship with David. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that Jonathan became very close friends with David]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 18:1 (#4)

כְּנַפְשׁוֹ

"as his soul"

The author is using one part of Jonathan, his **soul**, to mean all of him, by reference to what was most essential about him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as he loved himself]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 18:1 (#1)

וַיְהִי

"And it happened"

See how you translated the phrase "And it happened" in 1:12.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 18:2 (#1)

וַיִּקָּחֵהוּ שָׁאוּל

"And Saul took him"

The author assumes that his readers will know that by **Saul took him**, he means that Saul took David into his service. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And Saul took David into his service]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 18:3 (#1)

וַיִּכְרֹ֨ת יְהוֹנָתָ֜ן וְדָוִ֗ד בְּרִ֫ית בְּאַהֲבָתֹ֥ו אֹתֹ֛ו כְּנַפְשֹֽׁו׃

“And Jonathan cut a covenant with David because he loved him as his own soul”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And because Jonathan loved David as he loved himself, he cut a covenant with him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 18:3 (#2)

וַיִּכְרֹ֨ת & בְּרִ֫ית

“And & cut a covenant”

See how you translated this expression in 11:1. Alternate translation: [And made a covenant]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 18:4 (#1)

וַיִּתְפַּשֵּׁ֣שט יְהוֹנָתָ֗ן אֶת־הַמְּעִ֤יללֹ֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר עָלָ֔יו וַיִּתְּנֵ֖הוּ לְדָוִ֑ד וּמַדָּ֙יו֙ וְעַד־חַרְבֹּ֣ו וְעַד־קַשְׁתֹּ֔ו וְעַד־חֲגֹרֹֽו׃

“And Jonathan stripped himself {of} the robe that {was} on him, and he gave it to David, and his garments, and even his sword and even his bow and even his belt”

This was a symbolic action by which Jonathan pledged to protect David and provide for him as a faithful friend. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [And to show that as a faithful friend he would protect David and provide for him, Jonathan took off the robe he was wearing and gave it to David, along with his military tunic, his sword, his bow, and his belt]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 18:4 (#2)

וּמַדָּ֙יו֙

“and his garments”

The expression **garments** means the same thing here as in 17:38. See how you translated it there. Alternate translation: [and his military tunic]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 18:4 (#3)

וְעַד־חַרְבֹּ֣ו וְעַד־קַשְׁתֹּ֔ו וְעַד־חֲגֹרֹֽו׃

“and even his sword and even his bow and even his belt”

Since this **belt** would have been used to hold on a **sword**, as in 17:38, you may wish to put these terms together. Alternate translation: [and even his sword and belt and even his bow]

See: Information Structure

1 Samuel 18:5 (#2)

וַיִּיטַ֥ב בְּעֵינֵ֖י כָּל־הָעָ֑ם וְגַ֗ם בְּעֵינֵי֙ עַבְדֵ֣י שָׁא֔וּל

“And he was good in the eyes of all of the people and also in the eyes of the servants of Saul”

This could mean: (1) that **he** (David) was **good in the eyes** of the people and Saul’s servants. Alternate translation: [And the Israelites in general and Saul’s officers and officials in particular had a high regard for David]; (2) that “it” (Saul appointing David as a military commander) was **good in the eyes** of the people and Saul’s servants. Alternate translation: [And the Israelites in general and Saul’s officers and officials in particular approved of Saul making David a military commander]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 18:5 (#3)

בְּעֵינֵ֖י & בְּעֵינֵי֙

“in the eyes of & in the eyes of”

See how you translated this expression in 8:6. Alternate translation: [in the opinion of … in the opinion of]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 18:5 (#1)

וַיֵּצֵ֤א דָוִד֙ בְּכֹ֣לֹ אֲשֶׁ֔ר יִשְׁלָחֶ֖נּוּ שָׁא֑וּללֹ֙

“And David went out. In all that Saul sent him”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And David went out to war. In all that Saul sent him to do]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 18:6 (#2)

מֵהַכֹּ֥ות

“from striking”

See how you translated the term **striking** in 4:10. Alternate translation: [from destroying]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 18:6 (#3)

אֶת־הַפְּלִשְׁתִּי

“the Philistine”

Since the author is referring to a group of people, it may be more natural in your language to use the plural form of **Philistine**. Alternate translation: [the Philistines]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Samuel 18:6 (#6)

בְּתֻפִּים בְּשִׂמְחָה וּבְשָׁלִשִׁים

“with tambourines, with joy, and with triples”

It may be more natural in your language to put the information about **joy** first so that the information about the musical instruments will be together. Alternate translation: [with joy, with tambourines and triples]

See: Information Structure

1 Samuel 18:6 (#4)

מִכָּל־עָרֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“from all of the cities of Israel”

The author is making a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [from many cities in Israel]

See: Hyperbole

1 Samuel 18:6 (#5)

לָשׁוּר וְהַמְּחֹלֹלוֹת

“to sing and the dances”

This expression conveys a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **dances** tells what these women were doing while they were singing. (Some interpreters suggest that the text here originally read as in 29:5, “sing in the dances.” That would have the same meaning.) Alternate translation: [to sing while dancing]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 18:6 (#7)

בְּשִׂמְחָה

“with joy”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of joy, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [joyfully]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 18:6 (#1)

בְּבוֹאָם

“when they came”

The pronoun **they** refers to Saul and his army. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [when Saul and his whole army came back to Israel]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 18:6 (#8)

בְּתֻפִּים

“with tambourines”

A tambourine is a small drum with pieces of metal around its edges that make noise when the drum is shaken. If your readers would not be familiar with what **tambourines** are, in your translation you could use the name of a similar instrument that your readers would recognize, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [with small drums]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 18:6 (#9)

וּבְשָׁלִשִׁים

“and with triples”

The author could be using the expression **triples** to describe either a lute with three strings or a hanging metal triangle that women would sound by striking it with a stick. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate one of these possibilities in your translation. Alternate translation: [and with three-stringed lutes] or [and with triangles]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 18:7 (#1)

וַתְּאַמַּרְנָה

“and said”

The expression **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this expression explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 18:7 (#2)

הִכָּה שָׁאוּל

“Saul has struck”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:2. Alternate translation: [Saul has killed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 18:7 (#3)

באלפו וְדָוִד בְּרִבְבֹתָיו

“his thousands, and David his myriads”

The women are using the adjectives **thousands** and **myriads** as nouns to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [thousands of soldiers, and David myriads of soldiers]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 18:7 (#4)

וְדָוִד בְּרִבְבֹתָיו

“and David his myriads”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and David has struck his myriads] or [and David has killed myriads of soldiers]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 18:7 (#5)

בְּרִבְבֹתָיו

“his myriads”

Translate this number according to the conventions of your own language and culture. Alternate translation: [his ten thousands]

See: Numbers

1 Samuel 18:8 (#1)

וַיִּחַר לְשָׁאאוּל מְאֹד

“And it burned greatly to Saul”

See how you translated the similar expressions in 11:6 and 17:28. (The meaning is comparable, even though the term “nose” is not present here.) Alternate translation: [And this made Saul very angry]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 18:8 (#2)

וַיֵּרַע בְּעֵינָיו הַדָּבָר הַזֶּה

“and this thing was bad in his eyes”

See how you translated this similar expression in 1:18. Alternate translation: [and this thing greatly displeased him]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 18:8 (#3)

וְעוֹד לוֹ אַךְ הַמְּלוּכָה

“And only the kingship is yet for him”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And only the kingship is yet for him to acquire]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 18:9 (#1)

שָׁאאוּל עוֹן אֶת־דָּוִד

“Saul was eyeing David”

The author is using the term **eyeing** to represent that Saul was watching David with suspicion and hostility. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Saul was watching David with suspicion and hostility]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 18:10 (#3)

וְדָוִד מְנַגֵּן בְּיָדוֹ

“And David was playing by his hand”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context in 16:16 if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And David was playing the lyre by his hand]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 18:10 (#4)

וְדָוִד מְנַגֵּן בְּיָדוֹ

“And David was playing by his hand”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. See how you translated the similar expression in 16:16. Alternate translation: [And David was strumming the lyre]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 18:10 (#5)

כְּיוֹם ׀ בְּיוֹם

“as day by day”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean regularly or habitually. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as he did regularly]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 18:10 (#6)

וְהַחֲנִית בְּיַד־שָׁאוּל

“And a spear {was} in the hand of Saul”

This was a symbolic action that showed Saul’s royal authority. The description in 22:6 suggests that the spear served as a scepter and was a symbol of royalty. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [And Saul was holding his spear, which showed his royal authority]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 18:10 (#1)

רוּחַ֨ אֱלֹהִ֜ים ׀ רָעָ֗ה

“a bad spirit from God”

See the discussion of this phrase in the Introduction to chapter 16, and see how you translated it in 16:14–15.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 18:10 (#2)

וַיִּתְנַבֵּ֣א

“and he prophesied”

In this context, the word **prophesied** does not indicate that Saul spoke words from God for the warning and instruction of the people. Here the author is using the word to describe a raving state in which people are sometimes violent, as Saul was toward David. Alternate translation: [and he raved]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 18:11 (#1)

וַיְטֵ֣ל שָׁא֗וּל אֶת־הַחֲנִית֮ וַיֹּ֣אמֶר אַכֶּ֣ה בְדָוִד֒ וּבַקִּ֔יר

“And Saul hurled the spear, and he said, “I will strike David, and into the wall”

The author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. In your translation, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [And Saul said, “I will strike David, and into the wall!” and he hurled the spear.]

See: Order of Events

1 Samuel 18:11 (#2)

וּבַקִּ֔יר

“and into the wall”

Saul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the spear will drive him into the wall]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 18:11 (#3)

וַיִּסֹּ֥ב & מִפָּנָֽיו

“But & turned from his face”

The author is using one part of Saul, his **face**, to mean all of him in the act of trying to kill David. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But … avoided him]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 18:12 (#2)

וַיִּרָ֥א שָׁא֛וּל מִלִּפְנֵ֥י דָוִ֖ד

“And Saul was afraid from the face of David”

The author is using one part of David, his **face**, to mean all of him, suggesting that Saul found David personally to be imposing and intimidating. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Saul was afraid of David]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 18:12 (#3)

הָיָ֥ה יְהוָ֖ה עִמּֽוֹ

“Yahweh was with him”

See how you translated this expression in 3:19. Alternate translation: [Yahweh was helping him]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 18:12 (#1)

וַיִּרְאָ֥ שָׁא֖וּל מִלִּפְנֵ֣י דָוִ֑ד כִּֽי־הָיָ֣ה יְהוָ֔ה עִמּ֖וֹ וּמֵעִ֥ם שָׁא֖וּל סָֽר

“And Saul was afraid from the face of David. For Yahweh was with him, but he had turned from with Saul”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And since Yahweh was with David but had turned away from Saul, Saul was afraid from the face of David]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 18:12 (#4)

וּמֵעִ֥ם שָׁא֖וּל סָֽר

“but he had turned from with Saul”

The author is speaking as if Yahweh had once been physically present with Saul but had walked away from him. He means that Yahweh was no longer helping Saul. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but he was no longer helping Saul]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 18:13 (#1)

וַיֵּצֵ֥א וַיָּבֹֽא

“And he went out and came in”

The author is using a common expression of his culture that describes leadership. See the similar uses in Numbers 27:17 and 2 Chronicles 1:10. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he was a leader]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 18:13 (#2)

לְפָנָ֑י

“to the face of”

The author is using the term **face** to represent the front or head position. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of] or [at the head of]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 18:13 (#3)

הָעָ֔ם

“the people”

The term **people** has the same meaning here as in 13:2 and in its frequent occurrences in chapter 13, chapter 14, and chapter 15. Alternate translation: [these fighting men of Israel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 18:14 (#1)

וַיְהִ֥י דָוִ֖ד לְכָל־דרכו מַשְׂכִּ֑יל וַיהוָ֖ה עִמּֽוֹ

“And David was succeeding in all of his ways, for Yahweh {was} with him”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And because Yahweh was with him, David was succeeding in all of his ways]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 18:14 (#3)

וַיהוָ֖ה עִמּֽוֹ

“for Yahweh {was} with him”

See how you translated this expression in 3:19. Alternate translation: [because Yahweh was helping him]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 18:14 (#2)

לְכָל־דרכו

“in all of his ways”

The author is speaking as if David’s activities were paths that he walked on. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in everything he did]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 18:15 (#1)

וַיַּ֣גָר מִפָּנָֽיו

“And he dreaded from his face”

The word that the ULT translates as **dreaded** here is a stronger term than the one it translates as “was afraid” in 18:12. The term “face” seems to represent David himself in 18:12, but the term **face** here seems to refer more directly to David’s presence. The UST models one way to show this intensification of Saul’s feeling toward David.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 18:16 (#2)

וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל֙ וִיהוּדָ֔ה

“But all of Israel and Judah”

The author is making a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [But people throughout Judah and the rest of Israel]

See: Hyperbole

1 Samuel 18:16 (#3)

הַה֥וּא יוֹצֵ֖א וָבָ֑א לִפְנֵיהֶֽם

“he was going out and coming in to their face”

As in 18:13, the author is using the term **face** to represent “front,” and he is using the term **their** to represent the army of Israel and Judah. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use equivalent expressions or plain language. Alternate translation: [he was going out and coming in at the front of their soldiers]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 18:16 (#4)

הַה֥וּא יוֹצֵ֖א וָבָ֑א לִפְנֵיהֶֽם

“he was going out and coming in to their face”

See how you translated this expression in 18:13. Alternate translation: [he was leading their soldiers into battle]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 18:16 (#1)

וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל֙ וִיהוּדָ֔ה אֹהֵ֖ב אֶת־דָּוִ֑ד כִּי־ה֥וּא יוֹצֵ֖א וָבָ֑א לִפְנֵיהֶֽם

“But all of Israel and Judah were loving David, for he was going out and coming in to their face”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [But since David was going out and coming in to their face, all of Israel and Judah were loving David]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 18:17 (#1)

וַיֹּ֨אמֶר שָׁא֜וּל אֶל־דָּוִ֗ד הִנֵּ֤ה׀ בִּתִּ֙י הַגְּדוֹלָ֔ה מֵרַ֖ב אֹתָ֣הּ אֶתֵּן־לְךָ֣ לְאִשָּׁ֑ה אַ֚ךְ הֱיֵה־לִ֣י לְבֶן־חַ֔יִל וְהִלָּחֵ֖ם מִלְחֲמֹ֣ת יְהוָ֑ה וְשָׁא֣וּל אָמַ֗ר אַל־תְּהִ֤י יָדִי֙ בּ֣וֹ וּתְהִי־בּ֔וֹ יַד־פְּלִשְׁתִּֽים

“And Saul said to David, “Behold my older daughter Merab. I will give her to you for a wife. Only be for me a son of valor and fight the battles of Yahweh.” And Saul said, “Let not my hand be against him, but let the hand of the Philistines be against him”

The author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. In your translation, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [Then Saul thought, “Let not my hand be against him, but let the hand of the Philistines be against him.” So Saul said to David, “Behold my older daughter Merab. I will give her to you for a wife. Only be for me a son of valor and fight the battles of Yahweh.”]

See: Order of Events

1 Samuel 18:17 (#5)

אַל־תְּהִ֤י יָדִי֙ בּ֣וֹ וּתְהִי־בּ֔וֹ יַד־פְּלִשְׁתִּֽים

“Let not my hand be against him, but let the hand of the Philistines be against him”

Saul is using one part of himself and the Philistines, the **hand**, to mean the entire person in the act of killing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Let me not be the one who kills him, but let the Philistines be the ones who kill him]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 18:17 (#4)

לִ֥י לְבֶן־חַ֖יִל

“for me a son of valor”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:16. Alternate translation: [a valiant soldier in my service]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 18:17 (#2)

הִנֵּ֤ה׀ בִּתִּ֙י הַגְּדוֹלָ֔ה מֵרַ֖ב

“Behold my older daughter Merab”

It seems unlikely that Merab is present and that Saul is telling David to look at her. But Saul is also probably not using the word **Behold** primarily to call attention to what he was about to say. He seems to be using the word to mean "Consider," as David would do if he were actually looking at Merab in person and considering her as a wife. Alternate translation: [Consider my older daughter Merab]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 18:17 (#3)

אַךְ֙ הֱיֵ֣ה

"Only be"

The author assumes that his readers will know that by **Only be**, Saul means that this is the only bride-price he is asking. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [The only bride-price I ask is that you be]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 18:18 (#3)

לַמֶּ֥לֶךְ

"to the king"

David is speaking about Saul respectfully in the third person even though he is speaking to him directly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [to you, the king]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 18:18 (#1)

מִֽי־אָנֹכִי֮ וּמִ֣י חַיַּי֒ מִשְׁפַּחַ֤ת אָבִי֙ בְּיִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל כִּֽי־אֶהְיֶ֥ה חָתָ֖ן לַמֶּֽלֶךְ

"Who {am} I, and what {is} my family, the clan of my father in Israel, that I should be son-in-law to the king"

David is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I am not worthy to be the king's son-in-law! My family, my father's clan in Israel, is not important enough!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 18:18 (#2)

חָתָ֖ן לַמֶּֽלֶךְ

"son-in-law to the king"

Your language may have its own term or expression for this relationship. Alternate translation: [the husband of the king's daughter]

See: Kinship

1 Samuel 18:19 (#1)

בַּת־שָׁא֔וּל

"the daughter of Saul"

It is stated specifically in 18:17 that Merab is Saul's older daughter, but if your language regularly marks that distinction, you may wish to do so here. Alternate translation: [the older daughter of Saul]

See: Kinship

1 Samuel 18:19 (#2)

וְהָֽיְתָ֥ה נִתְּנָ֖ה

"that she was given"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in an active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that Saul gave her]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 18:20 (#1)

בַּת־שָׁא֔וּל

"the daughter of Saul"

If your language regularly marks the distinction between older and younger daughters, you may wish to do so here. Alternate translation: [the younger daughter of Saul]

See: Kinship

1 Samuel 18:20 (#2)

וַיַּגִּ֖דוּ לְשָׁא֑וּל

"And they declared to Saul"

Here the author is not using the pronoun **they** to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And Saul was told]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 18:20 (#3)

וַיִּשַׁ֥שׁ הַדָּבָ֖ר בְּעֵינָֽיו

"and the thing was right in his eyes"

See how you translated this similar expression in 1:18. Alternate translation: [and this pleased him]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 18:21 (#1)

אֶתְּנֶנָּה לּוֹ וּתְהִי־לֹו לְמוֹקֵשׁ וּתְהִי־בּוֹ יַד־פְּלִשְׁתִּים

“I will give her to him, that she may be a snare for him and the hand of the Philistines may be against him”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [So that she may be a snare for him and the hand of the Philistines may be against him, I will give her to him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 18:21 (#5)

בִּשְׁתַּיִם

“for a second {time”

The author is using the adjective **second** as a noun to mean a certain instance. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. The ULT does that by supplying the word **time**.

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 18:21 (#6)

הַיּוֹם

“today”

See how you translated this expression in 9:13. Alternate translation: [at this time]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 18:21 (#2)

וּתְהִי־לֹו לְמוֹקֵשׁ

“that she may be a snare for him”

Saul is speaking as if Michal were a **snare** that would catch an animal. He means that David’s wish to marry her would lead him into a deadly situation. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that his wish to marry her will lead him into a deadly situation]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 18:21 (#3)

וּתְהִי־בּוֹ יַד־פְּלִשְׁתִּים

“and the hand of the Philistines may be against him”

See how you translated this expression in 18:17. Alternate translation: [and the Philistines will be the ones who kill him]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 18:21 (#4)

וַיֹּאמֶר שָׁאוּל אֶל־דָּוִד בִּשְׁתַּיִם תִּתְחַתֵּן בִּבִּי הַיּוֹם

“So Saul said to David for a second {time}, “You may make yourself a son-in-law of mine today”

It is possible that the words **for a second time** are part of the direct quotation from Saul. Alternate translation: [So Saul said to David, “For a second time, you may make yourself a son-in-law of mine today”]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Samuel 18:22 (#4)

וְעַתָּה

“And now”

See how you translated the expression “And now” in 6:7. Alternate translation: [So this is what you should do]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 18:22 (#2)

בַּלָּטֻט

“in secrecy”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **secrecy**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [secretly]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 18:22 (#1)

דַּבְּרוּ אֶל־דָּוִד בַּלָּטֻט לֵאמֹר הִנֵּה חָפֵץ בְּךָ הַמֶּלֶךְ וְכָל־עֲבָדָיו אֲהֵבֻוךָ וְעַתָּה הִתְחַתֵּן בַּמֶּלֶךְ

“Speak to David in secrecy, saying, ‘Behold, the king delights in you, and all of his servants love you. And now, make yourself a son-in-law of the king”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Speak to David in

secrecy and tell him to consider that the king delights in him and that all of his servants love him, so he should make himself a son-in-law of the king]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 18:22 (#3)

הִנֵּה

“Behold”

See how you translated this expression in 18:17. Alternate translation: [Consider that]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 18:23 (#1)

וַיְדַבְּרוּ & אֶת־הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה

“And & spoke these words”

The author is using the term **words** to represent the message that Saul had communicated by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And … said what Saul had told them to say]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 18:23 (#4)

הֲנָקַלָּה & וְנִקְלֶה

“Does it seem light & and I am lightly esteemed”

David is using related verb forms to make his point eloquently and emphatically. Your language may have comparable forms or terms that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Does it seem like a little thing … and people have little regard for me]

See: Poetry

1 Samuel 18:23 (#3)

הֲנָקַלָּה בְעֵינֵיכֶם֙ הִתְחַתֵּן בַּמֶּלֶךְ

“Does it seem light in your eyes to make oneself a son-in-law of the king”

David is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [It should not seem light in your eyes to make oneself a son-in-law of the king!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 18:23 (#5)

הֲנָקַלָּה

“Does it seem light”

David is speaking as if becoming the king’s son-in-law were something that could be weighed and found to be **light**. This conveys the idea of insignificance. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Does it seem insignificant] or [It should not seem insignificant]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 18:23 (#6)

בְעֵינֵיכֶם֙

“in your eyes”

See how you translated this expression in 1:18. Alternate translation: [in your judgment]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 18:23 (#8)

וְנִקְלֶה

“and I am lightly esteemed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in an active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people esteem me lightly]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 18:23 (#9)

וְנִקְלֶה

“and I am lightly esteemed”

See the discussion in the Introduction to this chapter of the possible implicit meaning of this phrase.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 18:23 (#2)

בְּאָזְנֵי דָוִד

“in the ears of David”

The author is using the term **ears** to represent David’s hearing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the hearing of David] or [for David to hear]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 18:23 (#7)

וְאָנֹכִי אִישׁ־רָאׁשׁ

“And I {am} a poor man”

By calling himself **a poor man**, David means l that he would not be able to afford the bride-price for a princess. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And I would not be able to afford the bride-price for a princess]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 18:24 (#2)

לֵאמֹר כַּדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה דִּבֶּר דָּוִד

“saying, “Like these words David spoke”

It may be more natural in your language to have an indirect quotation here. Alternate translation: [and told him what David had said]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Samuel 18:24 (#1)

לֵאמֹר כַּדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה דִּבֶּר דָּוִד

“saying, “Like these words David spoke”

See how you translated this expression in 17:23. Alternate translation: [saying, “This is what David said”]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 18:25 (#6)

וְשָׁאוּל חָשַׁשׁ לְהַפִּיל אֶת־דָּוִד בְּיַד־פְּלִשְׁתִּים

“Now Saul thought to make David fall by the hand of the Philistines”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand Saul’s true motives. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 18:25 (#1)

כֹּה־תֹאמְרוּ לְדָוִד אֵין־חֵפֶץ לַמֶּלֶךְ בְּמֹהַר כִּי בְּמֵאָהֹ עָרְלֹוֹת פְּלִשְׁתִּים לְהִנָּקֵם בְּאֹיְבֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ

“Thus you shall say to David, ‘{There is} no desire to the king for a bride-price except for a hundred foreskins of Philistines, to be avenged against the enemies of the king”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Tell David that the king does not desire any bride-price except for a hundred foreskins of Philistines, to be avenged against his enemies]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 18:25 (#8)

לְהַפִּיל אֶת־דָּוִד

“to make David fall”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:10. Alternate translation: [to make David die] or [to kill David]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 18:25 (#2)

אֵין־חֵפֶץ לַמֶּלֶךְ בְּמֹהַר כִּי בְּמֵאָהֹ עָרְלֹוֹת פְּלִשְׁתִּים

“There is} no desire to the king for a bride-price except for a hundred foreskins of Philistines”

If it would appear in your language that Saul was making a statement and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [The only bride-price that the king desires is a hundred foreskins of Philistines]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

1 Samuel 18:25 (#3)

כִּי בְּמֵאָהֹ עָרְלֹוֹת פְּלִשְׁתִּים

“except for a hundred foreskins of Philistines”

As 17:54 shows, the usual trophy from a defeated enemy’s body was the head. Saul’s different requirement of **a hundred foreskins of Philistines** had both practical and symbolic significance. Since Israelite men were circumcised but Philistine men were not, this requirement ensured that David could not bring back the heads of slain Israelites and claim they were Philistines. Beyond that, as 14:6, 17:26, and 17:36 show, Israelites used the word “uncircumcised” as a derogatory term indicating that the Philistines did not worship Yahweh and did not obey his laws. So bringing back their foreskins as war trophies would symbolically show that Saul was being **avenged** on these **enemies** who were also hostile to Yahweh. (Saul tells David in 18:17 that he is sending him out to fight “the battles of Yahweh.”) Alternate translation: [except that you kill a hundred Philistines and bring back their foreskins to prove that it was indeed these uncircumcised heathen whom you killed]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 18:25 (#4)

לְהִנָּקֵם

“to be avenged”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in an active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [so that he may get revenge]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 18:25 (#5)

בְּאֹיְבֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ

“against the enemies of the king”

As he tells his men what to say to David, Saul anticipates that they will refer to him respectfully by his royal title. Depending on the conventions of your own culture, it may be possible to convey the same meaning with a simple pronoun. Alternate translation: [against his enemies]

See: Politeness

1 Samuel 18:25 (#7)

לְהַפִּ֥יל אֶת־דָּוִ֖ד בְּיַד־פְּלִשְׁתִּֽים

“to make David fall by the hand of the Philistines”

The author is using the term **hand** to represent the power and action of the Philistines. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [that this would enable the Philistines to make David fall]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 18:26 (#1)

וַיַּגִּ֣דוּ עֲבָדָ֗יו לְדָוִד֙ אֶת־הַדְּבָרִ֣ים הָאֵ֔לֶּה

“And his servants declared these words to David”

The author is using the term **words** to represent what Saul had instructed them to say by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And his servants told David what Saul had instructed them to say]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 18:26 (#2)

וַיִּשַׁ֥ר הַדָּבָ֖ר בְּעֵינֵ֣י דָוִ֑ד לְהִתְחַתֵּ֖ן בַּמֶּֽלֶךְ

“and the thing was right in the eyes of David, to make himself son-in-law of the king”

See how you translated the expression **in the eyes of** in 8:6. Alternate translation: [and it seemed appropriate to David to make himself son-in-law of the king in this way]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 18:26 (#4)

וְלֹ֥א מָלְא֖וּ הַיָּמִֽים

“And the days were not full”

The author assumes that his readers will know that by **the days**, he means a time limit that Saul had set. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And the time limit that Saul had set had not expired]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 18:26 (#3)

וְלֹ֥א מָלְא֖וּ הַיָּמִֽים

“And the days were not full”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean that a certain period of time had not yet ended. Express this in the way that people in your own culture would speak of a period that had not ended. Alternate translation: [And the time had not expired]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 18:27 (#1)

וַיָּ֤קָם דָּוִד֙

“and David arose”

See how you translated this expression in 1:9. Alternate translation: [and David took action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 18:27 (#2)

וַיַּ֔ךְ

“and he struck”

The author is using David to represent both him and his men in the act of killing these Philistines. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a plural pronoun here. Alternate translation: [and they struck]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 18:27 (#3)

וַיָּבֵא דָּוִד֙ אֶת־עָרְלֹתֵיהֶ֔ם וַיְמַלְאֻ֖ם לַמֶּ֑לֶךְ לְהִתְחַתֵּ֥ן בַּמֶּ֖לֶךְ וַיִּתֶּן־לֹ֥ו שָׁא֛וּל אֶת־מִיכַ֥ל בִּתְּ֖ו לְאִשָּׁ֥ה

“And David brought their foreskins, and they filled them to the king, to make himself son-in-law of the king. And Saul gave Michal, his daughter, to him for a wife”

It may be more natural in your language to put the information about David bringing the foreskins with the information about the purpose for which he brought them. It may also be more natural to put the information about counting them with the information about the result of the count. Alternate translation: [And David brought their foreskins to make himself son-in-law of the king, and they filled them to the king, so Saul gave his daughter Michal to him for his wife]

See: Information Structure

1 Samuel 18:27 (#5)

וַיְמַלְאֻם לַמֶּלֶךְ

“and they filled them to the king”

Here the author is not using the pronoun **they** to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and they were counted out in full number to the king]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 18:27 (#4)

וַיְמַלְאֻם לַמֶּלֶךְ

“and they filled them to the king”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean that they counted out the full number. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they counted them out in full number for the king]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 18:28 (#1)

וַיַּ֣רְא שָׁא֔וּל וַיֵּ֖דַע

“And Saul saw and knew”

The terms **saw** and **knew** mean similar things. (In this context, **saw** refers to more than vision; it means recognition.) The author is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [And Saul recognized clearly]

See: Doublet

1 Samuel 18:28 (#2)

יְהוָ֥ה עִם־דָּוִ֖ד

“Yahweh {was} with David”

See how you translated this expression in 18:14. Alternate translation: [Yahweh was helping David]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 18:28 (#3)

וּמִיכַ֥ל בַּת־שָׁא֖וּל

“and {that} Michal, the daughter of Saul”

The author is referring to Michal formally by her relationship to the king. Following the conventions of your own culture, you could use a different expression that would indicate her status appropriately. Alternate translation: [and that the princess Michal]

See: Politeness

1 Samuel 18:29 (#3)

כָּל־הַיָּמִֽים

“all of the days”

The author is using the term **days** to represent a specific period of time, Saul’s remaining lifetime. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for the rest of his life]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 18:29 (#2)

מִפְּנֵ֖י דָּוִֽד

“from the face of David”

The author is using one part of David, his **face**, to mean his entire person, with the suggestion that Saul found David personally to be even more imposing and intimidating. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [of the person of David]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 18:29 (#1)

וַיֹּ֣סֶף שָׁא֔וּל ל֥וֹ & עֹ֖וד

“and Saul added to be more afraid”

This expression conveys a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **added** tells in what way Saul became **more afraid**. Alternate translation: [and Saul became even more afraid]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 18:30 (#3)

וַיִּיקַר שְׁמֹו מְאֹד

"and his name became greatly precious"

The author is using the term **name** to represent David's reputation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and his reputation became very great] or [and people came to think very highly of him]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 18:30 (#1)

וַיֵּצְאוּ שָׂרֵי פְלִשְׁתִּים & צֵאתָם

"And the commanders of the Philistines came out & they came out"

The author is using these **commanders** to represent both them and their armies in the act of going out to battle. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the commanders of the Philistines led their armies out ... they led them out]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 18:30 (#2)

וַיֵּצְאוּ & צֵאתָם

"And & came out & they came out"

The author assumes that his readers will know that by **came out**, he means that they came out to fight against the Israelites. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And ... came out to fight against the Israelites]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel - Chapter 19 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the part of the book that describes how David became king (chapters 16–31). It describes how, after promising not to harm David, Saul once again became jealous of David's success as a military leader. This led Saul to try once again to kill David, both indirectly, by sending soldiers to kill him, and directly, by ordering soldiers to bring David to him and by pursuing David in person. But Yahweh continued to protect David so that he could survive and eventually become the next king of Israel.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

What was the "teraphim" that Michal had in her home?

In 19:13, the author says that Michal took a "teraphim" that she had in her home and put it in David's bed under a covering to make it look as if David was there. She did that to help David escape. Teraphim were idols that people kept in their homes. While contexts such as Genesis 31:34 suggest that in some cases they were small, the context in this chapter shows that the teraphim Michal had was the size of a man. It appears that Michal worshiped this idol in some way. But that does not mean that David did. Samuel said in 13:14 that Yahweh considered David to be "a man according to his heart" who would do all that he commanded. So we may be confident that David was wholeheartedly devoted to Yahweh and worshiped only him, even though his wife unfortunately kept an idol in their home.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"Naioth"

The author says in 19:18 that David and Samuel "stayed in Naioth." The word "Naioth" is not attested as a place name in any other passage of the Bible or in any historical sources. The term means "dwellings," and it seems to refer to a cluster of lodgings that had been built near Ramah for young prophets whom Samuel was training. Samuel apparently felt that David would be safer within a community of people, and he may also have hoped that Saul would not seek to harm David within an area that was dedicated to a sacred purpose. While Naioth may have become the name of these lodgings, it might also have been a descriptive term, and the author may be using it in that way. So instead of saying "in Naioth," you might choose to say something such as "among the lodgings of the young prophets." If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, consider what it says.

"Is Saul among the prophets?" (19:24)

In 10:12, the author describes the origin of this short popular saying. Originally people in the culture applied it to situations in which a person did something that was surprising in light of his upbringing or family of origin. In 19:24, the author describes how this saying came to be applied to a further type of situation, one in which a person did something that was very unexpected. You could indicate that explicitly in your

translation if that would be helpful to your readers. The UST models one way to do that.

1 Samuel 19:2 (#2)

וְיָשַׁבְתָּתָ֖ בַּסֵּ֑תֶר וְנַחְבֵּֽאתָ

“and stay in a secret place and hide yourself”

Jonathan is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. In your translation, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [and hide yourself and stay in that secret place]

See: Order of Events

1 Samuel 19:2 (#1)

וְעַתָּה֙

“And now”

See how you translated the expression **And now** in 6:7. Alternate translation: [So this is what you should do]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 19:3 (#1)

לְיַ֣ד

“at the hand of”

Jonathan is using the term **hand** to represent location next to someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [beside]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 19:3 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר אַתָּ֖ה שָׁ֑ם

“where you {are} there”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [where you are]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 19:3 (#3)

וְרָאִ֣יתִי מַֽמָּה֮ וְהִגַּדְתִּי֒ לָ֗ךְ

“and I will see what, and I will declare to you”

Jonathan is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and I will see what he says, and I will declare that to you]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 19:4 (#1)

אַל־יֶחֱטָ֤א הַמֶּ֙לֶךְ֙ בְּעַבְדּ֔וֹ בְּדָוִ֖ד כִּ֣י לֹ֣א חָטָ֣א לָ֑ךְ וְכִ֨י מַעֲשָׂ֔יו טוֹב־לְךָ֖ מְאֹֽד

“May the king not sin against his servant, against David, for he has not sinned against you, but surely his deeds {have been} very good for you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since his servant David has not sinned against the king, but surely his deeds have been very good for you, may you not sin against him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 19:4 (#2)

אַל־יֶחֱטָ֤א הַמֶּ֙לֶךְ֙ בְּעַבְדּ֔וֹ

“May the king not sin against his servant”

Jonathan is speaking to Saul respectfully in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [May you, the king, not sin against your servant]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 19:4 (#3)

אַל־יֶחֱטָ֤א הַמֶּ֙לֶךְ֙ בְּעַבְדּ֔וֹ

“May the king not sin against his servant”

Jonathan assumes that his father, King Saul, will know that by **sin against**, he means to do unjustified harm. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [May the king not sinfully do unjustified harm to his servant]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 19:5 (#4)

וַיַּ֤עַשׂ יְהוָה֙ תְּשׁוּעָ֣ה גְדוֹלָ֔ה לְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל

“and Yahweh made a great salvation for all of Israel”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **salvation**, you could express the same idea in

another way. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh saved all of Israel in a great way]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 19:5 (#3)

אֶת־הַפְּלִשְׁתִּי

“the Philistine”

See how you translated this expression in 17:8. Alternate translation: [Goliath, the Philistine warrior champion]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 19:5 (#1)

וַיָּשֶׂם֙ אֶת־נַפְשׁ֣וֹ בְכַפּ֔וֹ

“And he put his life in his palm”

Jonathan is using a common expression of his culture to mean that someone put himself in danger for the sake of others. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [And he took his life into his own hands] or [And he put himself in danger of being killed]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 19:5 (#2)

וַיַּ֣ךְ

“and struck”

See how you translated the term **struck** in 4:2. Alternate translation: [and killed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 19:5 (#5)

וְלָ֣מָּה תֶחֱטָ֞אְ בְּדָ֣ם נָקִ֗י לְהָמִ֤ית אֶת־דָּוִד֙ חִנָּ֔ם

“So why would you sin against innocent blood by killing David without cause”

Jonathan is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [So you should certainly not sin against innocent blood by killing David without cause!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 19:5 (#6)

בְּדָ֣ם נָקִ֗י

“against innocent blood”

Jonathan is using one part of David, his **blood**, to mean David as an entire person. He is using that part of David to represent him because Saul would shed his blood if he killed him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [against an innocent person]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 19:6 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁמַ֥ע שָׁא֖וּל בְּקֹ֣ול יְהוֹנָתָ֑ן

“And Saul listened to the voice of Jonathan”

The author is using the term **voice** to represent what Jonathan said by using his voice. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And Saul listened to what Jonathan said]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 19:6 (#3)

חַי־יְהוָ֕ה אִם־יּוּמָֽת

“The life of Yahweh, he shall not be killed”

Following the custom of his culture, Saul is swearing an oath by guaranteeing it by something he holds sacred. Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. Alternate translation: [I swear by Yahweh that David shall not be killed]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Samuel 19:6 (#4)

אִם־יּוּמָֽת

“he shall not be killed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in an active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I will not kill him]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 19:6 (#2)

וַיִּשְׁמַ֥ע שָׁא֖וּל בְּקֹ֣ול יְהוֹנָתָ֑ן

“And Saul listened to the voice of Jonathan”

The author assumes that his readers will know that by **listened**, he means that Saul agreed to do what Jonathan said. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers.

Alternate translation: [And Saul agreed to do what Jonathan said]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 19:7 (#1)

אֵת כָּל־הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה

“all of these words”

The author is using the term **words** to represent what Saul had communicated by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [everything that Saul had said]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 19:7 (#2)

לְפָנָיו

“to his face”

The author is using the term **face** to represent Saul’s presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in his presence]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 19:7 (#3)

כְּאֶתְמוֹל שִׁלְשׁוֹם

“as yesterday and the third day”

See how you translated this expression in 4:7. Alternate translation: [as he had been previously]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 19:8 (#2)

וַיַּךְ בָּהֶם מַכָּה גְדוֹלָה

“and he struck a great striking against them”

For emphasis, the author is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. See how you translated the similar expression in 14:14. Alternate translation: [and he slaughtered very many of them]

See: Poetry

1 Samuel 19:8 (#1)

וַיֵּצֵא דָוִד

“and David went out”

The author is using David to represent both him and his army in the act of going out to battle. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and David led the army out]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 19:8 (#3)

מִפָּנָיו

“from his face”

The author is using one part of David, his **face**, to represent him and the army he was commanding. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from him] or [from the army he was commanding]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 19:9 (#2)

וַתְּהִי רוּחַ יְהוָה ׀ רָעָה

“And a bad spirit from Yahweh came”

See the discussion of this phrase in the Introduction to chapter 16, and see how you translated it in 16:14–15 and 18:10.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 19:9 (#3)

וְדָוִד מְנַגֵּן בְּיָד

“and David was playing by hand”

See how you translated this expression in 16:16. Alternate translation: [and David was strumming the lyre]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 19:9 (#1)

וַתְּהִי רוּחַ יְהוָה ׀ רָעָה אֶל־שָׁאוּל וְהוּא בְּבֵיתוֹ יוֹשֵׁב וַחֲנִיתוֹ בְּיָדוֹ וְדָוִד מְנַגֵּן בְּיָד

“And a bad spirit from Yahweh came upon Saul, and he was sitting in his house, and his spear {was} in his hand, and David was playing by hand”

Since the last three clauses in this verse describe the setting in which the event took place that the first clause describes, it may be more natural in your language to put the information about the setting before the information about the event. Alternate translation: [And then, as Saul was sitting in his house with his spear in his hand and David was playing by hand, a bad spirit from Yahweh came upon Saul]

See: Information Structure

1 Samuel 19:10 (#2)

וַיִּפְטַרׇ מִפָּנָיו שָׁאוּל

“but he escaped from the face of Saul”

The author is using one part of Saul, his **face**, to represent all of him. See how you translated this in 18:11. Alternate translation: [escaped from Saul] or [eluded Saul’s attempt to kill him]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 19:10 (#4)

נָנָס וַיְמַלֵּט & הִוּא

“fled and rescued himself”

This expression conveys a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **fled** tells in what way David **rescued himself**. Alternate translation: [rescued himself by fleeing]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 19:10 (#3)

וַיַּךְ אֶת־הַחֲנִית בַּקִּיר

“and he struck the spear into the wall”

The pronoun **he** refers to Saul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and Saul struck the spear into the wall] or [so that the spear Saul threw stuck in the wall instead]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 19:10 (#1)

וּבַקִּיר

“and into the wall”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. See how you translated this in 18:11. Alternate translation: [so that the spear would drive him into the wall]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 19:11 (#1)

אַתָּה מוּמָת

“you will be being killed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in an active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [they will kill you]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 19:12 (#1)

וַיֵּלֶךְ

“And he went”

The author assumes that his readers will know that by **went**, he means that David went away from the house. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And he went away from the house]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 19:12 (#2)

וַיִּבְרַח וַיִּמָּלֵט

“and fled and rescued himself”

See how you translated this expression in 19:10. Alternate translation: [and rescued himself by fleeing]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 19:13 (#3)

וְאֶתֹת כְּבִיר הָעִזִּים שָׂשָׂמָה מְרַאֲשֹׁתָיו

“And she put a weaving of goats at its head”

The author is using the term **goats** to represent the hair of goats. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And she put a weaving of goats’ hair at its head]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 19:13 (#1)

אֶת־הַתְּרָפִים

“the teraphim”

See how you translated the term **teraphim** in 15:23. Alternate translation: [the household idol]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 19:13 (#2)

אֶת־הַתְּרָפִים

“the teraphim”

The author says **the** teraphim to indicate that this was a specific idol that Michal had in her home. While such idols could be small, as Genesis 31:34 indicates, here the context indicates that it was as large as a man, since Michal was able to use it to pretend that David was in the bed. It may be helpful to indicate this in your translation. Alternate translation: [the man-sized idol that she had in her home]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 19:13 (#4)

וְאֵת֩ כְּבִיר֙ הָעִזִּ֔ים שָׂ֥שָׂמָה מְרַאֲשֹׁתָ֖יו

“And she put a weaving of goats at its head”

Interpreters are unsure about the meaning of the phrase **a weaving of goats**. It could be describing: (1) a woven garment with visible fibers of goats’ hair that resembled human hair. Alternate translation: [And she put goats’ hair around the head of the statue to make it look like a human head]; (2) a woven pillow stuffed with goats’ hair. Alternate translation: [And she put a pillow stuffed with goat’s hair at the top of the statue to look like David’s head]; (3) a net woven from goats’ hair that people used to keep flies away. This covering would have disguised the head of the statue. Alternate translation: [And she put a flynet woven from goats’ hair over the head of the idol to disguise it]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 19:14 (#1)

וַתֹּ֥אמֶר

“But she said”

The pronoun **she** refers to Michal. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [But Michal said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 19:15 (#2)

הַעֲל֥וּ אֹת֛וֹ

“Bring him up”

In keeping with the conventions of his language and culture, Saul seems to be marking travel for change in elevation. Apparently Saul lived on the hill of Gibeah, while David lived in the town below the hill. See how you translated the comparable expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [Bring him]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 19:15 (#1)

לִרְאֹ֣ות אֶת־דָּוִ֔ד לֵאמֹ֕ר הַעֲל֥וּ אֹת֛וֹ בַּמִּטָּ֖ה אֵלַ֑י לַהֲמִתֹֽו׃

“to see David, saying, “Bring him up to me in the bed to kill him”

The author assumes that his readers will know that Saul wanted to **see** whether David really was too sick to get out of bed. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to see whether David really was too sick to get out of bed, saying, “If necessary, bring him up to me in the bed so that I can kill him”]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 19:16 (#1)

וְהִנֵּ֥ה

“and behold”

See how you translated the term **behold** in 2:31. Alternate translation: [and to their surprise]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 19:16 (#2)

וּכְבִיר֙ הָעִזִּ֔ים מְרַאֲשֹׁתָ֖יו

“and the weaving of goats {was} at its head”

See how you translated the phrase **weaving of goats** in 19:13.

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 19:17 (#2)

לָ֣מָּה אֲמִיתֶ֔ךָּ

“Why should I kill you”

Michal says that David used the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement. Alternate translation: [I should not have to kill you]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 19:17 (#1)

הוּא־אָמַ֥ר אֵלַ֖י שַׁלְּחֵ֑נִי לָ֣מָּה אֲמִיתֶֽךָּ׃

“He himself said to me, ‘Let me go. Why should I kill you”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [He himself told me that if I did not let him go, he would kill me]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 19:18 (#2)

בנוית

“in Naioth”

See the discussion of this phrase in the Introduction to this chapter.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 19:18 (#1)

וְדָוִד בָּרַח וַיִּמָּלֵט

“Now David fled and rescued himself”

See how you translated this expression in 19:10. Alternate translation: [Now David rescued himself by fleeing]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 19:19 (#1)

וַיֻּגַּד לְשָׁאוּל

“And it was declared to Saul”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in an active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And someone told Saul]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 19:20 (#2)

נִצָּב עֲלֵיהֶם

“having stationed himself over them”

The author is speaking as if Samuel had physically positioned himself above the prophets. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [supervising them as their teacher]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 19:20 (#1)

וַיַּרְא

“And one saw”

Here the author is not using the pronoun **one** to refer to a specific person. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And each one saw] or [And they saw]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 19:21 (#1)

וַיַּגִּדוּ לְשָׁאוּל

“And they declared {this} to Saul”

Here the author is not using the pronoun **they** to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And someone reported this to Saul]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 19:21 (#2)

וַיֹּסֶף שָׁאוּל וַיִּשְׁלַח מַלְאָכִים שְׁלִשִׁים

“And Saul added and sent messengers a third {time”

This expression conveys a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **added** tells in what way Saul **sent** messengers. Alternate translation: [And Saul once again sent messengers, for a third time]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 19:22 (#2)

וַיֹּאמֶר

“and said”

The expression **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this expression explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 19:22 (#1)

וַיֵּלֶךְ

“So he went”

The pronoun **he** refers to Saul. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [So Saul went]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 19:22 (#3)

וַיֹּאמֶר

“And one said”

Here the author is not using the pronoun **one** to refer to a specific person. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And someone said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 19:23 (#1)

עָלָיו גַּם־הוּא

“upon him, him also”

The author is repeating the pronoun **him** to emphasize that even Saul was affected. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate

to do that here in your translation. Alternate translation: [even upon him]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 19:23 (#2)

וַיֵּ֣לֶךְ הָל֔וֹךְ וְיִתְנַבֵּֽא

“and going, he went, and he prophesied”

The author is repeating forms of the verb “go” to indicate continuous action. Alternate translation: [and he went along, and he prophesied]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 19:23 (#3)

וַיֵּ֣לֶךְ הָל֔וֹךְ וְיִתְנַבֵּֽא

“and going, he went, and he prophesied”

This expression conveys a single idea by using two verbal phrases connected with **and**. The phrase **going, he went** tells the circumstances under which Saul **prophesied**. Alternate translation: [and as he went along, he prophesied]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 19:24 (#1)

וַיִּפְשַׁ֤ט גַּם־ה֙וּא֙ בְּגָדָ֔יו

“And he also stripped off his clothes”

This expression likely refers either to royal robes that Saul was wearing to demonstrate his status and authority or to armor and a tunic that Saul may have been wearing on this military expedition to capture David. Alternate translation: [And he also stripped off his royal robes] or [And he also stripped off his armor and his tunic] or [And he also stripped off his outer garments]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 19:24 (#4)

עָרֹ֑ם

“naked”

In biblical Hebrew, the term **naked** could refer to someone who was either entirely or partially unclothed. In this context, it seems that Saul had removed his robes or armor but not the rest of his clothes. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [without his outer garments]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 19:24 (#5)

עַל־כֵּ֣ן יֹאמְר֔וּ הֲגַ֥ם שָׁא֖וּל בַּנְּבִיאִֽם

“Therefore they said, “{Is} Saul also among the prophets”

See the discussion of this statement in the Introduction to this chapter.

See: Proverbs

1 Samuel 19:24 (#2)

וַיִּפְשַׁ֤ט גַּם־ה֙וּא֙ בְּגָדָ֔יו

“And he also stripped off his clothes”

Removing his royal robes or his armor was a symbolic action by which, under prophetic inspiration, Saul was acknowledging that he would eventually surrender the kingship to David, who was present. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [And he also symbolically surrendered his royal authority by stripping off his robe]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 19:24 (#3)

לִפְנֵ֣י שְׁמוּאֵ֔ל

“to the face of Samuel”

The author is using the term **face** to represent Samuel’s presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in Samuel’s presence]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel - Chapter 20 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the part of the book that describes how David became king (chapters 16–31). It describes how David’s friend Jonathan found out for certain that his father Saul intended to kill David and how Jonathan devised a secret way to warn David that he was in danger and that he should flee for his life.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did Saul assume that his son Jonathan would be the next king?

In 20:31, Saul says to his son Jonathan that “all of the days that the son of Jesse lives on the earth, you will not be established, nor your kingdom.” Saul is assuming that Jonathan will be king after him unless

David takes his place. He assumes this because in the ancient Near East, it was usually a king's oldest son who became king after his death. Jonathan was Saul's oldest son. But throughout the Old Testament, we see Yahweh accomplishing his purposes by doing things other than in the customary ways of a culture. Jonathan knew and understood this. He tells David in 23:17 that he expects David to be the next king but that he will be his most important official and advisor. Jonathan did not know that he would be killed in battle before this could happen.

Why did David flee from Naioth after Yahweh had protected him there?
Even though, as the author describes in 19:19–24, Yahweh protected David at Naioth in a supernatural way, we learn in 20:1 that "David fled from Naioth." He seems to have been concerned that someone who was not open to Yahweh's influence in the way that Saul and his messengers clearly were would come to try to capture him. David was right, as an ungodly man, Doeg the Edomite, killed all the priests of Yahweh in 22:18–19. However, it is not necessary to explain this reason in the text of your translation or in a footnote, since the reason becomes clear later in the story.

What was Jonathan doing with the arrows (20:20–22 and 35–40)?
By shooting arrows near the rock where he told David to hide, Jonathan provided a signal for David of whether or not he was safe. Even if David could not hear what Jonathan was saying to the boy, if he saw the boy turn around and head back toward Jonathan, then he would know that he too could return safely to the city and to Saul's court. Similarly, if he saw the boy running farther away after Jonathan called out to him, then he too needed flee for safety.

Why did Jonathan give his seat to Abner (20:25)?
It is possible that Jonathan was showing special courtesy and honor to Abner, Saul's cousin and general, by giving up his seat next to his father Saul and letting Abner sit there. But it's more likely that by seeming to do this, he was actually putting some distance between himself and his father Saul, expecting that Saul might become upset when he learned that Jonathan had given David permission not to be present. In 20:33, the story shows that this was a good idea, since it gave Jonathan more time to get out of the way of the spear that Saul threw at him.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Why did Jonathan make "the enemies of David" accountable for David's actions?
In 20:16, when Jonathan has David promise not to harm his descendants, he says, "And may Yahweh seek from the hand of the enemies of David!" This means, "If you break this promise, may Yahweh punish your enemies!" It does not immediately make sense why Jonathan would say "the enemies of David" rather than "David." Since this is a binding oath, the sense is that Yahweh will hold David accountable for keeping it. Yahweh would punish David, not David's enemies, if David broke the oath. Interpreters have different understandings of why Jonathan says "the enemies of David." It is possible that a person in this culture would not directly threaten another person with divine retribution, especially if they were on good terms. So Jonathan may be speaking indirectly. Other interpreters suggest that out of reverence for David, later scribes may have substituted the phrase about his enemies for a direct reference to David's name. In both explanations, someone is being polite and respectful to David. But if the meaning would not be clear in this polite form, you could state it directly in your translation. You might have Jonathan say, for example, "And may Yahweh seek from the hand of David."

1 Samuel 20:1 (#3)

מֶ֣ה עָשִׂ֔יתִי מֶ֥ה־עֲוֹנִ֖י

"What have I done? What {is} my iniquity"

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. If it would be clearer in your language, you could combine them. Alternate translation: [What have I done that would be iniquity?] or [I have done nothing iniquitous!]

See: Parallelism

1 Samuel 20:1 (#5)

כִּ֥י מְבַקֵּ֖שׁ אֶת־נַפְשִֽׁי

"that {he is} seeking my life"

David is using the term **life** to represent the end of his life, that is, his death. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [that he is seeking to end my life] or [that he is seeking to kill me]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 20:1 (#1)

לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוֹנָתָֽן

"to the face of Jonathan"

The author is using one part of Jonathan, his **face**, to mean all of him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to Jonathan in person]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 20:1 (#2)

מָֽה עָשִׂ֣יתִי֮ מֶה־עֲוֹנִ֒י וּמֶה־חַטָּאתִי֙ לִפְנֵ֣י אָבִ֔יךָ כִּֽי מְבַקֵּ֖שׁ אֶת־נַפְשִֽׁי

“What have I done? What {is} my iniquity? And what {is} my sin to the face of your father, that {he is} seeking my life”

David is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I have done nothing! I have no iniquity! There is no sin of mine to the face of your father, that he should seek my life!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 20:1 (#4)

לִפְנֵ֣י אָבִ֔יךָ

“to the face of your father”

David is using one part of Saul, his **face** to mean all of him in the act of potentially being offended or injured. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [against your father]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 20:2 (#6)

וּמַדּוּעַ֤ יַסְתִּ֙יר אָבִ֔י מִמֶּ֖נִּי אֶת־הַדָּבָ֣ר הַזֶּ֑ה

“So why would my father hide this thing from me”

Jonathan is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [So my father would not hide this thing from me!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 20:2 (#1)

וַיֹּ֥אמֶר לוֹ

“And he said to him”

The pronoun **he** refers to Jonathan, while the pronoun **him** refers to David. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Jonathan said to David]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 20:2 (#2)

חָלִילָ֖הּ

“Profane”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:30. Alternate translation: [Far be it from me to let that happen]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:2 (#3)

הִנֵּ֑ה

“Behold”

See how you translated the term “Behold” in 2:31.

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 20:2 (#4)

דָּבָ֤ר גָּדוֹל֙ אִ֣ם דָּבָ֣ר קָטֹ֔ן

“a great thing or a small thing”

Jonathan is speaking of two extremes in order to mean them and everything in between. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [anything at all]

See: Merism

1 Samuel 20:2 (#5)

וְלֹ֣א יִגְלֶ֔ה אֶת־אָזְנִ֖י

“and not uncover my ear”

Jonathan is using a common expression of his culture to mean that his father tells him such things. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [without telling me]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:2 (#7)

אַ֣יִן זֹ֑את

“There is} not this”

Jonathan is using a common expression of his culture. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [This cannot be happening]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:3 (#2)

מָצָאתִי חֵן בְּעֵינֶיךָ

“I have found favor in your eyes”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:18. Alternate translation: [you are favorably disposed toward me]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:3 (#4)

פֶּן־יֵעָצֵב

“lest he be grieved”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in an active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [lest it grieve him]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 20:3 (#3)

וַיֹּאמֶר אַל־יֵדַע־זֹאת יְהוֹנָתָן פֶּן־יֵעָצֵב

“So he said, ‘May Jonathan not know this, lest he be grieved”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [So he decided not to let you know about this, so you would not be grieved]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 20:3 (#6)

חַי־יְהוָה וְחֵי נַפְשֶׁךָ

“the life of Yahweh, and the life of your soul”

See how you translated the similar expressions in 14:39, 14:45, and 19:6. Alternate translation: [I swear by Yahweh and I swear by your life that]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Samuel 20:3 (#1)

יָדֹעַ יָדַע אָבִיךָ

“Knowing, your father knows”

David is repeating forms of the verb “know” in order to intensify his expression of the idea it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [Your father certainly knows]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 20:3 (#7)

כְּפֶשַׁע בֵּינִנִי וּבֵין הַמָּוֶת

“like a step {is} between me and between death”

David is speaking as if **death** were an object or a location a short distance away from him that he could reach by taking about **a step**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I am just about to be killed]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 20:3 (#5)

חַי־יְהוָה וְחֵי נַפְשֶׁךָ

“the life of Yahweh, and the life of your soul”

David is using one part of Jonathan, his **soul**, to mean all of him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the life of Yahweh, and your life]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 20:4 (#1)

תֹּאמַר נַפְשְׁךָ

“your soul says”

Jonathan is using one part of David, his **soul** to mean all of him in the act of speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you say]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 20:5 (#3)

עַד הָעֶרֶב הַשְּׁלִשִׁת

“until the third evening”

See how you translated the comparable expression in 9:20. Express this time reference the way your language and culture would. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:5 (#1)

הַחֹדֶשׁ

“the new moon”

David is using the term **new moon** to represent a feast that Saul would host on the occasion of the new moon. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the new moon festival]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 20:5 (#2)

וְאָנֹכִי יָשֹׁב־אֵשֵׁב

“and sitting, I should sit”

David is repeating forms of the verb “sit” in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [and I should certainly sit]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 20:6 (#1)

פָּקֹקַד יִפְקְדֵנִי אָבִיךָ

“missing, your father misses me”

David is repeating forms of the verb “miss” in order to intensify his expression of the idea it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [your father indeed misses me]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 20:6 (#3)

נִשְׁאֹלֹ֣ נִשְׁאַל מִמֶּנִּי דָוִד֮ לָרוּץ֒ בֵּית־לֶ֣חֶם עִירוֹ֔ כִּֽי־זֶ֥בַח הַיָּמִ֖ים שָׁ֑שָׁם לְכָל־הַמִּשְׁפָּחָֽה

“Asking, David asked from me to run {to} Bethlehem, his city, for the sacrifice of days {is} there for all of the clan”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since the sacrifice of days is there for all of the clan, asking, David asked from me to run to Bethlehem, his city]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 20:6 (#4)

נִשְׁאֹלֹ֣ נִשְׁאַל מִמֶּנִּי דָוִד֮

“Asking, David asked from me”

David is suggesting that Jonathan repeat forms of the verb “ask” in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for emphasis, it may be appropriate to do so here. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [David sincerely asked me]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 20:6 (#2)

וְאָמַרְתָּ֣ נִשְׁאֹלֹ֣ נִשְׁאַל מִמֶּנִּי דָוִד֮ לָרוּץ֒ בֵּית־לֶ֣חֶם עִירוֹ֔ כִּֽי־זֶ֥בַח הַיָּמִ֖ים שָׁ֑שָׁם לְכָל־הַמִּשְׁפָּחָֽה

“then you shall say, ‘Asking, David asked from me to run {to} Bethlehem, his city, for the sacrifice of days {is} there for all of the clan”

David is using a quotation within his speech. If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [then you shall tell him that asking, I asked from you to run to Bethlehem, my city, for the sacrifice of days is there for all of my clan]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 20:6 (#5)

זֶ֥בַח הַיָּמִ֖ים

“the sacrifice of days”

See how you translated the same expression in 1:21. Alternate translation: [the annual sacrifice]

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

1 Samuel 20:7 (#2)

שָׁל֣וֹם לְעַבְדֶּ֔ךָ

“peace {is} to your servant”

David is speaking about himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [peace is to me]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 20:7 (#1)

אִם־כֹּ֥ה יֹאמַ֖ר טָט֑וֹב

“If thus he says, ‘Good”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within

a quotation. Alternate translation: [If he says that is all right]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 20:7 (#3)

שָׁלֹ֥ום לְעַבְדֶּ֖ךָ

“peace {is} to your servant”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [I am safe]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 20:7 (#4)

חָרֹ֥ה יָחֱרָ֖ה לֹֽו׃

“burning, it burns to him”

David is repeating forms of the verb “burn” in order to intensify his expression of the idea it conveys. If your language can use repetition for emphatic effect, it would be appropriate to do so here. Alternate translation: [it indeed burns to him]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 20:7 (#5)

חָרֹ֥ה יָחֱרָ֖ה לֹֽו׃

“burning, it burns to him”

See how you translated the similar expression in 18:8. Alternate translation: [he indeed becomes very angry]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 20:7 (#6)

כָּלְתָ֥ה הָרָעָ֖ה מֵעִמֹּֽו

“harm has completed from with him”

David is using a common expression of his culture. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he has determined to harm me]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:8 (#2)

וְעָשִׂ֤יתָ חֶ֙סֶד֙ עַל־עַבְדֶּ֔ךָ כִּֽי & הֵבֵ֥אתָ אֶת־עַבְדְּךָ֖

“Then you shall do covenant faithfulness with your servant. For you have brought your servant”

David is speaking humbly about himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [Then you shall do covenant faithfulness with me, your servant. For you have brought me]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 20:8 (#5)

בִּבְרִ֣ית יְהוָ֔ה

“into a covenant of Yahweh”

David is using this possessive form to express the idea of a sworn covenant for which Yahweh has served as the witness. Alternate translation: [into a sworn covenant that Yahweh has witnessed]

See: Possession

1 Samuel 20:8 (#1)

וְעָשִׂ֤יתָ חֶ֙סֶד֙ עַל־עַבְדֶּ֔ךָ כִּֽי בִבְרִ֣ית יְהוָ֔ה הֵבֵ֥אתָ אֶת־עַבְדְּךָ֖ עִמָּ֑ךְ

“Then you shall do covenant faithfulness with your servant. For you have brought your servant into a covenant of Yahweh with you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Then, since you have brought your servant into a covenant of Yahweh with you, you shall do covenant faithfulness with your servant]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 20:8 (#3)

וְעָשִׂ֤יתָ חֶ֙סֶד֙ עַל־עַבְדֶּ֔ךָ

“Then you shall do covenant faithfulness with your servant”

The term translated as **covenant faithfulness** describes the obligations of a relationship. Every person has a general obligation to treat any other person generously and helpfully. That is the context in 15:6, where the ULT translates this term as “kindness.” Here the context is more specific. David is reminding Jonathan that he has made a covenant with him, and the term refers to the obligations of that covenant. Alternate translation: [Then you must be faithful to your covenant with me]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 20:8 (#6)

וְאִם־יֶ֥שׁ־בִּ֖י עָוֹ֑ן

“But if there is iniquity in me”

David is using the term **But** to introduce a contrast between what Jonathan should do if he considers him innocent and what he should do if he considers him guilty of doing something worthy of death. In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [But if you really think that there is iniquity in me]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

1 Samuel 20:8 (#8)

וְעַד־אָבִיךָ לָמָּה־זֶּה תְּבִיאֵנִי

“For why this, that should you bring me to your father”

It might seem that the expression **this, that you should** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [For why should you bring me to your father]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 20:8 (#4)

וְעָשִׂיתָ חֶסֶד עַל־עַבְדֶּךָ

“Then you shall do covenant faithfulness with your servant”

As 18:4 indicates, Jonathan’s covenant with David included a pledge to protect him. Alternate translation: [Then you must be faithful to your covenant with me and protect me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 20:8 (#7)

וְעַד־אָבִיךָ לָמָּה־זֶּה תְּבִיאֵנִי

“For why this, that should you bring me to your father”

David is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [There is no need for you to bring me to your father!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 20:9 (#4)

כָּלְתָה הָרָעָה מֵעִם אָבִי לָבוֹא עָלָיִךְ

“harm has completed from with my father to come upon you”

Jonathan is speaking as if **harm** were an object that Saul could actually make **come upon** David. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [my father has determined to harm you]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 20:9 (#1)

חָלִלָה לָךְ

“Profane to you”

See how you translated the similar expression in 2:30. Alternate translation: [May such a thing never happen to you]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:9 (#2)

אִם־יָדֹעַ אֵדַע

“if knowing, I know”

Jonathan is repeating forms of the verb “know” in order to intensify his expression of the idea it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do so here in your translation. Alternate translation: [certainly if I know]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 20:9 (#5)

וְלֹא אִתָּךְ אַגִּיד לָךְ

“then will I not declare it to you”

Jonathan is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [then I will certainly declare it to you!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 20:9 (#3)

כָּלְתָה הָרָעָה מֵעִם אָבִי לָבוֹא עָלָיִךְ

“harm has completed from with my father to come upon you”

Jonathan is using a common expression of his culture. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [my father has determined to make harm come upon you]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:11 (#1)

לְכָה וְנֵצֵא הַשָּׂדֶה

“Come, and let us go out {to} the field”

This is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. Alternate translation: [Please go out to the field with me]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

1 Samuel 20:12 (#4)

טוֹב אֶל־דָּוִד

“if} good {is} to David”

Jonathan is speaking about David in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the second person. Alternate translation: [if things will be well with you]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 20:12 (#1)

יְהוָה

“By} Yahweh”

Jonathan is swearing an oath. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [I swear by Yahweh]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Samuel 20:12 (#2)

הַשְּׁלִשִׁית

“the third day”

See how you translated the comparable expression in 9:20. Express this time reference the way your language and culture would. Alternate translation: [the day after tomorrow]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:12 (#3)

טוֹב אֶל־דָּוִד

“if} good {is} to David”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **good**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [if things will be well with David]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 20:12 (#7)

וְגָלִיתִי אֶת־אָזְנֶךָ

“and uncover your ear”

Jonathan is using a common expression of his culture. See how you translated the comparable expression in 9:15. Alternate translation: [and tell you]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:12 (#6)

וְלֹא־אָז אֶשְׁלַח אֵלֶיךָ וְגָלִיתִי אֶת־אָזְנֶךָ

“then will I not then send to you and uncover your ear”

Jonathan is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [then I will certainly then send to you and uncover your ear.]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 20:12 (#5)

טוֹב אֶל־דָּוִד

“if} good {is} to David”

Jonathan may be speaking about David in the third person, even though he is addressing him directly, because he is speaking by anticipation from his father’s perspective. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could show this by making this a direct quotation. Alternate translation: [if he says, “I do not intend to harm David”]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Samuel 20:13 (#1)

כֹּה־יַעֲשֶׂה יְהוָה לִיהוֹנָתָן וְכֹה יֹסִיף

“Thus may Yahweh do to Jonathan, and thus may he add”

Jonathan is swearing an oath. See how you translated the similar expression in 14:44. Alternate translation: [May Yahweh kill me, and may he do even worse than that to me, if I do not keep the following promise]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Samuel 20:13 (#4)

כִּי־יִיטַב אֶל־אָבִי אֶת־הָרָעָה עָלֶיךָ

“if harm upon you is good to my father”

The phrase **good to my father** seems to be a shorter form of the expression "good in the eyes of my father." Alternate translation: [if it seems good to my father to harm you] or [if my father intends to harm you]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 20:13 (#3)

כֹּה־יַעֲשֶׂה יְהוָֹה לִיהוֹנָתָן וְכֹה יֹסִיף

"Thus may Yahweh do to Jonathan, and thus may he add"

It was customary in this culture for a person swearing an oath to speak of himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [Thus may Yahweh do to me, and thus may he add]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 20:13 (#5)

וְגָלְיָתִי אֶת־אָזְנֶךָ

"then I will uncover your ear"

Jonathan is using a common expression of his culture. See how you translated the similar expression in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [then I will tell you]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:13 (#7)

וְהָלַכְתָּ לְשָׁלוֹם

"so you may go in peace"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [so you may safely escape]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 20:13 (#2)

כֹּה־יַעֲשֶׂה יְהוָֹה לִיהוֹנָתָן וְכֹה יֹסִיף

"Thus may Yahweh do to Jonathan, and thus may he add"

In this verse, Jonathan is describing what he will do by contrast if his father indeed intends to harm David. It may be helpful to indicate the contrast explicitly. Alternate translation: [But thus may Yahweh do to Jonathan, and thus may he add]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

1 Samuel 20:13 (#6)

וְגָלְיָתִי אֶת־אָזְנֶךָ

"then I will uncover your ear"

Jonathan is stressing that if David needs to flee for his life, then he will come and tell him that in person. He will not send a messenger with that news. Alternate translation: [then I will come and tell you personally]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 20:13 (#8)

וְיִהְיֶ יְהוָהֹ עִמָּךְ כַּאֲשֶׁר הָיָה עִם־אָבִי

"And may Yahweh be with you just as he was with my father"

See how you translated the comparable expression in 3:19. Alternate translation: [And may Yahweh help you just as he helped my father]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:14 (#1)

וְלֹא אִם־עוֹדֶנִּי חָיֶ

"And if I am not still alive"

Jonathan is referring to the time when David becomes king. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And if I am not still alive when you become king]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 20:14 (#2)

וְלֹא אִם־עוֹדֶנִּי חָיֶ

"And if I am not still alive"

Jonathan is describing a condition in which a second event will take place only if a first event does. Express this condition in a way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Suppose I am not still alive when I become king.]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

1 Samuel 20:14 (#3)

וְלֹא־תַעֲשֶׂה עִמְּדִי חֶסֶד יְהוָה וְלֹא אָמוּת

"then you shall not do the covenant faithfulness of Yahweh with me, so I do not die"

Jonathan is certain that if he were still alive when David became king, David would spare his life because of the covenant they have made together. But he also

wants to be certain that David will spare the lives of his descendants if he is no longer alive. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation, translating this in a way that would lead naturally to that statement in the next verse. Alternate translation: [then rather than doing the covenant faithfulness of Yahweh with me so that I do not die]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 20:14 (#4)

וְלֹא־תַעֲשֶׂה עִמָּדִי חֶסֶד יְהוָה

“then you shall not do the covenant faithfulness of Yahweh with me”

See how you translated the similar expression in 20:8. Alternate translation: [then rather than being faithful to the covenant of Yahweh you made with me]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 20:14 (#5)

וְלֹא־תַעֲשֶׂה עִמָּדִי חֶסֶד יְהוָה

“then you shall not do the covenant faithfulness of Yahweh with me”

Jonathan is using this possessive form to describe the covenant that he and David made with Yahweh as their witness. Alternate translation: [then rather than being faithful to the sworn covenant between us that Yahweh has witnessed]

See: Possession

1 Samuel 20:15 (#1)

וְלֹא־תַכְרִית אֶת־חַסְדְּךָ מֵעִם בֵּיתִי

“but you shall not cut off your covenant faithfulness from with my house”

Jonathan is speaking as if David’s **covenant faithfulness** were an object that he could **cut off**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but you shall not withhold your covenant faithfulness from my house] or [but you shall be sure to show your covenant faithfulness to my house]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 20:15 (#2)

מֵעִם בֵּיתִי

“from with my house”

Here, **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. Alternate translation: [from my descendants]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 20:15 (#4)

אֶת־אֹיְבֵי דָוִד

“the enemies of David”

Jonathan is referring to David in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the second person. Alternate translation: [your enemies]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 20:15 (#5)

אִישׁ מֵעַל פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה

“a man from upon the face of the ground”

Jonathan is using a common expression of his culture. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [so that not a single one is left on the surface of the earth]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:15 (#3)

בְּהַכְרֵת יְהוָה

“when Yahweh cuts off”

Jonathan is speaking as if David’s enemies were a branch of a bush or tree such as a person **cuts off**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when Yahweh destroys]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 20:16 (#6)

וּבִקֵּשׁ יְהוָה מִיַּד אֹיְבֵי דָוִד

“And may Yahweh seek from the hand of the enemies of David”

Following the custom of his culture, Jonathan is swearing an oath by stating only one part of a condition (“then”) but not the other part (“if”). If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explicitly state the first part of this condition. Alternate translation: [And if you or your descendants kill all of my descendants, then may Yahweh exact an equivalent penalty] or [And if you or your descendants kill all of my descendants, then may Yahweh kill you and all of your descendants]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Samuel 20:16 (#1)

וַיִּכְרֹ֥ת יְהוֹנָתָ֖ן

“And Jonathan cut”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And Jonathan cut a covenant]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 20:16 (#2)

וַיִּכְרֹ֥ת יְהוֹנָתָ֖ן

“And Jonathan cut”

See how you translated the fuller expression “cut a covenant” in 11:1. Alternate translation: [And Jonathan made a covenant]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:16 (#3)

עִם־בֵּ֣ית דָּוִ֑ד

“with the house of David”

See how you translated the similar expression in 20:15. Alternate translation: [with David that extended to his descendants]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 20:16 (#5)

וּבִקֵּ֖שׁ יְהוָ֥ה מִיַּ֛ד אֹיְבֵ֥י דָוִֽד

“And may Yahweh seek from the hand of the enemies of David”

Jonathan is using a common expression of his culture to mean to exact a penalty. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And may Yahweh exact an equivalent penalty from David]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:16 (#4)

וּבִקֵּ֖שׁ יְהוָ֥ה מִיַּ֛ד אֹיְבֵ֥י דָוִֽד

“And may Yahweh seek from the hand of the enemies of David”

This sentence is the content of the oath that David and Jonathan swore to one another. You may wish to indicate that explicitly in your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language.

Alternate translation: [saying, “And may Yahweh seek from the hand of the enemies of David!”]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 20:17 (#1)

וַיּ֤וֹסֶף יְהוֹנָתָן֙ לְהַשְׁבִּ֣יעַ אֶת־דָּוִ֔ד בְּאַהֲבָתֹ֖ו אֹתֹ֑ו כִּ֥י־אַהֲבַ֖ת נַפְשֹׁ֥ו אֲהֵבֹֽו

“And Jonathan added to make David swear by his love for him, for he loved him {like} the loving of his soul”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And since he loved him like the loving of his soul, Jonathan added to make David swear by his love for him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 20:17 (#2)

וַיּ֤וֹסֶף יְהוֹנָתָן֙ לְהַשְׁבִּ֣יעַ אֶת־דָּוִ֔ד

“And Jonathan added to make David swear”

Together, the words **added** and **swear** express a single idea. The word **added** tells in what way Jonathan made David **swear**. Alternate translation: [And Jonathan made David swear again]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 20:17 (#4)

אַהֲבַ֖ת נַפְשֹׁ֥ו

“like} the loving of his soul”

See how you translated this expression in 18:1. Alternate translation: [as he loved himself]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 20:17 (#3)

בְּאַהֲבָתֹ֖ו אֹתֹ֑ו כִּ֥י־אַהֲבַ֖ת נַפְשֹׁ֥ו אֲהֵבֹֽו

“by his love for him, for he loved him {like} the loving of his soul”

This could mean: (1) Alternate translation: [by the love that David had for Jonathan, for David loved Jonathan like the loving of his soul]; (2) Alternate translation: [because Jonathan loved David, for Jonathan loved David like the loving of his soul]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 20:18 (#4)

וְנִפְקַדְתָּ כִּֽי־יִפָּקֵד מוֹשָׁבֶךָ

“And you will be missed, for your seat will be missed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in an active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And my father will miss you, for he will miss your sitting in your seat] or [And my father will miss you, for he will see that you are not sitting in your seat]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 20:18 (#3)

וְנִפְקַדְתָּ כִּֽי־יִפָּקֵד מוֹשָׁבֶךָ

“And you will be missed, for your seat will be missed”

Jonathan is using the term **seat** to represent David’s action of sitting in his seat. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And you will be missed, for your sitting in your seat will be missed] or [And you will be missed, for your seat will be empty]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 20:18 (#1)

הַחֹדֶשׁ

“is} the new moon”

See how you translated this expression in 20:5. Alternate translation: [the new moon festival]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 20:18 (#2)

וְנִפְקַדְתָּ כִּֽי־יִפָּקֵד מוֹשָׁבֶךָ

“And you will be missed, for your seat will be missed”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And since your seat will be missed, you will be missed]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 20:19 (#1)

וְשָׁלַשְׁתָּ

“And you shall stay three days”

See how you translated the similar expression in 20:12. Alternate translation: [And on the day after tomorrow]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:19 (#4)

אֵצֶל הָאֶבֶן הָאָזֶל

“beside the stone Ezel”

The name **Ezel** is the name of a stone. The name Ezel means “departure.” It is possible that the stone got this name because it was the place where David and Jonathan parted from one another, as 20:41–42 describes. If so, the author would be using the later name while presenting what Jonathan said here, even though the stone did not have that name at this time. (The author does something similar with the name Ebenezer in 4:1.) If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain this in a footnote.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 20:19 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר־נִסְתַּרְתָּ שָׁ֖ם

“where you hid yourself there”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [where you hid yourself]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 20:19 (#3)

בְּיוֹם הַמַּעֲשֶׂה

“on the day of the deed”

Jonathan assumes that David will know that by **the day of the deed**, he means the time when Saul first tried to kill David, since Jonathan told David then, “stay in a secret place and hide yourself” (19:2). You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [at the time when my father first tried to kill you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 20:21 (#4)

לַנַּ֔עַר הִנֵּ֥ה הַחִצִּ֖ים ו מִמְּךָ֣ וָהֵ֑נָּה קָחֶ֔נּוּ

“to the boy, ‘Behold, the arrows {are} from you, and hither, get them”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a

quotation. Alternate translation: [that he should look and see that the arrows are from him, and hither, so he should get them]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 20:21 (#2)

אֶשְׁלַ֤ח אֶת־הַנַּ֙עַר֙ לֵ֣ךְ מְצָ֔א֥ אֶת־הַחִצִּ֖ים

“I will send a boy, ‘Go find the arrows”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [I will send a boy to go and find the arrows]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 20:21 (#6)

וְבֹ֖אָה כִּי־שָׁל֣וֹם לְךָ֔ וְאֵ֥ין דָּבָ֖ר

“then come, for peace {is} for you and there is no matter”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [then, since peace is for you and there is no matter, come]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 20:21 (#7)

שָׁל֣וֹם לְךָ֔

“peace {is} for you”

See how you translated this expression in 20:7. Alternate translation: [you are safe]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 20:21 (#8)

חַי־יְהוָ֕ה

“the life of Yahweh”

Following the custom of his culture, Jonathan is swearing an oath by guaranteeing it by something he holds sacred. Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. Alternate translation: [I swear this by Yahweh]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Samuel 20:21 (#3)

אִם־אָמֹ֥ר אֹמַ֖ר

“If saying, I say”

Jonathan is repeating forms of the verb “say” in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing emphasis. Alternate translation: [If I clearly say]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 20:21 (#5)

הַחִצִּ֗ים ו מִמְּךָ֥ וְהֵ֛נָּה קָחֶ֖נּוּ

“the arrows {are} from you, and hither, get them”

Jonathan is using a common expression of his culture to mean that the arrows are on his side of where the boy is standing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you have gone past the arrows, come back toward here and get them]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:21 (#1)

אֶשְׁלַ֤ח אֶת־הַנַּ֙עַר֙ לֵ֣ךְ מְצָ֔א֥ אֶת־הַחִצִּ֖ים

“I will send a boy, ‘Go find the arrows”

Jonathan is describing what he will say to the boy. You may wish to make this explicit in your translation, using a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [I will send a boy, saying, ‘Go find the arrows]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 20:22 (#1)

הַחִצִּ֗ים מִמְּךָ֥ וָהָלְאָ֖ה

“the arrows {are} from you, and beyond”

Jonathan is using a common expression of his culture to mean that the arrows are farther ahead of where the boy is standing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [keep going, the arrows are farther ahead of you]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:22 (#2)

לֵ֔ךְ כִּֽי־שַׁלְּחֲךָ֖ יְהוָֽה

“go, for Yahweh has sent you away”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first

phrase describes. Alternate translation: [since Yahweh has sent you away, go]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 20:22 (#3)

שִׁלַּחֲךָ יְהוָה

“Yahweh has sent you away”

Jonathan means that under these circumstances, Yahweh would be sending David away for his own safety. He is not saying that Yahweh does not want David to be at the royal court. Saul, through his own jealousy and suspicion, is responsible for making it unsafe for David to be there. Alternate translation: [Yahweh has sent you away for your own safety]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 20:23 (#2)

יְהוָה בֵּינִי וּבֵינְךָ

“Yahweh {is} between me and between you”

Jonathan means that Yahweh will serve as a witness to their promises and ensure that they keep them. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could make this explicit in your translation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh is a witness between me and you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 20:23 (#1)

וְהַדָּבָר אֲשֶׁר דִּבַּרְנוּ אֲנִי וָאָתָּה

“And the word that I and you have spoken”

Jonathan is using the term **word** to represent the promises he and David have made to each other. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [As for the promises that you and I have made to each other]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 20:24 (#1)

וַיֵּשֶׁב הַמֶּמֶלְךְּ עַל־הַלֶּחֶם לֶאֱכֹל

“and the king sat down at the food to eat”

The author is using the term **food** to represent the feast that was prepared for this occasion. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and the king sat down to eat the feast]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 20:25 (#1)

כְּפַעַם ׀ בְּפַעַם

“as time by time”

The author is using a common expression of his culture that means “as usual” or “as was customary.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as he did every time] or [as he usually did]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:25 (#2)

אֶל־מוֹשַׁבוֹ הַקִּקָּיר

“on the seat {by} the wall”

In this culture, as in many cultures, certain seats at a table were considered places of honor. The **seat by the wall** was the place of greatest honor at this table. (The context suggests that the table was long and extended out from the wall.) Sitting in that seat was a symbolic action by which Saul indicated his status as king. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of his action. Your language may have an appropriate expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [at the head of the table, since that was the place of greatest honor]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 20:25 (#3)

וַיָּקָם יְהוֹנָתָן וַיֵּשֶׁב אַבְנֵר מִצַּד שָׁאוּל

“And Jonathan arose, and Abner sat by the side of Saul”

See the discussion of this statement in the Introduction to this chapter.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 20:25 (#4)

וַיִּפָּקֵד מְקוֹם דָּוִד

“And the place of David was missing”

See how you translated the similar expression in 20:18. Alternate translation: [But David’s seat was empty]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 20:26 (#1)

אָמַר

“he said”

Saul did not say these words out loud. Rather, this was what he thought to himself. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could make this explicit in your translation. Alternate translation: [he said to himself] or [he thought]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 20:26 (#2)

בִּלְתִּ֥י טָה֖וֹר הַה֑וּא כִּי־לֹ֥א טָהֽוֹר

“He {is} not clean, surely not clean”

In this instance, Saul is actually not repeating the word **clean** for emphasis. Instead, the author is showing how Saul talked himself into this conclusion. So it would be appropriate to repeat the word in your translation.

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 20:27 (#1)

וַיְהִ֗י

“And it happened”

The author is introducing a new development in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 20:27 (#4)

בֶּן־יִשַׁ֛י

“the son of Jesse”

Saul could have referred to David by his name, or he could have respectfully called him “my son-in-law.” But he seems to call him **the son of Jesse** in front of his guests in order to suggest that David is of lowly origin and should not take for granted the opportunity to dine at the king’s table. So we recommend that you do not use the name David in place of the phrase Saul uses. It may be possible to represent this phrase in such a way as to indicate Saul’s tone and intention. Alternate translation: [that son of Jesse]

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 20:27 (#2)

הַחֹ֔דֶשׁ

“the new moon”

See how you translated this expression in 20:5. Alternate translation: [the new moon festival]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 20:27 (#3)

הַשֵּׁנִ֑י

“the second”

If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you can use a cardinal number here or an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [day two] or [the following day]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Samuel 20:27 (#5)

אֶל־הַלָּֽחֶם

“to the food”

See how you translated this expression in 20:24. Alternate translation: [to the feast]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 20:28 (#2)

עַד־בֵּ֥ית לָֽחֶם

“to Bethlehem”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [to go to Bethlehem]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 20:28 (#1)

נְשָׁאֹ֤ל נְשָׁאַל֙ דָּוִ֔ד

“Asking, David asked”

Jonathan is repeating forms of the verb “ask” to show that David made his request earnestly. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing emphasis. Alternate translation: [David earnestly asked]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 20:29 (#2)

אָחִ֔י

“my brother”

The context suggests that this would be David's oldest brother. If your language marks that distinction, you may wish to indicate that in your translation.

See: Kinship

1 Samuel 20:29 (#4)

וְעַתָּה

"And now"

See how you translated this expression in 6:7. Alternate translation: [So this is what I would like you to let me do]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 20:29 (#6)

אֶל־שֻׁלְחַן הַמֶּלֶךְ

"to the table of the king"

Jonathan is addressing Saul respectfully in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [to your table, O king]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 20:29 (#5)

מָצָאתִי חֵן בְּעֵינֶיךָ

"I have found favor in your eyes"

See how you translated the similar expression in 20:3. Alternate translation: [you are favorably disposed toward me]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:29 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר שַׁלְּחֵנִי נָּא כִּכְי זֶבַח מִשְׁפָּחָה לָנוּ בָּעִיר וְהוּא צִוָּה־לִי אָחִי וְעַתָּה אִם־מָצָאתִי חֵן בְּעֵינֶיךָ אִמָּלְטָה נָּא וְאֶרְאֶה אֶת־אֶחָי

"And he said, 'Please let me go. For the sacrifice of our clan {is} in the city, and my brother himself has commanded me. And now, if I have found favor in your eyes, may I please go away, and may I see my brothers"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [He asked me if I would please let him go, since the sacrifice of his clan is in that city, and his brother himself had commanded him. He asked me to allow him, if he had found favor in my eyes, please to go away and see his brothers]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 20:29 (#3)

שַׁלְּחֵנִי נָּא כִּכְי זֶבַח מִשְׁפָּחָה לָנוּ בָּעִיר וְהוּא צִוָּה־לִי אָחִי

"Please let me go. For the sacrifice of our clan {is} in the city, and my brother himself has commanded me"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since the sacrifice of our clan is in the city, and my brother himself has commanded me, please send me away]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 20:29 (#7)

אֶל־שֻׁלְחַן הַמֶּלֶךְ

"to the table of the king"

Jonathan is using the term **table** to represent the feast that was served on it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to your feast, O king]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 20:30 (#2)

בֶּן־נַעֲוַת הַמַּרְדּוּת

"Son of one perverting herself in rebellion"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **rebellion**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Son of one rebelliously perverting herself]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 20:30 (#1)

וַיִּחַר־אַף שָׁאוּל בִּיהוֹנָתָן

"And the nose of Saul burned against Jonathan"

See how you translated this expression in 11:6. Alternate translation: [And Saul became very angry with Jonathan]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 20:30 (#3)

הֲלֹוא יָדַעְתִּי כִּי־בֹחֵר אַתָּה לְבֶן־יִשַׁי לְבָשְׁתְּךָ וּלְבֹשֶׁת עֶרְוַת אִמֶּךָ

"Do I not know that you are choosing the son of Jesse to your shame and to the shame of the nakedness of your mother"

Saul is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Certainly I know that you are choosing the son of Jesse to your shame and to the shame of the nakedness of your mother!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 20:30 (#4)

לְבָֽשְׁתְּךָ֖ וּלְבֹ֣שֶׁת עֶרְוַ֔ת אִמֶּֽךָ

“to your shame and to the shame of the nakedness of your mother”

Saul is using these expressions to represent that Jonathan’s actions show that he is illegitimate and that his mother’s sexual conduct has been shameful. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [showing that you are shamefully illegitimate and that your mother’s sexual conduct has been shameful]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 20:31 (#5)

לֹ֤א תִכּ֙וֹן אַתָּ֔ה וּמַלְכוּתֶ֖ךָ

“you will not be established, nor your kingdom”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. Saul is using them together for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [you will certainly not be established as king] or [Yahweh will certainly not establish you as king]

See: Parallelism

1 Samuel 20:31 (#3)

לֹ֤א תִכּ֙וֹן אַתָּ֔ה וּמַלְכוּתֶ֖ךָ

“you will not be established, nor your kingdom”

Saul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [you will not be established, nor will your kingdom be established]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 20:31 (#1)

כִּֽי

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces a fuller explanation. Alternate translation: [I say this because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 20:31 (#2)

כָּל־הַיָּמִ֗ים

“all of the days”

Saul is using the term **days** to represent a particular time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the whole time]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 20:31 (#4)

לֹ֤א תִכּ֙וֹן אַתָּ֔ה וּמַלְכוּתֶ֖ךָ

“you will not be established, nor your kingdom”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in an active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The sense is the same as in 13:13, where Samuel uses an active form. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will not establish you, nor will he establish your kingdom]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 20:31 (#6)

שְׁלַ֥ח וְקָחֵ֖הוּ אֹתוֹ֙ אֵלַ֔י כִּֽי בֶן־מָ֖וֶת הֽוּא

“send and take him to me, for he {is} a son of death”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [since he is a son of death, send and take him to me]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 20:31 (#7)

בֶן־מָ֖וֶת הֽוּא

“he {is} a son of death”

In certain contexts, biblical authors and characters use the expression **son of** to indicate that a person is characterized by something. In this case, Saul means that David is characterized by death, that is, he deserves to die. If it would be helpful to your

readers, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he deserves to die]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:32 (#1)

וַיַּ֣עַן יְהוֹנָתָ֔ן אֶת־שָׁא֖וּל אָבִ֑יו וַיֹּ֥אמֶר אֵלָ֖יו

“And Jonathan answered Saul his father and said to him”

The phrase **and said to him** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this expression explicitly. Alternate translation: [And Jonathan responded to Saul his father]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 20:32 (#3)

לָ֥מָּה יוּמַ֖ת

“Why should he be killed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in an active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Why should you kill him?] or [You should not kill him!]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 20:32 (#2)

לָ֥מָּה יוּמַ֖ת מֶ֥ה עָשָֽׂה

“Why should he be killed? What has he done”

Jonathan is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [He should not be killed! He has done nothing to deserve that!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 20:33 (#1)

לְהַכֹּתֽוֹ

“to strike him”

See how you translated the term “struck” in 4:2. Alternate translation: [to kill him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 20:33 (#2)

כָּלָ֥ה הִהֲיָ֛א מֵעִ֥עִם אָבִ֖יו

“it had completed from with his father”

See how you translated this expression in 20:7. Alternate translation: [his father had determined]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:34 (#1)

בָּחֳרִי־אָ֑ף

“with burning of nose”

See how you translated this expression in 20:30. Alternate translation: [in great anger]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 20:34 (#2)

וְלֹא־אָכַ֥ל בְּיוֹם־הַחֹ֖דֶשׁ הַשֵּׁנִ֑י לֶ֚חֶם כִּֽי־נֶעְצַ֣ב אֶל־דָּוִ֔ד כִּ֥י הִכְלִמֽוֹ אָבִֽיו

“And he did not eat bread on the second day of the new moon, for he was grieved for David, because his father had dishonored him”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And because his father had dishonored David, he was grieved for him, so he did not eat bread on the second day of the new moon]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 20:34 (#4)

הַחֹ֖דֶשׁ

“the new moon”

See how you translated this expression in 20:5. Alternate translation: [the new moon festival]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 20:34 (#5)

נֶעְצַ֣ב אֶל־דָּוִ֔ד

“he was grieved for David”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in an active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [he had become aggrieved for David]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 20:34 (#3)

בְּיוֹם & הַשֵּׁנִי

“on the second day of”

If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you can use a cardinal number here or an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [on day two of] or [on that next day of]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Samuel 20:35 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“And it happened”

The author is introducing a new development in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 20:36 (#1)

וְהוּא־יָרָה הַחֵצִי לְהַעֲבִרוֹ

“and he shot the arrow to pass over him”

The pronoun **he** refers to Jonathan, while the pronoun **him** refers to the boy. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Jonathan shot an arrow beyond the young man]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 20:37 (#2)

הֲלֹלַוֹא הַחֵצִי מִמְּךָּ וָהָלְאָה

“Is} not the arrow from you, and beyond”

See how you translated this expression in 20:22. Alternate translation: [Is not the arrow farther ahead of you?] or [Keep going, the arrow is farther ahead of you!]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:37 (#1)

הֲלֹלַוֹא הַחֵצִי מִמְּךָּ וָהָלְאָה

“Is} not the arrow from you, and beyond”

Jonathan is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [The arrow is from you, and beyond!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 20:38 (#1)

אֶת־הַחִצִּי

“the arrows”

By using the plural term **arrows**, the author is indicating that Jonathan actually shot three arrows, as he said he would in 20:20. You may wish to indicate this in your translation. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 20:39 (#1)

וְהַנַּעַר לֹא־יָדַע מְאוּמָה

“Now the boy did not know anything”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what is happening in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 20:39 (#2)

וְהַנַּעַר לֹא־יָדַע מְאוּמָה

“Now the boy did not know anything”

The author means that the boy did not understand the significance of what Jonathan was doing with the arrows. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could make this explicit in your translation. Alternate translation: [Now the boy did not know anything about what Jonathan and David had arranged]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 20:41 (#3)

וַיִּשְּׁקְקוּ ׀ אִישׁ אֶת־רֵעֵהוּ

“And they kissed, a man with his companion”

The author is using a common expression of his culture. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And they kissed each other]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:41 (#4)

וַיִּשְּׁקְקוּ ׀ אִישׁ אֶת־רֵעֵהוּ

“And they kissed, a man with his companion”

In this culture, when men greeted other men who were family or friends, they would kiss them on one cheek or on both cheeks. If your readers would find it embar-

rassing if you said that one man kissed another man, you could explain the purpose of the gesture, or you could translate the expression in a more general way. Alternate translation: [And to show their friendship they kissed each other on the cheek] or [And they gave each other a warm, friendly greeting]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 20:41 (#2)

וַיִּפֹּ֤ל לְאַפָּיו֙ אַ֣רְצָה וַיִּשְׁתַּ֖חוּ שָׁלֹ֣שׁ פְּעָמִ֑ים

“and he fell on his nostrils to the ground, and he prostrated himself three times”

Be sure that it is clear in your translation that David did not fall down accidentally. He knelt down in front of Jonathan, pressing his face to the ground, as a gesture to honor him. He then pushed himself up onto his knees and lowered his face to the ground again for a total of three times in order to show great honor to Jonathan. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [and he knelt down and pressed his face to the ground in front of Jonathan to show him great honor. He bowed in front of him that way three times]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 20:41 (#5)

וַיִּבְכּוּ֙ אִ֣ישׁ אֶת־רֵעֵ֔הוּ

“And they wept, a man with his companion”

The author is using a common expression of his culture. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And they wept together]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 20:41 (#1)

הַנֶּ֔גֶב

“the south”

The author is using the term **south** to represent the south side of the stone where David was hiding. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the south side of the stone]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 20:41 (#7)

עַד־דָּוִ֖ד הִגְדִּֽיל

“until David made great”

This could mean: (1) Alternate translation: [until David was overcome with emotion]; (2) Alternate translation: [but David wept even more than Jonathan did]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 20:41 (#6)

עַד־דָּוִ֖ד הִגְדִּֽיל

“until David made great”

The author is leaving out some words that can be understood from the context. He is speaking about David similarly to the way he spoke about Hannah in 1:12 when he said that “she made great to pray” (although he is using a different verb for **made great** here). Alternate translation: [until David made great to weep]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 20:42 (#3)

לֵאמֹ֗ר יְהוָ֤ה יִהְיֶה֙ ׀ בֵּינִ֣י וּבֵינֶ֔ךָ וּבֵ֥ין זַרְעִ֖י וּבֵ֣ין זַרְעֲךָ֑ עַד־עוֹלָֽם

“saying, ‘Yahweh is between me and between you, and between my seed and between your seed, forever”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [that Yahweh will be between us and our seed forever]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 20:42 (#6)

וּבֵ֥ין זַרְעִ֖י וּבֵ֣ין זַרְעֲךָ֑

“and between my seed and between your seed”

Jonathan is speaking of descendants as if they were **seed** from which plants could grow. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and between my descendants and your descendants]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 20:42 (#7)

וַיָּ֖קָם וַיֵּלַ֑ךְ

“And he arose and went”

The pronoun **he** refers to David. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And David arose and went]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 20:42 (#8)

וַיָּ֖קָם וַיֵּלַ֑ךְ

“And he arose and went”

See how you translated this expression in 1:9. The term **arose** has a similar meaning of “took action,” with the implication here that David made himself do something that was difficult but necessary. Alternate translation: [And he resolutely left] or [And he forced himself to leave]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 20:42 (#1)

לֵ֚ךְ לְשָׁלֹ֔ום אֲשֶׁר֙ נִשְׁבַּ֣עְנוּ שְׁנֵ֔ינוּ אֲנַ֖חְנוּ בְּשֵׁ֣ם יְהוָ֑ה

“Go in peace, because we, the two of us, have sworn in the name of Yahweh”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since we, the two of us, have sworn in the name of Yahweh, go in peace]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 20:42 (#2)

לְשָׁלֹ֔ום

“in peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [peacefully]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 20:42 (#4)

נִשְׁבַּ֣עְנוּ & בְּשֵׁ֣ם יְהוָ֑ה

“have sworn in the name of Yahweh”

Jonathan is using the term **name** to represent Yahweh’s authority and power to enforce oaths. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [have sworn, asking Yahweh to enforce our oath]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 20:42 (#5)

יְהוָ֔ה יִהְיֶ֕ה ׀ בֵּינִ֖י וּבֵינֶ֑ךָ וּבֵ֤ין זַרְעִי֙ וּבֵ֣ין זַרְעֲךָ֔

“Yahweh is between me and between you, and between my seed and between your seed”

See how you translated this expression in 20:23. Alternate translation: [Yahweh is a witness between me and you, and he is a witness between my seed and your seed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel - Chapter 21 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the part of the book that describes how David became king (chapters 16–31). It describes how David fled hastily from Saul’s court in Gibeah in order to save his life. It first tells how he went to the city of Nob, where the Israelite priests were with the Box of Yahweh, and asked for food and a weapon. It then tells how he fled to the Philistine city of Gath, where Saul presumably could not attack him. However, the officials of the king of Gath did not want to have David, a great Israelite military commander, in their city. David pretended to be crazy so that they would not feel threatened by him.

Some translations set each line of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with the poetic song in 21:11.

1 Samuel 21:1 (#1)

וַיֶּחֱרַ֖ד אֲחִימֶ֑לֶךְ

“And Ahimelech trembled”

See how you translated the similar expression in 16:4. Alternate translation: [And Ahimelech trembled with fear]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 21:1 (#2)

מַדּ֥וּעַ אַתָּה֙ לְבַדֶּ֔ךָ וְאִ֖ישׁ אֵ֣ין אִתָּֽךְ

“Why {are} you by yourself and no man {is} with you”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. Ahimelech uses them together for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could combine them. Alternate translation: [Why have you come here all alone]

See: Parallelism

1 Samuel 21:2 (#1)

וַיֹּ֨אמֶר אֵלַ֜י אִ֣ישׁ אַל־יֵדַ֗ע מְאוּמָה֙ אֶת־הַדָּבָ֔ר אֲשֶׁר־אָנֹכִ֥י שֹׁלֵחֲךָ֖ וַאֲשֶׁ֣ר צִוִּיתִ֑ךָ

“and has said to me, ‘May a man not know anything {about} the matter {for} which I am sending you and {about} which I have commanded you”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and has told me not to let anyone know anything about the matter for which he is sending me and about which he has commanded me]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 21:3 (#2)

בְּיָדִי

“into my hand”

David is using one part of himself, his **hand**, to mean all of him in the act of receiving. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to me]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 21:3 (#1)

מַה־יֵּשׁ תַּחַת־יָדְךָ

“what is there under your hand”

The author is using a common expression of his culture. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what do you have on hand] or [what do you have available]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 21:3 (#3)

אוֹ הַנִּמְצָא

“or the {thing} being found”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [or whatever you might find]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 21:3 (#4)

אוֹ הַנִּמְצָא

“or the {thing} being found”

See how you translated the similar expression in 9:8. Alternate translation: [or whatever you might have]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 21:4 (#2)

אִם־נִשְׁמְרוּ הַנְּעָרִים אַךְ מֵאִשָּׁה

“If the young men have only kept themselves from women”

Ahimelech is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [The young men may have it if only they have kept themselves from women]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 21:4 (#1)

אֵין־לֶחֶם חֹל אֶל־תַּחַת יָדִי

“There is} no common bread toward under my hand”

See how you translated the similar expression in 21:3. Alternate translation: [I have no common bread on hand] or [I have no common bread available]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 21:5 (#2)

אִשָּׁה עֻצְּרָה־לָּנוּ

“a woman has been kept from us”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [we have kept ourselves from women]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 21:5 (#4)

כְּלֵי־הַנְּעָרִים & בַּכֶּלִי

“the vessels of the men & with the vessels”

David is using one part of the men’s bodies, their **vessels** (meaning their sexual organs), to mean all of them in the context of not having had sexual relations recently. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the bodies of the men ... with their bodies]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 21:5 (#3)

כִּתְמוֹל שִׁלְשׁוֹם

“as yesterday and the third day”

See how you translated this expression in 4:7. Alternate translation: [as in the past] or [as always]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 21:5 (#1)

אִשָּׁשָׁה עֲצֻרָה־לָּנוּ

“a woman has been kept from us”

David is not referring to a specific **woman**. He means women in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using a plural form. Alternate translation: [women have been kept from us]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 21:6 (#4)

לֶּחֶם הַפָּנִים & מִלִּפְנֵי יְהוָה

“the bread of the face & from to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated the term **face** in 1:12. Alternate translation: [the bread of the presence ... from the presence of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 21:6 (#2)

קֹדֶשׁ

“the holy”

The author is using the adjective **holy** as a noun to mean holy bread. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [holy bread]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 21:6 (#5)

הַמּוּסָרִים

“having been removed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [which they had removed]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 21:6 (#6)

בְּיוֹם הִלָּקְחוֹ

“on the day of its being taken away”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [at the time when they took it away]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 21:6 (#3)

כִּי לֹא־הָיָה שָׁשָׁם לֶחֶם כִּי־אִם־לֶחֶם הַפָּנִים

“For no bread was there except the bread of the face”

If it would appear in your language that the author was making a statement and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [For the only bread that was there was the bread of the face]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

1 Samuel 21:6 (#1)

וַיִּתֶּן־לוֹ הַכֹּהֵן קֹדֶשׁ כִּי לֹא־הָיָה שָׁשָׁם לֶחֶם כִּי־אִם־לֶחֶם הַפָּנִים הַמּוּסָרִים מִלִּפְנֵי יְהוָה לָשׂוּם לֶחֶם חֹם בְּיוֹם הִלָּקְחוֹ

“So the priest gave to him the holy. For no bread was there except the bread of the face having been removed from to the face of Yahweh to put hot bread on the day of its being taken away”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [So since no bread was there if not the bread of the face having been removed from to the face of Yahweh to put hot bread on the day of its being taken away, the priest gave to him the holy]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 21:7 (#2)

נֶעְצָר

“He was detained”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. The context suggests that Doeg needed to stay at the sacred tent, which was in Nob at this time, in order to fulfill a vow or to wait out a period of ceremonial uncleanness. Alternate translation: [A religious obligation was detaining him]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 21:7 (#3)

וּשְׁמֹו֙ דֹּאֵ֣גֹ הָאֲדֹמִ֔י אַבִּ֖יר הָרֹעִ֑ים אֲשֶׁ֖ר לְשָׁא֥וּל

“And his name {was} Doeg the Edomite, the chief of the herders who {were} to Saul”

Here the author is introducing Doeg as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Samuel 21:7 (#1)

וְשָׁ֣ם אִישׁ֩ מֵעַבְדֵ֨י שָׁא֜וּל בַּיּ֣וֹם הַה֗וּא נֶעְצָר֙ לִפְנֵ֣י יְהוָ֔ה וּשְׁמֹו֙ דֹּאֵ֣גֹ הָאֲדֹמִ֔י אַבִּ֖יר הָרֹעִ֑ים אֲשֶׁ֖ר לְשָׁא֥וּל

“Now a man {was} there from the servants of Saul on that day. He was detained to the face of Yahweh. And his name {was} Doeg the Edomite, the chief of the herders who {were} to Saul”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 21:8 (#1)

וְאֵ֣ין יֶשׁ־פֹּ֗ה תַּ֚חַת־יָדְךָ֔ חֲנִ֥ית אֽוֹ־חֶ֖רֶב

“And is there not here under your hand a spear or a sword”

See how you translated the similar expression in 21:3. Alternate translation: [And would you have on hand a spear or a sword] or [And would you have a spear or sword available]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 21:8 (#4)

בְּיָדִ֑י

“in my hand”

David is using one part of himself, his **hand**, to mean all of him in the act of carrying weapons. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with me]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 21:8 (#2)

כִּֽי־

“For”

Here the word **For** provides not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [I am asking because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 21:8 (#5)

הָיְתָ֥ה דְבַר־הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ נָחוּֽץ

“the matter of the king was being urged”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the king was urging the matter] or [the matter of the king was urgent]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 21:8 (#3)

גַּם־חַרְבִּ֥י וְגַם־כֵּלַ֖י לֹא־לָקַ֣חְתִּי בְיָדִ֑י כִּֽי־הָיְתָ֥ה דְבַר־הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ נָחוּֽץ

“both my sword and also my weapons I did not take in my hand, because the matter of the king was being urged”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [since the matter of the king was being urged, both my sword and also my weapons I did not take in my hand]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 21:9 (#1)

גָּלְיָ֣ת הַפְּלִשְׁתִּ֔י

“Goliath the Philistine”

See how you translated this name in 17:8. Alternate translation: [Goliath, the Philistine warrior champion]

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 21:9 (#3)

הִנֵּ֤ה

“behold”

Ahimelech is using the term **behold** to focus David’s attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. See how you translated this term in 2:31.

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 21:9 (#6)

אֵ֣ין אַחֲרֶ֔ת זוּלָתָ֖הּ בָּזֶ֑ה

“no other except it {is} in this {place”

If it would appear in your language that Ahimelech was making a statement and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [it is the only one in this place]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

1 Samuel 21:9 (#7)

תְּנֻנָּה לִי

“Give {it} to me”

This is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as “please” to make this clear.

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

1 Samuel 21:9 (#2)

הִכִּיתָ

“you struck”

See how you translated the similar expression in 4:2. Alternate translation: [you killed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 21:9 (#5)

אִם־אֹתָהּ תִּקַּח־לְךָ קָחָה כִּי אֵין אַחֶרֶת זוּלָתָהּ בָּזֶה

“If you would take it for yourself, take, for no other except it {is} in this {place”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [since no other except it is in this place, if you would take it for yourself, take]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 21:9 (#4)

הִנֵּה לוּטָה בַשִּׂמְלָה אַחֲרֶי

“it {is} wrapped in a cloak behind”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [we have wrapped it in a cloak and put it behind]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 21:10 (#2)

מִפְּנֵי שָׁאוּל

“from the face of Saul”

The author is using Saul’s **face** to represent his determination to kill David. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from Saul, who wanted to kill him]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 21:10 (#1)

וַיָּקָם דָּוִד

“And David arose”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:9. Alternate translation: [And David took action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 21:11 (#1)

הֲלוֹא־זֶה דָּוִד מֶלֶךְ הָאָרֶץ הֲלֹלוֹא לָזֶה יַעֲנוּ בַמְּחֹלוֹת לֵאמֹר הִכָּה שָׁאוּל בַּאלָפָו וְדָוִד בְּרִבְבֹתָיו

“QUOTE_NOT_FOUND: הֲלוֹא־זֶה דָּוִד מֶלֶךְ הָאָרֶץ הֲלֹלוֹא לָזֶה יַעֲנוּ בַמְּחֹלוֹת לֵאמֹר הִכָּה שָׁאוּל בַּאלָפָו וְדָוִד בְּרִבְבֹתָיו”

The servants are using the question form for emphasis. If speakers of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [This David is the king of the land! Certainly they sing about him in the dances, saying, ‘Saul has struck his thousands, and David his myriads!’]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 21:11 (#4)

הִכָּה שָׁאוּל בַּאלָפָו וְדָוִד בְּרִבְבֹתָיו

“QUOTE_NOT_FOUND: הִכָּה שָׁאוּל בַּאלָפָו וְדָוִד בְּרִבְבֹתָיו”

See how you translated the similar expression in 18:7. Alternate translation: [Saul has killed thousands of soldiers, and David has killed tens of thousands of soldiers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 21:11 (#2)

הָאָרֶץ

“the land”

The servants mean **the land** of Israel. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would

be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the land of Israel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 21:11 (#3)

לֵאמֹ֑ר הִכָּ֤ה שָׁאוּל֙ באלפו וְדָוִ֔ד בְּרִבְבֹתָֽיו

“QUOTE_NOT_FOUND: לֵאמֹ֑ר הִכָּ֤ה שָׁאוּל֙ באלפו וְדָוִ֔ד בְּרִבְבֹתָֽיו”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and say that Saul has struck his thousands, and David his myriads]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 21:12 (#1)

וַיָּ֣שֶׂם דָּוִ֔ד אֶת־הַדְּבָרִ֖ים הָאֵ֑לֶּה בִּלְבָבֽוֹ

“And David put these words in his heart”

See how you translated the similar expression in 9:20. Alternate translation: [And David became concerned about these words]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 21:12 (#2)

אֶת־הַדְּבָרִ֖ים הָאֵ֑לֶּה

“these words”

The author is using the term **words** to represent what the servants were saying about David. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [what they were saying]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 21:12 (#3)

מִפְּנֵ֖י אָכִ֥ישׁ

“from the face of Achish”

See how you translated the similar expression in 21:10. The author is using one part of Achish, his **face**, to mean all of him in his potential hostility toward David. Alternate translation: [of Achish]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 21:13 (#3)

ויתו עַל־דַּלְתֹ֣ות הַשַּׁ֔עַר

“And he made marks on the doors of the gate”

This could mean: (1) that David scratched the doors of the gate with his fingernails. Alternate translation: [And he scratched the doors of the gate with his fingernails]; (2) that David scribbled nonsense on the doors of the gate. Alternate translation: [And he scribbled nonsense on the doors of the gate]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 21:13 (#1)

בְּעֵינֵיהֶ֑ם

“in their eyes”

See how you translated this similar expression in 1:18. Alternate translation: [while they were watching]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 21:13 (#2)

בְּיָדָ֔ם

“in their hand”

The author is using the term **hand** to represent control or custody. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for as long as he was in their custody]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 21:14 (#1)

לָ֣מָּה תְבִיאֻ֔הוּ אֹתִ֖ו אֵלָֽי

“Why did you bring him to me”

Achish is using the question form for emphasis. If speakers of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You should not have brought him to me!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 21:15 (#1)

חֲסַ֤ר מְשֻׁגָּעִים֙ אָ֣נִי כִּֽי־הֲבֵאתֶ֔ם אֶת־זֶ֖ה לְהִשְׁתַּגֵּ֣עַ עָלָ֑י הַזֶּ֥ה יָבֹ֖וא אֶל־בֵּיתִֽי

“Am I lacking ravers, that you have brought this {one} to rave near me? Should this {one} enter into my house”

Achish is using the question form for emphasis. If speakers of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I am not lacking ravers, so you did not need to bring

this one to rave near me! This one should not enter into my house!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel - Chapter 22 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the part of the book that describes how David became king (chapters 16–31). It describes how David fled from the Philistine city of Gath when he no longer felt safe there. He brought his parents to the king of Moab for safety and stayed in Moab himself for a while. But then Yahweh's prophet Gad told him to return to the land of Judah. There he gathered a force of 400 men, including his older brothers, and became their commander. This chapter also describes how Saul accused the Israelite priests of conspiring with David against him and had one of his officials kill all of them.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Saul and the chief priest and his family

One of Saul's officials, Doeg the Edomite, tells Saul that Ahimelech the high priest gave David food and a sword and asked Yahweh to guide him. Saul summoned the priests and accused them of encouraging David to rebel against him. This was a serious accusation. The priests had an obligation to represent Yahweh and support his purposes. They would have been rebelling against Yahweh's king if this accusation had been true. But it was not. Nevertheless, Saul had Doeg kill all the priests and their families. Only one young man escaped to tell David. (See: high priest, chief priest)

1 Samuel 22:1 (#1)

וַיֵּרְדוּ

"and they went down"

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:3, where the author similarly marks travel for change in elevation. Alternate translation: [and they went]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 22:2 (#3)

אִישׁ מַר־נֶפֶשׁ

"man bitter of soul"

As in 2:35, here the term **soul** represents a person's inward feelings. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [man who was feeling bitter]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 22:2 (#2)

אִישׁ מָצוֹק

"man of distress"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **distress**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [man who was distressed] or [man who was being oppressed]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 22:2 (#1)

כָּל־אִישׁ מָצוֹק וְכָל־אִישׁ אֲשֶׁר־לוֹ נֹשֶׁא וְכָל־אִישׁ מַר־נֶפֶשׁ

"every man of distress and every man for whom {was} a creditor and every man bitter of soul"

The author is making a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [men who were in distress and men who had creditors and men who were bitter of soul]

See: Hyperbole

1 Samuel 22:3 (#1)

יָצֵא & אִתְּכֶם

"let & come out {and be} with you"

The author is leaving out some words that in many languages would be needed to complete the meaning. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [let ... come out of Israel and stay with you]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 22:4 (#1)

וַיַּנְחֵם אֶת־פְּנֵי מֶלֶךְ מוֹאָב

"And he led them to the face of the king of Moab"

The author is using one part of the king, his **face**, to mean all of him in his role as protector. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he brought them to the king of Moab] or [And he brought them under the protection of the king of Moab]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 22:5 (#1)

לֵ֣ךְ ובָ֗אתָ־לְךָ֙ אֶ֣רֶץ יְהוּדָ֔ה

“Leave and enter for yourself the land of Judah”

Gad is using the reflexive pronoun **yourself** to indicate that David should do this **for** his own benefit. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express this meaning in another way. Alternate translation: [It is better for you to leave and enter the land of Judah]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

1 Samuel 22:6 (#1)

נוֹדַ֥ע דָּוִ֖ד וַאֲנָשִׁ֣ים אֲשֶׁ֑ר אִתּֽוֹ

“David had become known, and the men who {were} with him”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people knew where David and his men were]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 22:6 (#2)

וְשָׁא֤וּל ׀ יוֹשֵׁ֣ב בַּגִּבְעָ֗ה תַּחַת־הָאֶ֙שֶׁל֙ בָּרָמָ֔ה וַחֲנִיתוֹ֙ בְּיָד֔וֹ

“Now Saul was sitting in Gibeah under the tamarisk tree on the height, and his spear {was} in his hand”

Sitting under this **tree** holding this **spear** was a symbolic action that showed Saul was acting as king. The tree and spear were symbols of royal authority in this culture. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [Now Saul was in Gibeah on the height, sitting under the tamarisk tree and holding his spear to show his authority]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 22:7 (#1)

בְּנֵ֣י יְמִינִ֔י

“Benjaminite”

Saul is not referring to a specific **Benjaminite**. He means all the Benjaminites who were there. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using a plural form. (Saul had given the important positions in his court to people from his own tribe of Benjamin, and he suggests in the next verse that as king, David would give their positions to people from his tribe of Judah.) Alternate translation: [you Benjaminites]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 22:7 (#2)

גַּם־לְכֻלְּכֶ֔ם יִתֵּ֥ן בֶּן־יִשַׁ֖י שָׂדוֹת֙ וּכְרָמִ֔ים לְכֻלְּכֶ֖ם יָשִׂ֣ים שָׂרֵ֣י אֲלָפִ֔ים וְשָׂרֵ֖י מֵאֽוֹת

“Will the son of Jesse give fields and vineyards even to all of you? Will he make all of you commanders of thousands and commanders of hundreds”

Saul is using the question form for emphasis. If speakers of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You seem to believe that the son of Jesse will give fields and vineyards also to all of you! You seem to believe that he will make all of you commanders of thousands and commanders of hundreds!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 22:7 (#3)

גַּם־לְכֻלְּכֶ֔ם

“even to all of you”

Saul means that his officials seem to believe David would give these things **even to all of** them, and not just to his fellow Judeans. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [even to all of you, and not just to his fellow Judeans]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 22:8 (#4)

הֲקִ֣ימוֹ֔ בְּנִ֖י אֶת־עַבְדִּ֣י עָלַ֑י

“my son had raised up my servant against me”

Saul is speaking of Jonathan’s actions as if he had physically lifted David up to fight against him. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [my son had incited my servant to rebel against me]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 22:8 (#1)

כִּֽי־

“For”

Here the word **For** provides not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [I say this because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 22:8 (#2)

וְאֵין־גֹּלֶה אֶת־אָזְנִי & וְגֹלֶה אֶת־אָזְנִי

“And {there was} no uncovering my ear & or uncovering my ear”

See how you translated the similar expression in 9:15. Alternate translation: [And no one told me ... and no one told me]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 22:8 (#3)

בִּכְרֹת־בְּנִי

“when my son cut”

See how you translated the similar expression in 20:16. Alternate translation: [when my son cut a covenant] or [when my son made a covenant]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 22:8 (#5)

כַּיּוֹם הַזֶּה

“as this day”

Saul is using the term **day** to represent the present time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [as he is doing right now]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 22:9 (#3)

וַיֹּאמַר

“and said”

The expression **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this expression explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 22:9 (#1)

וַיַּעַן דֹּאֵג הָאֲדֹמִי וְהוּא נִצָּב עַל־עַבְדֵי־שָׁאוּל וַיֹּאמַר

“And Doeg the Edomite answered (now he had stationed himself beside the servants of Saul) and said”

It may be more natural in your language to put the information about Doeg’s position before his response. Alternate translation: [Now Doeg the Edomite had stationed himself beside the servants of Saul. He answered and said]

See: Information Structure

1 Samuel 22:9 (#2)

וְהוּא נִצָּב עַל־עַבְדֵי־שָׁאוּל

“now he had stationed himself beside the servants of Saul”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 22:10 (#2)

גָּלְיָת הַפְּלִשְׁתִּי

“Goliath the Philistine”

See how you translated this name in 17:8. Alternate translation: [Goliath, the Philistine warrior champion]

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 22:10 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁאַל־לוֹ בַּיהוָה

“And he inquired of Yahweh for him”

The pronoun **he** refers to Ahimelech, while the pronoun **him** refers to David. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Ahimelech inquired of Yahweh for David]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 22:12 (#1)

הִנֵּנִי

“Behold me”

See how you translated this expression of respect in 3:4. Ahimelech is responding to his king with appropriate deference. Alternate translation: [I am listening]

See: Politeness

1 Samuel 22:13 (#2)

כַּיּוֹם הַזֶּה

“as this day”

See how you translated the similar expression in 22:8. Alternate translation: [as he is doing right now]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 22:13 (#1)

לָֽמָּה קְשַׁרְתֶּם עָלַי אַתָּה וּבֶן־יִשַׁי בְּתִתְּךָ לוֹ לֶחֶם וְחֶרֶב וְשָׁאוֹל לוֹ בֵּאלֹהִים לָקוּם אֵלַי לָאֹרֶב כַּיּוֹם הַזֶּה

“Why have you conspired against me, you and the son of Jesse, by your giving to him bread and a sword and inquiring of God for him, to rise up against me, to lie in ambush, as this day”

Saul is using the question form for emphasis. If speakers of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You have conspired against me with the son of Jesse by giving him bread and a sword and inquiring of God for him so that he could rise up against me and lie in ambush, as this day!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 22:14 (#3)

וַחֲתַ֥ן הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ

“and the son-in-law of the king”

Ahimelech is speaking about Saul in the third person out of respect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the second person. Alternate translation: [who is also your son-in-law]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 22:14 (#6)

וְנִכְבָּ֖ד בְּבֵיתֶֽךָ

“and being honored in your house”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and someone whom the people of your court honor]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 22:14 (#1)

וַיַּ֤עַן אֲחִימֶ֙לֶךְ֙ אֶת־הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ וַיֹּאמַ֖ר

“And Ahimelech answered the king and said”

The expression **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this expression explicitly. Alternate translation: [And Ahimelech responded to the king]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 22:14 (#2)

וּמִ֨י בְכָל־עֲבָדֶ֜יךָ כְּדָוִ֣ד נֶאֱמָ֗ן וַחֲתַ֤ן הַמֶּ֙לֶךְ֙ וְסָ֣ר אֶל־מִשְׁמַעְתֶּ֔ךָ וְנִכְבָּ֖ד בְּבֵיתֶֽךָ

“Now who among all of your servants is being faithful like David, and the son-in-law of the king, and commander over your bodyguard, and being honored in your house”

Ahimelech is using the question form for emphasis. If speakers of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [No one among all of your servants is being faithful like David, who is the son-in-law of the king and commander over your bodyguard and being honored in your house!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 22:14 (#4)

וַחֲתַ֥ן הַמֶּ֖לֶךְ

“and the son-in-law of the king”

See how you translated this relationship term in 18:18.

See: Kinship

1 Samuel 22:14 (#5)

וְנִכְבָּ֖ד בְּבֵיתֶֽךָ

“and being honored in your house”

Ahimelech is speaking Saul’s court, that is, all of his royal servants, as if it were an actual **house**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and being honored in your court] or [and being honored by your royal servants]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 22:15 (#5)

אַל־יָשֵׂ֤ם הַמֶּ֙לֶךְ֙ & דָּבָ֔רׇ

“May the king not set a word”

Ahimelech is using the term **word** to represent the accusation that Saul has made by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [May the king not make such an accusation]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 22:15 (#3)

חָלִלָ֣ילָה לִ֔לִּי

“Profane to me”

See how you translated this expression of strong denial in 2:30. Alternate translation: [Far be it from me to do such a thing as you have suggested]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 22:15 (#6)

אַל־יָשֵׂ֤ם הַמֶּ֙לֶךְ֙ בְּעַבְדּ֣וֹ דָבָ֔ר & כִּ֚י לֹא־יָדַ֣ע עַבְדְּךָ

“May the king not set a word against his servant & For your servant does not know”

Ahimelech is speaking respectfully to Saul and humbly about himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the second person and the first person. Alternate translation: [May you, O king, not set a word against me, your servant ... For I, your servant, do not know]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 22:15 (#2)

הַיּ֥וֹם הַחִלֹּ֖תִי לִשְׁא֣וֹל־לֹ֑ו בֵּאלֹהִ֔ים

“Did I begin to inquire of God for him today”

Ahimelech is using the question form for emphasis. If speakers of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [This was certainly not the first time I inquired of God for him!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 22:15 (#7)

בְּכָל־בֵּ֥ית אָבִ֖י

“against all of the house of my father”

See how you translated this expression in 9:20. Alternate translation: [against my entire extended family]

See: Kinship

1 Samuel 22:15 (#8)

בְּכָל־זֹ֣את דָּבָ֔ר קָטֹ֥ן וְאֹו גָד�ֹ֖ול

“about any of this matter, small or great”

Ahimelech is speaking of two extremes, **small** and **great**, in order to mean them and everything in between. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [anything at all about this matter]

See: Merism

1 Samuel 22:15 (#1)

הַיּ֥וֹם הַחִלֹּ֖תִי לִשְׁא֣וֹל־לֹ֑ו בֵּאלֹהִ֔ים

“Did I begin to inquire of God for him today”

Ahimelech is using a common expression of his culture to mean that this was not the first time he had done this. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Was this the first time I inquired of God for him?]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 22:15 (#4)

אַל־יָשֵׂ֤ם הַמֶּ֙לֶךְ֙ בְּעַבְדּ֣וֹ דָבָ֔ר בְּכָל־בֵּ֥ית אָבִ֖י כִּ֚י לֹא־יָדַ֣ע עַבְדְּךָ בְּכָל־זֹ֣את דָּבָ֔ר קָטֹ֥ן וְאֹו גָד�ֹ֖ול

“May the king not set a word against his servant, against all of the house of my father. For your servant does not know about any of this matter, small or great”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since your servant does not know about any of this matter, small or great, may the king not set a word against his servant, against all of the house of my father]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 22:16 (#1)

מָ֥וֹת תָּמֻ֖ות

“Dying, you shall die”

The author is repeating forms of the verb “die” in order to intensify his expression of the idea it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [You shall certainly die]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 22:17 (#1)

לָרָצִ֔ים

“to the runners”

The term **runners** refers to the king's bodyguards. Samuel described them in 8:11 when he said that a king would have men who would "run to the face of his chariot." They would surround him when he traveled in order to protect him, although having a large entourage was also symbolic of the king's power and authority. Alternate translation: [to his bodyguards]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 22:17 (#4)

גַּם־יָדָם֙ עִם־דָּוִ֔ד & לִשְׁלֹ֖חַ & יָדָֽם

"their hand {is} also with David & to stretch out their hand"

Since Saul is referring to a group of people, it may be more natural in your language to use the plural form of **hand**. Alternate translation: [their hands are also with David ... to stretch out their hands]

See: Collective Nouns

1 Samuel 22:17 (#5)

גַּם־יָדָם֙ עִם־דָּוִ֔ד

"their hand {is} also with David"

Saul is using one part of the priests, their **hand**, to mean all of them in the act of helping David. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they are also helping David]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 22:17 (#2)

סֹ֣בּוּ וְהָמִ֔יתוּ ׀ כִּֽי־גַם֙ יָדָ֣ם עִם־דָּוִ֔ד וְכִ֥י יָדְע֖וּ כִּי־בֹרֵ֣חַ הֽוּא֑ וְלֹ֥א גָלְל֖וּ אֶת־אָזְנִ֑י

"Turn and kill the priests of Yahweh, because their hand {is} also with David, and because they knew that he was fleeing but they did not uncover my ear"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since their hand is also with David, and since they knew that he was fleeing but they did not uncover my ear, turn and kill the priests of Yahweh]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 22:17 (#3)

סֹ֣בּוּ וְהָמִ֔יתוּ

"Turn and kill"

While it is possible that Saul's bodyguards were facing him and that they would have needed to turn physically in order to kill the priests, here the word **Turn** has a meaning similar to that of the word "arise" elsewhere in the book. It means to take action to do something. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Go ahead and kill]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 22:17 (#6)

וְלֹ֥א גָלְל֖וּ אֶת־אָזְנִ֑י

"but they did not uncover my ear"

See how you translated this expression in 22:8. Alternate translation: [but they did not tell me]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 22:17 (#7)

לִשְׁלֹ֖חַ & יָדָ֣ם לִפְגֹּ֑עַ

"to stretch out their hand to attack"

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean attacking or violently harming someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to use violence to attack]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 22:18 (#1)

סֹ֣ב אַתָּ֔ה & וַיִּסֹּ֥ב דוֵ֖ג הָאֲדֹמִ֑י וַיִּפְגַּ֥ע־הוּא֙ בַּכֹּהֲנִ֔ים

"You turn & So Doeg the Edomite turned and he himself attacked the priests"

See how you translated this expression in 22:17. Alternate translation: [You go ahead ... So Doeg the Edomite went ahead and attacked the priests himself]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 22:18 (#2)

אִ֣ישׁ נֹשֵׂ֔א אֵפֹ֖וד בָּֽד

"men wearing a linen ephod"

The author is using the **linen ephod**, a priestly garment, to represent the men who wore it as priests. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [men who were priests]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 22:19 (#1)

וְאֵת נֹ֣ב עִיר־הַכֹּהֲנִ֗ים הִכָּ֛ה לְפִי־חָ֖רֶב

“And Nob, the city of the priests, he struck to the mouth of the sword”

See how you translated this expression in 15:8. Alternate translation: [And he completely destroyed Nob, the city of the priests]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 22:19 (#2)

מֵאִישׁ֙ וְעַד־אִשָּׁ֔ה מֵעוֹלֵ֖ל וְעַד־יוֹנֵ֑ק וְשׁ֣וֹר וַחֲמ֔וֹר וָשֶׂ֖ה לְפִי־חָֽרֶב

“from man and to woman, from child and to infant, and ox and donkey and sheep, to the mouth of the sword”

The author is speaking of the two human sexes, of an extreme of age, and of animals with different roles (plowing, carrying, giving wool and milk) to mean them and everything in between. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all of the people, regardless of their age or sex, and all of the animals, he completely destroyed]

See: Merism

1 Samuel 22:20 (#1)

בֶּן־אֶחָ֖ד לַאֲחִימֶ֣לֶךְ

“a son of one to Ahimelech”

In certain contexts, biblical authors and characters use the expression **son of** to indicate that a person has the characteristic of something. In this case, Abiathar had the characteristic of being the only **one** of Ahimelech’s sons who **escaped**. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a solitary son of Ahimelech]

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 22:22 (#2)

אָנֹכִ֕י סַבּ֖וֹתִי בְּכָל־נֶ֣פֶשׁ בֵּֽית־אָבִֽיךָ

“I myself have turned against every soul of the house of your father”

David is using the word **turned** in the same sense as in 22:17 and 22:18, speaking as if he himself had actively killed all of Abiathar’s relatives. He means that he is responsible for their deaths. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I myself am responsible for the deaths of every soul of the house of your father]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 22:22 (#3)

בְּכָל־נֶ֣פֶשׁ בֵּֽית־אָבִֽיךָ

“against every soul of the house of your father”

David is using one part of a person, the **soul**, to mean the whole person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [every person in the house of your father] or [every one of your relatives]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 22:22 (#1)

כִּֽי־הַגֵּ֥ד יַגֵּ֖יד לְשָׁא֑וּל

“that declaring, he would declare to Saul”

David is repeating forms of the verb “declare” in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [that he would certainly declare to Saul]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 22:23 (#3)

כִּֽי־מִשְׁמֶ֥רֶת אֲתָ֖תָּה עִמָּדִֽי

“Surely protection {for} you {is} with me”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **protection**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [I will surely protect you]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 22:23 (#1)

שְׁבָ֥ה אִתִּ֖י אַל־תִּירָ֑א כִּ֣י אֶת־נַפְשִׁ֗י יְבַקֵּשׁ֙ אֶת־נַפְשֶׁ֔ךָ

“Stay with me, do not be afraid. For {he} who seeks my life seeks your life”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since he who seeks my life seeks your life, stay with me, do not be afraid]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 22:23 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר־יְבַקֵּשׁ אֶת־נַפְשִׁי יְבַקֵּשׁ אֶת־נַפְשֶׁךָ

“he} who seeks my life seeks your life”

See how you translated this expression in 20:1. Alternate translation: [he who is seeking to end my life is seeking to end your life] or [he who is seeking to kill me is seeking to kill you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel - Chapter 23 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the part of the book that describes how David became king (chapters 16–31). It describes how David rescued the city of Keilah from the Philistines who were stealing their harvest. Saul then went to Keilah to capture David, but Yahweh warned David and he fled to the wilderness near Ziph. Saul chased David there, and he would have caught him, but he had to leave to fight the Philistines, who were invading Israel.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

David trusts Yahweh to protect him

While the author does not state this specifically but leaves it for readers to recognize on their own, Yahweh worked out the timing of all these circumstances in order to rescue David from being captured and killed. Saul wanted to kill David, but David trusted in Yahweh, and Yahweh kept rescuing him. (See: trust, trusted, trustworthy, trustworthiness)

1 Samuel 23:1 (#3)

בִּקְעִילָֽה

“with Keilah”

The word **Keilah** is the name of a city in the territory of Judah. It was located in the lowlands near Philistine territory.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 23:1 (#1)

וַיַּגִּדוּ לְדָוִד

“And they declared to David”

The author is not using the pronoun **they** to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And David was told]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 23:1 (#2)

הִנֵּה

“Behold”

The people who spoke with David were using the term **Behold** to focus his attention on what they were about to say. See how you translated this term in 2:31.

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 23:2 (#1)

וְהִכִּֽיתִי

“and strike”

In this context, the author is using the term **strike** to mean “attack.” It does not necessarily have the specific sense here of “kill,” as it does elsewhere in the book. Alternate translation: [and attack]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 23:3 (#2)

וְאַף

“And much more”

David’s men are leaving out some words that in many languages would be needed to complete the meaning. You can supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [And we will be much more afraid] or [And we will be in much more danger]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 23:3 (#3)

מַעַרְכוֹת פְּלִשְׁתִּים

“the arrays of the Philistines”

David’s soldiers are using the term **arrays** (battle formations) to represent the soldiers who form them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. See how you translated the term “arrays” in 17:10. Alternate translation: [the soldiers of the Philistines]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 23:3 (#1)

אֲנַחְנוּ & יְרֵאִים

“we {are} afraid”

David’s men are using the emotion of fear to represent the danger that causes that fear. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expres-

sion or plain language. Alternate translation: [we are in danger]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 23:4 (#2)

קוּם רֵד קְעִילָה כִּי־אֲנִי נֹתֵן אֶת־פְּלִשְׁתִּים בְּיָדֶךָ

“Arise, go down to Keilah, for I am giving the Philistines into your hand”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since I am giving the Philistines into your hand, arise, go down to Keilah]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 23:4 (#4)

רֵד

“go down”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:3, where the author marks travel for change in elevation. Keilah was at a lower elevation than where David was. Alternate translation: [go]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 23:4 (#5)

בְּיָדֶךָ

“into your hand”

See how you translated this expression in 4:3. Alternate translation: [into your power]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 23:4 (#1)

וַיּוֹסֶף עוֹד דָּוִד לִשְׁאֹל בַּיהוָה

“So David added yet to inquire of Yahweh”

Together, the words **added** and **inquire** express a single idea. The word **added** tells in what way David inquired of Yahweh. Alternate translation: [So David inquired of Yahweh yet again]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 23:4 (#3)

קוּם

“Arise”

See how you translated this term in 16:12. Alternate translation: [Take action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 23:5 (#1)

וַיְנַהַג אֶת־מִקְנֵיהֶם וַיַּךְ בָּהֶם מַכָּה גְדוֹלָה

“And he drove off their livestock and struck a great striking against them”

The author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. In your translation, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [And he struck a great striking against them, and he drove off their livestock]

See: Order of Events

1 Samuel 23:5 (#2)

וַיַּךְ בָּהֶם מַכָּה גְדוֹלָה

“and struck a great striking against them”

See how you translated this same expression in 19:8. Alternate translation: [and slaughtered very many of them]

See: Poetry

1 Samuel 23:6 (#2)

אֵפוֹד יָרַד בְּיָדוֹ

“an ephod came down in his hand”

The author is using one part of Abiathar, his **hand**, to mean all of him in the act of bringing the ephod. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he brought an ephod with him]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 23:6 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“And it happened that”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 23:7 (#5)

בְּעֵעִיר דְּלָתַיִם וּבְרִיחַ

“into a city of doors and a bar”

Saul is using the terms **doors** and **bar** to represent a walled city that had gates that could be closed and locked. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [into a walled city whose gates can be locked]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 23:7 (#2)

בָּבָא דָּוִד קְעִילָה

“David had come to Keilah”

In this context, your language might say “gone” instead of **come**. Alternate translation: [David had gone to Keilah]

See: Go and Come

1 Samuel 23:7 (#3)

נִבַּר אֹתְתוֹ אֱלֹהִיסַם בְּיָדִי כִּבְי נִסְגַּר לָבבֹוא בְּעִעִיר דְּלָתַתַיִם וּבְרִיחַ

“God has delivered him into my hand. For he has enclosed himself by entering into a city of doors and a bar”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since he has enclosed himself by entering into a city of doors and a bar, God has delivered him into my hand]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 23:7 (#4)

בְּיָדִי

“into my hand”

See how you translated this expression in 23:4. Alternate translation: [into my power]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 23:7 (#1)

וַיֻּגַּד

“And it was declared”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And someone declared]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 23:8 (#1)

וַיְשַׁמַּע שָׁאאוּל אֶת־כָּל־הָעָם לַמִּלְחָמָה

“And Saul made all of the people hear for battle”

The author is using a common expression of his culture that means that Saul called his troops together for military service. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Saul summoned all of his troops to prepare for battle]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 23:10 (#1)

שָׁמֹעַ שָׁמַעע עַבְדְּךָ

“hearing, your servant has heard”

David is repeating forms of the verb “hear” in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [your servant has clearly heard]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 23:10 (#2)

שָׁמֹעַ שָׁמַעע עַבְדְּךָ

“hearing, your servant has heard”

David is speaking about himself in the third person as a way of showing respect to Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [I, your servant, have clearly heard]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 23:11 (#2)

הֲיַסְגִּרֻנִי בַעֲלֵיי קְעִילָה בְּיָדוֹ

“Will the lords of Keilah enclose me in his hand”

David is speaking of the lords of Keilah surrendering him to Saul as if they would place him in Saul’s hand and **enclose** him in it by wrapping Saul’s fingers tightly around him. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Will the lords of Keilah surrender me to him]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 23:11 (#3)

כַּאֲשֶׁר֙ שָׁמַ֣ע עַבְדֶּ֔ךָ & הַגֶּד־נָ֖א לְעַבְדֶּֽךָ

“just as your servant has heard & please declare to your servant”

David is speaking about himself in the third person as a way of showing respect to Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [just as I, your servant, have heard ... please declare to me, your servant]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 23:11 (#1)

הֲיַסְגִּרֻ֨נִי בַעֲלֵי֙ קְעִילָ֔ה בְּיָד֖וֹ הֲיֵרֵ֣ד שָׁא֑וּל כַּאֲשֶׁר֙ שָׁמַ֣ע עַבְדֶּ֔ךָ

“Will the lords of Keilah enclose me in his hand? Will Saul come down, just as your servant has heard”

David is asking about one event before asking about another event that would precede it. In your translation, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they would happen. Alternate translation: [Will Saul come down, just as your servant has heard? Will the lords of Keilah enclose me in his hand?]

See: Order of Events

1 Samuel 23:12 (#1)

יַסְגִּירוּ

“They will enclose”

Yahweh is leaving out some words that in many languages would be needed to complete the meaning. You can supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [They will enclose you and your men in the hand of Saul]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 23:13 (#1)

וַיָּקָם֩ דָּוִ֨ד וַאֲנָשָׁ֜יו כְּשֵׁ֣שׁ־מֵא֗וֹת אִ֫ישׁ

“So David and his men, about 600 men, arose”

See how you translated the term **arose** in 1:9. Alternate translation: [So David and his men, about 600 men, took action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 23:13 (#2)

וּלְשָׁא֔וּל הֻגַּ֖ד

“And it was declared to Saul”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And someone declared to Saul]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 23:14 (#3)

וְלֹא־נְתָנ֥וֹ אֱלֹהִ֖ים בְּיָדֽוֹ

“but God did not give him into his hand”

The author is using the term **hand** to represent power and control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [but God did not allow him to capture him]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 23:14 (#1)

וַיֵּ֤שֶׁב דָּוִד֙ בַּמִּדְבָּ֔רָה בַּמְּצָד֖וֹת וַיֵּ֣שֶׁב בָּהָ֑ר בְּמִדְבַּר־זִ֗יף וַיְבַקְשֵׁ֤הוּ שָׁאוּל֙ כָּל־הַיָּמִ֔ים וְלֹא־נְתָנ֥וֹ אֱלֹהִ֖ים בְּיָדֽוֹ

“And David stayed in the wilderness, in the strongholds, and he stayed in the hill country in the wilderness of Ziph. And Saul sought him all of the days, but God did not give him into his hand”

Here the author is saying what happened at the end of this part of the story of David fleeing from Saul. Your language may have its own way of presenting information that brings one part of a story to a close.

See: End of Story

1 Samuel 23:14 (#2)

כָּל־הַיָּמִ֔ים

“all of the days”

The author is using the term **days** to represent “time.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all of the time] or [continually]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 23:15 (#1)

וַיַּ֣רְא דָּוִ֔ד כִּֽי־יָצָ֥א שָׁא֖וּל לְבַקֵּ֣שׁ אֶת־נַפְשׁ֑וֹ וְדָוִ֗ד בְּמִדְבַּר־זִ֛יף בַּחֹ֖רְשָׁה

“And David saw that Saul had come out to seek his life. Now David {was} in the wilderness of Ziph, in the forest”

It may be more natural in your language to put the information about David’s location before the infor-

mation about what he saw Saul doing. Alternate translation: [While David was in the wilderness of Ziph, in the forest, he saw that Saul had come out to seek his life]

See: Information Structure

1 Samuel 23:15 (#4)

לְבַקֵּשׁ אֶת־נַפְשׁוֹ

“to seek his life”

See how you translated this expression in 20:1. Alternate translation: [to find him so that he could end his life] or [to find him so that he could kill him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 23:15 (#2)

וַיַּ֣רְא דָּוִ֔ד כִּֽי־יָצָ֥א שָׁא֖וּל לְבַקֵּ֣שׁ אֶת־נַפְשׁ֑וֹ

“And David saw that Saul had come out to seek his life”

The author is using the term **saw** to represent becoming aware. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And David became aware that Saul had come out to seek his life]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 23:15 (#3)

וַיַּ֣רְא דָּוִ֔ד כִּֽי־יָצָ֥א שָׁא֖וּל לְבַקֵּ֣שׁ אֶת־נַפְשׁ֑וֹ

“And David saw that Saul had come out to seek his life”

The author is using Saul to represent people he sent out to find David. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And David was aware that Saul was sending people out to seek his life]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 23:15 (#5)

וְדָוִ֗ד בְּמִדְבַּר־זִ֛יף בַּחֹֽרְשָׁ֖ה

“Now David {was} in the wilderness of Ziph, in the forest”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 23:16 (#1)

וַיְחַזֵּ֖ק אֶת־יָדֽוֹ

“And he strengthened his hand”

The author says that Jonathan **strengthened** David’s **hand** to mean that he encouraged him, to represent the way that people have less strengthen in their hands when they are discouraged and afraid and more strength when they are encouraged and brave. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And he encouraged him]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 23:17 (#4)

וְאָנֹכִ֕י אֶֽהְיֶה־לְּךָ֖ לְמִשְׁנֶ֑ה

“and I myself will be to you for a second”

Jonathan is using the ordinal number **second** to describe his future position in David’s kingdom. If your language does not use ordinal numbers, you can use an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [and I myself will be the next most powerful person in the kingdom]

See: Ordinal Numbers

1 Samuel 23:17 (#3)

לֹ֣א תִמְצָאֲךָ֔ יַ֖ד שָׁא֣וּל אָבִ֑י

“the hand of Saul my father will not find you”

Jonathan is using one part of Saul, his **hand**, to mean all of him in the act of trying to capture David. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Saul my father will not find you and capture you]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 23:17 (#1)

וַיֹּ֥אמֶר אֵלָ֖יו

“And he said to him”

The pronoun **he** refers to Jonathan, while the pronoun **him** refers to David. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Jonathan said to David]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 23:17 (#2)

אַל־תִּירָ֑א כִּ֣י לֹ֤א תִמְצָאֲךָ֙ יַ֣ד שָׁא֣וּל אָבִ֔י

“Do not be afraid, for the hand of Saul my father will not find you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since the hand of Saul my father will not find you, do not be afraid]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 23:18 (#1)

וַיִּכְרְתוּ & בְּרִית

“And & cut a covenant”

See how you translated this expression in 11:1. Alternate translation: [And ... made a covenant]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 23:18 (#2)

וַיִּכְרְתוּ & בְּרִית

“And & cut a covenant”

Since David and Jonathan had already made a covenant in chapter 18, by **cut a covenant**, the author means they renewed their previous agreement. Alternate translation: [And ... renewed their covenant]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 23:18 (#3)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“to the face of Yahweh”

See how you translated this expression in 1:12. Alternate translation: [in the presence of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 23:19 (#1)

הֲלֹא דָוִד מִסְתַּתֵּר עִמָּנוּ בַּמְּצָדוֹת בַּחֹרְשָׁה בְּגִבְעַת הַחֲכִילָה אֲשֶׁר מִימִין הַיְשִׁימוֹן

“Is not David hiding himself among us in strongholds in the forest on the hill of Hakilah, which {is} from the south of Jeshimon”

The Ziphites are using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [David is hiding himself among us in strongholds in the forest on the hill of Hakilah, which is from the south of Jeshimon!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 23:19 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר מִימִין הַיְשִׁימוֹן

“which {is} from the south of Jeshimon”

These Ziphites are describing the location of one place relative to another in the way that is characteristic of their culture. In your translation, express this in the way your culture describes the relative location of places. Alternate translation: [which is south of Jeshimon]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 23:20 (#2)

הַסְגֵּירוֹ בְיַד הַמֶּלֶךְ

“to enclose him in the hand of the king”

See how you translated this same image in 23:11. Alternate translation: [to surrender him to the king]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 23:20 (#1)

לְכָל־אַוַּת נַפְשְׁךָ

“according to all of the desire of your soul”

The Ziphites are using one part of Saul, his **soul**, to mean all of him in the act of desiring something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [according to all of your desire]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 23:20 (#3)

הַסְגֵּירוֹ בְיַד הַמֶּלֶךְ

“to enclose him in the hand of the king”

The Ziphites are addressing Saul respectfully in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the second person. Alternate translation: [to enclose him in your hand, O king] or [to surrender him to you, O king]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 23:21 (#3)

חֲמַלְתֶּם עָלָי

“you have had compassion on me”

Saul is using the term **compassion** to represent the help that people provide to others for whom they feel

compassion. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [you have helped me]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 23:21 (#2)

אַתֶּ֣ם & חֲמַלְתֶּ֔ם

“be} you & you have had compassion”

The instances of the word **you** are plural here and through verse 23 because Saul is addressing all of the Ziphites, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Samuel 23:21 (#1)

בְּרוּכִ֥ים אַתֶּ֛ם לַיהוָ֖ה כִּֽי־ חֲמַלְתֶּ֥ם עָלָֽי

“Blessed {be} you by Yahweh! For you have had compassion on me”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since you have had compassion on me, blessed be you by Yahweh!]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 23:22 (#5)

כִּֽי־ אָמַ֣ר אֵלַ֔י עָרֹ֥ום יַעְרִ֖ם הֽוּא

“For one has said to me, ‘Being craftly, he is crafty”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [For one has said to me that being craftly, he is crafty]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 23:22 (#2)

וּדְע֣וּ וּרְא֔וּ אֶת־ מְקֹומֹ֖ו

“and know and see his place”

Saul is describing one event before describing another event that would precede it. In your translation, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they would happen. Alternate translation: [and look in order to know his place]

See: Order of Events

1 Samuel 23:22 (#4)

מִֽי־ רָאָ֥ה שָׁ֖ם

“Who has seen him there”

Saul is using the question form to emphasize how important it is to have a reliable firsthand report of David’s location. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement. Alternate translation: [Be sure that someone reliable has seen him there]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 23:22 (#6)

אָמַ֣ר אֵלַ֔י

“one has said to me”

Saul is not using the pronoun **one** to refer to a specific person. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I have been told]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 23:22 (#3)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר תִּֽהְיֶ֖ה רַגְלֹ֑ו

“where his foot is”

Saul is using one part of David, his **foot**, to mean all of him in the act of being somewhere, as if he were standing there on his feet. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [where he is]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 23:22 (#7)

עָרֹ֥ום יַעְרִ֖ם הֽוּא

“Being craftly, he is crafty”

Saul is repeating forms of the verb “be crafty” in order to intensify the expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [He is very crafty]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 23:22 (#1)

לְכ֣וּ־ נָ֔א הָכִ֖ינוּ עֹ֑וד וּדְע֣וּ וּרְא֔וּ אֶת־ מְקֹומֹ֖ו אֲשֶׁ֥ר תִּֽהְיֶ֖ה רַגְלֹ֑ו מִֽי־ רָאָ֥ה שָׁ֖ם כִּֽי־ אָמַ֣ר אֵלַ֔י עָרֹ֥ום יַעְרִ֖ם הֽוּא

“Please go, confirm again, and know and see his place, where his foot is. Who has seen him there? For one has said to me, ‘Being craftly, he is crafty”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since one has said to me, ‘Being craftly, he is crafty,’ please go, confirm again, and know and see his place, where his foot is. Who has seen him there?]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 23:23 (#1)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר יִתְחַבֵּ֖א שָׁ֑ם

“where he hides himself there”

It might seem that the expression **where he hides himself there** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [where he hides himself]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 23:23 (#2)

נָכוֹן

“a confirmed {thing”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [information that you have confirmed]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 23:23 (#4)

בְּכֹל֙ אַלְפֵ֣י יְהוּדָ֔ה

“among all of the thousands of Judah”

Saul is using the term **thousands**, meaning clans, to represent the territory where these clans lived. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the territory of all of the clans of Judah]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 23:23 (#3)

בְּכֹל֙ אַלְפֵ֣י יְהוּדָ֔ה

“among all of the thousands of Judah”

See how you translated this expression in 10:19. Alternate translation: [all of the clans of Judah]

See: Numbers

1 Samuel 23:24 (#1)

לִפְנֵ֥י שָׁא֖וּל

“to the face of Saul”

The author is using one part of Saul, his **face**, to mean all of him in the act of intending to go to the area of Ziph. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [ahead of Saul]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 23:25 (#2)

וַיַּגִּ֖דוּ לְדָוִֽד

“And they declared to David”

The author is not using the pronoun **they** to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And David was told]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 23:25 (#1)

וַיֵּ֤לֶךְ שָׁאוּל֙ וַאֲנָשָׁ֔יו לְבַקֵּ֑שׁ

“And Saul and his men went to seek”

You could indicate explicitly in your translation whom Saul and his men **went to seek** if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And Saul and his men went to seek David]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 23:26 (#1)

מִפְּנֵ֥י שָׁא֖וּל

“from the face of Saul”

The author is using one part of Saul, his **face**, to mean all of him in the act of pursuing David. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from Saul]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 23:27 (#1)

מַהֲרָ֣ה וְלֵ֔כָה כִּי־פָשְׁטוּ֙ פְּלִשְׁתִּ֣ים עַל־הָאָ֔רֶץ

“Hurry and go, for the Philistines have raided against the land”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since the Philistines have raided against the land, hurry and go]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 23:27 (#2)

מַהֲרָ֥ה וְלֵ֖ךְ

“Hurry and go”

This expression conveys a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **hurry** tells in what way the messenger wants Saul to **go**. Alternate translation: [Go hurriedly]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 23:27 (#3)

מַהֲרָ֥ה וְלֵ֖ךְ

“Hurry and go”

In this context, your language might say “come” instead of **go**. Alternate translation: [Hurry and come] or [Come hurriedly]

See: Go and Come

1 Samuel 23:28 (#2)

סֶ֣לַע הַמַּחְלְקוֹת

“Sela Hammahlekoth”

The name **Sela Hammahlekoth** means “the Crag of Divisions.” The name indicates that at this crag, the forces of Saul and David divided and went in separate directions. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain this in a footnote.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 23:28 (#1)

קָרְא֥וּ לַמָּק֖וֹם הַהֽוּא

“they called that place”

The author is not using the pronoun **they** to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that place was called]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel - Chapter 24 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the part of the book that describes how David became king (chapters 16–31). It describes how Saul, after fighting off the Philistines, returned to the wilderness to try to capture David and kill him. Instead, David got the opportunity to kill Saul, but he did not do so, since Yahweh had anointed Saul to be the king. David proved to Saul that he could have killed him, and Saul realized that David was not his enemy and said that he would become king after him.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

“pens of sheep”

The author says in 24:3 that Saul came to some “pens of sheep” along the roadway. These were enclosures that shepherds had created in this area by building circular stone walls outside the openings of caves. The sheep stayed within the enclosures in good weather during the day, and they could go inside the caves for warmth and shelter at night and during storms. Describe these enclosures with a term or phrase that would help your readers understand what they were.

Why did David cut off the edge of Saul’s robe?

In 24:4, David cuts off the edge of Saul’s robe. Shortly afterwards, he is able to show this piece of the robe as proof that he could have killed Saul but did not. But this action may have had further symbolic significance. In 15:27–28, Saul tears off the edge of Samuel’s robe as he is trying to keep him from leaving. Samuel replies, “Yahweh has torn the kingdom of Israel from upon you today.” If David had learned of this incident, he may have been showing Saul that Samuel’s prophecy was coming true as Yahweh preserved his life so that he could be the next king. However, as the author does not make this point explicitly, we recommend that you do not say anything about it in the text of your translation or in a footnote. This repeated imagery speaks for itself within the story, and you can let it do that in your translation.

What does the proverb mean that David quotes to Saul?

In 24:13, David says to Saul, “As the proverb of the ancient says, ‘From the wicked comes out wickedness.’” He is using this proverb to mean, “If I had been a wicked person, I would have wickedly killed you in the cave. But I did not. So you can be sure that I will do nothing to harm you.”

1 Samuel 24:1 (#2)

וַיַּגִּ֥דוּ לוֹ֖

“that they declared to him”

The author is not using the pronoun **they** to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that it was declared to him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 24:1 (#3)

הִנֵּה

“Behold”

See how you translated this term in 2:31. The people who spoke with Saul were using the term **Behold** to focus his attention on what they were about to say.

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 24:1 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“And it happened”

See how you translated this expression in 1:12. The author is introducing a new development in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method here that is natural in your language for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 24:2 (#1)

בָּחֳחוּר מִכָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“chosen from all of Israel”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom he had chosen from all of Israel]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 24:2 (#2)

וַיֵּ֫לֶךְ

“And he went”

The author is using Saul to represent himself and all his men in the act of traveling. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a plural pronoun to indicate this. Alternate translation: [And they went]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 24:2 (#3)

עַל־פְּנֵי

“on the face of”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:25. The author is using the term **face** to mean the surface or slopes of these **cliffs**. Alternate translation: [on the slopes of]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 24:2 (#4)

עַל־פְּנֵי

“on the face of”

These cliffs contained many caves where David could have been hiding, and the author means that Saul went to search for David in the caves that opened up onto the **face** or slopes of the cliffs. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in the caves in]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 24:3 (#1)

לְהָסֵךְ אֶת־רַגְלָיו

“to cover his feet”

The author is speaking in a polite way about a private or uncomfortable matter. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [to relieve himself]

See: Euphemism

1 Samuel 24:3 (#2)

וְדָוִד וַאֲנָשָׁיו בְּיַרְכְּתֵי הַמְּעָרָה יֹשְׁבִים

“Now David and his men were staying in the recesses of the cave”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens next in the story. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 24:4 (#5)

יִטַּב בְּעֵינֶיךָ

“is good in your eyes”

See how you translated this expression in 1:18. Alternate translation: [you see fit]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 24:4 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר־אָמַר יְהוָה אֵלֶיךָ הִנֵּה אָנֹכִי נֹתֵן אֶת־אֹיִבְךָ בְּיָדֶךָ וְעָשִׂיתָ לּוֹ כַּאֲשֶׁר יִטַב

“is} what Yahweh said to you, ‘Behold, I am giving your enemy into your hand, and you will do to him just as is good”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [is what Yahweh meant when he told you that he would give your enemy into your hand and that you would do to him just as was good in your eyes]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 24:4 (#4)

בְּיָדֶךָ

“into your hand”

See how you translated this expression in 4:3. Alternate translation: [into your power]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 24:4 (#8)

בַּלָּט

“in secrecy”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **secrecy**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [secretly]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 24:4 (#1)

הַיּוֹם

“today”

The men are using a common expression of their culture. See how you translated the similar expression in 9:13. Alternate translation: [what is happening at this time]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 24:4 (#6)

וַיָּקָם דָּוִד

“And David arose”

See how you translated this term in 1:9. Alternate translation: [And David took action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 24:4 (#7)

וַיִּכְרֹת אֶת־כְּנַף־הַמְּעִיל אֲשֶׁר־לְשָׁאוּל

“and cut off the edge of the robe that {was} to Saul”

This was a symbolic action that demonstrated that David could have killed Saul. David shows the piece of the robe to make that point explicitly in 24:11, and Saul acknowledges it in 24:18. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [and cut off the edge of Saul’s robe to show that he could have killed him]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 24:4 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר־אָמַר יְהוָה אֵלֶיךָ הִנֵּה אָנֹכִי נֹתֵן אֶת־אֹיִבְךָ בְּיָדֶךָ וְעָשִׂיתָ לּוֹ כַּאֲשֶׁר יִטַב

“is} what Yahweh said to you, ‘Behold, I am giving your enemy into your hand, and you will do to him just as is good”

The author has not directly quoted Yahweh as saying this to David at any earlier point in the book, so this could be the way David’s men interpreted the more general statements by Yahweh that he had chosen David to be the next king. (Jonathan’s concern for his own descendants shows that people in this culture expected a king to destroy any enemies who could threaten him.) To show that this is not necessarily something that Yahweh said to David directly, you could make this an indirect quotation, as suggested in the Quotes in Quotes note, even if your language can present one direct quotation within another.

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Samuel 24:5 (#2)

וַיַּךְ לֵב־דָּוִד אֹתוֹ עַל אֲשֶׁר כָּרַת אֶת־כְּנַף אֲשֶׁר לְשָׁאוּל

“that the heart of David struck him because he had cut off the edge that {was} to Saul”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [that because he had cut off the edge that was to Saul, the heart of David struck him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 24:5 (#1)

וַיְהִי אַחֲרֵי־כֵן

“And it happened after this”

The author is introducing a new development in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method here that is natural in your language for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 24:5 (#3)

וַיַּךְ לֵב־דָּוִד אֹתָֽוֹ

“that the heart of David struck him”

The author is speaking as if David’s **heart** had physically **struck** him. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that David felt very guilty]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 24:5 (#4)

אֶת־כְּנַף אֲשֶׁר לְשָׁאוּל

“the edge that {was} to Saul”

The author is leaving out some words that in many languages would be needed to complete the meaning. You can supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [the edge of the robe that belonged to Saul]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 24:6 (#2)

חָלִילָה לִּי֙ מֵיהוָ֔ה אִם־אֶֽעֱשֶׂה֙ אֶת־הַדָּבָ֣ר הַזֶּ֔ה לַאדֹנִ֖י

“Profane to me from Yahweh if I have done this thing to my master”

David is speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, then you could translate this as a confident statement. Alternate translation: [Profane to me from Yahweh, that I have done this thing to my master]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

1 Samuel 24:6 (#1)

חָלִילָה לִּי֙ מֵיהוָ֔ה אִם־אֶֽעֱשֶׂה֙ אֶת־הַדָּבָ֣ר הַזֶּ֔ה לַאדֹנִ֖י לִמְשִׁ֣יחַ יְהוָ֑ה לִשְׁלֹ֤חַ יָדִי֙ בּ֔וֹ כִּי־מְשִׁ֥יחַ יְהוָ֖ה הֽוּא

“Profane to me from Yahweh if I have done this thing to my master, to the anointed one of Yahweh, to stretch out my hand against him. For he {is} the anointed one of Yahweh”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since he is the anointed one of Yahweh, profane to me from Yahweh if I have done this thing to my master, to the anointed one of Yahweh, to stretch out my hand against him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 24:6 (#4)

חָלִילָה לִּי֙ מֵיהוָ֔ה אִם־אֶֽעֱשֶׂה֙ אֶת־הַדָּבָ֣ר הַזֶּ֔ה לַאדֹנִ֖י

“Profane to me from Yahweh if I have done this thing to my master”

See how you translated the expression “profane to me” in 2:30. Alternate translation: [Far be it from me to sin against Yahweh by doing this thing to my master]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 24:6 (#5)

לִמְשִׁ֣יחַ יְהוָ֑ה & מְשִׁ֣יחַ יְהוָ֔ה הֽוּא

“to the anointed one of Yahweh & he {is} the anointed one of Yahweh”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [to the one whom Yahweh has anointed … he is the one whom Yahweh has anointed]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 24:6 (#3)

חָלִילָה לִּי֙ מֵיהוָ֔ה אִם־אֶֽעֱשֶׂה֙ אֶת־הַדָּבָ֣ר הַזֶּ֔ה לַאדֹנִ֖י

“Profane to me from Yahweh if I have done this thing to my master”

The similar assertions in 12:13 and Joshua 22:29 suggest that David is leaving out some words that in many languages would be needed to complete the meaning. You can supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [Profane to me from sinning against Yahweh by doing this thing to my master]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 24:6 (#6)

לִשְׁלֹ֤חַ יָדִי֙ בּ֔וֹ

“to stretch out my hand against him”

See how you translated this expression in 22:17. Alternate translation: [to attack him] or [to use violence against him in any way]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 24:7 (#2)

וַיְשַׁסַּע דָּוִד אֶת־אֲנָשָׁיו

“And David dispersed his men”

In its few other uses in the Hebrew Bible, the term translated as **dispersed** means to tear in pieces or to divide. Here it could mean: (1) that David’s men had gathered in a large group in preparation to attack Saul, but by refusing to allow them to do that, David caused them to move back into various parts of the cave in smaller groups. The ULT suggests this meaning. (2) that David spoke harshly to his men to keep them from attacking Saul. In that case, the author would be speaking of David’s action as if he had slashed at the crowd of men the way someone might slash a sacrificial animal in order to divide it into pieces. Alternate translation: [And David rebuked his men]; (3) that David restrained his men. Some interpreters believe that the text originally had a word with this meaning that was altered in the process of transmission. Alternate translation: [And David restrained his men]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 24:7 (#5)

וְשָׁאוּל קָם מֵהַמְּעָרָה

“And Saul arose from the cave”

The cave was not a hole in the ground that Saul had to climb out of. The author says that he **arose** from the cave to indicate that he left the cave and continued his search for David once he had finished relieving himself. Alternate translation: [And Saul moved on from the cave]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 24:7 (#1)

וַיְשַׁסַּע דָּוִד אֶת־אֲנָשָׁיו בַּדְּבָרִים וְלֹא נְתָנָם לָקוּם אֶל־שָׁאוּל

“And David dispersed his men with words and did not allow them to arise against Saul”

It is possible that David’s men told him that if he did not feel he could attack and kill Saul himself, they would do it for him. (In 26:8, Abishai tells David that directly when David gets another opportunity to kill Saul.) If that is the case, then the author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. In your translation, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they would have happened. Alternate translation: [And David did not allow his men to arise against Saul, but he dispersed them with words]

See: Order of Events

1 Samuel 24:7 (#3)

בַּדְּבָרִים

“with words”

The author is using the term **words** to represent what David said by using words. The author could be referring to: (1) what David said in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [by saying this]; (2) something further that David said to keep his men from killing Saul themselves. Alternate translation: [by persuading them that they too should respect Saul as Yahweh’s anointed]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 24:7 (#4)

לָקוּם אֶל־שָׁאוּל

“to arise against Saul”

See how you translated this expression in 1:9. Alternate translation: [to take action against Saul]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 24:8 (#2)

וַיִּקְקֹד דָּוִד אַפַּיִם אַרְצָה וַיִּשְׁתָּחוּ

“and David bowed, nostrils to the ground, and prostrated himself”

See how you translated the description of this symbolic action in 20:41. Alternate translation: [and David knelt down and pressed his face to the ground, stretching himself out completely, to show great honor to Saul]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 24:8 (#1)

אֲדֹנִי הַמֶּלֶךְ

“My master the king”

David is referring to Saul by a respectful title. Use a comparable title or expression for addressing someone of high status respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [Your Majesty]

See: Politeness

1 Samuel 24:9 (#4)

אֶת־דִּבְרֵי אָדָם לֵאמֹר

“to the words of a man, saying”

David is using the term **words** to represent what people were telling Saul by using words. Alternate translation: [to what anyone says who claims]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 24:9 (#6)

רָעָתֶךָ

“your harm”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **harm**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [to harm you]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 24:9 (#2)

לָמָּה תִשְׁמַע אֶת־דִּבְרֵי

“Why do you listen to the words of”

See the discussion in the Introduction to 1 Samuel of the author’s use of the term “listen.” In this context, it means “believe.” Alternate translation: [Why do you believe]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 24:9 (#5)

לֵאמֹר הִנֵּה דָוִד מְבַקֵּשׁ רָעָתֶךָ

“saying, ‘Behold, David is seeking your harm”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [who tells you to be watch out because I am seeking your harm]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 24:9 (#1)

לָמָּה תִשְׁמַע אֶת־דִּבְרֵי אָדָם לֵאמֹר הִנֵּה דָוִד מְבַקֵּשׁ רָעָתֶךָ

“Why do you listen to the words of a man, saying, ‘Behold, David is seeking your harm”

David is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement. Alternate translation: [You should not listen to the words of a man, saying, ‘Behold, David is seeking your harm.’]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 24:9 (#3)

אֶת־דִּבְרֵי אָדָם לֵאמֹר

“to the words of a man, saying”

David is not referring to a specific man. He means any person in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning with a plural form. Alternate translation: [the words of anyone, saying]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 24:10 (#7)

וְאֹמַר לֹא־אֶשְׁלַח יָדִי בַּאדֹנִי כִּי־מְשִׁיחַ יְהוָה הוּא

“And I said, ‘I will not stretch out my hand against my master, for he {is} the anointed one of Yahweh”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And I said that I would not stretch out my hand against my master, for he was the anointed one of Yahweh]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 24:10 (#4)

וְאָמַר לַהֲרָגְךָ

“And one said to slay you”

It may be more natural in your language to express this as a direct quotation. Alternate translation: [And my men told me, ‘Kill him!’]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Samuel 24:10 (#9)

לֹא־אֶשְׁלַח יָדִי בַּאדֹנִי

“I will not stretch out my hand against my master”

See how you translated this expression in 22:17 and 24:6. Alternate translation: [I will not attack my master] or [I will not use violence against my master]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 24:10 (#1)

רָאוּ עֵינֶיךָ

“your eyes have seen”

David is using one part of Saul, his **eyes**, to mean all of him in the act of witnessing what happened. Your

language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [you have seen with your own eyes] or [you have seen for yourself]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 24:10 (#5)

וַתָּחָס עָלַיִךְ

“but it had compassion on you”

David is leaving out some words that in many languages would be needed to complete the meaning. Contexts such as Deuteronomy 7:16, Isaiah 13:18, and Ezekiel 7:4 suggest that the fuller form of this expression would be “my eye had compassion.” You can supply these words if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [but my eye had compassion on you]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 24:10 (#6)

וַתָּחָס עָלַיִךְ

“but it had compassion on you”

David is using one part of himself, his **eye**, to mean all of himself in the act of showing mercy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but I had compassion on you]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 24:10 (#8)

לֹא־אֶשְׁלַח יָדִי בַּאדֹנִי כִּי־מְשִׁיחַ יְהוָה הִוא

“I will not stretch out my hand against my master, for he {is} the anointed one of Yahweh”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since my master is the anointed one of Yahweh, I will not stretch out my hand against him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 24:10 (#3)

וְאָמַר לַהֲרָגְךָ

“And one said to slay you”

David is not using the pronoun **one** to refer to a specific person. He means his men in general. Alternate translation: [And my men said to slay you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 24:10 (#2)

נְתָנְךָ יְהוָה & בְּיָדִי

“Yahweh gave you into my hand”

David is using the term **hand** to represent power and control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh gave you into my power] or [Yahweh gave me an opportunity to kill you]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 24:11 (#6)

וְאַתָּה צֹדֶדֶת אֶת־נַפְשִׁי לְקַחְתָּהּ

“but you are hunting my life, to take it”

David is using one part of himself, his **life**, to mean all of himself in the act of being hunted. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but you are hunting me to take my life]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 24:11 (#1)

וְאָבִי רְאֵה גַּם רְאֵה

“And see, my father, even see”

David is repeating the verb “see” in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [Now look carefully, my father, at]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 24:11 (#4)

דַּע וּרְאֵה

“Know and see”

David is describing one event before describing another event that would precede it. In your translation, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they would happen. Alternate translation: [See and know]

See: Order of Events

1 Samuel 24:11 (#5)

בְּיָדִֽי

“is} in my hand”

David is using one part of himself, his **hand**, to mean all of himself potentially acting against Saul. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is motivating my actions]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 24:11 (#2)

וְאָבְבִי רְאֵֽה

“And see, my father”

David is referring to Saul by a respectful title. Use a comparable title or expression for addressing someone of high status respectfully in your language. Alternate translation: [And see, O king]

See: Politeness

1 Samuel 24:11 (#3)

כִּֽי

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [This is significant because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 24:12 (#1)

וְיָדִ֣י לֹֽא תִהְיֶה־בָּֽךְ

“but my hand will not be against you”

David is using one part of himself, his **hand**, to mean all of himself potentially acting against Saul. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [but I will not do anything against you]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 24:13 (#1)

כַּאֲשֶׁ֤ר יֹאמַר֙ מְשַׁלֵּ֣ל הַקַּדְמֹנִ֔י מֵרְשָׁעִ֖ים יֵצֵ֣א רֶ֑שַׁע

“As the proverb of the ancient says, ‘From the wicked comes out wickedness”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [The proverb of the ancient says that from the wicked comes out wickedness]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 24:13 (#3)

הַקַּדְמֹנִ֔י

“the ancient”

David is using the adjective **ancient** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the ancient ones] or [our ancestors]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 24:13 (#4)

מֵרְשָׁעִ֖ים יֵצֵ֣א רֶ֑שַׁע

“From the wicked comes out wickedness”

David is using the adjective **wicked** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [From wicked people comes out wickedness]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 24:13 (#5)

מֵרְשָׁעִ֖ים יֵצֵ֣א רֶ֑שַׁע

“From the wicked comes out wickedness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **wickedness**, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Wicked people commit wicked actions]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 24:13 (#2)

הַקַּדְמֹנִ֔י

“the ancient”

David is not referring to a specific ancient person. He means the remote ancestors of the Israelites in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning with a plural form. Alternate translation: [the ancients]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 24:14 (#1)

אַחֲרֵ֣י מִ֔י יָצָ֖אאֿ מֶ֣לֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵ֑לאֵ֚ אַחֲרֵ֣י מִ֔י אַתָּ֖ה רֹדֵ֥ף

“After whom does the king of Israel come out? After whom are you pursuing”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. For emphasis, David is repeating the idea they express. If it would be clearer in your language, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [After whom has the king of Israel come out violently in pursuit?]

See: Parallelism

1 Samuel 24:14 (#2)

אַחֲרֵ֣י מִמִּ֤י יָצָא֙ מֶ֣לֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל אַחֲרֵ֖י מִמִּ֣י אַתָּ֣ה רֹדֵ֑ף

“After whom does the king of Israel come out? After whom are you pursuing”

David is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or exclamation. Alternate translation: [The king of Israel has not come out after anyone dangerous! You are not pursuing anyone significant!] or [The king of Israel has not come out in pursuit of anyone who is a danger to him!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 24:14 (#3)

אַחֲרֵ֣י מִמִּ֤י יָצָא֙ מֶ֣לֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“After whom does the king of Israel come out”

David is addressing Saul directly, but he is speaking respectfully to him in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the second person. Alternate translation: [After whom have you, the king of Israel, come out?] or [You, the king of Israel, have not come out after anyone dangerous!]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 24:14 (#4)

אַחֲרֵי֙ כֶּ֣לֶב מֵ֔ת אַחֲרֵ֖י פַּרְעֹ֣שׁ אֶחָֽד

“After a dead dog! After one flea”

David is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [You are pursuing after a dead dog! You are pursuing after one flea]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 24:14 (#5)

אַחֲרֵי֙ כֶּ֣לֶב מֵ֔ת

“After a dead dog”

David is speaking as if he were actually a **dead dog**. In this culture, wild dogs were considered dirty, and they were regarded with contempt. Moreover, a **dead dog** would be powerless. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [After someone who is powerless and whom people regard with contempt!]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 24:14 (#6)

אַחֲרֵ֖י פַּרְעֹ֣שׁ אֶחָֽד

“After one flea”

David is speaking as if he were actually a **flea**, a tiny and insignificant creature. Moreover, David is just **one** person, but Saul has raised an army of 3,000 soldiers to pursue him. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [After merely one man, who is insignificant!]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 24:15 (#1)

וְיִרְאֶ֣ה וְיָרֵ֔ב אֶת־רִיבִ֖י

“and conduct my case”

For emphasis, David is using a construction in which a verb (translated as **conduct**) and its object (translated as **case**) come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, since this is a legal expression, there may be a comparable one in your language that you can use. Alternate translation: [and defend me]

See: Poetry

1 Samuel 24:15 (#2)

וְיִשְׁפְּטֵ֥נִי מִיָּדֶֽךָ

“and may he judge me out of your hand”

David is using the term **hand** to represent power and control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and may he judge that I should not be in your power]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 24:16 (#6)

וַיִּשָּׂא שָׁאוּל קֹלוֹ וַיֵּבְךְּ

“And Saul lifted up his voice and wept”

This expression conveys a single idea by using two phrases connected with **and**. The expression **lifted up his voice** tells in what way Saul **wept**. Alternate translation: [And Saul wept in a loud voice] or [And Saul wept loudly]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 24:16 (#4)

בְּנִי

“my son”

Saul is using this kinship term to acknowledge David as the husband of his daughter. Your language may have its own term or expression for this relationship. Be sure that the term you choose is affectionate and embracing. Previously Saul has referred to David disdainfully as the “son of Jesse.” Here he acknowledges him as a member by marriage of the royal family. Alternate translation: [my son-in-law]

See: Kinship

1 Samuel 24:16 (#5)

וַיִּשָּׂא שָׁאוּל קֹלוֹ וַיֵּבְךְּ

“And Saul lifted up his voice and wept”

The author is speaking as if Saul’s **voice** were an object that he could have **lifted up**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Saul spoke loudly and wept]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 24:16 (#1)

לְדַבֵּר אֶת־הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה

“speaking these words”

The author is using the term **words** to represent the things that David said by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [saying these things]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 24:16 (#2)

הֲקֹלְךָ זֶּה בְּנִי דָוִד

“Is} this your voice, my son David”

Saul is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement. Alternate translation: [I recognize your voice, my son David!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 24:16 (#3)

הֲקֹלְךָ זֶּה בְּנִי דָוִד

“Is} this your voice, my son David”

Saul is using the term **voice** to represent David speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Is it you speaking to me, my son David?] or [I recognize that it is you speaking to me, my son David!]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 24:17 (#2)

אַתָּה גְּמַלְתַּנִי הַטּוֹבָה וַאֲנִי גְּמַלְתִּתִּיךָ הָרָעָה

“you did good to me, but I did evil to you”

Saul is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. In your translation, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [even though I did evil to you, you then did good to me]

See: Order of Events

1 Samuel 24:17 (#3)

אַתָּה גְּמַלְתַּנִי הַטּוֹבָה וַאֲנִי גְּמַלְתִּתִּיךָ הָרָעָה

“you did good to me, but I did evil to you”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **good** and **evil**, you could express these ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [you did something good to me, but I did something evil to you] or [even though I did something evil to you, you then did something good to me]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 24:17 (#1)

צַדִּיק אַתָּה מִמֶּנִּי כִּי אַתָּה גְּמַלְתַּנִי הַטּוֹבָה וַאֲנִי גְּמַלְתִּתִּיךָ הָרָעָה

“You {are} more righteous than I. For you did good to me, but I did evil to you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first

phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since you did good to me, but I did evil to you, you are more righteous than I]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 24:18 (#1)

סִגְּרַנִי יְהוָה בְּיָדֶךָ

“Yahweh enclosed me in your hand”

See how you translated the similar expression in 23:11. Saul is speaking as if he were an object that could be **enclosed** in David’s **hand**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh surrendered me to you] or [Yahweh gave you power over me]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 24:19 (#1)

וְכִי־יִמְצָא אִישׁ אֶת־אֹיְבוֹ וְשִׁלְּחָנוֹ בְּדֶרֶךְ טוֹבָה

“Now if a man finds his enemy, will he send him on a good way”

Saul is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement. Alternate translation: [Now if a man finds his enemy, he does not send him on a good way!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 24:19 (#2)

יִמְצָא

“finds”

See how you translated this term in 9:11. By **finds**, Saul is describing a situation in which a **man** unexpectedly encounters someone. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [encounters]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 24:19 (#3)

בְּדֶרֶךְ טוֹבָה

“on a good way”

Saul is speaking of this **way** as **good** to represent the condition of the **enemy** a man would surprisingly send on it. The enemy would be in good condition, that is, unharmed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [away in good condition] or [away unharmed]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 24:20 (#1)

מָלֹךְ תִּמְלֹךְ

“reigning, you will reign”

Saul is repeating forms of the verb “reign” in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [you will certainly reign]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 24:20 (#2)

וְקָמָה בְיָדְךָ מַמְלֶכֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל

“and the kingdom of Israel will stand in your hand”

See how you translated the similar expression “your kingdom will not stand” in 13:24. Alternate translation: [and the kingdom of Israel will endure under your rule]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 24:21 (#2)

אִם־תַּכְרִית אֶת־זַרְעִי אַחֲרָי וְאִם־תַּשְׁמִיד אֶת־שְׁמִי מִבֵּית אָבִי

“if you shall cut off my seed after me, and if you shall destroy my name from the house of my father”

Saul is asking David to swear an oath following the custom of his culture by stating the first part of a condition (“if”) but not the second part (“then”). The understood second part would invoke divine punishment for breaking the oath. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explicitly state this second part. Alternate translation: [that if you cut off my seed after me and if you destroy my name from the house of my father, then may he punish you very severely]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Samuel 24:21 (#3)

אִם־תַּכְרִית אֶת־זַרְעִי אַחֲרָי וְאִם־תַּשְׁמִיד אֶת־שְׁמִי מִבֵּית אָבִי

“if you shall cut off my seed after me, and if you shall destroy my name from the house of my father”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. For emphasis, Saul is repeating the idea of destroying his family line. If it would be clearer in your language, you could combine them and express the emphasis in

another way. Alternate translation: [if you completely destroy my family line after I am gone]

See: Parallelism

1 Samuel 24:21 (#6)

וְאִם־תַּשְׁמִיד & שְׁמִי מִבֵּית אָבִי

“and if you shall destroy my name from the house of my father”

Saul is using the term **name** to represent his memory and legacy as carried on through his descendants. The **house of my father** means his extended family. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [so that no one who would name me as an ancestor remains alive in my extended family]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 24:21 (#4)

תַּכְרִית

“you shall cut off”

See how you translated this expression in 2:33. Saul is speaking as if his family line were a branch that could be **cut off** from a tree. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you kill]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 24:21 (#5)

אֶת־זַרְעִי

“my seed”

See how you translated this expression in 20:42. Saul is speaking of his descendants as if they were the **seed** from which new plants would grow. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [my descendants]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 24:21 (#1)

הִשָּׁבְעָה לִי֙ בַּיהוָ֔ה אִם־תַּכְרִית֙ אֶת־זַרְעִ֔י אַחֲרָ֑י וְאִם־תַּשְׁמִ֗יד אֶת־שְׁמִי֙ מִבֵּ֣ית אָבִ֔י

“swear to me by Yahweh, if you shall cut off my seed after me, and if you shall destroy my name from the house of my father”

Saul is stating the content of an oath that he wants David to swear. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could present this content as a direct quotation. Alternate translation: [swear to me by Yahweh, “If I cut off your seed after you and if I destroy your name from the house of your father!”]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Samuel 24:22 (#1)

וְדָוִד֙ וְאֲנָשָׁ֔יו עָל֖וּ עַל־הַמְּצוּדָֽה

“and David and his men went up onto the stronghold”

By **the stronghold**, the author means one of the specific “strongholds of Engedi” that he mentioned in 23:29. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and David and his men went back into one of the strongholds of Engedi]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel - Chapter 25 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the part of the book that describes how David became king (chapters 16–31). It describes David and his men protected the extensive flocks of a man named Nabal who lived in the southern part of the territory of Judah. When David then reasonably asked for some food from a feast that Nabal was holding to celebrate the shearing of his sheep, Nabal rudely refused him. This made David so angry that he wanted to kill all the men in Nabal’s household. But Nabal’s prudent wife Abigail sent very generous portions of food to David, and she convinced him not to attack and kill those men, persuading him that if he did, he would deeply regret that when he became king.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Sheep-shearing

People in ancient Israel who owned sheep would cut off their wool when the weather started to get warm so that they could use the wool to make clothing, blankets, and other articles. The sheep would eventually grow back another thick coat of wool, but in the meantime they would stay cool in the warmer weather. Cutting the wool of sheep is called “shearing” them. Sheep-shearing was like a time of harvest, since it gave sheep owners and their workers benefits in return for the hard work they had done caring for their sheep. So it was also a time of celebration. Sheep owners would reward those who had helped care for their flocks by hosting them at banquets. When someone told David that Nabal was shearing

his sheep, David therefore thought it was reasonable for him to ask Nabal for some of the food from the banquet he knew Nabal would be hosting. David and his men had protected Nabal's shepherds and flocks while they were in the area and, as a result, Nabal got even more wool from his flocks than usual, since he had suffered no losses due to theft or wild-animal attacks. In ancient Israelite culture, this kind of protection was understood to have created an obligation of hospitality and sharing, especially during times of celebration like sheep-shearing. David's request was therefore not just a matter of charity but was based on the established social customs and the practical services that he and his men had provided to Nabal. It was outrageous for Nabal to deny David this recognition of his help and this well-deserved share in the banquet. That is why David became so angry with Nabal.

1 Samuel 25:1 (#1)

וַיִּקָּבְצוּ כָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

"and all of Israel gathered"

The author is making a generalization for emphasis. Not every person in Israel came, but people came from throughout the nation. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [and many people from throughout Israel]

See: Hyperbole

1 Samuel 25:1 (#4)

וַיֵּרֶד

"and went down"

See how you translated the similar phrase in 1:3, where the author, in keeping with the conventions of his culture, marks travel for change in elevation. Alternate translation: [and went]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 25:1 (#2)

וַיִּקְבְּרֻהוּ

"and they buried him"

The author is not using the pronoun **they** to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and people buried him] or [and he was buried]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 25:1 (#3)

וַיָּקָם דָּוִד

"Then David arose"

See how you translated the similar expression in 24:7. Alternate translation: [Then David left]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 25:2 (#1)

וְאִישׁ בְּמָעוֹן

"Now a man {was} in Maon"

Here the author is introducing Nabal as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Now there was a certain man in Maon]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Samuel 25:2 (#2)

וְלוֹ

"For to him"

Here the author is using the word **For** to introduce not a reason but an explanation of why he describes Nabal as **very great**. (In this context, that word means "rich" or "wealthy.") Alternate translation: [After all]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 25:3 (#1)

וְשֵׁם אִשְׁתּוֹ אֲבִגַיִל וְהָאִשָּׁה טוֹבַת־שֶׂכֶל וִיפַת תֹּאַר

"and the name of his wife {was} Abigail. Now the woman {was} good of insight and beautiful of appearance"

Here the author is introducing Abigail as another new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [and he had a wife whose name was Abigail. She was a woman of good judgment and beautiful appearance]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Samuel 25:4 (#1)

גֹּזֵז נָבָל אֶת־צֹאנוֹ

"Nabal was shearing his sheep"

Here, **Nabal** represents the people who worked for him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alter-

nate translation: [Nabal's servants were shearing his sheep]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:5 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁלַ֣ח דָּוִ֔ד עֲשָׂרָ֖ה נְעָרִ֑ים

"And David sent ten young men"

Sending a round and significant number of representatives was a symbolic action by which David expressed respect for Nabal. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [And David showed respect for Nabal by sending ten young men to speak with him]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 25:5 (#2)

וּשְׁאֶלְתֶּ֥ם־לוֹ֙ בִּשְׁמִ֔י לְשָׁלֽוֹם

"and you shall ask him in my name regarding peace"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express this idea in another way. See how you translated the similar expression in 10:4. Alternate translation: [and you shall ask him in my name whether all is well with him]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 25:5 (#3)

וּשְׁאֶלְתֶּ֥ם־לוֹ֙ בִּשְׁמִ֔י לְשָׁלֽוֹם

"and you shall ask him in my name regarding peace"

It may be more natural in your language to express this as a direct quotation. Alternate translation: [and you shall tell him that David asks, 'Is all well with you?']

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Samuel 25:5 (#4)

בִּשְׁמִ֔י

"in my name"

David is using the term **name** to represent his own interests. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [on my behalf]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:6 (#3)

וְאַתָּ֣ה שָׁלוֹם֮ וּבֵיתְךָ֣ שָׁלוֹם֒ וְכֹ֥ל אֲשֶׁר־לְךָ֖ שָׁלֽוֹם

"And peace {to} you and peace {to} your house and peace {to} all that {is} to you"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And may all go well with you and with your house and with all that is to you]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 25:6 (#2)

לְחָיֶ֑יךָ

"To life"

David is using a phrase that expresses a strong feeling, an earnest wish that Nabal's **life** is happy and prosperous. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. Alternate translation: [May you live long and prosper!]

See: Exclamations

1 Samuel 25:6 (#1)

וְאָמַרְתֶּ֣ם כֹּ֔ה לְחָיֶ֑יךָ וְאַתָּ֣ה שָׁלוֹם֮ וּבֵיתְךָ֣ שָׁלוֹם֒ וְכֹ֥ל אֲשֶׁר־לְךָ֖ שָׁלֽוֹם

"And you shall say thus, 'To life! And peace {to} you and peace {to} your house and peace {to} all that {is} to you"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And you shall tell him that I wish him a good life and that peace may be to him and to his house and to all that is to him]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 25:6 (#4)

וּבֵיתְךָ֣ שָׁלוֹם֒

"and peace {to} your house"

David is speaking of the people in Nabal's household as if they were his **house**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and peace to your whole household] or [and may all go well with your whole household]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 25:7 (#1)

וְעַתָּ֣ה שָׁמַ֔עְתִּי כִּֽי־גֹזְזִ֖ים לָֽךְ

“And now, I have heard that shearers {are} to you”

If you decided to translate David’s instructions so that there would not be a quotation within a quotation, you can continue to do that here. (The rest of this verse would not need to be changed.) Alternate translation: [And now, he says he has heard that shearers are to you]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 25:7 (#4)

עִמָּ֑נוּ לֹ֥א הֲכְלַמְנֻֽם

“with us. We have not hurt them”

David is instructing his messengers to use the pronouns **us** and **we** to refer to him and his men but not to Nabal, so use the exclusive form of those words if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

1 Samuel 25:7 (#3)

עַתָּ֣ה הָרֹעִ֗ים אֲשֶׁר־לְךָ֙ הָי֣וּ עִמָּ֔נוּ

“Now the shepherds who {are} to you have been with us”

David is providing background information to support his request for food from the sheep-shearing feast that Nabal is hosting. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 25:7 (#6)

כָּל־יְמֵ֥י

“all of the days of”

David is using the term **days** to represent time, since time is made up of days. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all of the time of]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:7 (#5)

וְלֹא־נִפְקַ֥ד לָהֶ֖ם מְאוּמָ֑ה

“and anything to them has not been missing”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and we have not taken anything that belonged to them]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 25:7 (#2)

וְעַתָּ֣ה

“And now”

And now was a common expression that speakers in this culture used to introduce their main topic. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. See how you translated this expression in 6:7. Alternate translation: [Now please let me make a small request]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 25:8 (#3)

וְיִמְצְא֤וּ הַנְּעָרִים֙ חֵ֣ן בְּעֵינֶ֔יךָ כִּֽי־עַל־י֥וֹם טוֹב֖ בָּ֑אנוּ

“So let the young men find favor in your eyes, for we have come on a good day”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [So since we have come on a good day, let the young men find favor in your eyes]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 25:8 (#7)

אֵ֚ת אֲשֶׁ֣ר תִּמְצָ֔א יָדְךָ֖

“whatever your hand finds”

David is instructing his messengers to use a common expression of their culture. See how you translated the similar expression in 10:7. Alternate translation: [whatever seems suitable to you]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 25:8 (#8)

לַעֲבָדֶ֔יךָ

“to your servants”

David is instructing his messengers to speak about themselves humbly in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [to us, your servants]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 25:8 (#1)

שְׁאַל־נְעָרֶיךָ וְיַגִּדוּ לָךְ וְיִמְצְאוּ הַנְּעָרִים חֵן בְּעֵינֶיךָ כִּי־עַל־יוֹם טוֹב בָּאנוּ תְּנָה־נָּא אֵתתָּ אֶשֶׁר תִּמְצָא יָדְךָ לַעֲבָדֶיךָ וּלְבִנְךָ לְדָוִד

“Ask your young men, and they will declare to you. So let the young men find favor in your eyes, for we have come on a good day. Please give whatever your hand finds to your servants and to your son, to David”

If you decided to translate David’s instructions so that there would not be a quotation within a quotation, you can continue to do that here. Alternate translation: [He invites you to ask your young men, and they will declare to you. He hopes that we young men will find favor in your eyes, for all of us have come on a good day. He asks you please to give whatever your hand finds to us, your servants, and to him, your son, to David]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 25:8 (#9)

וּלְבִנְךָ לְדָוִד

“and to your son, to David”

David is instructing his messengers to refer to him humbly as Nabal’s **son**, indicating that David regards Nabal as a father-figure and benefactor. Use a comparable title or expression from your own language and culture.

See: Politeness

1 Samuel 25:8 (#2)

שְׁאַל־נְעָרֶיךָ וְיַגִּדוּ לָךְ

“Ask your young men, and they will declare to you”

This is an imperative, but David is instructing his messengers to use it to make a polite request rather than to give a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. Alternate translation: [Please ask your young men, and they will declare to you that this is true]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

1 Samuel 25:8 (#4)

וְיִמְצְאוּ הַנְּעָרִים חֵן בְּעֵינֶיךָ

“So let the young men find favor in your eyes”

See how you translated the expression **in your eyes** in 1:18. Alternate translation: [So please regard these young men favorably]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 25:8 (#6)

עַל־יוֹם טוֹב

“on a good day”

David is instructing his messengers to speak of this **day** as **good** to represent the mood that they presume Nabal will be in at sheep-shearing time. In this culture, that was an occasion for celebration and generosity. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [on a day of celebration] or [at a time when you must be feeling happy]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:8 (#5)

בָּאנוּ

“we have come”

David is instructing his messengers to use the pronoun **we** to refer to themselves but not to Nabal, so use the exclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

1 Samuel 25:9 (#1)

וַיָּבֹאוּ נַעֲרֵי דָוִד

“So the young men of David came”

In a context such as this, your language might say “went” instead of **came**. Alternate translation: [So the young men of David went]

See: Go and Come

1 Samuel 25:9 (#2)

בְּשֵׁשֵׁם דָּוִד

“in the name of David”

The author is using the term **name** to represent that these messengers spoke on David’s behalf. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [on behalf of David]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:10 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר

“and said”

The expression **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this expression explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 25:10 (#2)

מִמַּי דָוִד וּמִמִּי בֶן־יִשָׁי

“Who {is} David? And who {is} the son of Jesse”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. For emphasis, Nabal is repeating the idea they express. If it would be clearer in your language, you could combine them. Alternate translation: [Who is David, this son of Jesse?]

See: Parallelism

1 Samuel 25:10 (#4)

אִישׁ מִפְּנֵי אֲדֹנָיו

“a man from the face of his master”

Nabal is using one part of a master, his **face**, to mean all of him in the act of exercising authority. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a man from his master] or [a man from his master’s authority]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 25:10 (#3)

מִמַּי דָוִד וּמִמִּי בֶן־יִשָׁי

“Who {is} David? And who {is} the son of Jesse”

Nabal is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or exclamation. Alternate translation: [David, that son of Jesse, is not anyone I must be generous to!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 25:11 (#3)

וְאֶת טִבְחָתִי אַשָּׁשְׁר טָבַחְתִּי

“and my slaughter that I have slaughtered”

For emphasis, Nabal is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [and the precious meat from the animals I have slaughtered]

See: Poetry

1 Samuel 25:11 (#4)

אֲשֶׁרׇ לׇא יָדַעְתִּי אֵי מִזֶּה הֵמָּה

“whom I do not know where from this they {are”

Nabal is using a common expression of his culture. The expression encapsulates a question and answer: “Where are these men from? They are from this place.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when I do not know where they come from]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 25:11 (#5)

אֲשֶׁרׇ לׇא יָדַעְתִּי אֵי מִזֶּה הֵמָּה

“whom I do not know where from this they {are”

By this expression, Nabal means that he considers David and his men to be drifters and outlaws who have no settled place of residence. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [who are roaming outlaws]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 25:11 (#1)

וְלָקַחְתִּי אֶת־לַחְמִי וְאֶת־מֵימַי וְאֶתׇ טִבְחָתִי אֲשֶׁר טָבַחְתִּי לְגֹזְזָי
וְנָתַתִּיׇ לַאֲנָשִׁים אֲשֶׁרׇ לׇא יָדַעְתִּי אֵי מִזֶּה הֵמָּה

“So shall I take my bread and my water and my slaughter that I have slaughtered for my shearers and give to men whom I do not know where from this they {are”

Nabal is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or exclamation. Alternate translation: [So I am not going to take my bread and my water and my slaughter that I have slaughtered for my shearers and give them to men whom I do not know where from this they are!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 25:11 (#2)

אֶת־לַחְמִיׇ וְאֶת־מֵימַי

“my bread and my water”

Nabal is using two specific items, **bread** and **water**, to mean all of the food and drink he has prepared. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the

meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [my food and my drink]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 25:12 (#1)

כְּכֹל֙ הַדְּבָרִ֣ים הָאֵ֔לֶּה

“according to all of these words”

The author is using the term **words** to represent what Nabal had said by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [everything that Nabal had said]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:13 (#2)

וַיַּֽעֲל֥וּ & כְּאַרְבַּ֖ע מֵא֣וֹת אִ֑ישׁ

“And about 400 men went up”

By **went up**, the author means that these men went up to Carmel. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And about 400 men went up to Carmel] or [And about 400 men went to Carmel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 25:13 (#1)

חִגְר֤וּ ׀ אִ֙ישׁ אֶת־חַרְבּ֔וֹ

“Strap on, a man his sword”

While the term **man** is singular, the implied “you” in the imperative **Strap on** is plural because David is addressing all his men, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction. Alternate translation: [All of you, strap on your swords]

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Samuel 25:13 (#4)

וּמְאַתַּ֥יִם יָשְׁב֖וּ

“and 200 stayed”

The author is using the number **200** as a noun to mean a certain number of men. Your language may use numbers in the same way. If not, you can translate this with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [and 200 men stayed]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 25:13 (#3)

אַחֲרֵ֥י דָוִֽד

“behind David”

The author is using the term **behind** to represent under David’s leadership. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [with David as their leader] or [under David’s command]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:14 (#1)

וְלַאֲבִיגַ֣יִל ׀ אֵ֣שֶׁת נָבָ֗ל

“But & to Abigail, the wife of Nabal”

Here the author is reintroducing Abigail as a participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of reintroducing participants that you can use in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Samuel 25:14 (#2)

לְבָרֵ֖ךְ

“to bless”

By **bless**, the young man means to greet respectfully. See how you translated the similar expression in 13:10. Alternate translation: [to greet]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 25:14 (#3)

אֶת־אֲדֹנֵ֑ינוּ

“our master”

While a wife in this culture might speak respectfully of her husband as her “lord,” that is a different term from the one that the young man uses here for **master**. So the servants are using the pronoun **our** to refer to themselves but not to Abigail, to whom they are speaking. Use the exclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

1 Samuel 25:15 (#1)

וְלֹא־פָקְקָ֥דְנוּ מְאוּמָ֖ה

“and we did not miss anything”

By this expression, the young man means that David’s men did not steal anything from him and his fellow servants. See how you translated the similar expression in 25:7. Alternate translation: [and they did not steal anything from us]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 25:15 (#2)

כָּל־יְמֵי

“all of the days when”

The young man is using the term **days** to represent time, since time is made up of days. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for the whole time that]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:16 (#3)

כָּל־יְמֵי הֱיוֹתֵנוּ עִמָּם

“all of the days of our being with them”

The young man is using the term **days** to represent time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for the whole time that we were with them]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:16 (#2)

גַּם־לַיְלָה גַּם־יוֹמָם

“both night and day”

The young man is speaking of the two major components of time, **night and day**, to mean all of time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [constantly]

See: Merism

1 Samuel 25:16 (#1)

חוֹמָה֙ הָיוּ עָלֵ֔ינוּ

“They were a wall for us”

The young man is speaking of David’s men as if they had been a **wall** that provided protection. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [They provided protection for us]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 25:17 (#4)

בֵּיתוֹ

“his house”

The young man is speaking of the people in Nabal’s household as if they were his **house**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his family]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 25:17 (#1)

וְעַתָּ֣ה דְּעִ֔י וּרְאִ֕י מַה־תַּעֲשִׂ֖י כִּי־כָלְתָ֣ה הָרָעָ֑ה אֶל־אֲדֹנֵ֨ינוּ֙ וְעַ֣ל כָּל־בֵּיתֹ֔ו

“And now, know and see what you shall do, for harm has completed against our master and against all of his house”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And now, since harm has completed against our master and against all of his house, know and see what you shall do]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 25:17 (#2)

דְּעִי וּרְאִי

“know and see”

See how you translated this same expression in 12:17. Alternate translation: [consider carefully]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 25:17 (#6)

מִדַּבֵּ֖ר אֵלָֽיו

“from speaking to him”

The young man is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and that keeps anyone from speaking to him] or [so that there is no speaking to him]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 25:17 (#3)

כָּלְתָ֣ה הָרָעָ֔ה אֶל

“harm has completed against”

The young man is using a common expression of his culture that means someone has determined to do harm. See how you translated the similar expression in 20:7. Alternate translation: [David has determined to harm]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 25:17 (#5)

בֶּן־בְּלִיַּ֣עַל

“a son of wickedness”

In certain contexts, biblical authors and characters use the expression **son of** to indicate that a person has the characteristic of something. In this case, Abigail is saying that Nabal has the characteristic of being wicked. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [such a wicked person]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 25:18 (#2)

וְחָמֵ֥שׁ צֹ֖אן עֲשׂוּת

“and five prepared sheep”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and five sheep that her servants had prepared]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 25:18 (#3)

וְחָמֵ֥שׁ סְאִים֙ קָלִ֔י

“and five seahs of roasted grain”

These **seahs** were each equivalent to 7.7 liters or a little over two gallons. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this in terms of modern measurements, either in the text or in a footnote.

See: Biblical Volume

1 Samuel 25:18 (#1)

וַתְּמַהֵ֣ר אבוגיל וַתִּקַּ֗ח

“And Abigail hurried and took”

This expression conveys a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **hurried** tells in what way Abigail **took**. Alternate translation: [And Abigail hurriedly took]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 25:19 (#1)

לְפָנַ֑י

“to my face”

Abigail is using the term **face** to represent the area ahead of her in direction she is facing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [ahead of me]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:19 (#2)

לֹ֥א הִגִּ֖ידָה

“she did not declare”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [she did not declare that she was bringing these gifts to David and his men]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 25:20 (#1)

בְּסֵ֣תֶר הָהָ֔ר

“in the cover of the mountain”

By **in the cover of the mountain**, the author means in a place where the mountain provided concealment. Such a place would do that because it was where the terrain sloped downward out of view. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [into a hollow of the mountain]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 25:20 (#2)

לִקְרָאתָ֑הּ

“to meet her”

By **to meet her**, the author means that David and his men were traveling in her direction. They did not know she was coming, and they were not intending to meet with her personally. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in her direction]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 25:21 (#3)

שָׁמַ֣רְתִּי

“I kept”

David is using **I** to mean himself and his men in the act of protecting Nabal’s property. If it would be helpful

in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [we kept]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 25:21 (#5)

וַיָּשֶׁב־לִ֥י רָעָ֖ה תַּ֣חַת טוֹבָֽה

“For he has returned evil to me for good”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **evil** and **good**, you could express these ideas in another way. See how you translated the similar expression in 24:17. Alternate translation: [For he has done something evil to me even though I did something good to him]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 25:21 (#4)

וְלֹא־נִפְקַ֥ד & מְאוּמָֽה

“and not anything was missed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. See how you translated the similar expression in 25:7. Alternate translation: [and I did not take anything]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 25:21 (#2)

לַשָּׁ֑וְא

“for a lie”

David is using a common expression of his culture that he had acted on a belief that was not true. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with false expectations]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 25:21 (#1)

אַךְ֩ לַשָּׁ֨וְא שָׁמַ֜רְתִּי אֶת־כָּל־אֲשֶׁ֣ר ׀ לָזֶ֣ה בַּמִּדְבָּ֗ר וְלֹא־נִפְקַ֥ד מִכָּל־אֲשֶׁר־לֹ֛ו מְאוּמָ֖ה וַיָּ֣שֶׁב־לִ֑י רָעָ֖ה תַּ֣חַת טוֹבָֽה

“Surely for a lie I kept all that {was} to this {one} in the wilderness, and not anything was missed from all that {was} to him. For he has returned evil to me for good”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since he has returned evil to me for good, surely for a lie I kept all that {was} to this {one} in the wilderness, and not anything was missed from all that {was} to him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 25:22 (#2)

וְכֹ֣ה יֹסִ֔יף

“and thus may he add”

David is using a common expression of his culture. See how you translated the similar expression in 3:17. Alternate translation: [and even more]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 25:22 (#1)

לְאֹיְבֵ֖י דָּוִֽד

“to the enemies of David”

See the discussion of the expression “the enemies of David” in the Introduction to chapter 20. The expression may have a similar explanation here. See how you translated it in 20:16. Alternate translation: [to David]

See: Politeness

1 Samuel 25:22 (#3)

מִכָּל־אֲשֶׁר־לֹ֑ו & מַשְׁתִּ֥ין בְּקִ֖יר

“any pissing against the wall who {are} to him”

David is referring by association to the males in Nabal’s household. In his anger, he is using an expression that might be considered vulgar in some cultures. If it would not be appropriate for your readers if you reproduced this exact expression, you could use an equivalent expression that would reflect David’s anger. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [every single one of the men in his household]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:23 (#1)

וַתְּמַהֵ֖ר וַתֵּ֥רֶד

“and she hurried and got down”

This expression conveys a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **hurried** tells in what way Abigail **got down**. Alternate translation: [and she hurriedly got down]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 25:23 (#2)

וַתִּפֹּ֤ל לְאַפֶּי֙ דָּוִד֙ עַל־פָּנֶ֔יהָ וַתִּשְׁתַּ֖חוּ אָ֥רְצָה

“And she fell to the face of David on her face and prostrated herself {on} the ground”

This was a symbolic action by which Abigail was showing great honor to David. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. See how you translated the similar expression in 20:41. Alternate translation: [and she knelt down and pressed her face to the ground in front of David to honor him]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 25:24 (#4)

בִּי־אֲנִ֣י אֲדֹנִ֔י הֶֽעָוֹ֖ן

“On me myself, my master, {be} the iniquity”

Abigail is addressing David in the third person as **my master** to show respect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a humble form in the second person. Alternate translation: [You, my master, may consider me personally responsible for this wrongdoing]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 25:24 (#5)

וּתְדַבֶּר־נָ֣א אֲמָתְךָ֔ בְּאָזְנֶ֖יךָ וּשְׁמַ֣ע אֵ֑את דִּבְרֵ֖י אֲמָתֶֽךָ

“Now please let your maidservant speak in your ears, and hear the words of your maidservant”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. Abigail is repeating the idea for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could combine them. Alternate translation: [Now please listen carefully to what I have to say]

See: Parallelism

1 Samuel 25:24 (#1)

וַתִּפֹּ֖ל עַל־רַגְלָֽיו

“And she fell at his feet”

This was a symbolic action by which Abigail was showing that she was taking the posture of someone making an urgent request to a superior. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [Then she approached and knelt down right in front of him, in the posture of someone who is going to ask a superior for something]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 25:24 (#2)

בִּי־אֲנִ֣י אֲדֹנִ֔י הֶֽעָוֹ֖ן

“On me myself, my master, {be} the iniquity”

In the original, Abigain adds the pronoun “me,” the meaning of which is already included in the implied verb represented as **be**. This adds emphasis to what she is saying. If your language uses explicit pronouns for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. Other languages may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. The ULT does so by using the intensive pronoun **myself**. Alternate translation: [on me personally, my master, be the iniquity]

1 Samuel 25:24 (#3)

בִּי־אֲנִ֣י אֲדֹנִ֔י הֶֽעָוֹ֖ן

“On me myself, my master, {be} the iniquity”

Abigail is speaking as if **iniquity** were something that could physically be **On** her. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [My master, hold me personally responsible for this wrongdoing]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 25:24 (#6)

אֲמָתְךָ֔ & אֵ֑את דִּבְרֵ֖י אֲמָתֶֽךָ

“your maidservant & the words of your maidservant”

Abigail is speaking about herself humbly in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [me ... my words]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 25:24 (#8)

אֵ֑את דִּבְרֵ֖י אֲמָתֶֽךָ

“the words of your maidservant”

Abigail is using the term **words** to represent the message she wants to communicate by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [what your maidservant has to say]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:24 (#7)

בְּאָזְנֶ֖יךָ

“in your ears”

Abigail is using one part of David, his **ears**, to mean all of him in the act of listening. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to you]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 25:25 (#5)

נָבָל שְׁמוֹ וּנְבָלָה עִמּוֹ

“Nabal {is} his name, and foolishness {is} with him”

The word **Nabal** means “fool.” In this culture, that term indicated a disregard for moral and religious obligations, including the obligation to share hospitality. (This was probably not his birth name, but a name he was given later, reflecting his character, as was common in this culture.) If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain this in your translation. Alternate translation: [His name means “fool,” and he acts just like a fool]

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 25:25 (#1)

אַל־נָ֣א יָשֵׁ֗ת אֲדֹנִי֙ ׀ אֶת־לִבּ֔וֹ & אֶת־נַעֲרֵ֖י אֲדֹנִֽי

“May my master please not set his heart & the young men of my master”

Abigail is addressing David respectfully in the third person. (She continues to address him that way, and to speak of herself humbly in the third person, through verse 31.) If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [May you, my master, please not set your heart ... your young men]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 25:25 (#2)

אַל & יָשֵׁ֗ת & אֶת־לִבּ֔וֹ אֶל־אִישׁ֙ הַבְּלִיַּ֣עַל הַזֶּ֔ה עַל־נָבָ֖ל

“May & not set his heart to this man of wickedness, upon Nabal”

Abigail is using a common expression of her culture that means not to be concerned about someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression in 9:20. Alternate translation: [May ... not be concerned about this man of wickedness, about Nabal]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 25:25 (#3)

אִישׁ֙ הַבְּלִיַּ֣עַל

“man of wickedness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **wickedness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [wicked man]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 25:25 (#4)

כִּֽי

“for”

Here the word **for** introduces not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [after all]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 25:25 (#6)

וּנְבָלָה עִמּוֹ

“and foolishness {is} with him”

Abigail is speaking of **foolishness** as if it were a person who could be **with** someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he does foolish things]

See: Personification

1 Samuel 25:26 (#4)

אֲשֶׁ֣ר מְנָעֲךָ֗

“who has restrained you”

Abigail is using the past tense to describe something that she believes is happening in the present. She is doing that in order to express her confidence that the event is surely happening. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use the present tense. Alternate translation: [who is now restraining you] or [who is now using me to restrain you]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

1 Samuel 25:26 (#9)

אֹיְבֶ֙יךָ֙ וְהַמְבַקְשִׁ֣ים אֶל־אֲדֹנִ֔י רָעָ֖ה

“your enemies and the ones seeking harm against my master”

The terms **enemies** and **ones seeking harm** mean similar things. Abigail is using them together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase.

Alternate translation: [all those who hostilely seek to harm you, my master]

See: Doublet

1 Samuel 25:26 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר מְנָעֲךָ יְהוָה

“it is} Yahweh who has restrained you”

By this statement, Abigail means that Yahweh has arranged for them to meet at this moment to prevent bloodshed. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [by having us meet in this way, it is Yahweh who has restrained you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 25:26 (#7)

מִבּוֹא בְדָמִים

“from entering into bloodshed”

Abigail is speaking of **bloodshed** as if it were a place that someone could enter. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from shedding much blood]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 25:26 (#8)

מִבּוֹא בְדָמִים

“from entering into bloodshed”

Abigail is using the term **bloodshed** to represent killing people, since blood is shed when people are killed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from killing many people]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:26 (#10)

כִּנָּבָל

“like Nabal”

By saying she wants David’s enemies to be **like Nabal**, Abigail means she wants them to become as insignificant and contemptible as he is. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [also too insignificant to be considered] or [equally contemptible]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 25:26 (#1)

חַי־יְהוָה וְחֵי־נַפְשְׁךָ

“the life of Yahweh, and the life of your soul”

Following the custom of her culture, Abigail is swearing an oath by guaranteeing it by two things that she holds sacred. Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. Alternate translation: [I swear by Yahweh, and I swear by the life of your soul]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Samuel 25:26 (#5)

מִבּוֹא בְדָמִים וְהוֹשִׁעַ יָדְךָ לָךְ

“from entering into bloodshed and your hand saving for yourself”

Abigail is describing one event before describing another event that would have preceded it. In your translation, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they would have happened. Alternate translation: [from your hand saving for yourself and entering into bloodshed]

See: Order of Events

1 Samuel 25:26 (#6)

מִבּוֹא בְדָמִים וְהוֹשִׁעַ יָדְךָ לָךְ

“from entering into bloodshed and your hand saving for yourself”

Abigail is using one part of David, his **hand**, to mean all of him in the act of taking revenge for himself. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [from taking matters into your own hands and entering into bloodshed] or [from taking revenge personally on an enemy by entering into bloodshed]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 25:26 (#2)

וְחֵי־נַפְשְׁךָ

“and the life of your soul”

Abigail is using one part of David, his **soul**, to mean all of him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and your own life]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 25:27 (#1)

הַבְּרָכָה הַזֹּאת אֲשֶׁר־הֵבִיא שִׁפְחָתְךָ לַאדֹנִי וְנִתְּנָהּ

“may this blessing that your maidservant has caused to come to my master be given”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [may you, my master, give this blessing that I, your maidservant, have caused to come]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 25:27 (#2)

הַבְּרָכָה

“blessing”

Abigail is using the term **blessing** to represent a gift that she hopes will be beneficial to David and his men. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [gift]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:27 (#3)

שִׁפְחָתְךָ

“your maidservant”

Here Abigail describes herself as a **maidservant**, using a different term than the one she had been using, which the ULT translates as “female servant.” This term refers to a lower-ranking member of the household. If your language and culture have different terms for female servants of different rank, use the term for a female servant of lower rank here.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 25:27 (#4)

הַמִּתְהַלְּכִים בְּרַגְלֵי אֲדֹנִי

“going about at the feet of my master”

Abigail is using the expression **at the feet** to represent under David’s command, since followers walk behind their leader. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [who follow you] or [whom you command]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:28 (#6)

בַּיִת נֶאֱמָן

“an established house”

Abigail is speaking of David’s royal dynasty as if it were a **house** that would stand firmly. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [an enduring royal dynasty]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 25:28 (#9)

מִיָּמֶיךָ

“from your days”

Abigail is using the term **days** to represent a specific time, the lifetime of David, since time is made up of days. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for your whole lifetime]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:28 (#1)

שָׂא & לְפֶשַׁע

“lift off the transgression of”

Abigail is speaking of **transgression** as if it were an object that someone could **lift off** another person. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [forgive the transgression of]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 25:28 (#2)

כִּי

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces a reason why David should forgive Abigail. Alternate translation: [You should do this because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 25:28 (#4)

עָשֹׂה־יַעֲשֶׂה יְהוָה לַאדֹנִי בַּיִת נֶאֱמָן

“making, Yahweh will make for my master an established house”

Abigail is repeating forms of the verb “make” in order to intensify her expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation:

[Yahweh will surely make for you, my master, an established house]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 25:28 (#5)

עָשֹׂה־יַעֲשֶׂה יְהוָה לַאדֹנִי בַּיִת נֶאֱמָן

“making, Yahweh will make for my master an established house”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will surely establish a house for you, my master]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 25:28 (#8)

וְרָעָה לֹא־תִמָּצֵא בְךָ

“And evil will not be found in you”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evil**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And you will not be guilty of having done something very wrong]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 25:28 (#3)

כִּי עָשֹׂה־יַעֲשֶׂה יְהוָה לַאדֹנִי בַּיִת נֶאֱמָן כִּי־מִלְחֲמוֹת יְהוָה אֲדֹנִי נִלְחָם

“For making, Yahweh will make for my master an established house, because my master is fighting the battles of Yahweh”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since you, my master, are fighting the battles of Yahweh, making, Yahweh will make for you, my master, an established house]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 25:28 (#7)

וְרָעָה לֹא־תִמָּצֵא בְךָ

“And evil will not be found in you”

Abigail is using a common expression of her culture. When she says that evil will not be **found**, she means that it will not be able to be found because it will not be there. See how you translated the similar expression in 9:8. Alternate translation: [And there will be no evil in you]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 25:29 (#5)

יְקַלְּעֶנָּה בְּתוֹךְ כַּף הַקָּלַע

“he will sling it away in the midst of the pocket of a sling”

Abigail is speaking of Yahweh destroying David’s enemies as if he would use a sling to throw away their lives. The point of comparison is that Yahweh will do this suddenly and powerfully, the way a stone comes out of a sling. (Abigail seems to be making an allusion to the way David was able to kill Goliath with a stone from a sling, reminding him of Yahweh’s protection at that time.) If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will end it suddenly and powerfully]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 25:29 (#1)

וַיָּקָם אָדָם לִרְדָפְךָ וּלְבַקֵּשׁ אֶת־נַפְשֶׁךָ וְהָיְתָה נֶפֶשׁ אֲדֹנִי צְרוּרָה בִּצְרֹר הַחַיִּים אֵת יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ ׀

“If a man arises to pursue you and to seek your life, then the life of my master will be bound in the bundle of the living by Yahweh your God”

Abigail is speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but she means that it is actually true. She knows that Saul has been pursuing David and seeking to kill him. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, then you could translate this as a confident statement. Alternate translation: [Even though a man has arisen to pursue you and to seek your life, the life of my master will nevertheless be bound in the bundle of the living by Yahweh your God]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

1 Samuel 25:29 (#2)

וַיָּקָם אָדָם

“If a man arises”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:9. Alternate translation: [If a man takes action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 25:29 (#3)

לִרְדָפְךָ וּלְבַקֵּשׁ אֶת־נַפְשֶׁךָ

“to pursue you and to seek your life”

This expression conveys a single idea by using two phrases connected with **and**. The phrase **seek your life** tells for what reason the man would **pursue**. Alternate translation: [in deadly pursuit of you]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 25:29 (#4)

וְהָיְתָה֙ נֶ֣פֶשׁ אֲדֹנִ֔י צְרוּרָ֕ה ׀ בִּצְר֖וֹר הַחַיִּ֑ים אֵ֚ת יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ

“then the life of my master will be bound in the bundle of the living by Yahweh your God”

Abigail is speaking of Yahweh protecting David as if he would tie up David’s life securely in a **bundle** with other people whose lives he was preserving. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [then Yahweh your God will ensure that you, my master, remain among those who are alive]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 25:30 (#1)

אֶת־הַטּוֹבָ֔ה

“the good”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **good**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the good things]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 25:31 (#5)

וְזָכַרְתָּ֥ אֶת־אֲמָתֶֽךָ

“and you will remember your maidservant”

Abigail is using herself to represent the advice she has given. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and you will remember the good advice that I, your maidservant, have given you]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:31 (#1)

וְלֹ֣א תִהְיֶ֣ה זֹּ֗את ׀ לְפ֣וּקָ֣ה וּלְמִכְשׁ֣וֹל לֵלֵ֣ב לַאדֹנִ֔י וְלִשְׁפְּךְ־דָּ֥ם חִנָּ֖ם וְלֹֽהוֹשִׁ֣יעַ אֲדֹנִ֣י לוֹ֑

“then this will not be an obstacle for you or a stumbling block of heart for my master, or for the pouring out of blood without cause, or for my master saving himself”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [then, because you, my master, will not have tried to save yourself by pouring out blood without cause, this will not be an obstacle for you or a stumbling block of heart for you, my master]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 25:31 (#4)

וְלִשְׁפְּךְ־דָּ֥ם חִנָּ֖ם

“or for the pouring out of blood without cause”

Abigail is using the expression **pouring out of blood** to represent killing, since blood pours out of people when they are killed violently. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [because you would have killed many people without cause]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:31 (#3)

לְפ֣וּקָ֣ה וּלְמִכְשׁ֣וֹל לֵלֵ֣ב לַאדֹנִ֔י

“an obstacle for you or a stumbling block of heart for my master”

Abigail is speaking of future regret as if it were something physical that could make a person stumble and fall and of David’s **heart** as if it were such a person. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a source of deep grief for you, my master]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 25:31 (#2)

לְפ֣וּקָ֣ה וּלְמִכְשׁ֣וֹל לֵלֵ֣ב לַאדֹנִ֔י

“an obstacle for you or a stumbling block of heart for my master”

The terms **obstacle** and **stumbling block of heart** mean similar things. Abigail is using them together to emphasize how serious this would be. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [anything that will make your heart trip and fall, my master]

See: Doublet

1 Samuel 25:32 (#1)

בָּרוּךְ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֲשֶׁר שְׁלָחֵךְ

“May Yahweh, the God of Israel, be blessed, who sent you”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I bless Yahweh, the God of Israel, for sending you]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 25:33 (#3)

מִבּוֹא בְדָמִים וְהוֹשֵׁעַ יָדִי לִי

“from entering into bloodshed and my hand saving for myself”

David is using one part of himself, his **hand**, to mean all of him in the act of potentially taking revenge. See how you translated the similar expression in 25:26. Alternate translation: [from taking matters into my own hands and entering into bloodshed] or [from taking revenge personally on an enemy by entering into bloodshed]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 25:33 (#4)

מִבּוֹא בְדָמִים

“from entering into bloodshed”

David is speaking of killing as if it were a place that someone could enter. See how you translated the similar expression in 25:26. Alternate translation: [from shedding much blood] or [from killing many people]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 25:33 (#1)

וּבָרוּךְ טַעְמֵךְ וּבְרוּכָה אָתְּ אֲשֶׁר

“And blessed be your discernment, and blessed be {you} who”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And I bless your discernment, and I bless you]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 25:33 (#2)

וּבָרוּךְ טַעְמֵךְ וּבְרוּכָה אָתְּ אֲשֶׁר

“And blessed be your discernment, and blessed be {you} who”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **discernment**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And I bless you for being so discerning]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 25:34 (#4)

כִּי אִם־נוֹתַר לְנָבָל עַד־אוֹר הַבֹּקֶר מַשְׁתִּין בְּקִיר

“that if one pissing against the wall had been left to Nabal until the light of the morning”

David is referring to the oath he made in verse 22. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate this explicitly. Alternate translation: [that I would have kept my oath not to leave to Nabal until the light of the morning one pissing against the wall]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Samuel 25:34 (#1)

חַי־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the life of Yahweh, the God of Israel”

Following the custom of his culture, David is swearing an oath by guaranteeing it by something he holds sacred. Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. Alternate translation: [I swear by Yahweh, the God of Israel]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Samuel 25:34 (#2)

מֵהָרַע אֹתָךְ

“from harming you”

By **harming**, David means causing Abigail great loss and sorrow by killing her husband and the men of her household. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [from causing you great loss and sorrow]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 25:34 (#3)

מַהַרְתְּ ותבאתי

“you had hurried and come”

This expression conveys a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **hurried** tells in what way Abigail **came**. Alternate translation: [you had hurriedly come]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 25:34 (#5)

אִם־נוֹתַר לְנָבָל & מַשְׁתִּתִּין בְּקִיר

“if one pissing against the wall had been left to Nabal”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I would not have left to Nabal one pissing against the wall]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 25:34 (#6)

מַשְׁתִּתִּין בְּקִיר

“one pissing against the wall”

David is using this expression to represent any male person. See how you translated the same expression in 25:22. Alternate translation: [even one male person]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:35 (#1)

מִיָּדָהּ

“from her hand”

The author is using one part of Abigail, her **hand**, to mean all of her in the act of giving. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from her]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 25:35 (#4)

שָׁמַעְתִּי בְקוֹלֵךְ

“I have listened to your voice”

David is using the term **voice** to represent what Abigail has said by using her voice. See how you translated the similar expression in 2:25. Alternate translation: [I have agreed to do what you have said]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:35 (#5)

וְאֶשָּׂא פָנֶיךְ

“and I have lifted up your face”

David is using the expression **lifted up your face** to represent he has granted Abigail’s request. In this culture, a supplicant would look down at the ground in front of a superior, and the superior would reach down and lift up the person’s face if he were going to grant the request. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [so I have granted your request]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:35 (#2)

לְשָׁלוֹם

“in peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [peacefully] or [fearing no harm]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 25:35 (#3)

רְאִי

“See”

David is using **See** in the same way that people in this culture often used the comparable term “Behold,” to call attention to what he is about to say. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Let me assure you]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 25:36 (#2)

וְלֵב נָבָל טוֹב עָלָיו

“And the heart of Nabal was good within him”

Here the **heart** represents a person’s feelings and mood. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Nabal was in a very happy mood]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 25:36 (#1)

כְּמִשְׁתֵּה הַמֶּלֶךְ

“like the feast of a king”

The point of this comparison is that just as a king would serve an abundance of fine food and drink at a feast, so Nabal had prepared a very lavish celebration. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [like the lavish feast that a king would prepare]

See: Simile

1 Samuel 25:36 (#3)

דָּבָר קָטֹן וְגָדוֹל

“a thing small or great”

The author is speaking of two extremes, **small** and **great**, in order to mean such things and everything in between. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [anything at all]

See: Merism

1 Samuel 25:37 (#2)

בְּצֵאת הַיַּיִן מִנָּבָל

“when the wine had gone out from Nabal”

The author is using **wine** to represent its intoxicating effects. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [when Nabal was no longer feeling the effects of the wine]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:37 (#4)

וְהוּא הָיָה לְאָבֶן

“and he became a stone”

The author is speaking of Nabal as if he had turned into a **stone**. He means that Nabal became completely unresponsive, apparently from a stroke. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he could no longer move]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 25:37 (#3)

וַיָּמָת לִבּוֹ בְּקִרְבּוֹ

“And his heart died in the midst of him”

Since Nabal lived for another ten days, as the next verse indicates, the author is probably not using the term **heart** to mean the organ that pumped Nabal’s blood. Instead, as in the previous verse, the term probably describes his feelings. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You could also use plain language. Alternate translation: [And he lost all heart] or [And he became terribly upset]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 25:37 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“And it happened”

The author is using this phrase to introduce a new development in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method here that is natural in your language for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 25:38 (#1)

וַיִּגֹּף יְהוָה אֶת־נָבָל וַיָּמֹת

“and Yahweh struck Nabal and he died”

When the author says that **Yahweh struck Nabal**, this probably indicates that Nabal had another medical event such as a second stroke. However, the author is saying that Yahweh caused this so that Nabal would die. Since it is not clear exactly what happened in medical terms, you may wish to state this generally in your translation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh caused Nabal to die]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 25:39 (#1)

בָּרוּךְ יְהוָה

“Blessed be Yahweh”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. See how you translated the similar expression in 25:32. Alternate translation: [I bless Yahweh]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 25:39 (#6)

וַיִּשְׁלַח דָּוִד וַיְדַבֵּר

“And David sent and spoke”

The author means that David **sent** messengers to Abigail, and they **spoke** on his behalf. Alternate translation: [And David sent people to speak]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:39 (#4)

עַבְדּוֹ

“his servant”

David is speaking about himself in relation to Yahweh humbly in the third person. If it would be helpful in

your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [me, his servant]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 25:39 (#5)

נָבָל֔וֹ & וְאֶת־רָעַ֥ת & הֵשִׁ֛יב יְהוָ֖ה בְּרֹאשׁ֑וֹ

“And Yahweh has returned the evil of Nabal on his head”

David is speaking of Nabal’s **evil** as if it were an object that Yahweh could have brought back to him and placed on his **head**. He means that Yahweh has caused the consequences of those actions to affect him. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And because Nabal did something bad to me, Yahweh made something bad happen to him]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 25:39 (#3)

חֶרְפָּתִ֥י מִיַּ֖ד & נָבָ֑ל

“my reproach from the hand of Nabal”

David is using one part of Nabal, his **hand**, to mean all of him in the act of insulting David by refusing his request. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Nabal insulting me by refusing to give me anything]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 25:39 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֤ר רָב֙ אֶת־רִ֣יב חֶרְפָּתִ֔י מִיַּ֖ד & נָבָ֑ל

“who has conducted the case of my reproach from the hand of Nabal”

David is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root to emphasize how completely Yahweh has defended him. See how you translated the similar expression “conduct my case” in 24:15. Alternate translation: [who has defended me after my reproach from the hand of Nabal]

See: Poetry

1 Samuel 25:41 (#3)

הִנֵּ֥ה אֲמָתְךָ֖

“Behold your female servant”

Abigail is responding to David’s marriage proposal with the courteous expression that people in this culture used to tell a superior that they had heard a summons and were ready and willing to obey. See how you translated this expression in 3:4. Alternate translation: [I am at your service]

See: Politeness

1 Samuel 25:41 (#4)

אֲמָתְךָ֖

“your female servant”

The word **your** is singular here because Abigail is addressing David through his messengers. So use the singular form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Samuel 25:41 (#6)

לְשִׁפְחָ֔ה

“for a maidservant”

Abigail is using the same term for a female servant of lower status that she used in 25:14. See how you translated the term there.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 25:41 (#7)

אֲדֹנִ֑י

“my master”

Abigail is speaking about David respectfully in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the second person. Alternate translation: [you, my master]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 25:41 (#1)

וַתִּשְׁתַּחוּ֙ אַפַּ֣יִם אָ֔רְצָה

“and bowed down, nostrils to the ground”

This was a symbolic action by which Abigail was showing great honor to David. See how you translated similar expressions in 20:41 and 24:8. Alternate translation: [and knelt down and pressed her face to the ground to show great honor to David]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 25:41 (#2)

הִנֵּ֥ה אֲמָתְךָ֖

“Behold your female servant”

Abigail is speaking about herself humbly in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you

could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [Behold me, your maidservant]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 25:41 (#5)

לְשַׁפְחָה לִרְחֹץ רַגְלֵי עַבְדֵי אֲדֹנִי

“for a maidservant for washing the feet of the servants of my master”

Abigail is making an overstatement for emphasis. She means that she is willing to serve David in any way, even in the most humble tasks. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [I am willing to serve you in any task, no matter how humble]

See: Hyperbole

1 Samuel 25:42 (#1)

וַתְּמַהֵר וַתָּקָם אֲבִיגַיִל

“And Abigail hurried and arose”

By saying that Abigail **arose**, the author means that she took action in response to David’s proposal. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And Abigail hurried and took action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 25:42 (#2)

וַתְּמַהֵר וַתָּקָם אֲבִיגַיִל

“And Abigail hurried and arose”

This expression conveys a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **hurried** tells in what way Abigail **arose** (took action). Alternate translation: [And Abigail hurriedly took action]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 25:42 (#3)

הַהֹלְכוֹת לְרַגְלֶיהָ

“were going at her feet”

The author is using the expression **at her feet** to represent that Abigail’s young women walked behind her. (Even though Abigail was riding a donkey, the author is speaking as if she was walking on her **feet**.) See how you translated the similar expression in 25:27. Alternate translation: [followed her]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 25:43 (#1)

וְאֶת־אֲחִינֹעַם לָקַח דָּוִד מִיִּזְרְעֶאל

“And David took Ahinoam from Jezreel”

This could mean either: (1) that around this time, David also married a woman named Ahinoam who came from Jezreel. The ULT reflects this understanding. Alternate translation: [And David married Ahinoam from Jezreel]; (2) that David had already married Ahinoam at some previous time. Some interpreters believe that this is the case because Ahinoam is named first in the list of David’s sons and their mothers in 2 Samuel 3:2. (However, other interpreters believe that is because she bore David his first son, not necessarily because he married her first.) Alternate translation: [And David had married Ahinoam from Jezreel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 25:43 (#2)

וַתִּהְיֶיןָ גַּם־שְׁתֵּיהֶן לוֹ לְנָשִׁים

“and the two of them also became wives for him”

The word **also** indicates “in addition to Michal,” whom the author discusses in the next verse. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the two of them became wives for him in addition to Michal]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 25:44 (#1)

וְשָׁאוּל נָתַן אֶת־מִיכַל בִּתּוֹ אֵשֶׁת דָּוִד לְפַלְטִי בֶן־לַיִשׁ

“But Saul had given his daughter Michal, the wife of David, to Palti the son of Laish”

This was a symbolic action by which Saul showed that he no longer wanted to have anything to do with David. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [But Saul had given his daughter Michal, the wife of David, to Palti the son of Laish as his wife, to show that he no longer wanted to have anything to do with David, his former son-in-law]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel - Chapter 26 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the part of the book that describes how David became king (chapters 16–31). It describes how David got a second opportunity to

kill Saul when Saul once again pursued him into the wilderness. Once again David did not kill him, since Yahweh had anointed Saul to be the king. David proved to Saul once more that he could have killed him, and Saul admitted that he had been wrong to pursue David and promised that he would never harm him.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did David take Saul's spear and water jug?
As in the case of David cutting off the edge of Saul's robe 24:4, when David took the spear and water jug that were near Saul's head (26:11), he was able shortly afterwards to show these items as proof that he could have killed Saul but did not. But in this case as in that earlier case, this action may have had further symbolic significance. As 22:6 shows, the spear was an emblem of Saul's royal office. The water jar may have been a similar emblem. In some ancient cultures, an important official accompanying the king would carry a beautiful and valuable jug containing water for the king to use to wash his hands before eating and for other personal purposes. The context suggests that it was the duty of Abner, as Saul's general, to carry this jug with him and present it to Saul whenever he wanted to use the water in it. By taking these royal emblems, David may have been dramatizing how the kingship would pass from Saul to him. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain this possibility in a footnote.

1 Samuel 26:1 (#3)

עַ֖ל פְּנֵ֣י הַיְשִׁימֹֽן

"on the face of Jeshimon"

The Ziphites are using the term **on the face of** to represent in front of or opposite. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [opposite Jeshimon]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 26:1 (#2)

הֲלֹ֥וא דָוִ֛ד מִסְתַּתֵּ֥ר בְּגִבְעַ֖ת הַחֲכִילָ֑ה עַ֖ל פְּנֵ֥י הַיְשִׁימֹֽן

"Is} not David hiding himself on the hill of Hakilah, on the face of Jeshimon"

The Ziphites are using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [David is hiding himself on the hill of Hakilah, on the face of Jeshimon!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 26:1 (#1)

וַיָּבֹ֣אוּ הַזִּפִּ֗ים אֶל־שָׁאוּל֙ הַגִּבְעָ֣תָה

"Now the Ziphites came to Saul at Gibeah"

The author is introducing a new development in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method here that is natural in your language for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 26:2 (#1)

וַיָּ֣קָם שָׁא֔וּל

"And Saul arose"

See how you translated the similar phrase in 1:9. Alternate translation: [And Saul took action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 26:2 (#2)

וַיֵּ֣רֶד

"and went down"

See how you translated the similar phrase in 1:3, where the author, in keeping with the conventions of his culture, marks travel for change in elevation. Alternate translation: [and went]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 26:2 (#3)

בְּחוּרֵ֥י יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל

"chosen {ones} of Israel"

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom he had chosen from throughout Israel]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 26:3 (#1)

וַיַּ֖רְא

"And he saw"

The author is using the term **saw** to represent that David learned this, since people often learn things by seeing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And he learned]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 26:4 (#1)

אֶל־נָכוֹן

“as a confirmed {thing”

See how you translated the similar phrase in 23:23. Alternate translation: [as something that he had confirmed]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 26:5 (#2)

וְאַבְנֵר בֶּן־נֵר שַׂר־צְבָאוֹ

“and Abner, the son of Ner, the commander of his army”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and Abner, the son of Ner, the commander of his army, lay nearby]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 26:5 (#3)

בַּמַּעְגָּל

“within the wagon-track”

The author is using the term **within the wagon-track** to represent within the defensive circle of supply wagons around the camp. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [within the defensive circle of supply wagons around the camp]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 26:5 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר חָנָה־שָּׁם שָׁאוּל & אֲשֶׁר שָׁכַב־שָּׁם שָׁאוּל

“where Saul had camped there & where Saul lay there”

It might seem that the expressions **where Saul had camped there** and **where Saul lay there** contain extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten them. Alternate translation: [where Saul had camped … where Saul lay]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 26:5 (#4)

וְהָעָם

“and the people”

As he has done frequently in previous chapters, the author is using the term **people** here to mean soldiers. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and his soldiers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 26:6 (#1)

וַיַּ֥עַן דָּוִ֖ד וַיֹּ֣אמֶר

“And David answered and said”

Here the author is using **answered** to express that David was responding to seeing Saul asleep in the camp. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And in response to what he had seen, David said]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 26:6 (#3)

צְרוּיָ֔ה

“Zeruiah”

The word **Zeruiah** is the name of a woman. She was David’s older sister. (So the author is identifying Abishai, not Zeruiah, as the **brother of Joab**.)

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 26:6 (#4)

אֲנִ֥י אֵרֵ֖ד עִמָּֽךְ

“I, I will go down with you”

Abishai is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I will go down** already includes this meaning. He is doing that because he is emphasizing his agreement to accompany David down to Saul’s camp. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [I agree to go down with you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 26:6 (#2)

וַיַּ֥עַן דָּוִ֖ד וַיֹּ֣אמֶר ׀ אֶל־אֲחִימֶ֣לֶךְ

“And David answered and said to Ahimelech”

The expression **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this expression explicitly. Alternate translation: [And David answered Ahimelech]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 26:7 (#1)

וְהִנֵּה

“And behold”

The author is using the term **behold** to focus his readers’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. See how you translated the term in 2:31.

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 26:7 (#2)

וַחֲנִיתְתּוֹ מְעוּכָה־בָאָרֶץ מראשתו

“and his spear was pressed into the ground by his head”

Displaying the **spear** in this way was a symbolic action that identified Saul as the king, similarly to the way Saul held this spear in his hand in 22:6 when he was holding court. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [and his spear was pressed into the ground by his head to identify him as the king]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 26:7 (#3)

וַחֲנִיתְתּוֹ מְעוּכָה־בָאָרֶץ

“and his spear was pressed into the ground”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and he had pressed his spear into the ground]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 26:8 (#1)

בְּיָדֶךָ

“into your hand”

The author is using the term **hand** to represent power or control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [into your control]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 26:8 (#2)

וְלֹא אֶשְׁנֶה לוֹ

“And I will not do again to him”

Abishai is not asking David for just one chance to kill Saul and promising that he will let Saul live if he fails to kill him the first time. He means that he will not need to strike Saul more than once, since the first blow will kill him. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And I will not need to strike him a second time]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 26:9 (#2)

מִמִּי שָׁלַח יָדוֹ בִּמְשִׁיחַ יְהוָה וְנָקֹה

“who has stretched out his hand against the anointed one of Yahweh and been innocent”

David is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [no one has stretched out his hand against the anointed one of Yahweh and been innocent!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 26:9 (#3)

כִּי מִמִּי שָׁלַח יָדוֹ בִּמְשִׁיחַ יְהוָה

“For who has stretched out his hand against the anointed one of Yahweh”

David is using a common expression of his culture to mean attacking or harming someone. See how you translated the similar phrase in 24:6. Alternate translation: [has used violence against the anointed one of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 26:9 (#4)

בִּמְשִׁיחַ יְהוָה

“against the anointed one of Yahweh”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. See how you translated this in 24:6. Alternate translation: [against the one whom Yahweh has anointed]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 26:9 (#1)

אַל־תַּשְׁחִיתֵהוּ כִּֽי מִמִּי שָׁלַח יָדוֹ בִּמְשִׁיחַ יְהוָה וְנָקֶה

“Do not destroy him. For who has stretched out his hand against the anointed one of Yahweh and been innocent”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Who has stretched out his hand against the anointed one of Yahweh and been innocent? So do not destroy him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 26:10 (#1)

חַי־יְהוָה

“The life of Yahweh”

At the beginning of this quotation, David starts to swear an oath that he will not kill Saul, as he does say in the next verse. But in the rest of this verse, he says what will happen instead. It may be more natural in your language to put this phrase at the end of this verse so that it will directly precede what David swears in the next verse.

See: Information Structure

1 Samuel 26:10 (#4)

אִוֹ֣ בְיוֹמ֔וֹ יֵרֵ֖ד וְנָסָֽפָה

“or he will go down into a battle and be swept away”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [or he will go down into a battle and it will sweep him away]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 26:10 (#2)

יְהוָה יִגְּפֶֽנּוּ

“Yahweh will strike him”

By **strike him**, David means that Yahweh will kill Saul. See how you translated the similar phrase in 4:2. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will kill him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 26:10 (#3)

אִוֹ־יוֹמ֖וֹ יָבֹ֑וא וָמֵֽת

“or his day will come and he will die”

David is using the term **his day** to represent the time when Saul will die. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [or the time will come for him to die]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 26:10 (#5)

וְנִסְפָּֽה

“and be swept away”

David is speaking as if battle were a flood that could sweep Saul away. See how you translated the similar phrase in 12:25. Alternate translation: [and be destroyed] or [and it will destroy him]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 26:11 (#2)

מִשְׁלֹ֣חַ יָדִ֔י בִּמְשִׁ֖יחַ יְהוָ֑ה

“to stretch out my hand against the anointed one of Yahweh”

David is using a common expression of his culture, **stretch out my hand**, to mean attacking or harming someone. See how you translated the similar phrase in 24:6. Alternate translation: [to attack the anointed one of Yahweh] or [to use violence against the anointed one of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 26:11 (#3)

בִּמְשִׁ֖יחַ יְהוָ֑ה

“against the anointed one of Yahweh”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the one whom Yahweh has anointed]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 26:11 (#4)

קַח & אֶת־הַחֲנִ֥ית אֲשֶׁר־מראשתו וְאֶת־צַפַּ֖חַת הַמָּֽיִם

“take the spear that {is} by his head and the jug of water”

Taking the **spear** and the **jug of water** was a symbolic action that demonstrated that David had been close enough to kill Saul but had chosen not to do so. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the

significance of this action. Alternate translation: [take the spear that is by his head and the jug of water to show that we could have killed him but chose not to]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 26:11 (#5)

וְנֵלְכָה לָּנוּ

“and let us go for ourselves”

After saying **let us go**, David uses the pronoun **ourselves** to emphasize that there is benefit for him and Abishai in doing that. He means that the two of them should leave before any of the soldiers awake and they are discovered and captured. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate this emphasis. Alternate translation: [and let us get out of here!]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

1 Samuel 26:11 (#1)

חָלִלָה לִּי֙ מֵיהוָ֔ה מִשְׁלֹ֥חַ יָדִ֖י

“profane to me from Yahweh to stretch out my hand”

David is using a common expression of his culture, **Profane to me**, to mean that he would be committing a serious sin against Yahweh if he were to harm Saul. See how you translated the similar phrase in 24:6. Alternate translation: [far be it from me to sin against Yahweh by stretching out my hand]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 26:12 (#3)

תַּרְדֵּמַ֤ת יְהוָה֙ נָפְלָ֣ה עֲלֵיהֶ֔ם

“a deep sleep of Yahweh had fallen on them”

The author is speaking as if **sleep** were an object that could have **fallen** on these soldiers. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh had caused all of them to fall fast asleep] or [Yahweh had caused all of them to be completely asleep]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 26:12 (#2)

וְאֵ֣ין רֹאֶ֔ה וְאֵ֥ין יוֹדֵ֖עַ וְאֵ֣ין מֵקִ֑יץ כִּ֣י כֻלָּ֗ם יְשֵׁנִ֛ים כִּֽי תַרְדֵּמַ֥ת יְהוָ֖ה נָפְלָ֥ה עֲלֵיהֶֽם

“And none was seeing, and none was knowing, and none was awakening, for all of them were sleeping, because a deep sleep of Yahweh had fallen on them”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And because a deep sleep of Yahweh had fallen on them, so all of them were sleeping, thus none was seeing, and none was knowing, and none was awakening]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 26:12 (#1)

וַיִּקַּ֤ח דָּוִד֙

“And David took”

The author is using one person who was involved in this action, David, who requested it, to represent another person who was involved, Abishai, who took the items at David’s request. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [So Abishai took for David]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 26:13 (#1)

עַל־רֹאשׁ־הָהָר

“on the head of a hill”

The author is speaking as if the top of this **hill** were actually its **head**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on top of a hill] or [high up on a hill]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 26:14 (#2)

אַבְנֵ֔ר & הֲלֹ֥וא תַעֲנֶ֖ה

“Will you not answer, Abner”

David is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Answer me, Abner!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 26:14 (#3)

וַיַּ֥עַן אַבְנֵ֖ר וַיֹּ֣אמֶר

“And Abner answered and said”

The expression **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this expression explicitly. Alternate translation: [And Abner replied]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 26:14 (#4)

קָרָאתָ אֶל־הַמֶּלֶךְ

“who} call to the king”

By **call to the king**, Abner does not mean that David has called out to Saul. The author describes how David called out to him by name. Rather, Abner means to ask who is calling out so as to disturb the king’s sleep. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [who call out so as to disturb the king]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 26:14 (#1)

וַיִּקְרָ֣א דָּוִ֔ד אֶל־הָעָ֖ם וְאֶל & אַבְנֵֽר

“And David called to the people and to Abner”

This expression conveys a single idea by using two phrases connected with **and**. The phrase **to the people** tells among whom David called **to Abner**. Alternate translation: [And David called to Abner among the people]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 26:15 (#1)

הֲלוֹא־אִ֣ישׁ אַתָּ֔ה וּמִ֥י כָמֹ֖וךָ בְּיִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל וְלָ֣מָּה֩ לֹ֨א שָׁמַ֜רְתָּ אֶל־אֲדֹנֶ֗יךָ הַמֶּ֙לֶךְ֙

“Are} you not a man? And who {is} like you in Israel? So why did you not watch over your master the king”

David is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You are a man! No one is like you in Israel! So you should have watched over your master the king!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 26:15 (#4)

אַחַ֣ד הָעָ֔ם

“one of the people”

By **one of the people**, David means a soldier. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [a soldier]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 26:15 (#3)

כִּ֣י

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [I say this because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 26:15 (#2)

הֲלוֹא־אִישׁ אַתָּה

“Are} you not a man”

By **a man**, David means a great warrior. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Are you not a great warrior?] or [You are a great warrior!]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 26:16 (#5)

וְעַתָּ֗ה ׀ רְאֵה֙ אֵי־חֲנִ֣ית הַמֶּ֔לֶךְ וְאֵת֙־צַפַּ֣חַת הַמַּ֔יִם אֲשֶׁ֖ר מראשתו

“And now, see, where {are} the spear of the king and the jug of water that {were} by his head”

David is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [And now, see, someone has taken the spear of the king and the jar of water that were by his head!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 26:16 (#3)

מְשִׁ֥יחַ יְהוָֽה

“the anointed one of Yahweh”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the one whom Yahweh has anointed]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 26:16 (#1)

חַי־יְהוָ֔ה כִּ֥י

“The life of Yahweh, that”

Following the custom of his culture, David is swearing an oath by guaranteeing it by something he holds sacred. Alternate translation: [I swear by Yahweh that]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Samuel 26:16 (#2)

בְּנֵי־מָ֣וֶת אַתֶּ֗ם אֲשֶׁ֤ר לֹא־שְׁמַרְתֶּם֙ עַל־אֲדֹנֵיכֶ֔ם

“you {are} sons of death who did not watch over your master”

David is using a common expression of his culture to mean that Abner and his men deserve to die for not protecting Saul. See how you translated the similar phrase in 20:31. Alternate translation: [you who did not watch over your master deserve to die]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 26:16 (#4)

וְעַתָּ֕ה

“And now”

And now was a common expression that speakers in this culture used to introduce their main topic. David is using it to introduce his proof that someone could have killed Saul that night. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. See how you translated this expression in 6:7. Alternate translation: [Let me prove to you that someone could have killed the king tonight]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 26:16 (#6)

וְעַתָּ֕ה ׀ רְאֵ֗ה אֵי־חֲנִ֙ית הַמֶּ֜לֶךְ וְאֵ֤ת־צַפַּ֙חַת֙ הַמַּ֔יִם אֲשֶׁ֖ר מראשתו

“And now, see, where {are} the spear of the king and the jug of water that {were} by his head”

This could mean: (1) that David is telling Abner to look around Saul and see that the spear and jar are missing. The ULT reflects this meaning. (2) that David is holding up the spear and jar and telling Abner to see that he has them. Alternate translation: [And now, see where the spear of the king and the jar of water are that were by his head!]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 26:17 (#3)

בְּנִ֥י דָוִ֖ד

“my son David”

In the similar episode in 24:16, Saul seemed to be using this same expression to reaffirm David as his own son-in-law, after he had been referring to him dismissively as “the son of Jesse.” By this point, however, Saul has repudiated David as his son-in-law by giving his daughter Michal to another man (25:44.) So here **my son** is probably a term of endearment rather than a kinship term. Alternate translation: [my dear David]

See: Kinship

1 Samuel 26:17 (#1)

הֲקוֹלְךָ֥ זֶ֛ה בְּנִ֖י דָוִ֑ד

“Is} this your voice, my son David”

Saul is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. See how you translated the similar phrase in 24:16. Alternate translation: [I recognize your voice, my son David!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 26:17 (#2)

הֲקוֹלְךָ֥ זֶ֛ה בְּנִ֖י דָוִ֑ד

“Is} this your voice, my son David”

Saul is using the term **voice** to represent the person who is speaking. See how you translated the similar phrase in 24:16. Alternate translation: [Is it you speaking to me, my son David?] or [I recognize that it is you speaking to me, my son David!]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 26:17 (#4)

קוֹלִ֣י

“My voice”

David is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [It is my voice] or [I am the one speaking]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 26:18 (#4)

אֲדֹנִ֣י רֹדֵ֔ף אַחֲרֵ֖י עַבְדּ֑וֹ

“my master pursuing after his servant”

David is addressing Saul respectfully in the third person and speaking about himself humbly in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [you, my master, pursuing after me, your servant]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 26:18 (#5)

מֶ֣ה עָשִׂ֔יתִי וּמַה־בְּיָדִ֖י רָעָֽה

“what have I done, and what evil {is} in my hand”

David is using one part of himself, his **hand**, to mean all of him in the act of potentially doing evil. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what have I done, and what evil have I committed]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 26:18 (#6)

מֶ֣ה עָשִׂ֔יתִי וּמַה־בְּיָדִ֖י רָעָֽה

“what have I done, and what evil {is} in my hand”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evil**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what have I done, and what evil action have I committed]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 26:18 (#7)

מֶ֣ה עָשִׂ֔יתִי וּמַה־בְּיָדִ֖י רָעָֽה

“what have I done, and what evil {is} in my hand”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. If it would be clearer in your language, you could combine them. Alternate translation: [what wrong have I done]

See: Parallelism

1 Samuel 26:18 (#3)

לָ֣מָּה זֶּ֔ה אֲדֹנִ֖י רֹדֵ֣ף אַחֲרֵ֑י עַבְדּ֗וֹ כִּֽי־מֶ֣ה עָשִׂ֔יתִי וּמַה־בְּיָדִ֖י רָעָֽה

“Why {is} this, my master pursuing after his servant? For what have I done, and what evil {is} in my hand”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [What have I done, and what evil is in my hand? So why {is} this, my master pursuing after his servant?] or [I have done nothing wrong, and no evil is in my hand. So my master should not be pursuing after his servant!]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 26:18 (#1)

וַיֹּ֖אמֶר

“And he said”

The pronoun **he** refers to David. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And David said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 26:18 (#2)

לָ֣מָּה זֶּ֔ה אֲדֹנִ֖י רֹדֵ֣ף אַחֲרֵ֑י עַבְדּ֗וֹ כִּֽי־מֶ֣ה עָשִׂ֔יתִי וּמַה־בְּיָדִ֖י רָעָֽה

“Why {is} this, my master pursuing after his servant? For what have I done, and what evil {is} in my hand”

David is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [My master should not be pursuing after his servant! For I have done nothing wrong, and no evil is in my hand.]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 26:19 (#2)

אֵ֚את דִּבְרֵ֣י עַבְדּ֔וֹ

“the words of his servant”

David is speaking about himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [what I, his servant, have to say]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 26:19 (#3)

יָרַ֥ח מִנְחָֽה

“may he smell an offering”

David is using the term **smell** to represent accept. In the Israelite sacrificial system, when Yahweh accepted an offering, he was understood to be pleased with its smell. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [may he accept an offering]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 26:19 (#5)

בְּנֵ֥י הָאָדָֽם

“sons of man”

Here the masculine terms **sons** and **man** have a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of

both men and women. Alternate translation: [human beings]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Samuel 26:19 (#9)

מֵהִסְתַּפֵּחַ בְּנַחֲלַת יְהוָה

“from joining myself with the inheritance of Yahweh”

David is speaking as if the people of Israel were something that Yahweh had inherited as a lasting possession. He means that the Israelites belong to Yahweh perpetually. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression in 10:1. Alternate translation: [from living together with his chosen people] or [from living among the other Israelites]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 26:19 (#10)

לֵאמֹר לֵךְ עֲבֹד אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים

“saying, ‘Go, serve other gods”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [telling me to go and serve other gods]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 26:19 (#11)

לֵךְ עֲבֹד אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים

“Go, serve other gods”

By **Go, serve other gods**, David means that his enemies are forcing him to live in another country, where the people worship other gods. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Go and live in another country, where the people worship other gods]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 26:19 (#7)

אֲרוּרִים הֵם לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“may they be cursed to the face of Yahweh”

David is using the term **face** to represent Yahweh’s regard or attention. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [may they be cursed in Yahweh’s regard]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 26:19 (#8)

אֲרוּרִים הֵם לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

“may they be cursed to the face of Yahweh”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [may Yahweh regard them as people whom he should curse] or [may Yahweh curse them]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 26:19 (#6)

אֲרוּרִים הֵם לִפְנֵי יְהוָה כִּי־גֵרְשׁוּנִי הַיּוֹם מֵהִסְתַּפֵּחַ בְּנַחֲלַת יְהוָה לֵאמֹר לֵךְ עֲבֹד אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים

“may they be cursed to the face of Yahweh. For they have driven me out today from joining myself with the inheritance of Yahweh, saying, ‘Go, serve other gods”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [since they have driven me out today from joining myself with the inheritance of Yahweh, saying, ‘Go, serve other gods,’ may they be cursed to the face of Yahweh]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 26:19 (#1)

אֵאֶת דִּבְרֵי עַבְדּוֹ

“the words of his servant”

David is using the term **words** to represent what he has to say. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [what his servant has to say]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 26:19 (#4)

וְאִם ׀ בְּנֵי הָאָדָם

“But if sons of man”

David is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [But if sons of man have incited you against me]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 26:20 (#5)

כַּאֲשֶׁר יִרְדֹּף הַקֹּרֵא בֶּהָרִים

“just as one pursues a partridge in the mountains”

The point of this comparison is that just as it would not be worthwhile for a person to pursue a **partridge** once it had fled into the **mountains**, since whole flocks of partridges lived in fields where people could catch them easily, so the pursuit of **one flea** would not justify the attention and effort of a king and his army. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [just as it would be pointless for someone to pursue a partridge in the mountains]

See: Simile

1 Samuel 26:20 (#1)

אַל־יִפֹּל דָּמִי אַרְצָה

“do not let my blood fall to the earth”

David is using the term **blood** to represent his death, since as a foreigner in another country he would be at risk of being killed violently. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [do not let me die a violent death]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 26:20 (#2)

מִנֶּגֶד פְּנֵי יְהוָה

“from before the face of Yahweh”

David is using the term **face** to represent Yahweh’s presence. He is referring to the land of Israel, where Yahweh is worshiped. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [away from the presence of Yahweh] or [in some distant country where the people do not worship Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 26:20 (#3)

כִּי

“For”

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [You can safely agree to this because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 26:20 (#4)

אֶת־פַּרְעֹשׁ אֶחָד

“one flea”

David is speaking as if he were a **flea**, a small, insignificant insect. See how you translated the similar phrase in 24:14. Alternate translation: [one man, who is insignificant]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 26:20 (#6)

הַקֹּרֵא

“a partridge”

A **partridge** is a medium-sized bird that people of this culture hunted for food. If your readers would not be familiar with what a partridge is, in your translation you could use the name of a similar bird that your readers would recognize, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [a game bird] or [a wild bird]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 26:21 (#2)

יָקְרָה נַפְשִׁי בְּעֵינֶיךָ

“my life was precious in your eyes”

See how you translated this similar expression in 1:18. Alternate translation: [you considered my life to be precious]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 26:21 (#4)

הִסְכַּלְתִּי וָאֶשְׁגֶּה הַרְבֵּה מְאֹד

“I have acted foolishly and have strayed very greatly”

The terms **acted foolishly** and **strayed** mean similar things. Saul is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. The UST models one way to do that.

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 26:21 (#5)

וָאֶשְׁגֶּה

“and have strayed”

Saul is speaking as if he had wandered off a path. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state

the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and have done the wrong thing]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 26:21 (#1)

שׁוּבָה בְּנִי־דָוִד כִּי֩ לֹא־אָרַ֨ע לְךָ֜ ע֗וֹד תַּ֚חַת אֲשֶׁ֣ר יָקְרָ֣ה נַפְשִׁ֣י בְּעֵינֶ֔יךָ הַיּ֖וֹם הַזֶּ֑ה

“Return, my son David! For I will not harm you again, for my life was precious in your eyes this day”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since my life was precious in your eyes this day, I will not do evil to you again, so return, my son David!]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 26:21 (#3)

תַּ֚חַת אֲשֶׁ֣ר יָקְרָ֣ה נַפְשִׁ֣י בְּעֵינֶ֔יךָ

“for my life was precious in your eyes”

Saul is speaking as if his **life** were a valuable object that David considered **precious**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you valued my life] or [you considered my life worth saving]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 26:23 (#3)

בְּיָדִ֔י

“into {my} hand”

David is using the term **hand** to represent his power or control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [into my power]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 26:23 (#4)

לִשְׁלֹ֥חַ יָדִ֖י בִּמְשִׁ֥יחַ יְהוָֽה

“to stretch out my hand against the anointed one of Yahweh”

David is using a common expression of his culture to mean attacking or harming someone. See how you translated the similar phrase in 22:17. Alternate translation: [to use violence against the anointed one of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 26:23 (#5)

בִּמְשִׁ֥יחַ יְהוָֽה

“against the anointed one of Yahweh”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the one whom Yahweh has anointed]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 26:23 (#1)

וַיהוָה֙ יָשִׁ֣יב לְאִ֔ישׁ אֶת־צִדְקָת֖וֹ וְאֶת־אֱמֻנָתֽוֹ

“And may Yahweh return to a man his righteousness and his faithfulness”

David is speaking as if **righteousness** and **faithfulness** were objects that Yahweh could **return** to a person. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And may Yahweh reward each person for his righteousness and his faithfulness]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 26:23 (#2)

וַיהוָה֙ יָשִׁ֣יב לְאִ֔ישׁ אֶת־צִדְקָת֖וֹ וְאֶת־אֱמֻנָתֽוֹ

“And may Yahweh return to a man his righteousness and his faithfulness”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **righteousness** and **faithfulness**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [And may Yahweh reward each person for the righteous and faithful things he has done]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 26:24 (#1)

גְּדֹלָ֣ה נַפְשְׁךָ֗ בְּעֵינַי֙ & תִּגְדַּ֣ל נַפְשִׁ֔י בְּעֵינֵ֖י יְהוָ֑ה

“your life was great in my eyes & may my life be great in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the similar expression in 8:6. Alternate translation: [I considered your life important … may Yahweh consider my life important]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 26:25 (#1)

בָּר֣וּךְ אַתָּ֔ה

“Blessed be you”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [May Yahweh bless you]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 26:25 (#2)

גַּם עָשׂוֹ תַּעֲשֶׂה וְגַם יָכֹל תּוּכָל

"Both doing, you will do, and also being able, you will be able"

Saul is repeating forms of the verbs "do" and "be able" in order to intensify his expression of the ideas that they convey. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [You will certainly do, and you will certainly be able]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 26:25 (#3)

וְגַם יָכֹל תּוּכָל

"and also being able, you will be able"

By **being able, you will be able**, Saul could mean: (1) that the verb **be able** has the same sense as in 17:9. Alternate translation: [and you will certainly prevail] or [and you will certainly become king instead of me]; (2) that Saul is using two verbs together to convey a single idea. Alternate translation: [and you will certainly be able to do many things]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel - Chapter 27 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the part of the book that describes how David became king (chapters 16–31). It describes how David fled for a second time to the Philistine city of Gath for safety. This time Achish, the king of Gath, agreed to let David live there and serve him. David and his men went on raids against other people groups in the area but told Achish that they had attacked Israelite communities. This made Achish think that David would not be able to go back to Israel and so David would always serve him.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did David leave Israel even after Saul promised not to kill him?

Even though Saul promised in 26:21 that he would never kill David, nevertheless David fled to Philistia for safety immediately afterwards. It seems that David did not trust Saul to keep his promise. David had good reason not to trust Saul. In 19:6, Saul swore an oath by Yahweh that he would not kill David, but shortly afterwards, when Saul learned of David's great military success against the Philistines, he became jealous and tried to kill David again. So David had learned that Saul was someone whose promises could not be trusted.

Why did Achish give David the town of Ziklag to live in?

In 27:5, David asks King Achish to allow him and his men to live away from the royal city of Gath, in one of the smaller settlements within its territory. Achish agrees and gives David and his men the town of Ziklag. David had told Achish there was no need for him and his men to live with the king. This suggests that for as long as they were in the royal city, they were the king's guests and lived at his expense. David was courteously offering to do without this support, and Achish accepted his offer. But this also gave David much more freedom of movement, since he was no longer where the officials of Achish could watch him and report on his actions. This allowed him to pretend that he was attacking Israelite settlements when he really was not.

1 Samuel 27:1 (#6)

טוֹב

"good"

David is using the adjective **good** as a noun to mean a certain kind of thing. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [good thing]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 27:1 (#9)

מִיָּדוֹ

"from his hand"

David is using the term **hand** to represent Saul's power or control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [his power]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 27:1 (#4)

אֶסָּפֶה יוֹם־אֶחָד בְּיַד־שָׁאוּל

“I will be swept away one day by the hand of Saul”

David is using one part of Saul, his **hand**, to mean all of him in the act of attacking him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will be destroyed one day by Saul] or [Saul will destroy me one day]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 27:1 (#5)

אֵין־לִי טוֹב כִּי הִמָּלֵט אִמָּלֵט

“There is} no good for me except escaping, I should escape”

If it would appear in your language that David was making a statement and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [The only good thing for me is that escaping, I should escape]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

1 Samuel 27:1 (#8)

גְּבוּל יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the border of Israel”

David is using the term **border** to represent the territory within borders. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the territory of Israel]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 27:1 (#1)

אֶל־לִבּוֹ

“to his heart”

David is using one part of himself, his **heart**, representing his thoughts, to mean all of him in the act of thinking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to himself]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 27:1 (#2)

אֶסָּפֶה יוֹם־אֶחָד בְּיַד־שָׁאוּל

“I will be swept away one day by the hand of Saul”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the hand of Saul will sweep me away one day]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 27:1 (#7)

הִמָּלֵט אִמָּלֵט

“escaping, I should escape”

David is repeating forms of the verb “escape” in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [I should definitely escape]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 27:1 (#3)

אֶסָּפֶה יוֹם־אֶחָד בְּיַד־שָׁאוּל

“I will be swept away one day by the hand of Saul”

David is speaking as if he were an object that could be **swept away**. See how you translated the similar phrase in 26:10. Alternate translation: [I will be destroyed by the hand of Saul] or [the hand of Saul will destroy me one day]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 27:2 (#1)

וַיָּקָם דָּוִד

“And David arose”

By **arose**, the author means that David took action based on his decision. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [So David took action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 27:3 (#1)

אִישׁ וּבֵיתוֹ

“a man and his house”

The author is speaking as if each man’s family were his **house**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [each man with his family]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 27:3 (#2)

אֵשֶׁת־נָבָל

“the wife of Nabal”

Your language may have its own term or expression for this relationship, since Nabal was now dead and Abigail was no longer his legal **wife**. Alternate translation: [who had been the wife of Nabal] or [the widow of Nabal]

See: Kinship

1 Samuel 27:4 (#1)

וַיֻּגַּד לְשָׁאוּל

“And it was declared to Saul”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And someone told Saul]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 27:4 (#2)

וְלֹא־יוסף עוֹד לְבַקְּשׁוֹ

“and he did not add to seek him more”

The author is using a common expression of this culture to mean that Saul stopped doing something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [so he did not continue to seek him further]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 27:5 (#2)

יִתְּנוּ־לִי

“may they give to me”

The author is not using the pronoun **they** to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [may you give to me] or [may I be given]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 27:5 (#4)

בְּאַחַת עָרֵי הַשָּׂדֶה

“in one of the cities of the field”

David is using the term **field** to represent a rural area. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in a city in a more rural area]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 27:5 (#1)

מָצָאתִי חֵן בְּעֵינֶיךָ

“I have found favor in your eyes”

See how you translated the similar phrase in 1:18. Alternate translation: [you regard me favorably]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 27:5 (#3)

לִי & וְאֵשְׁבָה

“to me & and let me dwell”

David is using himself as a representative of his entire group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to us ... and let us dwell]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 27:5 (#5)

וְלָמָּה יֵשֵׁב עַבְדְּךָ בְּעִיר הַמַּמְלָכָה עִמָּךְ

“For why should your servant dwell in the city of the kingship with you”

David is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [There is no need for your servant to dwell in the city of the kingship with you.]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 27:5 (#6)

עַבְדְּךָ

“your servant”

David is speaking about himself humbly in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [I, your servant]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 27:6 (#2)

לָכֵן הָיְתָה צִקְלַג לְמַלְכֵי יְהוּדָה עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה

“Therefore Ziklag is to the kings of Judah to this day”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand why the city of Ziklag, for-

merly a Philistine possession, belonged to the kings of Judah in their own time. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 27:6 (#3)

עַ֚ד הַיּ֣וֹם הַזֶּ֔ה

“to this day”

By **up to this day**, the author means the time when he was writing. In your translation, make clear that the phrase refers to a time that is now in the past. Avoid giving the impression the phrase means “to the present day.” Alternate translation: [right up to the time of this writing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 27:6 (#1)

בַּיּ֣וֹם הַה֗וּא

“on that day”

The author is using the term **day** to represent a specific time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [at that time]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 27:7 (#2)

בִּשְׂדֵ֥ה פְלִשְׁתִּֽים

“in the field of the Philistines”

The author is using the term **field** to represent a territory or region in which there were fields. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the territory of the Philistines]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 27:7 (#1)

וַיְהִי֙ מִסְפַּ֣ר הַיָּמִ֔ים

“And the number of the days”

The author is using the term **the number of the days** to represent a certain length of time, since time is made up of days. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And the length of time … was]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 27:7 (#3)

יָמִ֑ים

“was days”

In Hebrew, the plural form **days** can mean a year. That is the meaning in this context. Alternate translation: [one year]

See: Unusual Uses of the Plural

1 Samuel 27:8 (#1)

וַיַּ֤עַל דָּוִד֙ וַאֲנָשָׁ֔יו

“And David and his men went up”

See how you translated the similar phrase in 1:3, where the author, in keeping with the conventions of his culture, marks travel for change in elevation. The Philistine territory was on the coastland, and David and his men had to go **up** in elevation to reach the other places the author describes. Alternate translation: [And David and his men went]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 27:8 (#3)

כִּֽי֩ הֵ֨מָּה יֹשְׁבִ֜ים הָאָ֗רֶץ אֲשֶׁ֥ר מֵעוֹלָֽם

“for they were dwelling in the land, that from ancient times”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand who these people groups were. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture. Alternate translation: [(for they had lived in that area since ancient times)]

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 27:8 (#4)

בּוֹאֲךָ֥ שׁ֖וּרָה וְעַד־אֶ֥רֶץ מִצְרָֽיִם

“in your going to Shur and to the land of Egypt”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mean the area extending as far as Shur and the border of Egypt. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as far as Shur and up to the border of Egypt]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 27:8 (#2)

הַגְּשׁוּרִ֥י וְהַגִּרְזִ֖י וְהָעֲמָלֵקִ֑י

“the Geshurite and the Girzite and the Amalekite”

The author is not referring to a specific **Geshurite**, **Girzite**, or **Amalekite**. He means the members of these people groups in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using a plural form. Alternate translation: [the Geshurites and the Girzites and the Amalekites]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 27:9 (#1)

וְהִכָּה דָוִד אֶת־הָאָרֶץ וְלֹא יְחַיֶּה אִישׁ וְאִשָּׁה

“And David struck the land and did not let a man or a woman live”

The author is using the term **land** to represent the people who lived in the land. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And David struck the people who lived there and did not let a man or a woman live]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 27:9 (#2)

וְהִכָּה דָוִד אֶת־הָאָרֶץ וְלֹא יְחַיֶּה אִישׁ וְאִשָּׁה

“And David struck the land and did not let a man or a woman live”

Here the context shows that the term **struck** means “killed,” as it often does elsewhere in the book. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And David killed the people and did not let a man or a woman live]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 27:9 (#3)

וְהִכָּה דָוִד אֶת־הָאָרֶץ וְלֹא יְחַיֶּה אִישׁ וְאִשָּׁה

“And David struck the land and did not let a man or a woman live”

The author is speaking of two basic types of people, **man** and **woman**, in order to mean all people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And David struck the land and did not let anyone live]

See: Merism

1 Samuel 27:9 (#4)

וְהִכָּה דָוִד אֶת־הָאָרֶץ וְלֹא יְחַיֶּה אִישׁ וְאִשָּׁה

“And David struck the land and did not let a man or a woman live”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. If it would be clearer in your language, you could combine them. Alternate translation: [And David killed every one of the people]

See: Parallelism

1 Samuel 27:9 (#5)

וְלֹא יְחַיֶּה אִישׁ וְאִשָּׁה

“and did not let a man or a woman live”

Since the author indicates in 27:11 the reason why David killed all the people, you do not need to explain that reason here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

1 Samuel 27:10 (#4)

נֶגֶב יְהוּדָה & נֶגֶב הַיְרַחְמְאֵלִי & נֶגֶב הַקֵּינִי

“the Negeb of Judah & the Negeb of the Jerahmeelite & the Negeb of the Kenite”

The author is using the term **Negev** to represent the people who lived in that region. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people who live in the part of the Negev that belongs to Judah ... the people who live in the part of the Negev that belongs to the Jehrameelite ... the people who live in the part of the Negev that belongs to the Kenite]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 27:10 (#1)

אַל־פְּשַׁטְתֶּם הַיּוֹם

“Have you not raided today”

Achish is using the question form for emphasis. (David probably brought him a share of the spoils from his raids, which is what would have prompted this response.) If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for emphasis, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You must have raided today!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 27:10 (#3)

וַיֹּאמֶר דָּוִד עַל־נֶגֶב יְהוּדָה וְעַל־נֶגֶב הַיְרַחְמְאֵלִי וְאֶל־נֶגֶב הַקֵּינִי

“And David said, “Against the Negeb of Judah” or “against the Negeb of the Jerahmeelite” or “against the Negeb of the Kenite”

David is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And David would say, “We raided against the Negev of Judah” or “We raided against the Negev of the Jerahmeelite” or “We raided against the Negev of the Kenite.”]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 27:10 (#5)

הַיְרַחְמְאֵלִ֥י & הַקֵּינִֽי

“the Jerahmeelite & the Kenite”

The author is not referring to specific individuals but to people groups. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using a plural form. Alternate translation: [the Jehrameelites ... the Kenites]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 27:10 (#2)

אַל־פְּשַׁטְתֶּ֖ם הַיּ֑וֹם

“Have you not raided today”

The word **you** is plural here because Achish is speaking of David and his men, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

1 Samuel 27:11 (#4)

בִּשְׂדֵ֥ה פְלִשְׁתִּֽים

“in the field of the Philistines”

The author is using the term **field** to represent a territory or region in which there were fields. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the territory of the Philistines]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 27:11 (#2)

וְאִ֥ישׁ וְאִשָּׁ֖ה לֹא־יְחַיֶּ֣ה דָוִ֑ד

“Now David did not let a man or a woman live”

The author is speaking of two basic types of people, **man** and **woman**, in order to mean all people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Now David did not let anyone live]

See: Merism

1 Samuel 27:11 (#3)

פֶּן־יַגִּ֥דוּ עָלֵ֖ינוּ לֵאמֹ֑ר כֹּה־עָשָׂ֥ה דָוִ֖דְ

“Lest they declare about us, saying, ‘Thus did David do”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Lest they declare about us and tell what I actually did]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 27:11 (#1)

וְאִ֥ישׁ וְאִשָּׁ֖ה לֹא־יְחַיֶּ֣ה דָוִ֑ד לְהָבִ֥יא גַּתְּ֖

“Now David did not let a man or a woman live to bring {to} Gath”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand why David killed all the people in the places he raided. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 27:12 (#3)

הַבְאֵ֥שׁ הִבְאִישׁ֙ בְּעַמּ֔וֹ בְּיִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל

“Stinking, he stinks among his people in Israel”

Achish is speaking as if David were giving off a bad odor that would make people avoid him. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [He has certainly made himself odious to his people in Israel] or [His fellow Israelites must now consider him to be a terrible person]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 27:12 (#1)

בְּדָוִ֔ד

“in David”

The author is using the term **David** to represent what David told Achish. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in what David told him]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 27:12 (#2)

הַבְאֵשׁ הִבְאִישׁ בְּעַמּוֹ בְיִשְׂרָאֵל

“Stinking, he stinks among his people in Israel”

Achish is repeating forms of the verb “stink” in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [He must certainly stink among his people in Israel]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel - Chapter 28 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the part of the book that describes how David became king (chapters 16–31). It describes how, because of Saul’s disobedience, Yahweh would no longer guide him about how to fight against the Philistines. It tells how Saul instead asked a woman to contact the spirit of Samuel for him so that Samuel could provide guidance. But Samuel only told Saul that what he had prophesied was about to come true. Saul and his sons would be killed in battle against the Philistines the next day.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

What were “ritual pits” and “familiar spirits” (28:3)?
A “ritual pit” was a hole that some people in this culture dug in the ground in order to use it in ceremonies in which they tried to contact the spirits of dead people. Some versions of the Bible translate this term as “medium,” referring to a person who tries to contact such spirits. However, the most recent biblical scholarship suggests that the term refers to the pit rather than to the person who uses it. A “familiar spirit” was a supernatural being that people in this culture believed could help them gain secret knowledge. Some versions of the Bible translate this term as “wizard,” “spiritist,” or “soothsayer,” once again referring to the person who uses the means rather than the means itself. But current scholarship suggests in this case as well that it refers to the spirit rather than the person who uses it. The law of Moses forbade such practices, and that was why Saul at first had banned them from Israel. The fact that he now turned to a woman who owned a ritual pit shows how he was no longer obeying God.

How did the woman know her visitor was Saul once she had seen Samuel?
In 28:12, the author says that when the woman with the ritual pit saw Samuel, she “cried out with a loud voice” and then said to her visitor, “Why have you deceived me? For you are Saul!” While the author does not state this explicitly, this suggests that the woman was not expecting to see anyone or anything like Samuel when he appeared. The overall teaching of the Bible is that it is not possible to contact the spirits of people who have died and that it is not possible for those spirits to return to earth. So Yahweh apparently did something very exceptional in this case. This surprised and frightened the woman. She also apparently concluded that this would only have happened for someone as important as Saul, and that was how she realized who her visitor was. Readers of the Bible are not meant to take any encouragement from this episode to try to contact the spirits of people who have died. Samuel announced that Yahweh had judged Saul for his disobedience and that he was going to punish him with death before another day went by. Trying to contact the spirit of a dead person was further disobedience, and it only resulted in a definitive pronouncement of judgment and punishment.

Where were Shunem and Gilboa?
The author says in 28:4 that Philistines assembled their troops and marched into Israel and set up their tents near the city of Shunem. That city was in the north of Israel, within the Valley of Jezreel. While the Israelites lived in hilly territory that became more mountainous the farther it got from the coast, the Philistines were able to use that valley to march well into Israel. The author also says in 28:4 that Saul gathered the Israelite army and they set up their tents at Gilboa. That was a mountain range on one side of the Valley of Jezreel. So as in the case of the battle in which Goliath challenged the Israelites (17:3), the Israelites took up defensive positions on a height overlooking a potential field of battle.

1 Samuel 28:1 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“And it happened”

The author is introducing a new event, an invasion of Israel by the Philistine army. Use a word, phrase, or other method here that is natural in your language for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 28:1 (#4)

אֶת־מַחֲנֵיהֶם

“their camps”

The author is using the term **camps** to represent the soldiers who stayed in those camps. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [their soldiers]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:1 (#5)

יָדֹעַ תֵּדָע

“Knowing, you know”

Achish is repeating forms of the verb “know” in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [You must certainly know]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 28:1 (#2)

וַיֹּ֨אמֶר אָכִישׁ֜ אֶל־דָּוִ֗ד יָדֹ֤עַ תֵּדַע֙ כִּֽי אִתִּ֣י תֵצֵ֔א בַּמַּחֲנֶ֖ה אַתָּ֣ה וַאֲנָשֶׁ֑יךָ

“And Achish said to David, “Knowing, you know that you shall go out with me into the camp, you and your men”

Here and in the next verse, the author is introducing an episode within the event of the Philistine invasion, King Achish of Gath requiring David and his men to join him in fighting against Israel. The author will resume his account of this episode in 29:1 after relating a different episode in this chapter. Use a word, phrase, or other method here that is natural in your language for introducing an episode within an event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 28:1 (#3)

בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם

“in those days”

The author is using the term **days** to represent a certain time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [at that time]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:2 (#5)

שֹׁמֵר לְרֹאשִׁ֑י

“the keeper of my head”

Achish is using one part of himself, his **head**, to mean all of him in the act of protection. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [my personal bodyguard]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 28:2 (#1)

לָכֵן֙ אַתָּ֣ה תֵדַ֔ע

“Therefore you yourself will know”

David is using the word **Therefore** to acknowledge that what Achish has just said is true and to describe something that is also true as a result. Alternate translation: [That being the case, you yourself will know]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 28:2 (#2)

אַתָּ֣ה תֵדַ֔ע

“you yourself will know”

David is using the term **know** to represent seeing or experiencing something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [you yourself will see]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:2 (#3)

עַבְדֶּ֖ךָ

“your servant”

David is speaking about himself in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [I, your servant]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 28:2 (#4)

לָכֵ֕ן & אֲשִׂימְךָ֖

“Therefore I am appointing you”

Achish is using the word **Therefore** in the same sense that David uses it earlier in this verse. Alternate translation: [That being the case, I am appointing you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 28:2 (#6)

כָּל־הַיָּמִים

“all of the days”

Achish is using the term **days** to represent time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all of the time] or [permanently]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:3 (#1)

וּשְׁמוּאֵל֙ מֵ֣ת & וְשָׁא֔וּל הֵסִ֥יר הָאֹבֹ֖ות וְאֶת־הַיִּדְּעֹנִ֑ים מִן־הָאָֽרֶץ

“Now Samuel had died & And Saul had removed the ritual pits and the familiar spirits from the land”

The author is providing background information to help readers understand what happens in the episode that he relates in this chapter. In your translation, introduce this information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 28:3 (#2)

וַיִּקְבְּרֻ֥הוּ

“and they had buried him”

The author is not using the pronoun **they** to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the Israelites had buried him] or [and he was buried]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 28:3 (#4)

הָאֹבֹ֖ות וְאֶת־הַיִּדְּעֹנִ֑ים

“the ritual pits and the familiar spirits”

The author is using the terms **ritual pits and familiar spirits** to represent the people who used these things. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people who used ritual pits to contact the dead and the people who consulted familiar spirits to obtain secret knowledge]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:3 (#5)

הָאֹבֹ֖ות

“the ritual pits”

A **ritual pit** was a hole in the ground that was used in ceremonies to contact the spirits of dead people. If your readers would not be familiar with what a ritual pit was, in your translation you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [the places that people used to try to contact the dead]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 28:3 (#6)

הַיִּדְּעֹנִ֑ים

“the familiar spirits”

A **familiar spirit** was a supernatural being that people in this culture believed could help them gain secret knowledge. If your readers would not be familiar with this, in your translation you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [the spirits that people believed could give them secret knowledge]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 28:3 (#3)

וְשָׁא֔וּל הֵסִ֥יר הָאֹבֹ֖ות וְאֶת־הַיִּדְּעֹנִ֑ים מִן־הָאָֽרֶץ

“And Saul had removed the ritual pits and the familiar spirits from the land”

The author means that Saul had forbidden these practices. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And Saul had forbidden people to use ritual pits or consult familiar spirits in the land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 28:4 (#1)

אֶת־כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“all of Israel”

The author is using the term **Israel** to represent the Israelite army. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the whole Israelite army]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:5 (#1)

אֶת־מַחֲנֵ֥ה פְלִשְׁתִּ֖ים

“the camp of the Philistines”

The author is using the term **camp** to represent the soldiers in the camp. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the army of the Philistines]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:6 (#2)

בָּאוּרִֽים

“by the Urim”

The **Urim** was one of two objects (along with the Thummim) that the high priest used to determine God’s will. If your readers would not be familiar with what the Urim was, in your translation you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [by the sacred lots]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 28:6 (#1)

בָּאוּרִֽים

“by the Urim”

The author is using one of two objects that were used to obtain guidance, the **Urim**, to represent both parts. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by the Urim and Thummim]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 28:7 (#1)

אֵֽשֶׁת בַּעֲלַ֥ת & אֵשֶׁת בָּעָלַת

“a woman of a mistress of & a woman of a mistress”

Saul and the servants are using this possessive form to mean that this woman is the mistress or owner of the pit. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [a woman who is the owner of ... a woman who is the owner of]

See: Possession

1 Samuel 28:7 (#2)

הִנֵּ֥ה

“Behold”

The servants are speaking as if they were showing Saul something that he could see. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Listen] or [Pay attention to what I am about to tell you]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 28:7 (#3)

אֵֽשֶׁת בַּעֲלַ֥ת־אֹ֖וב בְּעֵ֥ין דֹּֽור

“a woman of a mistress of a ritual pit {is} in Endor”

The author is quoting what Saul’s servants said in order to introduce this woman as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [there is a certain woman in Endor who owns a ritual pit]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Samuel 28:8 (#1)

וַיִּתְחַפֵּ֣שׂ שָׁא֗וּל וַיִּלְבַּ֤שׁ בְּגָדִים֙ אֲחֵרִ֔ים

“And Saul disguised himself and put on other garments”

This expression conveys a single idea by using two words connected with and. The words **put on other garments** tells in what way Saul **disguised himself**. Alternate translation: [And Saul disguised himself by putting on other garments]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 28:8 (#2)

וְהַֽעֲלִי־

“and bring up”

Saul is using the term **bring up** to represent to summon a spirit from the realm of the dead. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and summon]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:9 (#2)

אֶת־הָאֹבֹ֥ות וְאֶת־הַיִּדְּעֹנִ֖י

“the ritual pits and the familiar spirits”

The woman is using the terms **ritual pits** and **familiar spirits** to represent the people who used those things. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [people who use ritual pits to contact the dead and people who consult familiar spirits to obtain secret knowledge]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:9 (#4)

מִתְנַקֵּשׁ בְּנַפְשִׁשֵׁי

“setting a trap against my life”

The woman is speaking as if her visitor were setting a physical **trap** to catch her. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [asking me to do something that would put my life in danger]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 28:9 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר הִכְרִית

“that he has cut off”

The woman is speaking as if these **pits** and **spirits** as if they were something that Saul had **cut off** from a larger thing of which they were a part. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that he has banned]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 28:9 (#3)

וְלָמָּה אַתָּה מְנַקֵּשׁ בְּנַפְשִׁשֵׁי לַהֲמִיתֵנִי

“So why are you setting a trap against my life, to cause me to die”

The woman is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [So you should not be setting a trap against my life, to cause me to die!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 28:10 (#1)

חַי־יְהוָה אִם־יִקָּרֶךְ עָוֹן בַּדָּבָר הַזֶּה

“The life of Yahweh, if punishment shall meet you for this thing”

Following the custom of his culture, Saul is swearing an oath by guaranteeing it by something he holds sacred. What he states as a condition is what he means will not happen. Use a natural way in your language to express an oath. Alternate translation: [I swear by Yahweh that no punishment shall meet you for this thing]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Samuel 28:10 (#2)

אִם־יִקָּרֶךְ עָוֹן בַּדָּבָר הַזֶּה

“if punishment shall meet you for this thing”

Saul is speaking of **punishment** as if it were a person who could **meet** someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [no one will punish you for this thing]

See: Personification

1 Samuel 28:11 (#1)

אַעֲלֶה & הַעֲלִי

“shall I bring up & Bring up”

The woman and Saul are using the expression **bring up** to represent to summon someone from the realm of the dead. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [shall I summon ... Summon]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:12 (#1)

וַתִּזְעַק בְּקוֹל גָּדוֹל & וְאַתָּה שָׁאוּל

“and she cried out with a loud voice & For you are Saul”

See the discussion in the Introduction to this chapter of why the woman **cried out** and how she knew that her visitor was **Saul**.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 28:12 (#2)

וְאַתָּה שָׁאוּל

“For you are Saul”

Here the word **For** introduces the woman’s explanation of why she said that her visitor had **deceived** her. Alternate translation: [In fact, you are Saul]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 28:13 (#1)

אֱלֹהִים

“a god”

The word translated as **god** can refer in some contexts to a being that is considered divine, but in this context it refers simply to a being that is a spirit, that is, a being that does not have a body. Express this in a way that would be natural in your language and culture.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 28:14 (#1)

וַיִּקֹּד אַפַּיִם אַרְצָה וַיִּשְׁתָּחוּ

“and he bowed, nostrils to the ground, and he prostrated himself”

This was a symbolic action that showed respect and submission. See how you translated the similar expression in 20:41. Alternate translation: [and he knelt down and pressed his face to the ground, stretching himself out completely, to show great honor to Samuel]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 28:15 (#1)

צַר־לִי מְאֹד וּפְלִשְׁתִּים ׀ נִלְחָמִים בִּבְּי

“It is very narrow to me, for the Philistines are fighting with me”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [The Philistines are fighting with me, so it is very narrow for me]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 28:15 (#4)

בְּיַד־הַנְּבִיאִם

“by the hand of prophets”

Saul is using the term **hand** to represent action or agency. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [through the agency of prophets]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:15 (#2)

צַר־לִי מְאֹד

“It is very narrow to me”

Saul is using **it is very narrow to me** as a common expression of his culture to mean “I am in a very dangerous situation.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression in 13:6. Alternate translation: [I am in a tight situation] or [I am in very dangerous circumstances]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 28:15 (#3)

וֵאלֹהִים סָר מֵעָלָי

“And God has turned aside from with me”

Saul is speaking as if God had physically **turned aside** and moved away from him. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And God has abandoned me] or [And God is no longer helping me]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 28:16 (#1)

וְלָמָּה תִשְׁאָלֵנִי וַיהוָה סָר מֵעָלֶיךָ וַיְהִי עָרֶךָ

“And why do you ask me, since Yahweh has turned aside from with you and has become your enemy”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since Yahweh has turned aside from with you and has become your enemy, why do you ask me?]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 28:16 (#2)

וְלָמָּה תִשְׁאָלֵנִי וַיהוָה סָר מֵעָלֶיךָ וַיְהִי עָרֶךָ

“And why do you ask me, since Yahweh has turned aside from with you and has become your enemy”

Samuel is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [You should not ask me, since Yahweh has turned aside from with you and has become your enemy!] or [Since Yahweh has turned aside from with you and has become your enemy, you should not ask me!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 28:16 (#3)

וַיהוָה סָר מֵעָלֶיךָ

“since Yahweh has turned aside from with you”

Samuel is speaking as if Yahweh had physically **turned aside** and moved away from Saul. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [since Yahweh is no

longer helping you] or [since Yahweh has abandoned you]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 28:17 (#4)

וַיִּקְרַ֤ע יְהוָה֙ אֶת־הַמַּמְלָכָ֔ה מִיָּדֶ֖ךָ

“For Yahweh has torn the kingdom from your hand”

Samuel is speaking as if the **kingdom** were a physical object that Yahweh had **torn** away from Saul. See how you translated the similar expression in 15:28. Alternate translation: [Yahweh has taken the kingdom away from you]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 28:17 (#1)

בְּיָדִ֑י

“by my hand”

Samuel is using the term **hand** to represent his action or agency. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [through my agency]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:17 (#3)

וַיִּקְרַ֤ע יְהוָה֙ אֶת־הַמַּמְלָכָ֔ה מִיָּדֶ֖ךָ

“For Yahweh has torn the kingdom from your hand”

Samuel is using one part of Saul, his **hand**, to mean all of him in the act of ruling. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [For Yahweh has torn the kingdom from you]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 28:17 (#2)

וַיִּקְרַ֤ע יְהוָה֙ אֶת־הַמַּמְלָכָ֔ה מִיָּדֶ֖ךָ

“For Yahweh has torn the kingdom from your hand”

Here the word **For** introduces Samuel’s explanation of what he meant by saying that Yahweh had done what he spoke. Alternate translation: [Specifically, Yahweh has torn the kingdom from your hand]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 28:18 (#3)

וְלֹא־עָשִׂ֗יתָ חֲרוֹן־אַפּוֹ֙ בַּעֲמָלֵ֔ק

“and you did not do the burning of his nose against Amalek”

Samuel is using the expression **the burning of his nose** to represent Yahweh’s anger. See how you translated the similar expression in 11:16. Alternate translation: [and you did not do his great anger against Amalek] or [and you did not execute his great wrath against Amalek]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:18 (#2)

לֹא־שָׁמַעְתָּ֙ בְּקֹ֣ול יְהוָ֔ה

“you did not listen to the voice of Yahweh”

By **you did not listen**, Samuel means that Saul did not obey. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [you did not obey what Yahweh told you to do]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 28:18 (#1)

לֹא־שָׁמַעְתָּ֙ בְּקֹ֣ול יְהוָ֔ה

“you did not listen to the voice of Yahweh”

Samuel is using the term **voice** to represent what Yahweh said by using his voice. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [you did not listen to what Yahweh told you]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:19 (#2)

עִמְּמִ֑י

“will be} with me”

By **with me**, Samuel means in the realm of the dead. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [with me in the realm of the dead]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 28:19 (#1)

בְּיַד־פְּלִשְׁתִּ֔ים

“into the hand of the Philistines”

Samuel is using the term **hand** to represent power or control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain lan-

guage. Alternate translation: [into the power of the Philistines]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:19 (#3)

אֶת־מַחֲנֵה יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the camp of Israel”

Samuel is using the term **camp** to represent the army that is staying in the camp. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the army of Israel]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:20 (#4)

גַּם־כֹּחַ֙ לֹא־הָיָ֣ה בּ֔וֹ כִּ֥י לֶ֛חֶם לֹ֥א אָכַ֖ל כָּל־הַיּ֑וֹם וְכָל־הַלָּֽיְלָה

“Also strength was not in him, for he had not eaten bread all of the day and all of the night”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Also, because he had not eaten bread all of the day and all of the night, strength was not in him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 28:20 (#5)

לֶ֛חֶם

“bread”

The author is using one kind of food, **bread**, to mean food in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [food]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 28:20 (#3)

מִדִּבְרֵ֥י שְׁמוּאֵ֖ל

“from the words of Samuel”

The author is using the term **words** to represent the message that Samuel delivered by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [because of what Samuel had said]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:20 (#2)

וַיְמַהֵ֣ר שָׁא֗וּל וַיִּפֹּ֛ל

“And Saul hurried and fell”

This expression conveys a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **hurried** tells in what way Saul **fell**. Alternate translation: [And Saul hurriedly fell] or [And Saul immediately fell down]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 28:20 (#1)

וַיְמַהֵ֣ר שָׁא֗וּל וַיִּפֹּ֛ל מְלֹא־קוֹמָתוֹ֙ אַ֣רְצָה וַיִּרָ֕א מְאֹ֖ד מִדִּבְרֵ֣י שְׁמוּאֵ֑ל

“And Saul hurried and fell, the fullness of his height to the ground, for he feared greatly from the words of Samuel”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And because Saul feared greatly from the words of Samuel, he hurried and fell, the fullness of his height to the ground]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 28:21 (#8)

וָאֶשְׁמַ֖ע אֶת־דִּבְרֶ֑יךָ אֲשֶׁ֥ר דִּבַּ֖רְתָּ אֵלָֽי

“for I heard the words that you spoke to me”

By **I heard the words**, the woman means that she obeyed what Saul told her to do. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [for I obeyed what you told me to do]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 28:21 (#1)

נִבְהַ֥ל מְאֹ֖ד

“he was very frightened”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [this had frightened him greatly]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 28:21 (#2)

שָׁמְעָ֣ה שִׁפְחָתֶ֔ךָ

“your maidservant has listened”

The woman is speaking about herself humbly in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [I, your maidservant, have listened]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 28:21 (#3)

שָׁמְעָה & בְּקוֹלֵךְ

“has listened to your voice”

The woman is using the term **voice** to represent what Saul said by using his voice. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [has listened to what you said]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:21 (#5)

וְאָשִׂשְׂיִם נַפְשִׁי בְּכַפִּי וָאֶשְׁמַעְ אֶת־דְּבָרָיִךְ אֲשֶׁר דִּבַּרְתְּ אֵלָי

“and I have put my life in my palm, for I heard the words that you spoke to me”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [and because I heard the words that you spoke to me, I have put my life in my palm]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 28:21 (#6)

וְאָשִׂשְׂיִם נַפְשִׁי בְּכַפִּי

“and I have put my life in my palm”

The woman is using a common expression of her culture to mean that she has risked her life. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. You could also use plain language. See how you translated the similar expression in 19:5. Alternate translation: [And I have taken my life into my own hands] or [And I have put myself in danger of being killed]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 28:21 (#4)

שָׁמְעָה & בְּקוֹלֵךְ

“has listened to your voice”

By **has listened to your voice**, the woman means that she has done what Saul requested. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [has done what you requested]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 28:21 (#7)

וָאֶשְׁמַעְ אֶת־דְּבָרָיִךְ אֲשֶׁר דִּבַּרְתְּ אֵלָי

“for I heard the words that you spoke to me”

The woman is using the term **words** to represent what Saul said by using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for I heard what you said to me]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:22 (#4)

בְּקוֹלָהּ שִׁפְחָתֶךָ

“to the voice of your maidservant”

The woman is using the term **voice** to represent what she is saying by using her voice. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to what I am telling you]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:22 (#3)

בְּקוֹלָהּ שִׁפְחָתֶךָ

“to the voice of your maidservant”

The woman is speaking about herself humbly in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [to my voice]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 28:22 (#2)

שְׁמַע

“listen”

See how you translated this same verb in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 28:22 (#5)

לְפָנֶיךָ

“to your face”

The woman is using the term **face** to represent the area in front of Saul. If it would be helpful in your

language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [before you]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:22 (#6)

פַּת־לֶ֖חֶם

“a piece of bread”

The woman is using the courteous hospitality language of her culture and understating what she is offering to Saul. Use a comparable way of speaking from your own language and culture. Alternate translation: [a simple meal]

See: Politeness

1 Samuel 28:22 (#1)

וְעַתָּ֣ה

“And now”

And now was a common expression that speakers in this culture used to introduce their main topic. See how you translated this expression in 6:7. Alternate translation: [So this is what I would like you to do]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 28:23 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁמַ֥ע לְקֹלָֽם

“and he listened to their voice”

The author is using the term **voice** to represent what the servants and the woman said by using their voices. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and he listened to what they said]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 28:23 (#2)

וַיִּשְׁמַ֥ע לְקֹלָֽם

“and he listened to their voice”

By **he listened to their voice**, the author means that Saul agreed to do what they said. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and he agreed to do what they said]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 28:23 (#3)

הַמִּטָּֽה

“the bed”

In this context, the word translated as **bed** described a couch or divan in a common room on which household members and guests could sit to visit and eat. Your language may have a term for such a piece of furniture that you can use in your translation.

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 28:24 (#2)

וַתְּמַהֵ֖ר וַתִּזְבָּחֶ֑הָ

“and she hurried and slaughtered it”

This expression conveys a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **hurried** tells in what way the woman **slaughtered** the calf. Alternate translation: [and she hurriedly slaughtered it]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 28:24 (#1)

עֶ֥גֶל־מַרְבֵּ֖קֶת

“was} a calf of the stall”

A **calf of the stall** was a young cow that people in this culture kept in a pen and fed well to make it fat so that its meat would be juicy and tasty when it was served on a special occasion or to important guests. If your readers would not be familiar with what this is, in your translation you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a general expression. Alternate translation: [was a young cow that she had been fattening]

See: Translate Unknowns

1 Samuel 28:25 (#1)

וַתַּגֶּשׁ֙ לִפְנֵי־שָׁא֔וּל וְלִפְנֵ֖י עֲבָדָ֑יו

“And she brought it to the face of Saul and to the face of his servants”

The author is using the term **face** to represent the area in front of these people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And she set it in front of Saul and his servants]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel - Chapter 29 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the part of the book that describes how David became king (chapters 16–31). It de-

scribes how the Philistine lords refused to have David and his men accompany them into battle against the Israelites.

Some translations set each line of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with the poetic song in 29:5.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Did David want to fight in the Philistine army against the Israelites?
It is unclear whether David wanted to go into battle with the Philistines against the Israelites. He would have been fighting against Saul, an enemy who was determined to kill him. But he also would have been fighting against the soldiers of his own people group, and they were not his enemies. Some scholars believe that David planned to turn against the Philistines during the battle, as the Philistine lords were afraid he would do. But the author does not say that specifically. As David speaks with Achish in 29:6–10, he insists that he wants to fight in his army (as he also does in 28:1–2). However, David may have said that for his own protection while he was among the Philistines and not really meant it. Since David's wishes are unclear, we recommend that you not suggest anything about them in the text of your translation or in a footnote.

1 Samuel 29:1 (#1)

וַיְקַבְּצוּ פְלִשְׁתִּים אֶת־כָּל־מַחֲנֵיהֶם אֲפֵקָה וְיִשְׂרָאֵל חֹנִים בַּעַיִן אֲשֶׁר בְּיִזְרְעֶאל

“Now the Philistines had gathered all of their camp {at} Aphek, and Israel was camping at the spring that {is} in Jezreel”

The author is reminding readers of the Philistine invasion, after relating in the previous chapter the episode of Saul seeking guidance from the woman who had a ritual pit. This is a restatement of where the action left off at 28:4–5, with the Israelites and Philistines in battle positions facing each other across a valley. Use a word, phrase, or other method here that is natural in your language for reminding readers where a story has left off.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 29:1 (#2)

מַחֲנֵיהֶם

“their camp”

The author is using the term **camp** to represent the army that was staying in the camp. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [their army]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 29:2 (#1)

וְסַרְנֵי פְלִשְׁתִּים עֹבְרִים לְמֵאוֹת וְלָאֲלָפִים וְדָוִד וַאֲנָשָׁיו עֹבְרִים בָּאַחֲרֹנָה עִם־אָכִישׁ

“Now the lords of the Philistines were passing over by hundreds and by thousands, and David and his men were passing over in the rear with Achish”

The author is returning to an earlier point in the story in order to provide background information about what happened to David before the battle between the Philistines and Israelites. In this chapter, the author will describe what happened to keep David from fighting in that battle, and in the next chapter, he will relate further information about David. Finally, in chapter 31, he will describe the battle itself. In your translation, introduce this background information in a way that would be natural in your own language and culture.

See: Background Information

1 Samuel 29:3 (#4)

זֶה יָמִים אוֹ־זֶה שָׁנִים

“these days, or these years”

Achish is using the terms **days** and **years** to represent periods of time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for many days, in fact, for years] or [for quite a long time]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 29:3 (#5)

וְלֹא־מָצָאתִי בּוֹ מְאוּמָה

“And I have not found anything in him”

Achish means that he has not **found anything** wrong in David's character or behavior. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And I have not found anything wrong in him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 29:3 (#6)

וְלֹא־מָצָאתִי בּוֹ מְאוּמָה

“And I have not found anything in him”

See how you translated the term **found** in 9:8. Alternate translation: [And he has done nothing wrong]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 29:3 (#1)

מָ֣ה הָֽעִבְרִ֣ים הָאֵ֔לֶּה

“What {are} these Hebrews”

The Philistine lords are using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [These Hebrews should not be marching with our army!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 29:3 (#7)

מִיּ֥וֹם נָפְל֖וֹ

“from the day of his falling”

Achish is using a common expression of this culture that describes deserting and going over to an opponent. Compare the similar usage in Jeremiah 37:13 and Jeremiah 38:19. Alternate translation: [from the time he deserted to me]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 29:3 (#2)

הָֽעִבְרִ֑ים

“are & Hebrews”

See how you decided to translate the name “Hebrews” in 13:3.

See: How to Translate Names

1 Samuel 29:3 (#3)

הֲלוֹא־זֶ֣ה דָוִ֗ד עֶ֚בֶד ׀ שָׁא֣וּל מֶֽלֶךְ־יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל אֲשֶׁ֥ר הָיָ֛ה אִתִּ֖י זֶ֣ה יָמִ֑ים אוֹ־זֶ֥ה שָׁנִ֖ים

“Is} this not David, the servant of Saul the king of Israel, who has been with me these days, or these years”

Achish is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [This is David, the former servant of Saul the king of Israel, and he has been with me these days, or these years!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 29:4 (#2)

וְלֹא־יֵרֵ֣ד

“For he shall not go down”

By saying **go down**, the Philistine lords are marking travel for elevation, as was customary in this culture. Express this in a way that would be natural in your language. See how you translated the similar expression in 1:3. Alternate translation: [For he shall not go]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 29:4 (#1)

אֶל־מְקוֹמ֔וֹ אֲשֶׁ֥ר הִפְקַדְתּ֖וֹ שָׁ֑ם

“to his place that you assigned him there”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [to his place that you assigned him]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 29:4 (#7)

בְּרָאשֵׁ֖י הָאֲנָשִׁ֣ים הָהֵ֑ם

“by the heads of these men”

The Philistine lords could also be suggesting that David and his men would cut off the heads of Philistine soldiers and bring them to Saul. That would be a symbolic action proving loyalty to Saul and providing him with war trophies, just as David took Goliath’s head as a war trophy in 17:54. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [by killing these men and presenting their heads to him as war trophies]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 29:4 (#3)

עִמָּ֑נוּ

“with us”

The Philistine lords are using the pronoun **us** to refer to themselves and to Achish, whom they are addressing, so use the inclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

1 Samuel 29:4 (#4)

וּבַמָּ֣ה יִתְרַצֶּ֔ה זֶ֖ה אֶל־אֲדֹנָ֑יו הֲלֹ֗וֹא בְּרָאשֵׁ֛י הָאֲנָשִׁ֥ים הָהֵ֖ם

“For by what shall this {one} make himself acceptable to his master? {Is it} not by the heads of these men”

The Philistine lords are using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [For this one would make himself acceptable to his master by the heads of these men!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 29:4 (#5)

וְלֹא־יֵרֵד

“For he shall not go down”

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but a further explanation. Alternate translation: [After all, he shall not go down]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 29:4 (#6)

בְּרָאשֵׁי הָאֲנָשִׁים הָהֵם

“by the heads of these men”

The Philistine lords are using one part of these men, their **heads**, to mean all of them in the act of potentially being killed by David and his men. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by killing these men]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 29:5 (#1)

הֲלוֹא־זֶה דָּוִד אֲשֶׁר יַעֲנוּ־לוֹ בַּמְּחֹלוֹת לֵאמֹר הִכָּה שָׁאוּל֙ בַּאֲלָפָ֔יו וְדָוִ֖ד ברבבתו

“Is} this not David, of whom they sing in the dances, saying, ‘Saul has struck his thousands, and David his myriads”

The Philistine lords are using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [This is David, of whom they sing in the dances, saying, ‘Saul has struck his thousands, and David his myriads’!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 29:5 (#5)

וְדָוִד ברבבתו

“and David his myriads”

The singers are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and David has struck his myriads] or [and David has killed his myriads]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 29:5 (#2)

יַעֲנוּ

“they sing”

The author is not using the pronoun **they** to refer to specific people. Use an expression for this that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [people sing] or [is sung]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 29:5 (#3)

לֵאמֹר הִכָּה שָׁאוּל֙ בַּאֲלָפָ֔יו וְדָוִ֖ד ברבבתו

“saying, ‘Saul has struck his thousands, and David his myriads”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [saying that Saul has struck his thousands, and David his myriads]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 29:5 (#4)

הִכָּה שָׁאוּל֙ בַּאֲלָפָ֔יו

“Saul has struck his thousands”

By **struck**, the singers mean killed in battle. See how you translated that term in 4:2. Alternate translation: [Saul has killed his thousands]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 29:5 (#6)

ברבבתו

“his myriads”

See how you translated this number in 18:7. Alternate translation: [his ten thousands]

See: Numbers

1 Samuel 29:6 (#1)

חַי־יְהוָ֔ה כִּי

“The life of Yahweh, that”

Following the custom of his culture, Achish is swearing an oath by guaranteeing it by something he knows that David holds sacred. Use a natural way in your language to express an oath.

See: Oath Formulas

1 Samuel 29:6 (#4)

צֵאתְךָ֥ וּבֹאֲךָ֖ אִתִּ֑י בַּמַּחֲנֶ֔ה

“your going out and your coming in with me in the camp”

Achish is speaking of the first and last actions of a military campaign, **going out** and **coming in**, in order to mean military activities as a whole. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [your marching and fighting with me in the army]

See: Merism

1 Samuel 29:6 (#6)

לֹא־מָצָ֥אתִי בְךָ֖ רָעָ֑ה

“I have not found evil in you”

See how you translated the similar expressions in 29:3. Alternate translation: [you have done nothing wrong]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 29:6 (#5)

וְטֹ֣וב בְּעֵינַ֔י & וּבְעֵינֵ֖י הַסְּרָנִ֑ים לֹא־טֹ֖וב אָֽתָּה

“and & is} good in my eyes & But in the eyes of the lords you {are} not good”

See how you translated the similar expression in 1:18. Alternate translation: [and ... is acceptable to me ... But you are not acceptable to the lords]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 29:6 (#2)

וְטֹ֣וב בְּעֵינַ֔י צֵאתְךָ֥ וּבֹאֲךָ֖ אִתִּ֑י בַּמַּחֲנֶ֔ה כִּ֣י לֹא־מָצָ֥אתִי בְךָ֖ רָעָ֑ה מִיּ֣וֹם בֹּאֲךָ֔ אֵלַ֖י עַד־הַיּ֥וֹם הַזֶּ֖ה

“and your going out and your coming in with me in the camp {is} good in my eyes, for I have not found evil in you from the day of your coming to me to this day”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [and since I have not found evil in you from the day of your coming to me until this day, your going out and your coming in with me in the camp is good in my eyes]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 29:6 (#3)

צֵאתְךָ֥ וּבֹאֲךָ֖ אִתִּ֑י בַּמַּחֲנֶ֔ה

“your going out and your coming in with me in the camp”

Achish is using the term **camp** to represent the army that was staying in the camp. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [your going out and your coming in with me in the army]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 29:7 (#2)

שׁ֣וּב וְלֵ֔ךְ בְּשָׁלֹ֑ום וְלֹא־תַעֲשֶׂ֥ה רָ֖ע בְּעֵינֵ֣י סַרְנֵ֣י פְלִשְׁתִּֽים

“return and go in peace, so you do not do evil in the eyes of the lords of the Philistines”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [so that you do not do evil in the eyes of the lords of the Philistines, return and go in peace]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 29:7 (#3)

שׁ֣וּב וְלֵ֔ךְ בְּשָׁלֹ֑ום

“return and go in peace”

The author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. In your translation, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [go in peace and return]

See: Order of Events

1 Samuel 29:7 (#1)

וְעַתָּ֖ה

“And now”

Achish is using a common expression of his culture to introduce his main topic. See how you translated this expression in 6:7. Alternate translation: [So this is what I would like you to do]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 29:7 (#4)

בְּשָׁלֹום

“in peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [peacefully]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 29:7 (#5)

רָעָ֥ע בְּעֵינֵי֙ סַרְנֵ֣י פְלִשְׁתִּ֔ים

“evil in the eyes of the lords of the Philistines”

See how you translated the similar expressions in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [anything that the lords of the Philistines consider to be wrong]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 29:8 (#3)

הָיִ֖יתִי לְפָנֶ֑יךָ

“I was to your face”

David is using the term **face** to represent Achish’s presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I came into your presence] or [I became your servant]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 29:8 (#1)

כִּ֣י מֶ֣ה עָשִׂ֔יתִי וּמַה־מָּצָ֥אתָ בְעַבְדְּךָ֖ מִיּ֣וֹם אֲשֶׁר֩ הָיִ֨יתִי לְפָנֶ֜יךָ עַד־הַיּ֣וֹם הַזֶּ֗ה כִּ֣י לֹ֤א אָבוֹא֙ וְנִלְחַ֣מְתִּי בְּאֹיְבֵ֔י אֲדֹנִ֖י הַמֶּֽלֶךְ

“But what have I done? And what have you found in your servant from the day when I was to your face to this day, that I may not come and fight with the enemies of my lord the king”

David is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [But I have done nothing wrong! And you have found nothing in your servant from the day when I was to your face up to this day, that I may not come and fight with the enemies of my master the king!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 29:8 (#2)

בְעַבְדְּךָ֖ & אֲדֹנִ֖י הַמֶּֽלֶךְ

“in your servant & my lord the king”

David is speaking about himself humbly in the third person and to Achish respectfully in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these expressions in the first and second persons. Alternate translation: [in me, your servant ... you, my master, the king]

See: First, Second or Third Person

1 Samuel 29:9 (#1)

וַיַּ֥עַן אָכִ֛ישׁ וַיֹּ֥אמֶר אֶל־דָּוִ֖ד

“And Achish answered and said to David”

The expression **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this expression explicitly. Alternate translation: [And Achish replied to David]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 29:9 (#2)

טָ֣וֹב אַתְּתָ֔ה בְּעֵינַ֖י

“you {are} good in my eyes”

See how you translated the similar expressions in 29:6 and 29:7. Alternate translation: [you are acceptable to me]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 29:9 (#4)

אָמְר֣וּ לֹא־יַעֲלֶ֥ה עִמָּ֛נוּ בַּמִּלְחָמָ֖ה

“have said, ‘He shall not go up with us into the battle”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [have said that you must not go up with us into the battle]

See: Quotes within Quotes

1 Samuel 29:9 (#5)

לֹא־יַעֲלֶ֥ה עִמָּ֛נוּ בַּמִּלְחָמָ֖ה

“He shall not go up with us into the battle”

By saying **go up**, the Philistine lords are marking travel for change in elevation. In this instance, they are referring to marching up from the coastal plain into Israel. In 29:4, they were envisioning going down into the valley to fight. Express this in a way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [He shall not go with us into the battle]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 29:9 (#3)

כְּמַלְאַךְ֙ אֱלֹהִ֔ים

“like an angel of God”

The point of this comparison is that just as an angel of God is completely innocent and trustworthy, so David has been completely innocent and trustworthy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [like an innocent, trustworthy angel of God]

See: Simile

1 Samuel 29:10 (#1)

וְעַבְדֵ֣י אֲדֹנֶ֗יךָ אֲשֶׁר־בָּ֤אוּ אִתָּךְ֙

“with the servants of your master who came with you”

By **the servants of your master**, Achish means the other men who formerly served Saul but who came with David to serve Achish. The other Philistine lords were suspicious of the loyalty of all such men. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [with the other men who formerly served Saul but who came with you to serve me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel - Chapter 30 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the part of the book that describes how David became king (chapters 16–31). It describes how David and his men discovered that the Amalekites had attacked their town of Ziklag while they were away. The Amalekites had captured their families and animals and burned down all the buildings in the town. David received guidance from Yahweh that he would be able to pursue and defeat the Amalekites and recover the family members and animals. Yahweh made it possible for him to do that and also to capture a great amount of further plunder from the Amalekites.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

How did Yahweh guide David to pursue the Amalekites?

When David wanted to find out whether he should pursue the Amalekites to try to recover the family members and animals they had captured, he asked Abiathar the priest to bring the ephod to him (30:7). This suggests that David wanted Abiathar to use the Urim and Thummim to answer yes-and-no questions that he would ask Yahweh. The author says that David asked Yahweh, “Shall I pursue after this band? Will I overtake it?” He says that Yahweh replied, “Pursue, for overtaking, you will overtake, and delivering, you will deliver.” But this might be a summary of a series of questions and answers. David may have first asked Yahweh, “Shall I pursue after this band?” Abiathar would then have drawn out whichever stone, the Urim or the Thummim, that they had asked Yahweh to use to indicate “yes.” David would then have asked Yahweh, “Will I overtake it?” The answer once again would have been “yes.” Finally, David would have asked, “Will I deliver the captured people and animals?” And Yahweh would have said “yes.” Represent this in your translation in a way that would be clear and natural in your language.

1 Samuel 30:1 (#2)

בַּיּ֣וֹם הַשְּׁלִישִׁ֔י

“on the third day”

The author is describing a particular time according to the conventions of his culture. See how you translated this in 4:7. Alternate translation: [on the second day after they left the Philistine army]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 30:1 (#1)

וַיְהִ֗י

“And it happened”

The author is introducing a new development in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method here that is natural in your language for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 30:1 (#3)

וַעֲמָלֵקִ֖י

“that the Amalekite”

The author is not referring to a specific **Amalekite**. He means Amalekites in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using a plural form. Alternate translation: [the Amalekites]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 30:1 (#4)

וַיַּכּוּ

“and they had struck”

By **struck**, the author means that they had attacked. See how you translated that term in 23:2. Alternate translation: [and they had attacked]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 30:1 (#5)

וַיִּשְׂרְפוּ אֹתָהּ בָּאֵשׁ

“and burned it with fire”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [and burned it down] or [and set it on fire]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 30:2 (#2)

מִקָּטֹן וְעַד־גָּדוֹל

“from small and to great”

Here the terms **small** and **great** refer to people’s ages. The author is speaking of two extremes in order to mean them and everything in between. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and all the other people of all ages]

See: Merism

1 Samuel 30:2 (#3)

אִישׁ

“a man”

Here the masculine term **man** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women, as in the UST.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Samuel 30:2 (#1)

מִקָּטֹן וְעַד־גָּדוֹל

“from small and to great”

The author is not using this phrase to describe the **women** of the city. He is using it to describe the other dependent family members, including children and older adults, whom David’s men had left behind when they marched out with the Philistine army. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and all the other people, from small and to great]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 30:3 (#1)

וְהִנֵּה

“and behold”

The author is using the term **behold** to focus readers’ attention on what he is about to say. See how you translated the same term in 2:31. Alternate translation: [and this was the situation]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 30:3 (#4)

וּנְשֵׁיהֶם וּבְנֵיהֶם וּבְנֹתֵיהֶם נִשְׁבּוּ

“And their wives and their sons and their daughters had been taken captive”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the Amalekites had taken their wives and their sons and their daughters captive]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 30:3 (#2)

שְׂרוּפָה בָּאֵשׁ

“it was burned with fire”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the Amalekites had burned it with fire]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 30:3 (#3)

שְׂרוּפָה בָּאֵשׁ

“it was burned with fire”

See how you translated this expression in 30:1. Alternate translation: [it was burned down]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 30:4 (#2)

וַיִּשָּׂא & קוֹלָם וַיִּבְכּוּ

“And & lifted up their voices and wept”

The author is speaking as if the people had physically **lifted** their **voices** upward. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And ... increased the volume of their voices and wept]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 30:4 (#3)

וַיִּשְׂאוּ & קוֹלָם וַיִּבְכּוּ

“And & lifted up their voices and wept”

This expression conveys a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The words **lifted up their voices** tell in what way the people **wept**. Alternate translation: [And ... wept very loudly]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 30:4 (#1)

וְהָעָם

“and the people”

By **the people**, the author means the fighting men who accompanied David. See how you translated this in 13:2. Alternate translation: [and the fighting men]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 30:5 (#2)

אֵשֶׁת נָבָל

“the wife of Nabal”

Your language may have its own term or expression for this relationship. See how you translated this in 27:3. Alternate translation: [the widow of Nabal]

See: Kinship

1 Samuel 30:5 (#1)

וּשְׁתֵּי נְשֵׁי־דָוִד נִשְׁבָּוּ

“And the two wives of David had been taken captive”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And the Amalekites had taken David’s two wives captive]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 30:6 (#3)

אָמְרוּ הָעָם לְסָקְלֹו

“the people said to stone him”

It may be more natural in your language to have a direct quotation here. Alternate translation: [the people said, “Stone him!”]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Samuel 30:6 (#2)

וַתֵּצַר לְדָוִד מְאֹד

“And it was very narrow to David”

The author is using **it was narrow to David** as a common expression of his culture to mean “David was in a dangerous situation.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression in 13:6. Alternate translation: [And David was in a tight situation] or [And David was in very dangerous circumstances]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 30:6 (#4)

מָמָרָה נֶפֶשׁ כָּל־הָעָם

“the soul of all of the people {was} bitter”

The author is using one part of the people, their **soul**, to mean all of them in the act of being bitter. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all of the people were bitter]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 30:6 (#1)

וַתֵּצַר לְדָוִד מְאֹד כִּי־אָמְרוּ הָעָם לְסָקְלֹו כִּי־מָמָרָה נֶפֶשׁ כָּל־הָעָם אִישׁ עַל־בְּנוֹ וְעַל־בְּנֹתָיו

“And it was very narrow to David, for the people said to stone him, for the soul of all of the people {was} bitter, a man for his sons and for his daughters”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [And the soul of all of the people {was} bitter, a man for his sons and for his daughters, so the people said to stone David, so it was very narrow to him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 30:6 (#5)

עַל־בְּנוֹ וְעַל־בְּנֹתָיו

“for his sons and for his daughters”

The author is speaking of two extremes, **sons** and **daughters**, in order to mean all family members. See 30:22, which shows that this included their wives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for his family]

See: Merism

1 Samuel 30:7 (#1)

אֶבְיָתָר הַכֹּהֵן בֶּן־אֲחִימֶלֶךְ

“Abiathar the priest, the son of Ahimelech”

Here the author is reintroducing **Abiathar** as a participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of reintroducing participants that you can use in your translation.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Samuel 30:8 (#2)

הַשֵּׂגֵ֥ג תַּשִּׂ֖יג וְהַצֵּ֣ל תַּצִּ֑יל

“overtaking, you will overtake, and delivering, you will deliver”

Yahweh is repeating forms of the verbs **overtake** and **deliver** in order to intensify his expression of the ideas that they convey. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [you will certainly overtake, and you will certainly deliver]

See: Reduplication

1 Samuel 30:8 (#1)

רְדֹ֣ף כִּי־הַשֵּׂגֵ֥ג תַּשִּׂ֖יג וְהַצֵּ֣ל תַּצִּ֑יל

“Pursue, for overtaking, you will overtake, and delivering, you will deliver”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since overtaking, you will overtake, and delivering, you will deliver, pursue]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 30:9 (#2)

וְהַנְּוֹתָרִ֖ים עָמָֽדוּ

“And the ones left behind stayed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And some stayed, so the others left them behind]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 30:9 (#3)

עָמָֽדוּ

“stayed”

Since the story indicates in the next verse that these men stayed behind because they were too exhausted to continue, you do not need to explain that reason here.

See: When to Keep Information Implicit

1 Samuel 30:9 (#1)

וְהַנְּוֹתָרִ֖ים עָמָֽדוּ

“And the ones left behind stayed”

The author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. In your translation, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [And some stayed and were left behind]

See: Order of Events

1 Samuel 30:11 (#2)

וַיִּמְצְאוּ

“And they found”

The author does not mean that David and his men were looking for people out in the **field** and that they **found** this man. He means that they met or encountered him. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. See how you translated the similar expression in 9:11. Alternate translation: [And they encountered]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 30:11 (#1)

וַיִּמְצְאוּ

“And they found”

The pronoun **they** refers to some of David's men. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And some of David's men found]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 30:11 (#3)

אִישׁ־מִצְרִי

"a man, an Egyptian"

Here the author is introducing an Egyptian man as a new participant in the story. Your language may have its own way of introducing new participants that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [a certain Egyptian man]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

1 Samuel 30:11 (#4)

וַיִּתְּנוּ־לוֹ לֶחֶם וַיֹּאכַל וַיַּשְׁקֻהוּ מָיִם

"And they gave bread to him, and he ate, and they had him drink water"

Since it is likely that the man could not have eaten the **bread** before he had drunk the **water**, it seems that the author is describing one event before describing another event that preceded it. In your translation, you may wish to relate these events in the order in which they happened. Alternate translation: [And they had him drink water, and they gave bread to him, and he ate]

See: Order of Events

1 Samuel 30:12 (#1)

וַתָּתָשֹׁב רוּחוֹ אֵלָיו

"and his spirit returned to him"

The author is speaking as if the man's **spirit** had left him and then **returned**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he regained his strength]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 30:12 (#2)

כִּי

"For"

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but a further explanation. Alternate translation: [He had been so weak because]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 30:12 (#3)

לֹא־אָכַל לֶחֶם וְלֹא־שָׁתָה מַיִם שְׁלֹשָׁה יָמִים וּשְׁלֹשָׁה לֵילוֹת

"he had not eaten bread and had not drunk water three days and three nights"

The author is using a common expression of his culture to describe a period of time. See how you translated the similar expression in 4:7. Alternate translation: [this was the first time since two days earlier that he had eaten any bread or drunk any water]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 30:12 (#4)

לֶחֶם

"bread"

Since he refers to a **fig cake** and **raisin clusters** earlier in the verse, here the author is using one kind of food, **bread**, to mean food in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [food]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 30:13 (#2)

עֲמָלֵקִי

"the Amalekite"

The Egyptian man is not referring to a specific **Amalekite**. He means Amalekites in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using a plural form. Alternate translation: [the Amalekites]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 30:13 (#4)

הַיּוֹם שְׁלִשִׁי

"the third day"

The author is using a common expression of his culture to mark time. See how you translated this in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [the day before yesterday]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 30:13 (#3)

וַיַּעַזְבֵנִי אֲדֹנִי כִּי חָלִיתִי הַיּוֹם שְׁלֹשָׁה

"But my master abandoned me the third day because I became sick"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [But because I became sick, my master abandoned me the third day]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 30:13 (#1)

וְאַיֵּ֣י מִזֶּ֔ה אָתָּ֖ה

“And where from this {are} you”

The author is using a common expression of his culture to ask about someone’s origin. See how you translated the similar expression in 25:11. Alternate translation: [And where are you from]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 30:14 (#1)

הַכְּרֵתִ֑י

“the Kerethite”

The author is not referring to a specific **Kerethite**. He means Kerethites in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using a plural form as in the UST.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 30:14 (#2)

כָּלֵ֖ב

“Caleb”

The author is using the name of the ancestor **Caleb** to refer to his descendants. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Calebites]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 30:14 (#3)

שָׂרַ֥פְנוּ בָאֵֽשׁ

“we burned with fire”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. See how you translated the similar expression in 30:3. Alternate translation: [we burned down] or [we set on fire]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 30:15 (#2)

הִשָּׁבְעָה־לִּ֣י בֵאלֹהִ֔ים אִם־תְּמִיתֵ֥נִי וְאִם־תַּסְגִּרֵ֖נִי בְּיַד־אֲדֹנִ֑י

“Swear to me by God, if you will cause me to die and if you will enclose me in the hand of my master”

Following the custom of his culture, the Egyptian man is asking David to swear an oath by stating the first part of a condition (“if”) but not the second part (“then”). If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explicitly state the second part of this condition. You could also state the basic meaning of the oath. Alternate translation: [Swear to me by God, “If I cause you to die, or if I deliver you into the hand of your master, then may God punish me severely!”] or [Swear to me by God that you will not cause me to die and that you will not deliver me into the hand of my master]

See: Oath Formulas

1 Samuel 30:15 (#3)

וְאִם־תַּסְגִּרֵ֖נִי בְּיַד־אֲדֹנִ֑י

“and if you will enclose me in the hand of my master”

The man is speaking as if he were an object that could be enclosed in his master’s hand. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar expression in 17:46. Alternate translation: [and if you will give you into my master’s power] or [and if will enable my master to overpower me]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 30:15 (#1)

הִשָּׁבְעָה־לִּ֣י בֵאלֹהִ֔ים אִם־תְּמִיתֵ֥נִי וְאִם־תַּסְגִּרֵ֖נִי בְּיַד־אֲדֹנִ֑י

“Swear to me by God, if you will cause me to die and if you will enclose me in the hand of my master”

It may be more natural in your language to have a direct quotation here. Alternate translation: [Swear to me by God, “If I cause you to die, or if I deliver you into the hand of your master!”]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

1 Samuel 30:16 (#3)

עַל־פְּנֵ֖י כָּל־הָאָֽרֶץ

“over the face of all of the land”

See how you translated the similar expression in 14:25. Alternate translation: [over the surface of all of the land]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 30:16 (#4)

עַל־פְּנֵי כָל־הָאָרֶץ

“over the face of all of the land”

The author is making an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [in widely scattered groups]

See: Hyperbole

1 Samuel 30:16 (#2)

וַיֹּרְדֵֽהוּ

“And he brought him down”

The author is using one part of David’s group, David himself, to mean David and his men. You could indicate this by using a plural pronoun. Alternate translation: [And he brought them down]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 30:16 (#5)

אֹכְלִים וְשֹׁתִים וְחֹגְגִים בְּכֹל הַשָּׁלָל הַגָּדוֹל אֲשֶׁר לָקְחוּ מֵאֶרֶץ פְּלִשְׁתִּים וּמֵאֶרֶץ יְהוּדָה

“eating and drinking and celebrating for all of the great plunder that they had taken from the land of the Philistines and from the land of Judah”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. It may be helpful to begin a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Because of all of the great plunder that they had taken from the land of the Philistines and from the land of Judah, they were eating and drinking and celebrating]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 30:16 (#1)

וַיֹּרְדֵֽהוּ

“And he brought him down”

The pronoun **he** refers to the Egyptian man, while the pronoun **him** refers to David. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the Egyptian man brought David down]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 30:17 (#2)

וַיַּכֵּם דָּוִד

“And David struck them”

In this context, by **struck**, the author means that they killed them. See how you translated this in 4:10. Alternate translation: [And David and his men killed them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 30:17 (#3)

מֵהַנֶּשֶׁף וְעַד־הָעֶרֶב לְמָחֳרָתָם

“from twilight and until the evening of the next day of them”

Here the author is describing a period of time according to the conventions of his culture. Since the term **twilight** could describe either dawn or dusk, to be clear that he does not mean from dawn until evening on the day after David discovered the Amalekites, he says **the next day of them**, meaning the next or second of the two days on which David first discovered the Amalekites and then finished slaughtering them. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate that explicitly in your translation. Alternate translation: [from the time it got dark that day until the evening of the following day]

See: Idiom

1 Samuel 30:17 (#5)

אֲשֶׁר־רָכְבוּ עַל־הַגְּמַלִּים וַיָּנֻסוּ

“who rode on camels and fled”

This expression conveys a single idea by using two phrases connected with **and**. The phrase **rode on camels** tells in what way the men **fled**. Alternate translation: [who fled by riding on camels]

See: Hendiadys

1 Samuel 30:17 (#1)

וַיַּכֵּם דָּוִד

“And David struck them”

The author is using one part of David’s group, David himself, to mean him and his men. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And David and his men struck them]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 30:17 (#4)

וְלֹא־נִמְלַט מֵהֶם֙ אִ֣ישׁ כִּֽי־אִ֔ם אַרְבַּ֥ע מֵא֖וֹת אִ֑ישׁ

“And a man did not escape from them except 400 men”

If it would appear in your language that the author was making a statement and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [And the only ones who escaped from them were 400 men]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

1 Samuel 30:18 (#1)

עֲמָלֵ֑ק

“Amalek”

The author is using the name of the ancestor **Amalek** to refer to his descendants. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language as in the UST.

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 30:19 (#1)

וְלֹ֥א נֶעְדַּר־לָהֶ֖ם

“And nothing was missing to them”

If your language does not use this passive form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And they were not missing anything]

See: Active or Passive

1 Samuel 30:19 (#2)

מִן־הַקָּטֹ֥ן וְעַד־הַגָּדֹ֖ול וְעַד־בָּנִ֣ים וּבָנ֑וֹת

“from small and to great and to sons and daughters”

The author is speaking of two pairs extremes in order to mean them and everything in between. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [including all of the captives of every age and sex]

See: Merism

1 Samuel 30:19 (#3)

וּמִשָּׁלָ֔ל וְעַ֖ד כֹּל־אֲשֶׁ֣ר לָקְחוּ־לָהֶ֑ם

“and from plunder and to all that they had taken for themselves”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. If it would be clearer in your language, you could combine them. Alternate translation: [and including all of their plundered possessions]

See: Parallelism

1 Samuel 30:20 (#1)

לְפָנַ֔י

“to the face of”

The author is using the term **face** to represent the front of something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 30:20 (#2)

הַמִּקְנֶ֣ה הַהֹ֑וא

“that livestock”

By **that livestock**, the author means their own recaptured livestock. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [their own recaptured livestock]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 30:21 (#1)

אַחֲרֵ֖י דָּוִ֑ד

“behind David”

Since the author has already mentioned David by name earlier in the sentence, it may be natural in your language to refer to him by a pronoun here. Alternate translation: [behind him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 30:21 (#2)

לְשָׁלֹ֔ום

“about peace”

See how you translated this expression in 17:18. Alternate translation: [how they were doing] or [if they were well]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 30:22 (#2)

וַיֹּאמְר֣וּ

“and said”

The expression **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this expression explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

1 Samuel 30:22 (#3)

לֹא־נִתֵּן לָהֶם מֵהַשָּׁלָל אֲשֶׁר הִצַּלְנוּ כִּי־אִם־אִישׁ אֶת־אִשְׁתּוֹ וְאֶת־בָּנָיו

“we will not give to them from the plunder that we have rescued except a man, his wife and his sons”

If it would appear in your language that the men were making a statement and then contradicting it, you could reword this as a positive statement. Alternate translation: [the only thing we will give to them from the plunder that we have rescued is a man, his wife and his sons]

See: Connect — Exception Clauses

1 Samuel 30:22 (#1)

אִישׁ־רָעָה וּבְלִיַּעַל

“the evil and wicked men”

The terms **evil** and **wicked** mean similar things. The author is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [the very wicked men]

See: Doublet

1 Samuel 30:22 (#4)

אֲאִישׁ אֶת־אִשְׁתּוֹ וְאֶת־בָּנָיו

“a man, his wife and his sons”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [that a man may take his wife and his sons]

See: Ellipsis

1 Samuel 30:22 (#5)

וְאֶת־בָּנָיו

“and his sons”

Here the masculine term **sons** has a generic sense that includes both sons and daughters. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both male and female children. Alternate translation: [and his children]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

1 Samuel 30:22 (#6)

וְיִנָּהֵגוּ

“that they may lead away”

Since this refers back to **a man**, it may be more natural in your language to use a singular pronoun here. Alternate translation: [that he may lead away]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

1 Samuel 30:23 (#1)

אֲחֵי

“my brothers”

Although David is the leader of this group of men, he is not using his authority to insist that they do as he says. Instead, he addresses the men who do not want to share the plunder as his **brothers**. In this context, the term means more than that they are fellow Israelites. David is using it to mean men who have just fought together (“brothers in arms”), as he describes in the next sentence. Your language may have a comparable term that you can use here in your translation.

See: Politeness

1 Samuel 30:23 (#3)

בְּיָדֵנוּ

“into our hand”

David is using the term **hand** to represent power and control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [into our power]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 30:23 (#2)

וַיִּשְׁמֹר

“For he has kept”

Here the word **For** introduces not a reason but a further explanation. Alternate translation: [After all he has kept]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

1 Samuel 30:24 (#1)

וּמִי יִשְׁמַע לָכֶם לַדָּבָר הַזֶּה

“Now who will listen to you regarding this matter”

David is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Now no one will listen to you regarding this matter!]

See: Rhetorical Question

1 Samuel 30:25 (#2)

לְחֹק וּלְמִשְׁפָּט לְיִשְׂרָאֵל

“for a statute and for an ordinance for Israel”

The terms **statute** and **ordinance** mean similar things. The author is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [for a practice for the Israelites to observe]

See: Doublet

1 Samuel 30:25 (#1)

מֵהַיּוֹם הַהוּא וָמָעְלָה וַיְשִׂמֶהָ לְחֹק וּלְמִשְׁפָּט לְיִשְׂרָאֵל

“from that day and beyond, that he set it for a statute and for an ordinance for Israel”

It may be more natural in your language to put the information about David establishing this statute and ordinance before the information about when it began. Alternate translation: [that he set it for a statute and for an ordinance for Israel from that day and beyond]

See: Information Structure

1 Samuel 30:25 (#3)

עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה

“to this day”

The author is using this phrase to refer to the time when he was writing. In your translation, make clear that the phrase refers to a time that is now in the past. Avoid giving the impression the phrase means “to the present day.” Alternate translation: [and the Israelites still share plunder in this way at the time of this writing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 30:26 (#1)

בְּרָכָה

“a blessing”

The author is using the term **blessing** to represent a gift. See how you translated this in 25:27. Alternate translation: [a gift]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 30:29 (#1)

הַיְרַחְמְאֵלִי & הַקֵּינִי

“the Jerahmeelite & the Kenite”

The author is not referring to specific **Jerahmeelite** or **Kenite**. He means Jerahmeelites and Kenites in general. It may be more natural in your language to express this meaning by using plural forms. Alternate translation: [the Jerahmeelites ... the Kenites]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

1 Samuel 30:31 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר־הִתְהַלַּךְ־שָׁמָּה דָּוִד

“where David had walked about there”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [where David had walked about]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel - Chapter 31 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues the part of the book that describes how David became king (chapters 16–31). The details of how he ultimately became king are told in the book of 2 Samuel. But this chapter is the end of the part of that story that involves Saul. It describes how Saul and his sons were killed in battle with the Philistines.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Why did the men of Jabesh Gilead get Saul’s body from Beth Shan?

After the Philistines killed Saul and his sons on Mount Gilboa, the Israelites who lived in that area fled across the Jordan River for safety. The Philistines occupied their cities and towns all the way to Beth Shan, a few miles from the Jordan. They hung the bodies of Saul and his sons on the wall of Beth Shan as a way of celebrating their victory, claiming that territory, and warning the Israelites against any further opposition. However, they were also disgracing and dishonoring

Saul's body by not burying it. The people of Jabesh Gilead were still grateful to Saul for rescuing them years before from the Ammonite king Nahash (11:1–11). To honor him, their soldiers marched all night to Beth Shan and, at great risk to themselves from the Philistines, took down his body and the bodies of his sons and brought them back to Jabesh Gilead for a proper and honorable burial.

1 Samuel 31:1 (#3)

חֲלָלִים

"pierced"

The author is using the term **pierced** to represent those who died from being pierced by swords or other weapons. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [dead]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 31:1 (#1)

וּפְלִשְׁתִּים נִלְחָמִים בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל

"Now the Philistines were fighting with Israel"

The author is resuming the story of the Philistine attack against Israel after relating in the previous two chapters the episode of David and his men leaving the Philistine army and rescuing their families and possessions from the Amalekites. The author is resuming the action from where it left off at 29:1, where the Israelites and Philistines were facing each other in battle positions. Use a word, phrase, or other method here that is natural in your language for resuming a story after relating another episode.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 31:1 (#2)

מִפְּנֵי פְּלִשְׁתִּים

"from the face of the Philistines"

The author is using one part of the Philistines, their **face**, to mean all of them in the act of attacking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from the attacking Philistines]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 31:2 (#1)

וַיַּכּוּ פְּלִשְׁתִּים

"And the Philistines struck"

By **struck**, the author means that the Philistine soldiers killed these men. See how you translated the term in 4:2. Alternate translation: [And the Philistines killed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 31:3 (#2)

וַיִּמְצָאֻהוּ הַמּוֹרִים אַנְשֵׁי הַקָּשֶׁת & מֵהַמּוֹרִים

"And the shooters, the men with the bow, found him & from the shooters"

Since the term **shooters** could describe either soldiers throwing javelins or soldiers launching arrows, the author adds the phrase **the men with the bow** to clarify his meaning. Your language may have a single term that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [And the archers found him ... from the archers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 31:3 (#1)

וַתִּכְבַּד הַמִּלְחָמָה אֶל־שָׁאוּל

"And the battle was heavy against Saul"

The author is speaking of the battle as if it were a **heavy** physical weight pressing down on Saul. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the Philistines fought fiercely against Saul]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 31:3 (#3)

וַיָּחֶל מְאֹד מֵהַמּוֹרִים

"And he writhed greatly from the shooters"

By this phrase, the author means that Saul was in great pain because the archers had wounded him with arrows. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And he writhed greatly in pain because the archers had wounded him with arrows]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 31:4 (#3)

הָעֲרֵלִים הָאֵלֶּה

"these uncircumcised {ones"

Saul is using the adjective **uncircumcised** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. See how you translated this in 14:6. Alternate translation: [these uncircumcised Philistines]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 31:4 (#1)

שְׁלֹף חַרְבְּךָ ׀ וְדָקְרֵנִי בָהּ פֶּן־יָבֹואוּ הָעֲרֵלִים הָאֵלֶּה וּדְקָרֵנִי וְהִתְעַלְּלוּ־בִי

“Draw your sword and stab me with it, lest these uncircumcised {ones} come and stab me and abuse me”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [So that these uncircumcised ones do not come and stab me and abuse me, draw your sword and stab me with it]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 31:4 (#4)

הָעֲרֵלִים הָאֵלֶּה

“these uncircumcised {ones”

Saul is using this expression as a term of derision. See how you translated it in 14:6. Alternate translation: [these heathen]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 31:4 (#5)

וְהִתְעַלְּלוּ־בִי

“and abuse me”

By **abuse**, Saul means that the Philistines would taunt and torture him. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and taunt and torture me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 31:4 (#6)

וְלֹא אָבָה נֹשֵׂא כֵלָיו כִּי יָרֵא מְאֹד

“But the carrier of his equipment was not willing, for he feared greatly”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [But since the carrier of his equipment feared greatly, he was not willing]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

1 Samuel 31:4 (#7)

אֶת־הַחֶרֶב

“the sword”

By **the sword**, the author means Saul’s own sword. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation, as in the UST, if that would be helpful to your readers.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 31:4 (#2)

וְדָקְרֵנִי

“and stab me”

Saul is using the first part of killing someone with a sword, to **stab** that person, to mean the entire act of killing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as in the UST.

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 31:6 (#1)

גַּם כָּל־אֲנָשָׁיו

“even all of his men”

By **all of his men**, the author means the rest of Saul’s bodyguard, not his entire army. (The later narrative makes clear that many of them, including his general Abner, survived.) You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the rest of his bodyguard]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 31:7 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר־בְּעֵבֶר הָעֵמֶק וַאֲשֶׁר ׀ בְּעֵבֶר הַיַּרְדֵּן

“who {were} on the other side of the valley and who {were} on the other side of the Jordan”

By these phrases, the author means the Israelites who lived in the territory north of the Valley of Jezreel and west of the Jordan River. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [who lived in the territory north of the Valley of Jezreel and west of the Jordan River]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 31:8 (#3)

אֶת־הַחֲלָלִים

“the pierced”

The author is using the term **pierced** to represent those who died from being pierced. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the dead]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 31:8 (#4)

נֹפְלִ֣ים

“fallen”

The author is using the term **fallen** to represent those who had died in battle, since soldiers fall down when they die. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [dead]

See: Metonymy

1 Samuel 31:8 (#1)

וַיְהִי֙

“And it happened”

The author is introducing a new development in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method here that is natural in your language for introducing a new development.

See: Introduction of a New Event

1 Samuel 31:8 (#2)

אֶת־הַחֲלָלִ֔ים

“the pierced”

The author is using the adjective **pierced** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [those whom they had pierced]

See: Nominal Adjectives

1 Samuel 31:9 (#1)

בֵּ֣ית עֲצַבֵּיהֶ֑ם

“to} the house of their idols”

The author is speaking of the temple in which the Philistines worshiped their idols as if it were a **house** in which that idol lived. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. (Since the narrative has already shown that the Philistines had multiple idol temples, you may wish to use a plural form.) Alternate translation: [to the temples of their idols]

See: Metaphor

1 Samuel 31:10 (#1)

וַיָּשִׂ֖ימוּ אֶת־כֵּלָ֑יו בְּבֵ֣ית עַשְׁתָּרוֹת֒

“And they put his equipment in the house of the Ashtoreths”

By this phrase, the author means that they put both Saul’s equipment and his head in their temple. The parallel account in 1 Chronicles 10:10 states that explicitly. You could indicate this in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And they put his equipment and his head in the house of the Ashtoreths]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 31:10 (#4)

גְּוִיָּתוֹ֙

“his corpse”

The author is using the body of one person that the Philistines fastened to the wall, Saul’s **corpse**, to represent the bodies of Saul and his sons. The author indicates in 31:12 that the Philistines also fastened his sons’ bodies to the wall. Alternate translation: [his corpse and the corpses of his sons]

See: Synecdoche

1 Samuel 31:10 (#2)

וַיָּשִׂ֖ימוּ אֶת־כֵּלָ֑יו בְּבֵ֣ית עַשְׁתָּרוֹת֒

“And they put his equipment in the house of the Ashtoreths”

Putting the armor (and, apparently in this case, the head) of a defeated enemy leader in a temple or sanctuary was a symbolic action that attributed the victory over this enemy to the help of the deity whom people worshiped in that temple or sanctuary. This is what David did with Goliath’s sword and head, as the author describes in 17:54. See how you described the similar action there. Alternate translation: [And they put his equipment and head in the house of the Ashtoreths as trophies of war]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 31:10 (#3)

וְאֶת־גְּוִיָּתוֹ֙ תָּקְע֔וּ בְּחוֹמַ֖ת בֵּ֥ית שָֽׁן

“and they fastened his corpse on the wall of Beth Shan”

The city of **Beth Shan** was a few miles west of the Jordan River. The narrative suggests in 31:7 that the Philistines had occupied this city. By hanging on the city wall the body of the Israelite king they had killed, they were asserting that they had conquered Israelite territory extending this far. (This act was probably also intended to terrify the surrounding Israelite population into non-resistance.) If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [and they fastened his corpse on the wall of Beth Shan to assert that they had conquered the territory extending that far]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 31:11 (#1)

אֵלָ֑יו & אֵ֥את אֲשֶׁר־עָשׂ֖וּ פְּלִשְׁתִּֽים

“about it, what the Philistines had done”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [about what the Philistines had done]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

1 Samuel 31:12 (#2)

אִ֣ישׁ חַ֔יִל

“the men of valor”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **valor**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the valiant men]

See: Abstract Nouns

1 Samuel 31:12 (#1)

וַיָּקֻ֖מוּ כָּל־אִ֣ישׁ חַ֑יִל

“And all of the men of valor arose”

By this phrase, the author means that these men took action. See how you translated the term **arose** in 1:9. Alternate translation: [And all of the men of valor took action]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 31:12 (#3)

וַיִּשְׂרְפ֥וּ אֹתָ֖ם שָֽׁם

“and they burned them there”

The Israelites probably **burned** the bodies in this instance, even though that was not their usual practice, in order to prevent any further desecration of them by the Philistines. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and they burned them there to prevent the Philistines from desecrating them any further]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

1 Samuel 31:13 (#1)

תַּ֖חַת־הָאֶ֥שֶׁל

“under the tamarisk tree”

Sitting under a **tamarisk tree** was symbolic of royal status, as the story indicates in 22:6. By burying Saul under that kind of tree, the people of Jabesh Gilead were giving him royal honors in his death. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [under the tamarisk tree in Jabesh to honor Saul’s royal status]

See: Symbolic Action

1 Samuel 31:13 (#2)

וַיָּצ֥וֹמוּ שִׁבְעַ֖ת יָמִֽים

“And they fasted seven days”

The people of Jabesh Gilead **fasted seven days** to show respect to Saul and to express their grief over his death. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action. Alternate translation: [And they fasted seven days as a sign of mourning and respect]

See: Symbolic Action